LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY

Thursday 22 October 2026

The Speaker (The Hon. Gregory Michael Piper) took the chair at 10:00.

The Speaker read the prayer and acknowledgement of country.

[*Notices of motions given.*]

Bills

RESIDENTIAL TENANCIES AMENDMENT (RENT CONTROL) BILL 2026

First Reading

Bill introduced on motion by Ms Jenny Leong, read a first time and printed.

Second Reading Speech

Ms JENNY LEONG (Newtown) (10:18): I move:

That this bill be now read a second time.

The rent is too damn high in New South Wales and it is getting worse. That is why I introduce the Residential Tenancies Amendment (Rent Control) Bill 2026. I do so as The Greens New South Wales spokesperson on housing and homelessness and as The Greens member for Newtown, where about 60 per cent of people rent. I acknowledge the renters and supporters of rent controls in the public gallery and watching online, including Patricia, who played a key role in getting this bill to where it is today.

I also acknowledge the tenant advocates and the CEO of the Tenants' Union of New South Wales, Leo Patterson Ross, who I believe will be watching online from their conference in Newcastle today.

I acknowledge the powerful work of Everybody's Home, led by Maiy Azize; Shelter NSW; Homelessness NSW; the NSW Council of Social Service; and other housing and frontline services that recognise the growing need for the Government to regulate rents urgently.

The stress on renters is unbearable. Without urgent action it will only get worse. It is impossible to ignore the desperation that many in our communities feel as rents continue to rise, pushing them further into housing stress, poverty and even into homelessness. The hollow phrase "the cost-of-living crisis", uttered by those who pretend to care while choosing to do absolutely nothing about ever-increasing rents, makes me sick to my stomach. There is no greater way for this Parliament to release the pressure valve on our community and deliver much-needed rent relief to millions who struggle every month with the cost of everything, including rents going up faster than wages, than to back the bill before the House to deliver rent controls for the people of New South Wales.

The reform will not cost the Government a single cent. There is no budget block to delivering this reform, yet the benefit to the daily budgets of everyone in this State will be real and felt immediately. Life feels hard. It feels stressful and it is challenging for many people right now. The pressure on anyone renting or anyone who loves someone who is renting is staggering. Sadly, it keeps getting worse. Across Sydney, 45 per cent of private renters live in rental stress, spending more than 30 per cent of their income on rent. Western Sydney has seen rental stress rates higher than 50 per cent. Since Labor was elected to government just three and a bit years ago, median rents in New South Wales have spiked 22 per cent. Imagine wages going up 22 per cent in that time. But no, just the rents have spiked.

The NSW Council of Social Service reports that almost one million people live in poverty, including one in seven children in this State. More than half are in extreme housing stress, spending more than half of their income on rent, up by one-third since the Minns Government was elected. Those figures are terrifying. They demand an urgent solution. That solution is simple and is before us today. The Greens have done the work to solve the problem by introducing rent controls. Putting a freeze and cap on rents tackles the biggest expense facing one in three households in New South Wales, because rent rises are rapidly outpacing wages year on year.

Rent controls have been proven to be effective. They cost nothing to deliver and have a majority of public support across renters, mortgage holders and outright home owners. The top one per cent who conveniently own a quarter of all property investments wonder why we want to do this. Why do we allow them to unleash unlimited rent increases and extreme stress on half a million renters living in poverty just so they can expand their property empires? That wealth inequality, that generational inequity, that grotesque idea that people living in poverty can go hungry and skip medical appointments or basic essentials and work more and more hours just to keep shelter over their heads while their landlords collect more and more rent from them, is just sickening. Our system allows the one per cent to add millions to their children's trust funds, but by the age of 14 a kid living in rental accommodation will have moved more than six times, on average. That is a disgrace.

It does not stop there. With the financial pressure comes anxiety, stress, escalating mental health crises, social isolation from not being able to go out and have fun, and limits on being able to commute to work or class or travel the long distances that now exist between family, friends and support systems. Without rent controls, more and more people will retire into poverty after a lifetime of working or caring for their family. Without rent controls, essential workers will spend hours going to and from a job that barely pays the bills. Without rent controls, it will be much harder for victim-survivors to leave abusers.

Failing to act on out-of-control rents will further escalate the disadvantage and lack of dignity faced by people living with a disability, people who are unemployed or unable to work, and people who are currently languishing on the ever-growing public housing waiting list. For those at breaking point, there is currently no safety net, no backup and no protection, because the public and social housing waiting list has grown 25 per cent under the Labor Government. Unless we deliver rent controls for the private market, there is no escape from the brutal reality of not being able to afford the rent, or the stress of trying to find a way to scrape together the money to meet the next rent increase. All the while, we see mega-mansions bought up by uber wealthy people in our city, the massive profits of banks and property developers continue to rise, and governments fail to take urgent action to rein them in.

Why are we in this situation? For too long, laws passed in this Parliament have sided with investors and valued housing as a commodity rather than a human right. Shamefully, that is not surprising in light of recent parliamentary disclosures of how many politicians add to their already generous pay packets with passive income from rents. The Greens rent control bill before us today will change all of that. The bill will introduce a temporary freeze on rents for 12 months and then impose an ongoing permanent rent cap of 2 per cent on any rent increases tied to the property each year. It also gives renters a pathway to getting a rent reduction. A rent decrease is never heard of, despite the fact that we hear news of property prices dropping. The bill will also introduce a two-year fixed term lease as the standard, which is in line with the ask from the Australian Council of Trade Unions.

The Greens want to rein in profits of investors and developers. We make no apologies for that. We want to end the ever-rising price of houses and ever-increasing rents. We want to put an end to a system designed to always deliver more profits for developers and more return on investments for landlords. We have had enough. We regulate the cost of so many other essentials: child care, health care, transport and power bills. Even politicians' pay is regulated independently. Why not rents, the largest expense for millions of households? Why allow unlimited rent increases each year for millions of renters who are already under so much pressure? Why is the investor class given special privileges and protections while renters are denied their basic human rights to afford a decent, habitable place to call home?

When asked about the out-of-control costs of housing that are pushing tens of thousands of new applicants onto the social housing waiting list, the housing Minister said:

> We don't have control over that, sadly. I don't have control over how much—cost-of-living pressures are increasing broadly in the economy. There are still significant pressures on the private rental market and private housing. These factors lead people to put their hands up for government housing.

But the Government and this Parliament do have control. Rents are the easiest part of the cost of housing for government to control, and it would not cost a single cent.

The bill that The Greens have brought before the Parliament today proves that there are very straightforward amendments that can happen to the Residential Tenancies Act that would introduce rent controls and relieve the unbearable pressures on millions of people. But up to this point the Premier, the housing Minister and this Labor Government have failed to act. Up to this point they have chosen to keep renters under intolerable stress. The Greens have done the work and brought a rent control bill to the Chamber and to the Parliament. Will the Government and the Opposition continue to wring their hands about the so-called cost-of-living crisis, or will they step up, take responsibility, work with The Greens and pass this rent control bill before Christmas?

There is evidence from Australia and all over the world that rent controls work. Rent controls have been in place in the Australian Capital Territory since 2019, with rents capped at 110 per cent of the rent component of

the consumer price index, which has supported much slower rent growth than other capital cities while having no impact on housing supply. A 2023 Macquarie University study looking at international examples and experiences of rent regulation prepared by the Tenants' Union NSW, Shelter NSW and researchers Dr Alistair Sisson—who I note is present in the gallery today—and Dr Penelope Bowyer-Pont found widespread evidence that rent regulation produces positive outcomes for tenants.

The study identified 25 OECD nations with forms of rent regulation, including Australia, 19 European nations, multiple states and cities across the United States and Canada, South Korea, Argentina and Brazil. It found a general consensus that rent regulation successfully reduces rents, moderates rent growth over time and improves security of tenure. It also found that where rent increases are made contingent on adequate repairs, and larger increases are made contingent on amenity improvements, rent controls improve housing quality across the jurisdiction. Further, it found scant evidence of rent regulation reducing construction activity, despite this claim being a common feature of the public debate. This is consistent with the seven years that we have seen that evidence play out in reality for the people of the Australian Capital Territory.

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Alex Greenwich): Order! It being 10.30 a.m., in accordance with the resolution of the House of 21 October 2025, debate is interrupted for the conduct of the deferred divisions arising from consideration of the Veterinary Services Bill 2026. I set down resumption of the second reading speech as an order of the day for a later hour.

VETERINARY SERVICES BILL 2026

Consideration in Detail

Consideration resumed from 21 October 2026.

[*Deferred division*]

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Alex Greenwich): Order! The House will now proceed with the deferred division on the question: That amendments Nos 1 to 9, 13 to 16, 18, 24 to 27, 29, 31 to 37 and 39 on sheet c2026-301C of the member for Wollondilly be agreed to.

The House divided.

Ayes 35
Noes 45
Majority.....10

AYES

Anderson, K	Henskens, A	Singh, G
Ayyad, T	Hodges, M	Sloane, K
Clancy, J	James, T	Speakman, M
Cooke, S	Kemp, M	Taylor, M
Coure, M	Layzell, D	Toole, P
Crouch, A (teller)	Moylan, B	Tuckerman, W
Dalton, H	Preston, R	Tudehope, M
Davies, T	Provest, G	Wallace, J
Di Pasqua, S	Regan, M	Williams, R
Donato, P	Roberts, A	Williamson, R (teller)
Griffin, J	Saunders, D	Wilson, F
Hannan, J	Scruby, J	

NOES

Aitchison, J	Harris, D	O'Neill, M
Atalla, E	Harrison, J	Park, R
Bali, S	Haylen, J	Quinnell, S
Barr, C	Hoenig, R	Saliba, D
Butler, L	Holland, M	Scully, P
Catley, Y	Kaliyanda, C	Shetty, K
Chanthivong, A	Kamper, S	Smith, T
Cotsis, S	Kirby, W	Stuart, M
Crakanthorp, T	Leong, J	Tesch, L (teller)
Daley, M	Li, J	Vo, T
Davis, D	McDermott, H	Voltz, L

NOES

Dib, J	McInerney, K	Warren, G
Doyle, T	McKeown, K	Washington, K
Finn, J	Mehan, D	Whan, S
Hagarty, N (teller)	Minns, C	Wilkinson, K

PAIRS

Dwyer, R	Hornery, S
Lane, J	Saffin, J
Petinos, E	Watson, A
Thompson, T	Car, P

Amendments negatived.

[*Deferred division*]

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Alex Greenwich): Order! The House will now proceed with the deferred division on the question: That amendments Nos 10, 12, 17, 19 to 23, 28, 30 and 38 on sheet c2026-301C of the member for Wollondilly be agreed to.

Division called for and Standing Order 185 applied.

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Alex Greenwich): There being only five members for the question, the question is resolved in the negative. I direct that the names of those members be recorded in the *Votes and Proceedings*.

Ayes, 5

Mrs H. Dalton
Mr P. Donato
Mrs J. Hannan
Mr M. Regan
Ms J. Scruby

Amendments negatived.

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Alex Greenwich): The question is that clauses 1 to 156 and schedules 1 to 4 be agreed to.

Clauses 1 to 156 and schedules 1 to 4 agreed to.

Third Reading

Mr STEVE WHAN: I move:

That this bill be now read a third time.

Motion agreed to.

RESIDENTIAL TENANCIES AMENDMENT (RENT CONTROL) BILL 2026

Second Reading Speech

Debate resumed from an earlier hour.

Ms JENNY LEONG (Newtown) (10:41): There is a need for rent control in New South Wales. I am sure those working in vet practices would also agree. I spoke about the powerful report commissioned by the Tenants' Union and Shelter NSW and the fact that the evidence for rent control is already in in jurisdictions across this country and the world. We should not be surprised when the private developer lobby and the investor class tell us that rent controls will not work. Because it is true: Rent controls will not work for them. Their greedy desire to extract maximum profit from people living in housing stress will not be satisfied if we implement rent controls. But rent controls will work for renters. That is why The Greens are committed to delivering on this reform.

How is it any different from bosses and heads of industry telling us that regulation of the minimum wage will somehow impact and result in job losses? Are they not the same 1 per cent of corporate interests who, whenever regulations that impact their profits are proposed, say it is simply impossible because of the same neoliberal economics of oversimplified concepts of supply and demand? I borrow a point from Nick Bano in his

book *Against Landlords*. We need to stop allowing those with vested interests to continue the fruitless debate about housing supply, and instead engage with deeper problems of housing wealth. It is time to change course and treat rents like the many other things in this economy that are regulated, from wages to health care to transport to childcare fees.

I turn to the detail of the bill. The bill introduces four major reforms to control rents and improve security of tenure for renters: a temporary rent freeze, a permanent cap of 2 per cent per year max imposed on the property, strengthening tenant rights to reduce excessive rents and introducing a two-year fixed-term lease as the standard. First, by the insertion of new section 41A, it would freeze rents for a period of 12 months from the date of assent of this bill. Rents under the fixed-term agreements commenced before the freeze period would be frozen until the end of the fixed term. Crucially, the freeze—much to the distress of landlords today, who have already been in touch with our office—is backdated to July 2026 so that last-minute increases put through before the assent of the bill will be nullified, with additional rents paid returned to the tenant. This rent freeze will give renters some time to catch up with rent increases that have more than doubled wage increases in recent years.

Secondly, by amending section 41 (1A), the bill would cap rent increases at 2 per cent per year following the rent freeze period. A 2 per cent cap lies at the lower end of the Reserve Bank of Australia's inflation target. Rent controls in the Australian Capital Territory are set at 110 per cent of the rent component of CPI. While that approach has supported the Australian Capital Territory to experience much lower rent increases than the rest of Australia, a 2 per cent cap has the benefit of being tied to the long-term inflation target and stabilising increases year on year. A fixed cap of 2 per cent, rather than being linked to CPI, means renters will not be hit with large increases during periods of high inflation, when their budgets are most under pressure.

Under amended section 41 (3), landlords would not be permitted to pass on a rent increase where they have not maintained the premises, in breach of the tenancy agreement. Landlords should not be permitted to increase rents while a request for repairs is outstanding. Crucially, with the insertion of proposed new section 22A (2A), that limit would apply to rental premises between tenancies, which is absolutely critical. That is referred to in rent control literature as "vacancy control". The amendment removes any incentive to evict a tenant to start a new tenancy at a higher rent. The rent cap will be set to the property. It will not just follow the tenant and allow for never-ending increases.

Where rental premises are subject to a new tenancy agreement, the rent may not exceed the rent of the previous agreement unless there has been a 12-month vacancy. Where there has been a vacancy of greater than 12 months, the maximum rent is the lesser of the previous rent plus 2 per cent per year of vacancy, or the median rent for similar premises, per the Government's published rent tables. Under amended section 42, to pass on a higher than 2 per cent increase, landlords would be required to make an application to the tribunal and demonstrate the completion of a significant amenity improvement such as a kitchen or bathroom renovation. The tribunal would consider that improvement and weigh it against the impact of any greater rent increase on the tenant.

Importantly, improvements made to meet minimum requirements such as the minimum energy efficiency rental standards, or MEERS, would be excluded from consideration. That will incentivise landlords to deliver amenity improvements that actually benefit tenants, while giving the tribunal ultimate oversight to ensure they are significant and that the tenants are protected against hardship. Thirdly, the bill would amend section 44 to introduce a new mechanism allowing tenants to apply to the tribunal for rent reductions. An amended section 44 would allow tenants to apply at any time for a rent reduction and remove the current provision that perversely prohibits the tribunal from considering the income of tenants or their ability to afford the rent.

Instead, the tribunal would be required to consider the impact rent is having on the tenant with respect to affordability and the tenant's connection to place, accounting for caring responsibilities, social and family connections, and length of tenure. That empowers tenants to seek fair and reasonable rent reductions, because freezing and capping rents do not go far enough when rents are already too high and causing hardship for millions. I will continue my second reading speech after question time, and I will continue to tell everybody that we need rent controls. Right now, everybody in our communities is feeling absolute pressure, a level of stress and a heightened escalation of tension. We have heard comments about the pressures that people are feeling day to day. It is impossible to live in this city and, indeed, in this State without feeling that sense of heightened anxiety and stress.

The bill could immediately reduce that stress for millions of people in this State. If we remove the pressure that comes from living in housing stress, we have the potential to reduce the pressure that exists on our roads, in our mental health care system and in our health system. It could reduce the level of abuse in retail shops and the level of heightened anxiety at grocery stores. People are ringing me because they cannot pay their electricity bill. Rents are one of the highest causes of anxiety and stress day to day for people in our community. That is why The Greens are saying that this is not just a housing solution. The bill is not just about housing justice. It is a

solution. Rent controls will deliver for people in New South Wales by massively lifting the pressures and the stresses caused by the rising cost of everything in our State.

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Alex Greenwich): I apologise to the member for Newtown and guests in the gallery for the disjointed nature of the member's second reading speech. We cannot always control things in the New South Wales Parliament as we would like. It being 10.50 a.m., in accordance with the routine of business, debate is interrupted for question time and the routine of business. I set down resumption of the debate as an order of the day for a later time. I shall now leave the chair. The House will resume at 11.00 a.m.

Members

MEMBER FOR WOLLONGONG

The SPEAKER: I understand that the Minister for Planning and Public Spaces is having a birthday soon. We are getting in before you go.

Mr Paul Scully: Do I get some latitude today, Mr Speaker?

The SPEAKER: You get latitude every day, Minister. The Opposition tells me that.

Visitors

VISITORS

The SPEAKER: I extend a warm welcome to Bob Bedford, guest of the member for Maitland. I welcome Grahame Kelly, from the Mining and Energy Union, and Clare Bailey, Dave Hartley, Josh Dever and Aden Worroll, guests of the member for Swansea. Where are you?

Mr Jihad Dib: As if you can't see them in that!

The SPEAKER: There is some high-vis upstairs as well. I want to make sure they are not cross-pollinating. The member for Heffron will come to order. I welcome visitors from Avalon Beach Probus Club and Newport Probus Club, guests of the member for Pittwater. I welcome Carol Micallef, Lawrence Micallef, Katherine Kirby, Trudy Scott, Tara Scott, Jennifer Parkins and Amy Neville, guests of the member for South Coast. I also welcome school leaders from Cerdon College, Merrylands High School, Granville South Creative and Performing Arts High School and Granville Boys High School, guests of the member for Granville. I welcome Wendy Eggins and Gordon Eggins, guests of the member for Orange.

I welcome Prudence Johnson, guest of the member for Parramatta. I also welcome Jakob Zaleski, guest of the member for Wollondilly. I think I met him earlier. I welcome Naomi Wood, Isidora Trovato and Belinda Ottmann, from Blacktown City Council, guests of the member for Mount Druitt, accompanied by Sarah Hatch from the member's office. I am sure everybody is excited when we have a collection of mayors in the gallery. I acknowledge the chair of the Hunter Joint Organisation, Jeff Drayton, Mayor of Muswellbrook; deputy chair Leah Anderson, Mayor of Port Stephens; Philip Penfold, Mayor of Maitland; Digby Rayward, Mayor of Dungog; Daniel Watton, Mayor of Cessnock; and Pat Ryan, Mayor of Upper Hunter Shire. Hopefully, the others will join us along the way. They are Worships one and all.

Ms Jenny Aitchison: Robert is up there, too—my husband.

The SPEAKER: I welcome Robert Aitchison, the Minister's husband.

Members

REPRESENTATION OF MINISTERS ABSENT DURING QUESTIONS

Mr RON HOENIG: On behalf of Mr Chris Minns: I inform the House that the Minister for Skills, TAFE and Tertiary Education will answer questions today in the absence of the Deputy Premier, Minister for Education and Early Learning, and Minister for Western Sydney.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Tweed to order for the first time.

Question Time

KNIFE CRIME

Ms KELLIE SLOANE (Vaucluse) (11:09): My question is directed to the Minister for Police and Counter-terrorism. Since 2023, police have seized more than 17,000 knives in public spaces. In the past week a father of three was stabbed to death in Mount Druitt, a 93-year-old man stabbed his wife at a Blacktown shopping centre and a 26-year-old was stabbed in a home invasion in Baulkham Hills. With Western Sydney facing constant knife crime, why will the Minister not support giving police "anytime, anywhere" knife wanding powers?

Ms YASMIN CATLEY (Swansea—Minister for Police and Counter-terrorism, and Minister for the Hunter) (11:09): I will answer the question straight up so there are no interruptions from those opposite. Police asked us for the knife reforms that we put in place. The legislation reflected what was asked for by New South Wales police.

The SPEAKER: Members will come to order.

Mr Michael Daley: Stop being so relevant!

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: I apologise, Attorney.

The SPEAKER: The Attorney General will come to order. Members will come to order.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: For the benefit of the House, I say that any knife crime is a serious crime. People who leave home with a knife in their back pocket do not understand that it does not make them safer; it makes them dangerous. All too often we see knife crime occurring throughout our community. However, if the Opposition wants to attack the police over this, quite frankly I find that abhorrent.

The SPEAKER: Members will come to order.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: New South Wales police officers are doing everything they can. They have confiscated more knives across our community than ever before. Their wanding operations are part of that, plus their other operations on transport and in our regional communities. You name it, New South Wales police are out there doing it.

Ms Kellie Sloane: Point of order—

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: I answered up-front.

Ms Kellie Sloane: It was not up-front.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: It was very up-front, actually.

The SPEAKER: Members will not argue across the table. I will hear the point of order from the Leader of the Opposition.

Ms Kellie Sloane: My point of order relates to Standing Order 129.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: It's the only one you know!

Ms Kellie Sloane: Let me finish.

The SPEAKER: Members will come to order.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: You need to read the rule book!

Ms Kellie Sloane: The question was "anytime, anywhere", not "sometimes, some places".

The SPEAKER: The Minister will come to order. I will preside and determine whether to uphold the point of order. I have the heard the point of order. The Minister has been directly relevant.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: Mr Speaker, I have to say that was an excellent decision on your behalf. There is no doubt that too many lives are lost. But police are doing not only their policing operations but also their work in schools, with the Beasley family, through the youth command and with the PCYC. Heavens above! I cannot believe the Opposition constantly criticises the police in this Chamber and blames them for crime when all the police are doing is an excellent job.

SYDNEY METRO SOUTHWEST

Ms JO HAYLEN (Summer Hill) (11:12): My question is addressed to the Premier. Will the Premier update the House on the progress towards opening the south-west metro, which will connect communities from Bankstown through the city to the north-west on one continuous 66-kilometre metro line?

Mr CHRIS MINNS (Kogarah—Premier) (11:12): I thank the member for Summer Hill for her question. In exciting news for New South Wales, the new metro extension will open on 30 October, with the first service at 4.31 a.m. from Bankstown. The Liberals and Nationals had this exciting initiative on the chopping block, but we were able to rehabilitate it and wrestle it to fruition. I thank Alia and the project managers for their incredible work in getting this up and running. It was not easy to convert a 100-year-old line into a brand-new twenty-first century metro, but the result will be exciting for Sydney. A trip from Bankstown to Central will take 28 minutes, saving six minutes, while Marrickville to Gadigal will take 12 minutes, saving 12 minutes.

A trip from Campsie to Macquarie University will take 44 minutes. Earlier I spoke to the Minister, and member for Canterbury, who is an alumna of that university. She said it used to take 2½ hours from her base in that part of Sydney to get to Macquarie University. Now students from Campsie will get there in 44 minutes. A trip from Lakemba to Victoria Cross will take 37 minutes. Perhaps more interestingly, the new metro line will connect different parts of metropolitan Sydney that have not been natural bedfellows. The North Shore and places in the Bankstown region will now be half an hour from each other. A person from the North Shore will be able to get a borek in Lakemba or a laksa in Tallawong. It will be a fantastic food journey. We expect a 50 per cent increase in passenger capacity on the T3 line as a result of these changes and a major uptick in the frequency and reliability of services for those who need to use the network.

Perhaps now is a good opportunity to thank the very patient businesses along that transport corridor. They have dealt with buses rather than trains, all in the hope of transformative infrastructure coming online, which is exactly what has happened. We thank those businesses for hanging in there during incredibly difficult times. Hopefully, on Friday week they will see a major uptick in the number of people patronising their cafes, restaurants and retail establishments. The opening of the new line will be fantastic for them. It has been long sought after and will be a huge boost for that part of Sydney. More than 2,600 driverless metro services will travel on the fully integrated Sydney Metro M1 line. Some 48,000 trips are expected to be made across the metro line on a typical weekend. We do not expect teething problems but there may well be some; there certainly were after the opening of the other metro lines in the past few years. I assure the public that any problems will be quickly ironed out. [*Extension of time*]

Those who have worked on the metro project have obviously worked incredibly hard to ensure the kinks are dealt with before it opens. However, we cannot see fully how the operation of the new line unfolds until there are tens of thousands of people on the network. I ask for a bit of patience as we iron out those kinks. However, this is an exciting addition to our public transport network. I urge people to use it and to explore a part of Sydney they perhaps do not particularly understand or have not seen in the past. I think this will be a fantastic opportunity for people to see and experience different parts of Sydney they have not seen before.

SMALL BUSINESS

Mr GURMESH SINGH (Coffs Harbour) (11:16): My question is directed to the Minister for Customer Service and Digital Government, representing the Minister for Small Business. Australian Restaurant and Cafe Association chief executive Wes Lambert has said that Labor's "cafe killer" bill is "another example of a government who does not understand small business", and that it is impossible for businesses to absorb additional expenses. Will Labor ditch the "cafe killer" bill, which will force already struggling small and family businesses to absorb the cost of running a re-usable cup scheme?

Mr Ron Hoenig: Point of order: If the Leader of The Nationals wants to ask a question about a piece of legislation, he should do so properly and refer to the legislation by its title, not give it a title that is his opinion of it. The question certainly infringes Standing Order 128 (2) as it contains argument, an inference, an imputation and, certainly, an ironical expression, as well as an expression of opinion under subparagraph (g). The question infringes Standing Order 128 in respect of virtually every category.

Ms Felicity Wilson: To the point of order: The term used to describe the legislation has been referred to in this House, the other House and on the front page of *The Daily Telegraph*. "Cafe killer" bill is common parlance and I think the Minister is able to understand the question.

The SPEAKER: Members will come to order.

Mr Greg Warren: To the point of order: The Manager of Opposition Business drew my attention to Standing Order 128 (3) (d), which states a question cannot ask for "confirmation of rumour or media reports". The Manager of Opposition Business has substantiated the Leader of the House's argument that the question is out of order.

The SPEAKER: As always, I appreciate the wise counsel. The question as put is out of order. The fact that a certain legislation has a colloquial name does not make it comport with the standing orders. I ask the member for Coffs Harbour to correct that. If not, I will give him an opportunity to do so later.

Mr GURMESH SINGH: My question is directed to the Minister for Customer Service and Digital Government, representing the Minister for Small Business. Australian Restaurant and Cafe Association chief executive Wes Lambert said that Labor's "cafe killer" bill, also known as the Environmental Legislation Amendment (Plastic Reduction and Container Recycling) Bill 2026, is "another example of a government that does not understand small business" and that it is impossible for businesses to absorb additional expenses. Will Labor ditch the cafe killer bill, also known as the Environmental Legislation Amendment (Plastic Reduction and

Container Recycling) Bill 2026, which will force already struggling small and family businesses to absorb the cost of running a re-usable cup scheme?

Mr Ron Hoenig: Point of order—

The SPEAKER: Members will come to order. I call the member for Bathurst to order for the first time. The member for Bankstown will come to order. I need to hear the Leader of the House.

Mr Ron Hoenig: The question by the member for Coffs Harbour contains the same expression that caused the infringement—

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Wahroonga to order for the first time. He will not put the Leader of the House off his game. The Leader of the House will not have to try too hard because I will not take much convincing on this one.

Mr Ron Hoenig: The question contains the same infringement of Standing Order 128, and the member for Coffs Harbour did it deliberately. Mr Speaker, I ask that you rule the question out of order and move to the next question.

The SPEAKER: I do not need to hear any further. The restated question was still out of order. It did not benefit from the colloquial description of the bill. That was an unnecessary provocation. The member for Coffs Harbour will have an opportunity to ask the question again later.

TRAIN MANUFACTURING

Mr CLAYTON BARR (Cessnock) (11:21): My question is addressed to the Minister for Roads, and Minister for Regional Transport. Will the Minister please detail for the House the importance of building trains in the Hunter to support jobs, rebuild the State's manufacturing capacity and deliver transport infrastructure that works?

The SPEAKER: Members will come to order.

Ms JENNY AITCHISON (Maitland—Minister for Roads, and Minister for Regional Transport) (11:22): Before I start, with indulgence of the House, I acknowledge a special constituent of the member for Cessnock, Bob Bedford. Members will know Bob by association with my chief of staff, Christine Boyd, who is one of the hardest working chiefs of staff in history. Bob is a real testament to the working culture in the Hunter. At 77 years of age, he is still working full time in the motor trade industry, which is impressive. That is what we do in the Hunter.

I thank the member for Cessnock for the question. He is a hardworking member for his communities, who knows how important it is to support local jobs in our communities, to rebuild manufacturing and to get that $12 billion investment in our State. It will unlock hundreds of jobs, provide certainty for thousands of businesses and improve the lives of men, women and children for generations in New South Wales. We are backing the Hunter. This is not a short-term promise; it is a long-term vision for the Hunter. We are reviving train manufacturing, which was unfairly stripped away by members opposite, starting with the refurbishment of the Tangara replacement fleet. We will then move on to the Millennium and Oscar fleets in the 2040s and to the Waratah fleet in the 2050s. That is 780 jobs during construction of the facilities and 550 ongoing jobs.

We have not stopped there. I acknowledge representatives from the Mining and Energy Union who are in the gallery today. Our Government has secured 1,000 jobs at Tomago, 1,600 jobs at Hunter Valley Operations, 400 jobs at Mount Pleasant and more than 1,300 jobs at the Teralba site.

The SPEAKER: There is too much audible conversation in the Chamber.

Ms JENNY AITCHISON: That is 4,000 jobs. I also acknowledge the mayors in the gallery and Jeff Smith, the general manager of Maitland council. The Hunter is in good hands with this investment in jobs, which will ensure a flow-on effect into our community. We understand how vital the Hunter is for the future of not only New South Wales but also our entire nation. But members opposite have already thrown in the towel. The Leader of the Opposition has admitted that she is not optimistic about her chances in the Hunter.

Mr Jihad Dib: Which one?

Ms JENNY AITCHISON: Sorry, the Opposition in this place, not the one outside it. Just this week the shadow transport Minister in the other place revealed how she really feels about transport manufacturing in the regions. She told the ABC:

> … domestic manufacturing has its place, but in transport you've got a fixed budget and variable cost.

That did not stop those opposite when they built their trains overseas with blowouts in time and cost. She also said:

> You've got to decide on your investment whether you put that into maintenance, new services, improving efficiency and capacity.

We will probably get none of those things from those opposite, who would offshore those jobs. [*Extension of time*]

The SPEAKER: I call the member for North Shore to order for the first time.

Ms JENNY AITCHISON: The Auditor-General did not agree with the approach of those opposite when they procured the Regional Rail fleet. After eight years, they failed to deliver a single train. We now have 16 of those 29 trains out there. That was a bit of old history, but there is some commentary from those opposite about new things on the horizon. Let's play a game of "Who said this?" while we are talking about Hunter manufacturing. This is an easy one; we should all know it:

> Australia and New South Wales are not good at building trains, that's why we have to purchase them.

That was Gladys Berejiklian in August 2020. Members should also know this one:

> I think most people know the car industry, the train industry, in terms of manufacturing here in Australia; we don't have it, and there's a reason for it.

Who said that? That was Andrew Constance in August 2020.

Mrs Wendy Tuckerman: Point of order—

The SPEAKER: The Minister will resume her seat. The member for Goulburn rises on a point of order.

Mrs Wendy Tuckerman: The Minister is directing questions to members in the Chamber. It is our duty to ask questions.

The SPEAKER: There is no point of order. The Minister will conclude her answer.

Ms JENNY AITCHISON: We will pivot here. I will not make members guess this one because it is pretty recent:

> We could potentially partner with a Korean company like Hyundai Rotem. We could help build the infrastructure with them and lean in on a lot of their IP.

That was Mike Newman from One Nation, the leader of those opposite. A few other recent ones have come from this Chamber. Anyone who was listening earlier this week might have heard this one:

> You have to wonder whether we can compete on a worldwide scale.

That is a real shot in the arm for manufacturing, is it not? I continue:

> Are we cost competitive?

Mr David Layzell: It's about solar panels.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Upper Hunter to order for the first time. I call the member for Upper Hunter to order for the second time.

Ms JENNY AITCHISON: I acknowledge the interjection of the member for Upper Hunter, because he is the one who said that. He will not back manufacturing. Labor is the only party that will back manufacturing, our jobs and our communities every single day.

The SPEAKER: The fact that the member for Upper Hunter is smiling has saved him on this occasion. If he continues to interject, he will be directed to remove himself from the Chamber.

SMALL BUSINESS

Mr GURMESH SINGH (Coffs Harbour) (11:27): Third time's a charm. My question is directed to the Minister for Customer Service and Digital Government, representing the Minister for Small Business. Australian Restaurant and Cafe Association chief executive Wes Lambert has said that Labor's environmental regulation—sorry, Environmental Legislation Amendment (Plastic Reduction and Container Recycling) Bill 2026—

[*Government members interjected.*]

I might start again, Mr Speaker.

The SPEAKER: The member for Coffs Harbour can hand the question to me and I will read it. We need to move along. The member for Rockdale will come to order. We need to hear the question.

Mr GURMESH SINGH: Australian Restaurant and Cafe Association chief executive Wes Lambert has said that Labor's Environmental Legislation Amendment (Plastic Reduction and Container Recycling) Bill 2026 is "another example of a government that does not understand small business" and that it is impossible for businesses to absorb additional expenses. Will Labor ditch the Environmental Legislation Amendment (Plastic Reduction and Container Recycling) Bill 2026, which will force already struggling small businesses to absorb the cost of running a re-usable cup scheme?

The SPEAKER: The Minister will be heard in silence.

Mr JIHAD DIB (Bankstown—Minister for Customer Service and Digital Government, Minister for Emergency Services, and Minister for Youth Justice) (11:28): My answer will be shorter than the question. To answer it without taking up a lot of time, the answer is no.

The SPEAKER: Members will come to order.

Mr JIHAD DIB: While I am here, I again wish Minister Saffin all the best for her recovery. I look forward to her coming back.

To the young students in the gallery I say this is a really great example of a potential scare campaign. I make it really clear at the outset that this bill does not ban single-use coffee cups. It does not do that. The Opposition is absolutely all over the place. As the Minister for Health would say, Opposition members are being a bit wishy-washy. They are unsure what they believe in and what they stand for anymore. I think about where the current Coalition sits and where it used to sit. Coalition members were the former champions of the environment. A media release today—

Mr Gurmesh Singh: Point of order: The Minister has heard the question three times. You would think he would get it right. The question is about re-usable cups, not single-use cups.

The SPEAKER: The member for Coffs Harbour will resume his seat. The Minister has the call.

Mr JIHAD DIB: I did not want to get in trouble from you today, Mr Speaker. I am still smarting over yesterday, so I answered the question straightaway. I saw a press release today from a couple of Opposition members. I thought, "Great, they're backing the bill in. That's fantastic." I am an old history and English teacher, so I will go back in history. I thought a certain shadow Minister for the Environment, also known as the Manager of Opposition Business, was backing the bill in because in 2021 she gave an enthusiastic contribution about the environment. She said, "Our goal is to reduce as much plastic waste as possible while protecting the environment, sustainably managing resources and ensuring materials circulate in our economy for as long as possible." I reckon that is a pretty ringing endorsement of what we are doing.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for North Shore to order for the second time.

Mr JIHAD DIB: I make it very clear again that we know this has an important environmental element, and we recognise the impact on businesses. I also make it clear again that the bill does not ban single-use coffee cups. The Opposition is trying to run a scare campaign. People can currently take their cup to a cafe, including Cafe Quorum here, and have the cafe fill it up. Cafes have the option to do that now if they want to. To the young students from the Granville electorate, if you ask a question, know what the answer is going to be. Do not start a scare campaign just because you have nothing else to talk about.

Ms Felicity Wilson: Point of order—

The SPEAKER: Has the Minister concluded his answer?

Mr JIHAD DIB: I have.

The SPEAKER: There is no point of order in relation to the question.

Ms Felicity Wilson: I would like to take my point of order regardless. My point of order is about the comportment of the Minister, who should not be engaging with visitors in the gallery. I ask that he be instructed not to do that.

Mr Jihad Dib: To the point of order—

The SPEAKER: I do not need to hear further. I do not uphold the point of order. It was a technical breach, but let us move on. I acknowledge the arrival of Lord Mayor Gavin Morris and his chief of staff Tracy McKelligott in the gallery. They are old friends of many of us here.

YOUTH MENTAL HEALTH

Mr MICHAEL REGAN (Wakehurst) (11:32): My question is directed to the Minister for Health, representing the Minister for Mental Health. The Brookvale youth mental health hub was announced in February 2025. When will it open and what services will it provide to support young people on the northern beaches experiencing mental health challenges?

Mr RYAN PARK (Keira—Minister for Health, Minister for Regional Health, and Minister for the Illawarra and the South Coast) (11:33): That is a really good question. I know that since the member for Wakehurst has been a member, he has been talking to the Minister for Mental Health, the hardworking Rose Jackson in the other place, about this. I am delighted to provide him and his community with an update on an issue that is important to all members. I acknowledge that this morning many members were in The Domain with the member for Barwon and others for an event to raise awareness of men's suicide, which is another important issue.

Minister Jackson has been engaging with the department and hearing from young people. She has been pleased to announce that the Brookvale Youth Wellbeing Hub is planned to start services in December 2026. The hub is a one-stop space for young people so they can access integrated services for mental health. From a health perspective and, more importantly, from a consumer and family perspective, it will reduce fragmentation and enhance access. It will mean that young people on the northern beaches have a single door to enter and access the care they need.

Working together with Minister Jackson and the member for Wakehurst, and by listening to his community and its young people, we have made the decision to redirect a portion of the funding that was stuck as part of the last Government's mess of youth mental health services into enhancing mental health services across the northern beaches. That includes the establishment of the Youth Wellbeing Hub in Brookvale; an enhancement to a northern beaches PACER team, which I know the member for Wakehurst and many other members have been strong advocates for; and the establishment of a child and youth mental health consultation liaison service. That is in addition to the Brookvale Safe Haven, which is providing drop-in services led by suicide prevention peer workers and a calm, non-clinical space to support young people.

With the support of the member for Wakehurst and his community, we have been trying to ensure that vital mental health care is delivered where and how the community needs it to be. That is happening after a period of significant frustration. All members understand that it has been a tough period for the people living on the northern beaches with their hospital and the services it delivers. I thank the member for Wakehurst for his advocacy, and I know I speak on behalf of the Minister for Mental Health in the other place. The member for Wakehurst has been a tireless advocate for his electorate, particularly for young people's mental health and wellbeing and the health services delivered on the northern beaches. I am confident that the enhanced mental health services on the northern beaches will be an improvement. I am confident that we will continue to engage with the member's community to deliver better health services for the people of the northern beaches.

HOUSING SUPPLY

Ms KYLIE WILKINSON (East Hills) (11:36): My question is addressed to the Minister for Planning and Public Spaces. Will the Minister update the House on the Minns Labor Government's plan for more homes, public spaces and improved neighbourhoods around Edgecliff and the future Woollahra station, ensuring all parts of Sydney take their fair share of new housing?

Mr PAUL SCULLY (Wollongong—Minister for Planning and Public Spaces) (11:36): I am happy to update the member for East Hills on the need to make sure that all parts of Sydney and New South Wales are providing homes and jobs in good communities. That is exactly the work that is going on in Edgecliff and Woollahra at the moment as part of more than 70 State-led rezonings happening across the State. Between them, the rezonings are unlocking around 257,000 new homes and creating 236,000 jobs. Places like Edgecliff and Woollahra present genuine opportunities to accommodate more housing close to the centre of Sydney. Families in growing parts of Sydney are entitled to see the established areas close to jobs, transport and services make a fair contribution to addressing the State's housing challenges. Every part of Sydney has that responsibility, and every part of New South Wales can make a contribution. That includes the eastern suburbs.

Young people should have more choice about where they can live and the lives their families can have in the future. Instead, in Sydney and other parts of New South Wales, too many young people find themselves priced out of areas or, because of years of a lack of home building, a lack of housing availability. The Government is working to address that because it is focused on expanding housing supply. One of the options, as the member for East Hills has rightly pointed out, is the work underway around Edgecliff and the soon-to-be-built Woollahra station. Over the next 20 years, that proposal could enable higher density housing and commercial spaces around

those stations, approximately 9,400 new homes, and more retail options, which would create around 1,000 jobs in the area. It could also enable additional community facilities, around 3.5 hectares of new and upgraded public open spaces, improved connections throughout the precinct and, importantly, the first heavy-rail station in a decade, which will be eight minutes from the Sydney CBD.

Given there has been strong debate about and interest in the proposal from both supporters and opponents, I extended the period of public consultation recently until 30 October. I genuinely want to make sure that everyone has the opportunity to have their say. The member for Vaucluse has been briefed on it. She has written to me on a number of occasions. I have not seen her submission yet. I wanted to make sure she had enough time to get a really considered and thoughtful piece in to see where she stands on such an important proposal for the future of Sydney. I also wanted her to be able to give everyone a sense of what a future Liberal government, if there was one, would say and do about housing.

I think that is fair. The Government should help to make sure that everyone has the opportunity to have their say. [*Extension of time*]

A person working in the city should have more options than having to move further away from where they need to live. This proposal will offer a diversity of new homes: a mix of studio, one-, two- and three-bedroom apartments. That matters because people have different housing needs at different stages of their lives. The new housing will bring a responsibility to pay attention to the streets and the spaces around it. That is why Transport for NSW is progressing the design of a new Woollahra station. That work is being considered alongside the housing proposal so that the relationship between transport and new development is addressed from the outset.

Importantly, the feedback the Government gets through this process will influence the final recommendation, expected in 2027, which is about when construction of that new station will begin. Residents and businesses will have an opportunity to put forward their views while the work is still being developed. I understand that some concerns have been expressed about infrastructure in the area. That is fair, so let me address some of those concerns. Some people are worried that there are insufficient schools. When putting the proposal together, the Government worked with School Infrastructure and discovered that not only has enrolment in local public schools been falling over the past few years, it is also expected to fall—

Ms Felicity Wilson: Under your watch.

The SPEAKER: I remind the member for North Shore that she is on two calls to order.

Mr PAUL SCULLY: The member for North Shore said that was under our watch, but it is because no-one who lives in the area has kids of primary school age. The population of Woollahra is ageing and has fallen over the past five decades, while the population of the rest of Sydney has gone up 76 per cent. But apparently it is our fault that school enrolments have fallen. Guess what? Because there are no young people in that area having children, school enrolments are expected to continue to fall. It is a great problem when people are too concerned about one issue that they then do not focus on the real issue, which is a chronic lack of housing in all parts of Sydney.

PATIENT HOSPITAL REFERRALS

Mrs TANYA THOMPSON (Myall Lakes) (11:41): My question is directed to the Minister for Health, and Minister for Regional Health. On Tuesday, when asked if he could guarantee that no other New South Wales hospital has unread or unactioned patient referral emails sitting in an inbox, the Minister said he would get information back from a review by Thursday. Given that today is Thursday, will the Minister advise the House how many unread or unactioned patient referrals to New South Wales hospitals have been found?

Mr RYAN PARK (Keira—Minister for Health, Minister for Regional Health, and Minister for the Illawarra and the South Coast) (11:42): I will be getting that information. The member for Myall Lakes is right; it is due back to the ministry from local health districts [LHDs] today. I will be seeking a briefing as soon as that information comes in. I will not be providing guarantees until I see it, but I am confident that we have the measures in place to ensure that does not happen. I want to make sure that the robust governance procedures around emails, particularly those dealing with admissions of people for surgery, are appropriately addressed and dealt with. That is what the Government will be doing.

I will make sure that members are kept abreast of the advice. But once that advice comes to me, I want to spend a bit of time looking at it. I think members will forgive me for doing that. I want to see what other LHDs are putting in place to make sure that people are complying with the policies and procedures that relate to admissions for surgery across the New South Wales health system.

GREAT KOALA NATIONAL PARK

Dr MARJORIE O'NEILL (Coogee) (11:43): My question is addressed to Minister for Skills, TAFE and Tertiary Education, in his capacity representing the Minister for Agriculture, and Minister for Regional New South Wales. Will the Minister detail for the House the progress of the Minns Labor Government's Great Koala National Park, which will protect koalas in one of the largest parks in New South Wales?

Mr STEVE WHAN (Monaro—Minister for Skills, TAFE and Tertiary Education) (11:43): I thank the member for Coogee for the question. I also thank members on this side of the House, as well as some members from the other side, for their enthusiasm for protecting koalas in New South Wales. The Great Koala National Park will protect one of our State's most significant environmental and cultural landscapes, while ensuring current and future generations can continue to experience and enjoy it. It will protect some of the best koala habitat in the State, ensuring our kids and their kids can continue to witness this iconic and beloved species in the wild. It also protects the habitat of over 100 other threatened species, recognises the enduring connection of Aboriginal people to country, and provides a foundation for sustainable recreation, tourism and new economic opportunities.

I was also pleased to hear mountain biking highlighted during debate on the bill the other day, as it is something I have a personal interest in. The park is a landmark addition to the national park estate, building on the proud legacy of forest conservation by the Wran and Carr governments. Following the bill's passage through the Legislative Council, the Government expects to open the park before the end of the year. I recognise the contribution of the member for Cronulla to the debate on Tuesday. He said:

> The koala is one of the world's most recognisable animals. It is also endangered in New South Wales.
>
> …
>
> The 2020 parliamentary inquiry warned that koalas … were on a trajectory towards extinction by 2050 …

The member for Cronulla gets this issue. He has read the science and, when he was Minister, he commissioned some of the research into it. Unfortunately, that is not a universal view in the Coalition.

Mr Michael Kemp: What does the member for Cessnock think?

Mr STEVE WHAN: On cue, the member for Oxley interjects. A short time later in the debate, he said:

> The message that koalas are at risk of extinction is absolutely false.

The Coalition cannot even agree on whether koalas are endangered, let alone what to do about it.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Wollongong to order for the first time.

Mr STEVE WHAN: The member for Oxley also complained that we had heard nothing but contributions from concrete-and-steel members on both sides of the House, not regional members. He obviously missed the earlier contribution of his Coalition colleague in the neighbouring electorate, the member for Port Macquarie, who said:

> I support this bill because protecting the environment, koalas and their habitat is the right thing to do.

I agree. The member for Oxley might want to talk to the shadow Minister for the Environment, the member for North Shore. In 2022 in this place she said:

> I record my support … for a plan to transition the native forestry industry towards sustainable plantations …

She is in good company. The member for Manly, a former environment Minister, advocated for ending native forestry. He said it was a compelling economic case, let alone an environmental one. The Minns Government has been absolutely consistent on this. [*Extension of time*]

Ms Felicity Wilson: It's already on *Hansard*. You don't need to read it again.

The SPEAKER: I remind the member for North Shore that she is on two calls to order.

Mr STEVE WHAN: Yes, it is on *Hansard*, member for North Shore. But you love having your quotes read again.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Myall Lakes to order for the first time.

Mr STEVE WHAN: People know where the Minns Labor Government stands on this. We have a plan, and are delivering it. The same cannot be said of the Liberals and The Nationals. The people of New South Wales deserve to know which environmental policy they will be voting for at the next election. When asked whether a future Coalition government would abolish the park, the member for Coffs Harbour said, "They're discussions we'll have." He left it open. The Liberals and The Nationals have shifted their positions, chasing One Nation out to the right. If they need to form government with One Nation, how much further will they go? We are sticking

to our plan and delivering the park. When voters right across New South Wales go to the next election, they deserve to know which Coalition policy they will be voting for. There are divisions everywhere on a range of issues on the other side of the House.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Clarence to order.

Mr STEVE WHAN: There are even divisions in The Nationals. I credit the principled stand of the member for Tweed, who demonstrated his consistent support for koalas in New South Wales through his vote this week. It is very important for the people of New South Wales to understand which Coalition policy they will be voting for. We have seen constant divisions on renewables in the Opposition. Its candidate for Monaro is distributing pamphlets opposing solar farms and posing for selfies with prominent One Nation members.

The SPEAKER: The member for Coffs Harbour will come to order.

Mr STEVE WHAN: There are contradictions about domestic manufacturing and single-use plastics. The Nationals members are running off to the right, chasing One Nation, and leaving all the normal middle-ground voters behind. It shows a complete lack of leadership from the member for Coffs Harbour and the Leader of the Liberal Party.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Coffs Harbour to order for the first time.

HOUSING SUPPLY

Ms ELENI PETINOS (Miranda) (11:49): My question is directed to the Premier. Last month the *St George and Sutherland Shire Leader* reported him as saying, "We don't want the shire to take more than their fair share," when discussing proposed development in the area. What is the specific number of dwellings that the Premier considers to be the Sutherland shire's "fair share"?

Mr CHRIS MINNS (Kogarah—Premier) (11:49): I am happy to take that question on notice and report back to the House about the State plan. However, it is all pretty transparent. Maybe the planning Minister can dig it up for me. I make it clear that if no-one takes their fair share, which is the crux of what I was saying to the leader, or anyone else—

Mr Gurmesh Singh: Except Kogarah.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: You say except for Kogarah.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Coffs Harbour to order for the second time.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: When I was elected as the member for Kogarah, 24 per cent of the people in my electorate lived in apartments. That is now 50 per cent. Would you take that density?

The SPEAKER: The member for Coffs Harbour will not be drawn in.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: He'll get drawn in. That is the whole point. Labor electorates have been accepting development for a long period of time. They do not oppose it. They allow it and accept it as part of Sydney's growth and future, especially if the development has access to transport lines and public transport. The group that has opposed it is you. The truth of the matter is—

Mr Gurmesh Singh: Point of order—

The SPEAKER: The Clerk will stop the clock. The member for Coffs Harbour rises on a point of order.

Mr Gurmesh Singh: For a start, the Premier needs to direct his remarks through the Chair. He also asked me a direct question. I would be happy take more density in Coffs Harbour, but it is the Premier's Labor candidate who opposes it at every single election.

The SPEAKER: There is no a point of order. I call the member for Coffs Harbour to order for the third time.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: This really goes to the heart of it. What we are seeing for the past 12 years is a deliberate policy from the previous Government to jam as much new development and people into Western Sydney as possible. That was their strategy from day one until the twelfth year of their term in office.

Ms Eleni Petinos: Point of order—

The SPEAKER: The Clerk will stop the clock.

Ms Eleni Petinos: My point of order is taken under Standing Order 129. The question is about the Sutherland shire. I said to the Premier that he knows, but he does not want to tell us.

The SPEAKER: The Premier is being directly relevant.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: If Woollahra does not go ahead, there will be more development for the Sutherland shire, Penrith, north-west Sydney and south-west Sydney. That is what is happening under the Coalition's policy. They refuse to have a commonsense approach to planning and development in their own electorates, so everybody else has to take more. For the past 3½ years, we have seen a deliberate and intentional policy from those opposite to deny and stop reasonable development in the eastern suburbs at the expense of communities in Sutherland, Blacktown, Penrith and St George.

Ms Eleni Petinos: Point of order—

The SPEAKER: The Clerk will stop the clock. Is the point of order again taken under Standing Order 129?

Ms Eleni Petinos: The question was about my community. My community wants an answer.

The SPEAKER: The Premier is being directly relevant. I place the member for Miranda on three calls to order.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: I am answering the question. The member for Miranda says, "My leader does not want any development in her area. I do not want any in my area either." So who is going to get it all? Western Sydney will.

Ms Eleni Petinos: Point of order—

Ms Felicity Wilson: Point of order—

Mr Justin Clancy: Point of order—

The SPEAKER: All members will come to order. I will not hear a point of order.

Ms Felicity Wilson: Why?

The SPEAKER: I will tell the member in a moment.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: The Coalition's policy for planning in New South Wales has been to deny development in North Shore, Woollahra and the eastern suburbs, and jam as many people as possible into Western Sydney. When we come to the table with a reasonable policy to spread it out so that everybody takes a bit and no-one takes too much, they say, "Why are you putting any in my area?" Members can rest assured that if the Coalition are returned in March 2027, they will jam families and communities into Western Sydney but do nothing in their own areas.

The SPEAKER: I was asked why I would not hear a point of order. I draw members' attention to Standing Order 131 (9), which states:

> Points of order taken during an answer to a question should not be vexatious, repetitive, interfering or used to make a statement …

All of those things occurred during that particular answer and previous answers.

HOSPITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Ms KAREN McKEOWN (Penrith) (11:54): My question is addressed to the Minister for Health, and Minister for Regional Health. Will the Minister detail to the House how the Minns Labor Government is unlocking more beds in New South Wales hospitals for those who need them most?

Mr RYAN PARK (Keira—Minister for Health, Minister for Regional Health, and Minister for the Illawarra and the South Coast) (11:54): I thank the fantastic member for Penrith for her question. There is just a small investment going to Western Sydney. A billion-dollar investment is going to Nepean, which has a very busy hospital. Brad Ceely and the team work really hard there. The hospital will benefit from our uplift to ratios, but it is under considerable pressure given its geographical location. Visitors in the gallery may know that our focus on this side of the House when it comes to health care is on more beds, staff and services.

Today I outline to the House the way in which we are doing that. In addition to trying to free up some of the beds that are under real pressure at the moment because of the number of aged people stuck in our State's hospitals, we are rolling out alternatives to emergency departments. Tens of thousands of people have been spared a trip to emergency departments across New South Wales public hospitals because of our urgent care services and online services. Those services are working in our communities.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Goulburn to order for the first time.

Mr RYAN PARK: I can say they are working because data is tracked each day. We are now seeing a steady decline in category 4 and category 5 admissions. People in those categories should not really be at an emergency department and should be seen elsewhere.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Oxley to order for the first time.

Mr RYAN PARK: Importantly, we are also rolling out additional staff. There are literally thousands more healthcare workers in our system now than in 2023. We have close to 7,000 additional nurses. That is a big reform off the back of better ratios, which is now one to three in emergency departments and one to four on the floor. People in hospitals will start to see an increase in staffing across general wards, which we need. As of this morning, over 1,100 beds—equivalent of two large Sydney hospitals— were offline for aged patients stuck in our State's hospitals.

Hospitals like St George have the equivalent of two wards taken offline. That is the reason we made the extraordinary decision last week to step into an area that is traditionally the responsibility of the Federal Government, as it should be. For the first time in our history, the State will provide home care packages that we hope will enable 300 older people to get back into their homes or residential aged-care homes and free up our hospital beds. [*Extension of time*]

That is great for them and for their families. Importantly, it is also great for our health service to have those additional beds. We are also upgrading or building 32 hospitals across New South Wales. I touched on Nepean at the beginning of my answer. Members know about Bankstown hospital in south-west Sydney—that small, $2 billion piece of infrastructure! For the information of visitors in the gallery, those opposite could not decide on a site for the hospital. In our first term, we decided what the site will be. We have bulldozers working on the site and we are going to keep the old hospital.

Blacktown and Mount Druitt hospitals will both get 30 new beds. Blacktown will get them at the end of this year; work is about to start in Mount Druitt. They are two busy hospitals in north-west Sydney that need additional bed space. Of course, there is the hospital at Rouse Hill, home to one of the fastest growing communities in north-west Sydney. It was promised three times at three elections and multiple times by multiple Premiers. It took a Minns Labor Government to start delivering it.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Kellyville to order for the first time. I call the member for Riverstone to order for the first time.

Mr RYAN PARK: We are doing upgrades and work at places like Canterbury, Fairfield and Liverpool. We are investing in the parts of the system where it is needed most.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Kellyville to order for the second time.

Mr RYAN PARK: That includes one that we are all delighted to see very close to opening, which the Parliamentary Secretary has been a strong advocate for, and that is the level 4 hospital in Eurobodalla. Our plan is a simple one, not based on privatisation, not based on a wages freeze but based on three things: more services, more beds and more staff.

PARLIAMENT BREASTFEEDING POLICY

Ms MONICA TUDEHOPE (Epping) (11:59): My question is directed to the Minister for Women. Yesterday the Parliament updated its *Breastfeeding Policy* to remove all reference to the word "mother". The Premier's Department *Lactation and Work Policy* circular was also updated in January this year to remove all references to the words "mother" and "women". Does the Minister support this change and, if not, what specific action will she take in response?

The SPEAKER: The Premier will take the question.

Mr CHRIS MINNS (Kogarah—Premier) (11:59): It is the Premier's Department.

The SPEAKER: Order! I call the member for North Shore to order for the third time.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: It would be unusual that the question would not be directed to me. In relation to that policy, I think it is important to note that the drafting of the policy began in 2022 with senior managers and unions.

Ms Kellie Sloane: It's your responsibility.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: Leave me a second to answer it and I will give you an answer. The crux of the policy was about more flexible working arrangements for mothers who might need to adjust their start or finish times as to when they feed, more consistent with the modern workplace and not just in terms of the strict ruling in the award. It removes wording which inhibited a mother's flexibility to extend a breastfeeding break beyond the

prescribed award entitlement and breaks up the breastfeeding breaks so that those who need to pump or breastfeed can do it more regularly. That was the crux of the policy. The truth of the matter is that the terminology used is strange. I do not think that we need to be in a situation where these documents should have anything other than commonsense language like "mother" and "breastfeeding". That is what the public expects and what I expect. I understand that State Government guidelines of a similar nature will from now on reflect that terminology.

The SPEAKER: I place the member for Terrigal on three calls to order.

Ms Sophie Cotsis: I can give them a history lesson about lactation breaks. I fought them on this.

The SPEAKER: The member for Canterbury can, but she is not going to at this stage. I call the member for Canterbury to order for the first time.

HUNTER REGION

Mr TIM CRAKANTHORP (Newcastle) (12:01): My question is addressed to the Minister for the Hunter. Will the Minister advise the House how the Minns Labor Government is delivering jobs, infrastructure and better services for the Hunter?

Ms YASMIN CATLEY (Swansea—Minister for Police and Counter-terrorism, and Minister for the Hunter) (12:02): I thank the member for Newcastle for the question. One thing about him is that he backs workers every day of the week. Not everyone in this place does, but I will get to that later. Before I answer, I acknowledge guests in the public gallery: Grahame Kelly of the mighty Mining and Energy Union [MEU], and four machinery operators from Mount Pleasant coalmine operations, Clare Bailey, Dave Hartley, Josh Dever and Aden Worroll. I welcome them to the New South Wales Parliament.

Mr Michael Kemp: They did not save the timber industry.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Oxley to order for the second time.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: Mate, I would not be having a go—

The SPEAKER: Minister, I will manage it.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: Next time, I might make a few—

The SPEAKER: Order! I call the member for Myall Lakes to order for the third time.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: This answer is for the visitors in the public gallery. Something has been building in the Hunter. There is an air of confidence and an air of excitement.

The SPEAKER: I call the member for Oxley to order for the third time.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: It is about what we have been achieving. We could see it a few weeks ago, when the Newcastle Knights went from being wooden spooners to the grand final. That gutsy effort reminded us of who we are and what we are capable of.

The SPEAKER: Members will come to order.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: This week, when the Minns Labor Government announced that Teralba will be the place where train manufacturing comes home to the Hunter, nobody was really surprised, because it was common sense. It was the right decision. We have the roads, rail, power and land. That land would be a wasteland under those members opposite. They have no imagination to think about what it could become or what its future will be. In addition to that, we have the skills, electricians and apprentices lining up to get on that site. A mine that ceased production would have just been forgotten by those opposite.

Our Government has a vision and it has a future. It is a $12 billion investment in that future, with 780 construction jobs and 550 ongoing jobs, well-paid, high-end manufacturing jobs that will continue for 30, 40 or even 50 years. As apprentices walk in the door today, their kids will follow them when it is their turn to get a job. This is about an industry supporting a region. In addition, we have also palled up with the Commonwealth to work with them on Tomago Aluminium, a $2.5 billion investment with 1,000 direct jobs and 5,000 indirect jobs. We have also backed the Hunter Valley Operations, protecting more than 1,500 jobs. It is why our guests from Mount Pleasant should know that this Government has their back.

Mr Tim Crakanthorp: I seek an extension of time to hear further about jobs, infrastructure and better services.

Ms Felicity Wilson: Point of order—

The SPEAKER: The Clerk will stop the clock. What is the member's point of order?

Ms Felicity Wilson: My point of order is that the Minister wasted the first two minutes of her answer flouting the standing orders and your rulings. I request that you do not give her an extension of a further two minutes now.

The SPEAKER: I do not believe the Minister did that. There is no point of order. I grant an additional two minutes.

Ms YASMIN CATLEY: The Government is bringing legislation to this place to save the 400 jobs in the Mount Pleasant operation. We have embraced and celebrated the Hunter region's tradition of having a world-class industrial base. We are also looking to the future with equal enthusiasm. Consider this: We all know the Port of Newcastle exports coal right around the world. At the same time, it is the biggest importer of renewable energy infrastructure that we have here in Australia. We are doing both at the same time because that is the right thing to do. It really does say it all. We have passed the Local Jobs First Bill 2026, which will bring public money back into the State, with jobs and skills along with it. We have passed the Future Jobs and Investment Bill 2025 so that the Hunter transition is planned and no-one is left behind.

We have developed a master plan for Mt Arthur Coal and Macquarie Coal so the community actually knows what is coming next. We are delivering for the families who are doing those jobs. Thanks to the Minister for Health and the Minister for Regional Health, we have the John Hunter Health and Innovation Precinct. There will be 24 schools and preschools in the Hunter, thanks to the Minister for Education and Early Learning. The Muswellbrook and Singleton bypasses are both under construction and we have finished the M1 and Raymond Terrace link under budget and under time, 18 months before it was due, thanks to the Minister for Roads, and Minister for Regional Transport. I do not pretend that everything is perfect but I what I can say is that this Government backs the Hunter, backs its workers and backs its industry. The Hunter can count on us to make sure that our plan will continue into the future because we back the Hunter.

OPERATION ROSNY

Mrs JUDY HANNAN (Wollondilly) (12:07): My question is directed to the Premier. Will the Premier advise how the New South Wales Government will review any conflicts, interests and roles to maintain the integrity of government regarding the conduct of individuals mentioned in ICAC's Operation Rosny, who my constituents suggest have strong associations in the Southern Highlands?

Mr CHRIS MINNS (Kogarah—Premier) (12:08): I thank the member for Wollondilly for her question. Before I answer the substantive part of the question, I acknowledge that a member of this Parliament, the member for Kellyville, is resigning. I am not heaping scorn on him. He took a principled stand in this Parliament, a difficult decision in difficult times. I wish him the best in his retirement from this place. He leaves with his reputation enhanced. I think the ICAC inquiry validated his concerns, which took enormous courage to bring to public life. I wish the member for Kellyville all the best.

In relation to Operation Rosny, my understanding is that the ICAC will provide recommendations to Parliament and findings as it relates to individuals in the coming months. Presumably, it will not be before the Parliament breaks. It will be up to the next Parliament to take action as it relates to findings and recommendations from the ICAC.

But I give the member for Wollondilly a commitment that if we are returned, we will implement the changes that the ICAC demands to ensure that New South Wales is corruption-proof, and that the appalling corruption we have seen under the Liberals and Nationals is not repeated in this State.

Those opposite claim that they have turned over a new leaf and that, all of a sudden, they are taking these recommendations seriously. But look at the curious case of the Hon. Chris Rath, who admitted to tipping off those who were the subject of an upper House investigation and telling them where the Serjeant-at-Arms and the process servers would be. For months, he was telling them where not to be to avoid a process server. We only found out about that when the ICAC began its investigation. There is also the curious case of the Hon. Damien Tudehope—

Ms Felicity Wilson: Point of order—

Mr CHRIS MINNS: —who admitted to tipping off the committee as it relates to the specific report from the upper House investigation.

The SPEAKER: Order! The Premier should not be surprised that the Manager of Opposition Business rises on a point of order.

Ms Felicity Wilson: My point of order is that the Premier is reflecting on members of this Parliament. If the Premier wants to make those reflections, he needs to do so by substantive motion.

The SPEAKER: There is no point of order. The member for North Shore will resume her seat.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: I am tempted to move a motion. We have a lot of people from Newcastle in the public gallery today. It is good to see them. They would remember Newcastle's favourite son, Damien Tudehope. He is running for the upper House in the Newcastle region. The bloke has never been there before, so we have a guy who tipped off members under investigation—

Ms Felicity Wilson: Point of order—

Mr CHRIS MINNS: —who is effectively disgraced in Parliament and in ICAC, but who has been promoted by the New South Wales Opposition.

The SPEAKER: The Premier will resume his seat.

Ms Felicity Wilson: The Premier has made a clear imputation against a member of this Parliament. I ask him to withdraw it and move a substantive motion if he wants to make it again.

The SPEAKER: The imputation is based on fact.

Ms Felicity Wilson: You didn't hear.

The SPEAKER: I did hear.

[*Opposition members interjected.*]

The Premier has been asked whether he will withdraw the comment. I shall put it to the Premier.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: No.

The SPEAKER: He will not. I call the member for Wollondilly.

Mrs Judy Hannan: If the Premier has not finished his answer, can I request an extension of time?

Mr CHRIS MINNS: Yes, you can. I do have more.

The SPEAKER: An additional two minutes is granted.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: It got to the point where we found out under questioning that the Hon. Damien Tudehope had given confidential information he only got as a member of the upper House to those who were the subject of the investigation. The Leader of the Opposition promised some kind of investigation, but instead he is promoted. Now we find out that he is running again.

Mr Justin Clancy: Point of order—

Mr CHRIS MINNS: But rather than run in his local area or in an at-large position—

The SPEAKER: Order! The member for Albury rises on a point of order.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: —he tells us that he is proud to represent the Hunter.

The SPEAKER: The Clerk will stop the clock. I will hear the point of order from the member for Albury, but first I draw the member's attention to Standing Order 131 (9).

Mr Justin Clancy: I understand, Mr Speaker, but my point of order is taken under Standing Order 129. The Premier has clearly strayed from the question asked by the member for Wollondilly.

The SPEAKER: I do not believe the Premier has strayed from the question. The member for Wollondilly would have taken a point of order if she felt that was the case.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: I am tempted to move a full motion. It deserves a bit of the Parliament's time, but we have a lot on so I will use the last minute and 30 seconds to get out what I can. The Leader of the Opposition was recently asked in Newcastle what electorates the Opposition will compete for in the upcoming election. She replied, "None. We are not going to be competing in any of them. We don't expect to compete or win any of those electorates." But do not worry, ladies and gentlemen, because the good news is that Damien Tudehope has decided to represent the people of Newcastle whether they want it or not.

Mr Justin Clancy: Point of order—

The SPEAKER: There is no point of order. I just ruled on the matter.

Mr CHRIS MINNS: I understand that a brave member of the Liberal Party has decided to enter the fray and challenge Damien Tudehope's reign as the long-serving Knights fan and Newcastle's favourite son in the preselection for the upper House. I do not know who that person is, but I wish him all the best. I am sure he can do a more decent job representing both the Liberal Party and Newcastle than Damien Tudehope, who, by any

objective measure, has disgraced himself. Without any sanction from the Liberal Party, he expects us to have some sort of memory fade between now and 13 March. That is not going to happen.

MAJOR EVENTS

Mr GREG WARREN (Campbelltown) (12:14): My question is addressed to the Minister for Sport, and Minister for Jobs and Tourism. Will the Minister please update the House on the blockbuster line-up of major events across New South Wales this October that is driving over $100 million into the New South Wales economy?

Mr STEPHEN KAMPER (Rockdale—Minister for Lands and Property, Minister for Multiculturalism, Minister for Sport, and Minister for Jobs and Tourism) (12:15): I thank the blockbuster member for Campbelltown for his question. He is a major event in his own right. October has been a blockbuster month for major events in New South Wales, with sport, entertainment and racing bringing visitors into our State and more than $100 million in economic benefits. Unlike some of the performances we have seen from members opposite, those events are delivering real impact. Rugby league got the party started with the NRL grand finals, which drew a crowd of over 80,000 people at Accor Stadium and packed out McDonald Jones Stadium in Newy with another 20,000. It was a fantastic weekend for rugby league and for the Sydney visitor economy, with Business Sydney estimating that nearly $35 million was injected into our economy over the grand final weekend.

For footy heads, the entertainment kept rolling. The Rugby League World Cup kicked off in spectacular fashion at Allianz Stadium with more than 40,000 fans watching Australia take on New Zealand. That was the highest attendance for a test match in Sydney for more than 50 years. The Rugby League World Cup is set to deliver more thrills and spills when it brings 16 matches to Sydney, Newcastle and Wollongong and an estimated $19 million flowing into our visitor economy. Some members of the House may not know Anyma or BIGBANG. There will be no performances by me this time, but both global superstars performed in Sydney this October and certainly knew how to draw a crowd. That was the start of a great summer of music that will include concerts by the Foo Fighters, Robbie Williams, Guns N' Roses, Harry Styles and Iron Maiden.

The Bledisloe Cup brought Wallabies and All Blacks supporters to Sydney for another chapter in one of Australia's great sporting rivalries, with an estimated $20 million boost to the economy. I do not want to dwell on the result, but at least the Wallabies turned up and had a crack. Those opposite still have not worked out a winning game plan. Damien Tudehope stacked the right wing and left the centre of the field is entirely empty. Thanks to the members representing the electorates of Manly, Wahroonga, Kellyville and Winston Hills, the Opposition is playing with an extended bench. They barely have a full team on the field. But never mind if you are not a fan of the footy—New South Wales has something for everyone. Some 52,000 fans packed out the Everest. The Bathurst 1000 roared to life alongside the iconic Deni Ute Muster. [*Extension of time*]

One thing sports fans love is a comeback. I can report to the House that the circus master himself, Mark Latham, made his return to the Everest this year. We had world-class thoroughbreds on the track and a political fossil back in the paddock. Then there was Mike Newman flying in from Tokyo to tell us how things should be run here. He has plenty of international travel but not much local form to go on. The former Liberal Government funded him in Japan for four years. Clearly, he has been working on his sumo game because he has come back to towel them all up. In October, we have seen what happens when you combine world-class sport, major entertainment and a government that backs our visitor economy: more visitors, more spending, and more jobs.

Documents

TRANSPORT FOR NSW

Reports

Ms JENNY AITCHISON: In accordance with section 133A of the Road Transport Act 2013, I announce the electronic tabling of the report of Transport for NSW entitled *Review of the Average Speed Camera Light Vehicle Trial: Outcomes report*.

DEPARTMENT OF CREATIVE INDUSTRIES, TOURISM, HOSPITALITY AND SPORT

Reports

Ms JENNY AITCHISON: In accordance with section 5 of the Creative Statement to Parliament Act 2025, I announce the electronic tabling of the report of the Department of Creative Industries, Tourism, Hospitality and Sport entitled *Creative Statement to Parliament 2026*.

Committees

JOINT STANDING COMMITTEE ON ELECTORAL MATTERS

Government Response

The CLERK: I announce receipt of the Government's responses to the following reports:

(1) Report No. 5/58 entitled *Display of electoral posters and other electoral signage at voting centres*, dated 21 October 2026.

(2) Report No. 6/58 entitled *Immediate Options for Enhancing Political Party Governance*, dated 21 October 2026.

Business of the House

ORDER OF BUSINESS

Mr RON HOENIG: I move:

That business be interrupted at 6.00 p.m. Wednesday 11 November 2026 to permit the presentation of a valedictory speech by the member for Kellyville.

Motion agreed to.

SUSPENSION OF STANDING AND SESSIONAL ORDERS: ORDER OF BUSINESS

Mr RON HOENIG (Heffron—Minister for Local Government) (12:21): I move:

That standing and sessional orders be suspended today and 11 November 2026, as follows:

(1) Today, at the conclusion of the petitions debate, permit the member for Blacktown and the member for Lane Cove to each give a five-minute statement on the 1956 Hungarian Revolution and its significance to the Australian Hungarian community in New South Wales.

(2) On Wednesday 11 November 2026 to provide for the following routine of business:

(a) at 12:00 p.m. the Speaker takes the chair;

(b) question time and associated routine of business;

(c) giving of general business notices of motions (general notices), for up to 15 minutes;

(d) Government business;

(e) at 5:00 p.m., public interest debate;

(f) Government business (if required);

(g) community recognition statements; and

(h) private members' statements, after which the House shall adjourn without motion moved until the next sitting day.

Wednesday 11 November is Remembrance Day. It is proposed that the House commences at 12.00 p.m. that day with question time and the routine of business.

Ms FELICITY WILSON (North Shore) (12:22): I thank the Leader of the House for responding to our request to start the sitting later to allow metropolitan members to participate in Remembrance Day services. I note that there have been a number of occasions on which the Government has set the House's sitting calendar for the year to sit on 11 November. We have repeatedly requested that that not be the case. We asked the Government for this weeks ago. It should have been provided to give certainty. It is disappointing that members from rural and regional areas will not be able to participate in remembering their veterans because of the way this Government set the sitting dates for this Parliament. We ask that the next government, which is likely to be a Liberal-Nationals government, consider that in setting the sitting dates for the year. It is an important day for us to recognise our veterans and should not be ignored by the Parliament of New South Wales.

The SPEAKER: The question is that the motion be agreed to.

Motion agreed to.

Petitions

PETITIONS RECEIVED

The CLERK: I announce that the following ePetition signed by 500 or more persons has been lodged for presentation:

Footpath Infrastructure

Petition requesting that the Legislative Assembly call on the Government to support and advocate for the funding and construction of continuous, safe pedestrian footpaths between Laurieton, Lakewood, Kew and Kendall, received from **Mr Robert Dwyer**.

RESPONSES TO PETITIONS

The CLERK: I announce that the following Minister has lodged a response to a paper petition signed by more than 500 persons:

The Hon. Ryan Park—Medical Negligence—lodged Thursday 17 September 2026 (Ms Kylie Wilkinson)

Bills

RESIDENTIAL TENANCIES AMENDMENT (RENT CONTROL) BILL 2026

Second Reading Speech

Debate resumed from an earlier hour.

Ms JENNY LEONG (Newtown) (12:24): I continue my second reading speech on the Residential Tenancies Amendment (Rent Control) Bill 2026. Before I was interrupted for question time, I was speaking specifically to the details of the bill and the four key areas of reform in it. The first is an immediate 12-month freeze on rents. The second is a 2 per cent cap on rent increases annually. I was moving to the detail of the third and the fourth reforms, which I turn to now. Third, the bill would amend section 44 of the Residential Tenancies Act to introduce a new mechanism allowing tenants to apply to the tribunal for rent reductions. An amended section 44 would allow tenants to apply at any time for a rent reduction and remove the current provision that perversely prohibits the tribunal from considering the income of the tenant or their ability to afford the rent.

Instead, the tribunal would be required to consider the impact that rent is having on the tenant with respect to affordability and the tenant's connection to place, accounting for caring responsibilities, social and family connections, and length of tenure. This would empower tenants to seek fair and reasonable reductions, because freezing and capping rents do not go far enough when the rents are already too high and causing hardship for millions. We hear stories of property prices going down, but we never hear stories of rent reductions or rent decreases in our community. It is critical that there is capacity for tenants to be able to put in a request for their rent to be decreased.

Fourth, the bill would empower tenants to secure two-year fixed-term agreements for new and existing tenancies. New section 17A would require new tenancies to be advertised on two-year fixed terms at a minimum, giving tenants the option to request a shorter term if they wish. This delivers on the call by the Australian Council of Trade Unions to introduce standard two-year fixed-term leases. This restriction on how premises are advertised would carry similar protections and enforcement to the existing provisions prohibiting rent bidding. New section 17B would give tenants the right to request an extension to two years during a tenancy, and to extend an existing tenancy for a further two years at their discretion. New section 18A would enable tenants on a periodic lease to convert to a fixed-term tenancy of up to two years.

Complementing the introduction of standard rolling two-year fixed terms, the bill would provide greater rights for tenants to terminate a fixed-term agreement without penalty. Amended section 96 would permit a tenant to terminate a fixed-term tenancy by the giving of four weeks notice without penalty, and amended section 100 would permit a tenant to terminate a fixed-term tenancy without penalty, where there are urgent circumstances justifying early termination. Overall, these changes would allow renters to stay in their homes with security for as long as they want and then leave without penalty by giving adequate notice or in urgent circumstances. That is critical. So often, renters feel the pressure in two different ways. One is the stress that exists as a result of knowing that at any point in time, they could get a horrific 200 per cent rent increase. The other stress is that people fear they are going to have to move. Providing longer leases is a simple and effective way that this Parliament can provide protection to renters and more security in our State. That is recognised nationally, with this reform being pushed by the Australian Council of Trade Unions.

The need for rent controls is clear. We can no longer ignore the inequity built into our laws and systems. We need to tackle housing wealth in this State. We need to call out the passive income that members of this Parliament make from their Airbnbs and multiple investment properties while they also earn a politician's salary, when other people are being pushed further and further into poverty. We need to demand that the Government, which already regulates the cost of other essential things, like health care, education, child care, aged care, power bills and the minimum wage, works with The Greens and others in this Parliament to deliver rent controls to provide immediate relief to our communities, which are struggling as the cost of everything goes up.

Rent is the biggest single expense—and the biggest stress—for millions in our State. Every day, uncontrolled rent increases are pushing people further towards breaking point.

Why does polling show that 80 per cent of people support some form of rent regulation? Why do even 70 per cent of home owners support rent controls? It is because every member in this House and everybody in the State knows a renter who is on the edge—a person for whom one rent increase is not just another expense; it is a life-altering crisis. It is the student who is midway through their final year, slugged with a rent increase they cannot afford and being forced to move instead of focusing on their studies. It is the mum and kids living in the same house as a violent partner they have separated from because they cannot afford to rent somewhere else.

It is the older woman who, after a life of work and community service, finds herself contemplating being homeless at the age of 75 because she cannot afford the 200 per cent rent increase and cannot find another place within her budget. It is the kid who has to leave their kindy buddies they just met during their first year of primary school because their parents cannot afford the rent rise they have been slugged with. And it is the family member or loved one who owns a home and is letting their adult children, siblings or parents live with them because they know the alternative is that they would be on the street.

It is no wonder that the vast majority of people in our community back The Greens' plan to deliver rent controls and are ready to stand with the millions of us who know that the rental crisis is real, rather than with the 1 per cent who are profiting from it. The Greens have done the work in drafting this legislation to provide immediate relief and ongoing protection for renters across New South Wales. We have evidence from the Australian Capital Territory and jurisdictions across the world that rent controls are possible and that they work. All that is needed now is for the Parliament to listen to the overwhelming majority who support rent controls and act.

It took this Parliament about a decade from when The Greens first introduced a bill to ban unfair, no-grounds evictions in this State to then finally pass that reform with support from the Government and the Opposition. I am putting all members on notice. Rent controls are next. Renters in New South Wales, however, cannot wait another decade for Labor and the Coalition to get on board and tackle the pain the community is feeling. Millions of renters in this State cannot survive the stress of inaction on rents. That is why The Greens have done the heavy lifting and brought this bill to the Chamber today. We know that the solution is clear: We absolutely need rent controls now.

Debate adjourned.

Business of the House

SUSPENSION OF STANDING AND SESSIONAL ORDERS: BILLS

Ms JENNY LEONG (Newtown) (12:33): I move:

That standing and sessional orders be suspended to provide that the lapsing date of the Residential Tenancies Amendment (Rent Control) Bill 2026 standing in name of the member for Newtown be extended to 28 November 2026.

I appreciate this motion may come as a surprise to members so I will clearly articulate my intention in moving it. I have just given the second reading speech for my private member's bill on rent controls. The lapsing date for the bill is before we return in November—before we can have a debate on the bill. It was my understanding that we might be able to incorporate changing that lapsing date into previous motions for the suspension of standing and sessional orders. That was not the case. Therefore, I have moved this suspension motion, as is my right as a member of this House.

This is not a controversial motion. It is not asking any member to take a position on rent controls but allowing members to have the chance to debate the absolute rental crisis that millions of people in New South Wales are facing now. Members already know that some adjustments have to made to bill lapsing dates because there are more crossbench members in this place and more private members' bills than before. So it is not a controversial thing to ask for the lapsing date to be extended. It is also critical to realise that, because we are coming to the end of a parliamentary term, renters across this State might have no rent relief until halfway through next year because Parliament will not sit until then.

The choice for all members in this place right now is whether they believe that renters, the pressure that they are under and the urgent need for rent relief are important enough to continue this debate in November. The choice that members of this House will make right now is whether they support millions of renters and the overwhelming public support for them, as shown by a recent YouGov poll published last week by the Australia Institute. That polling found that four in five voters support some form of government regulation around increasing rents and that 51 per cent of New South Wales voters believe rent increases should be capped at inflation or less. Another 25 per cent go further and want rents to be temporarily frozen. Only 15 per cent oppose limits on rent

rises. Some 94 per cent of renters support the reforms. Over 70 per cent of home owners support a freeze or a cap on rents.

The YouGov polling shows that support for rent controls is strong across all parties. Some 88 per cent of Australian Labor Party voters, 87 per cent of Independent voters and 76 per cent of Coalition voters support rent controls of some form. And 66 per cent of voters for the party that I will not name in this Chamber also support rent controls. The reform has overwhelming popular support. Members now have the opportunity not to take a position on rent controls but to recognise, as a Parliament, the stress that is being felt by millions of renters across this State. The old parties—Labor, the Liberals and The Nationals—have the choice as to whether they will side with those who are getting more passive income through rents while forcing people into poverty or whether they will take seriously the fact that the cost of everything is rising and that rents are the biggest cost to everybody in this State each week.

The choice is clear. The lapsing date of the bill should be extended so it can be debated in November. It will give all members time to look at the bill. I welcome the chance to look at whatever amendments members can make to get it through. So much of the rise of popular support for right-wing, conservative forces is due to people feeling the pressure in their communities and feeling disenfranchised about how out of touch politicians are with their realities. Not everybody gets passive income from Airbnbs or rental investments. Most people are struggling to make ends meet and they deserve that this House take their concerns about rising rent seriously. I urge members to support this suspension motion.

Mr JIHAD DIB (Bankstown—Minister for Customer Service and Digital Government, Minister for Emergency Services, and Minister for Youth Justice) (12:38): We oppose the motion for the suspension of standing and sessional orders for a number of reasons. Firstly, it was not discussed prior to being moved. It is a longstanding custom of this House that, if members want to move something like a suspension motion, it is discussed beforehand and not just moved at a minute before midnight. We oppose the motion on that basis.

I heard part of the member's second reading speech. I will come back to that. This is the first we have heard of this motion. Normally it would be discussed with the Leader of the House and negotiated. I take the opportunity to make some comments about the work that my outstanding ministerial colleague Minister Chanthivong has done in passing rental reform legislation, including banning no-grounds evictions; limiting rent increases to once a year; making it easier to have pets in rentals; and introducing Smart Rental Bonds, which he spoke about yesterday and the impact and difference that that is making, saving renters thousands of dollars.

That is the work of the Government and the Parliament, and those are some of those reforms that passed this place. They went through a process, and I commend the Minister for his work in that process. We recognise that the number of renters keeps growing exponentially, and there are many different reasons for that. The Parliament is trying to provide protections for renters through some of the measures I have talked about. Renters are a growing cohort but, as I said early on, the Government opposes the motion to suspend standing orders. I make that clear so it cannot be misconstrued in any way. Motions like these are not normally moved a minute before the Government is informed about them.

Ms FELICITY WILSON (North Shore) (12:40): By leave: It is the practice of this House, though not a requirement, that members share with each other their intention to suspend standing orders. I have had a quick chat with the member for Newtown. I understand there may have been some discussions behind the scenes that we were not privy to. It is the expectation that members of the House work according to the standing orders as much as we can. However, when private members' legislation is introduced in this House, particularly when there is a minority government, members with carriage of such legislation have only a very small amount of time to introduce and speak to it and try to get outcomes for their communities and for the State of New South Wales. Members should have the right to speak to and debate their legislation in this House.

The Opposition supports the motion to suspend standing orders so that the member for Newtown can finish her second reading speech and members can debate the bill. As we come to the end of the parliamentary term, it is important to note that interest rates under the Albanese Labor Government are higher than we have seen in a significant period, rental vacancies are at their lowest and rents are incredibly high across New South Wales. I am a renter, and a number of my colleagues are too. I represent one of the communities with the highest proportion of renters in New South Wales. It is important to have these debates so that renters' voices are heard in this Parliament.

It is disappointing that the Minns Labor Government would shut down a debate about and for renters, because it is important that they have a voice in Parliament as well, not just landlords and home owners. We would have preferred the member for Newtown to go through the usual processes to suspend standing orders. However, we are happy to support the motion so that the experiences of people living with housing stress across our State can be heard in this Parliament and the bill can be debated on its merits. The Opposition supports the motion.

Ms JENNY LEONG (Newtown) (12:42): In reply: I appreciate the contributions to debate on my motion and acknowledge the Government's concern that we did not share our intention to move it. I am happy to put on record that, indeed, we did not share our intention in advance with the Government to move this motion. Unfortunately, the Government has stopped sharing information about suspension motions with The Greens. I do not know whether it is sharing that information with the Independents, who make up the numbers to form government, but it stopped sharing such information with The Greens a long time ago. We had no idea that the previous suspension motion would be moved.

While I acknowledge that the current Manager of Opposition Business has shared a bit of detail, there is an unofficial deal between the Government and the Opposition where they get together and share stuff and run roughshod over those who are not in the major parties. It is very important to recognise that respect should be mutual. I hope the practice of the Government changes for the final two weeks of this term and that Government members share with us their intention to suspend standing orders in advance, so we know what is going on. With that said, we are dealing with a very simple suspension motion.

To clarify what was said about the bill, initial conversations were had about whether an amendment to the lapsing date could be included in a broader omnibus motion to suspend standing orders and debate extending the lapsing dates of other legislation, among other things. Unfortunately, that did not occur. It is my prerogative, as one of the 93 elected representatives in this place, to move a motion to suspend standing orders to allow debate on the bill this private members' day. It is not my intention to disrespect the processes of the House, but sometimes that is required. We need to move. We have just two weeks left in this term. It is important to recognise that members could support the extension of the lapsing date but not the bill.

Many mechanisms are available to the government of the day to gag me if it wants to prevent debate on the bill from occurring. But members need to leave open the option to consider the bill in November so that, after the second reading speech and tabling of the bill, members can debate it. There is no need to divide on the motion. Extending the lapsing date would enable us to consider debating the bill in November. That is all we are asking for. That was done for a number of bills by motion last sitting week, and I know the Government and the Opposition do not support those bills. This is just a procedural motion that simply makes room for debate to happen.

I ask that the Government reconsiders, or at the very least chooses not to call a division on the motion, so that we can have time to debate the bill, because renters are crying out for support and we owe them the opportunity to consider these complex ideas. The Minister outlined what the Labor Government has done in this term of government. I recognise that, but rents have risen by 22 per cent in that time, and wages have not risen by that much. People cannot continue in this crisis. Those of us who are privileged to be re-elected will return here after the March election. We will not be sworn in until May, and then we will consider new legislation. The bill will probably not be debated until June, and then we will have a winter recess in July. Renters will have gone for almost a year with no action from this Parliament because of the timing of the election cycle.

All we are saying is that renters deserve the chance to be heard, and that means we need to deal with the rising cost of rent, which we all agree is out of control. There is majority public support for that. Landowners, property owners, renters and mortgage holders know that we need to regulate rents in some way. That is not controversial; it has majority public support. Members can choose whether to side with people on passive income who are getting wealthier, or with the increasing number of people who are forced into poverty because of the rental crisis. That is our choice. We do not need to make a choice on rent controls today. We need to give ourselves time to look at the rent control bill that The Greens have done the work to introduce and then decide whether we support it. All we are asking is to suspend standing orders so that members can debate whether to extend the lapsing date of the bill.

The SPEAKER: The question is that the motion be agreed to.

The House divided.

Ayes 37
Noes 48
Majority.....11

AYES

Anderson, K	James, T	Sloane, K
Ayyad, T	Lane, J	Smith, T
Clancy, J	Layzell, D	Speakman, M
Cooke, S	Leong, J	Taylor, M
Coure, M	Moylan, B	Thompson, T

AYES

Cross, M	Petinos, E	Toole, P
Crouch, A (teller)	Preston, R	Tuckerman, W
Davies, T	Provest, G	Tudehope, M
Di Pasqua, S	Roberts, A	Wallace, J
Dwyer, R	Saunders, D	Williams, R
Griffin, J	Shetty, K	Williamson, R (teller)
Henskens, A	Singh, G	Wilson, F
Hodges, M		

NOES

Aitchison, J	Finn, J	Mehan, D
Atalla, E	Greenwich, A	Minns, C
Bali, S	Hagarty, N (teller)	O'Neill, M
Barr, C	Harris, D	Park, R
Butler, L	Harrison, J	Quinnell, S
Butler, R	Haylen, J	Regan, M
Car, P	Hoenig, R	Saliba, D
Catley, Y	Holland, M	Scully, P
Chanthivong, A	Kaliyanda, C	Stuart, M
Cotsis, S	Kamper, S	Tesch, L (teller)
Crakanthorp, T	Kirby, W	Vo, T
Daley, M	Li, J	Voltz, L
Dalton, H	McDermott, H	Warren, G
Davis, D	McGirr, J	Washington, K
Dib, J	McInerney, K	Whan, S
Doyle, T	McKeown, K	Wilkinson, K

Motion negatived.

Bills

PAYROLL TAX AMENDMENT BILL 2026

First Reading

Bill introduced on motion by Ms Kellie Sloane, read a first time and printed.

Second Reading Speech

Ms KELLIE SLOANE (Vaucluse) (12:56): I move:

That this bill be now read a second time.

This year alone, small and family businesses have been smashed by what accountant Belinda Raso has called a year from hell, with rising inflation, four interest rate rises, broken promises on business tax hikes, a ban on credit card surcharges, and a stagnant New South Wales economy. Businesses have been doing it tougher than ever under the Minns and Albanese Labor governments. Things have never been harder under Labor governments that simply do not understand how to run a business and how businesses work. Small and family businesses deserve better than this, and New South Wales deserves better than this. New South Wales deserves a government that will back our businesses, grow our economy and create new jobs. That is exactly the kind of government the people of New South Wales will get if they vote for the Liberals and Nationals in March next year.

Today this bill gives every member of this Parliament a choice to either back businesses with lower taxes or be for fewer jobs and more businesses going bust. More than 100 businesses go under every week in New South Wales, with 6,200 in the past year. The latest insolvency data from the September quarter showed 1,900 business insolvencies, the worst result on record, worse than during the global financial crisis. Unemployment is now at a five-year high of 4.7 per cent. Businesses are fleeing New South Wales. Almost 3,000 of them have left for other States and Territories over the past three years. This is the record of the Minns Labor Government. Businesses are going bust not because their owners and employees are not working hard enough; they are working bloody hard. They are going under because the Minns and Albanese Labor governments have mismanaged our State and national economies.

Behind every business collapse is a family who put in years of work. They missed birthdays and special occasions to keep the till ringing, and put their savings on the line. When the doors close—and too many have closed—workers they treat like family lose their jobs and suppliers often go unpaid. Right now New South Wales businesses are being whacked from every direction, with higher taxes, higher interest rates, higher inflation, higher costs and more red tape. Since Labor came to power in New South Wales, taxes are up 30 per cent, with Labor's latest budget showing a further 16 per cent increase in the years ahead.

Business confidence in New South Wales is at an all-time low, having reached a level worse than during the COVID pandemic. I have been privileged to meet with small and family businesses across our great State and hear firsthand their stories and their struggles. They have told me and my Liberal-Nationals team that things have never been this hard before and it feels like there is a tsunami coming.

Whether it is Edcon Steel in Brookvale, Southern Cross Truck Rentals in Narellan or Kazzi Beach Greek, businesses want to grow more and employ more but are being held back by Labor governments not interested in growing the economy. In fact, they are shrinking the economy. Recently I received a message from Manna, who runs a business with her husband that provides care services to the elderly and the disabled, employing around 70 people. She wrote to me:

> Like many small business owners, we wear multiple hats because employing another team member would significantly increase our payroll tax and overheads.
>
> If the payroll tax burden was reduced, we could immediately invest in another full-time administrative role. That would free us to focus on growing the business, creating more jobs and expanding the essential services we provide to our community.
>
> Small businesses aren't asking for handouts, we're asking for the opportunity to reinvest in our people, grow sustainably and continue making a difference.

When I visited Edcon Steel, owner Hugh Edmunds said about payroll tax:

> One of many imposts business faces, and the sad reality is as wages go up, unfortunately the payroll tax goes up and it's a double edge sword ...
>
> We're very reluctant to take on anybody that we don't need, and as people leave there's a lot of question marks as to whether we replace them or not.

Hugh went on to say:

> everybody rants about AI all the time and we're certainly looking at any way we can use technology to avoid having to fork out for extra people, it's a sad reality but unfortunately that's what we face.

That sentiment was echoed by Peter Papas, owner of Kazzi Beach Greek, who said he would be looking to QR code ordering over employing new staff because of payroll tax. I ask members to think about that: a steel business looking to technology instead of new workers and a restaurant choosing a QR code over a young person's first job. Payroll tax is a tax on jobs. The Liberals and Nationals do not want to see a young person lose out on a job because a business faces a higher tax bill. Labor sees business as a cash cow rather than a productive part of our economy responsible for creating jobs and prosperity. Government doesn't grow the economy—business does. We have to start backing New South Wales businesses again to get our economy moving.

The bill before the House will implement the payroll tax cut I announced earlier this year in my budget reply speech. While Labor mocks and ridicules payroll tax cuts and One Nation promises cuts that simply don't stack up financially, the Liberals and Nationals have developed this plan for a sound and sensible payroll tax cut to support our State's small and family businesses and to help them employ people. Our plan has three parts. First, the payroll tax threshold will be raised from $1.2 million to $1.5 million. Over the life of this Minns Labor Government, that threshold has not moved once, even as inflation has pushed wages up and dragged more businesses into either paying payroll tax or paying more of it.

By contrast, the payroll tax threshold increased six times under the former Liberal-Nationals Government, from $658,000 to $1.2 million. Schedule 1 [2] to the bill raises the annual payroll tax threshold from $1.2 million to $1.5 million from 1 July 2027 for the 2027-28 financial year. That means an estimated 4,000 businesses that currently pay payroll tax will pay nothing at all. That will mean no more tax on them just for employing staff. A business with a $1.5 million payroll that pays $16,350 in tax today will pay nothing. Second, the bill lowers the payroll tax rate from 5.45 per cent to 4.75 per cent on the first $10 million of a business's total Australian wages from 1 July 2027. Businesses with total Australian wages of $10 million or less will pay 4.75 per cent on all their taxable wages above the threshold.

Schedule 1 [1] and [4], read together, operate to achieve this, with new clause 1C setting out how the two rates apply. Schedule 1 [3] defines total Australian wages to include interstate wages and the wages of every member of a business group, so the $10 million tier applies to the whole Australian payroll of a business and cannot be gamed by splitting a business up. That will mean New South Wales will have the lowest payroll tax

rate of any Australian State for businesses with a payroll under $10 million. Together with the higher threshold, that means real savings. A business with a $3 million payroll—employing around 30 staff—will save $26,850 a year. A business with a $5 million payroll will save $40,850 a year. And a business with a payroll of $10 million will save $75,850 a year.

Mr Kevin Anderson: A game changer.

Ms KELLIE SLOANE: It is a game changer. Third, and finally, to stop businesses paying more payroll tax simply because of inflation—which is rising and rising under Labor—we will index the threshold to the consumer price index every year from 1 July 2028, as set out in schedule 1 [2] and new clause 1B inserted by schedule 1 [4]. The threshold will track Sydney CPI and can never go backwards. This package of reforms will mean New South Wales is open for business by having one of the lowest and most competitive payroll tax rates of any Australian State. It will mean more local jobs, more businesses and more opportunity across New South Wales. It will mean that a business like Edcon has one less reason to replace a worker with technology, and a restaurant like Kazzi Beach Greek has one less reason to choose a QR code over a young person. It means that Manna and her husband will be one step closer to hiring the administrator they told me they need.

At a time of high unemployment, high inflation, high costs and higher Labor taxes, it is time that businesses get a break and are backed in by government. Today every member of this House has what should be an easy choice: back the businesses that employ our neighbours, our children and our friends, or side with a Labor government that keeps taxing jobs. The Liberals and Nationals have made our choice, because stronger businesses mean a stronger New South Wales. I commend the bill to the House.

Debate adjourned.

HEALTH SERVICES AMENDMENT (SPLITTING OF THE MURRUMBIDGEE LOCAL HEALTH DISTRICT) BILL 2026

First Reading

Bill introduced on motion by Mrs Helen Dalton, read a first time and printed.

Second Reading Speech

Mrs HELEN DALTON (Murray) (13:08): I move:

That this bill be now read a second time.

Today I reintroduce my Health Services Amendment (Splitting of the Murrumbidgee Local Health District) Bill 2026. I say "reintroduce" because I first introduced this bill to the House as the Health Services Amendment (Splitting of the Murrumbidgee Local Health District) Bill 2025. Just like the healthcare problems facing my electorate of Murray, this bill is not going away. It is back because the problems are still there. Our hospitals are struggling to recruit and retain doctors and nurses. Families are still driving hundreds of kilometres to Wagga Wagga for surgical procedures, specialist appointments and other treatment that should be available much closer to home.

Mothers are still being forced, in 2026, to leave their communities to give birth.

A common scenario is a family trying to work out how they are going to afford the petrol, accommodation and time off work to see a specialist and who will look after the kids that they leave behind. Our hardworking doctors and nurses are doing their absolute best in a system that is not giving them the support they need. That is what a regional healthcare system in trouble looks like, and the people of Murray are living with the consequences every single day. That is the problem I am trying to fix.

The way to do it is by establishing a new local health district for Murray and surrounding communities called the Western Riverina Local Health District. Right now, my electorate is part of the Murrumbidgee Local Health District. But, as I have pointed out many times before, there is something rather misleading about calling it a local health district because, for most people in Murray, there is absolutely nothing local about it. The Murrumbidgee Local Health District is basically run from Wagga Wagga. For many of my communities, Wagga Wagga may as well be on the moon. Decisions about hospital staffing, funding, recruitment and services are made hundreds of kilometres away.

These are administrative decisions. When a country hospital loses a doctor or a nurse, patients can lose access to essential services. It puts enormous pressure on families who are already doing it tough. There are lots of things that can make people sick, and right now I believe neglect is one of those things making people sick in Murray. Let me put the distance into perspective. My electorate of Murray covers almost 111,000 square kilometres. That is more than 40 per cent bigger than Scotland; it is bigger than Portugal. Imagine telling the

people of Scotland that decisions about their local hospitals should be made from London. They would not stand for it. Neither should we. But that is effectively what we are expected to do in Murray.

Distance matters when it comes to health care. When a hospital is hundreds of kilometres away, a simple appointment can become an entire day's journey. When the people running your health services are hundreds of kilometres away, it is much easier for local problems to be overlooked. It is a vicious cycle. Services are reduced because there are not enough staff. Then it becomes harder to attract staff because the services have been reduced. Eventually, patients are told they have to go somewhere else, and, little by little, our country hospitals have been allowed to hollow out.

That is why I am reintroducing my bill. It will establish a new Western Riverina Local Health District, with its own leadership and responsibility for planning and delivering health care across our region. It is important to note that this is an administrative split, not a clinical split. The clinical pathways will remain the same. A separate health district would focus on the particular needs of our hospitals. It would develop recruitment strategies specifically designed to attract and retain doctors and nurses in the Western Riverina. It would plan services around the needs of our communities, rather than treating us as one small part of an enormous health district. It would give our local hospitals a much stronger voice when decisions are being made about staffing, resources and services.

What works for a large regional hospital does not necessarily work for a small country town. What looks efficient on a spreadsheet in Wagga Wagga can be an absolute nightmare for a family living hundreds of kilometres away. I am not pretending that a new health district will magically produce doctors and nurses overnight. But it will give us something we desperately need: local leadership and decision-making. Wagga Wagga Base Hospital is already under enormous pressure. When patients have to travel there because services are not available in our own communities, that only adds to the demand. A separate Western Riverina Local Health District would give us the opportunity to strengthen our own hospitals and reduce unnecessary reliance on Wagga Wagga. Wagga Wagga could concentrate on its region, and we could concentrate on ours. Surely that makes sense for everyone.

We make a lot of important decisions in this Parliament, but few have such direct consequences for people's health, safety and wellbeing. I want members to remember something: Sometimes the worst kind of management is remote management. When you are hundreds of kilometres away from a problem, it is easy not to see it. When you do not see it, you do not understand how serious it is. The people of Murray see these problems every day. They are the ones watching their local hospitals struggle, and they are the ones paying the price when decisions are made so far from home.

Nothing beats local knowledge. Surely, after everything our communities have been through, it is time we gave them a health district that actually understands their needs. It is time to put the "local" back into local health district. I urge every member of this House, including the Premier and the Minister for Health, to support the Health Services Amendment (Splitting of the Murrumbidgee Local Health District) Bill 2026.

Debate adjourned.

URANIUM MINING AND NUCLEAR FACILITIES (PROHIBITIONS) REPEAL BILL 2025

Second Reading Speech

Mr ROY BUTLER (Barwon) (13:15): I move:

That this bill be now read a second time.

The Uranium Mining and Nuclear Facilities (Prohibitions) Repeal Bill 2025 repeals the Uranium Mining and Nuclear Facilities (Prohibitions) Act 1986. That Act has stood for almost 40 years. It is time to have a look at it again. The world has changed since 1986. Back then, uranium was seen as dangerous. Today uranium is in high demand, and it is only going to grow. Let me give the numbers. Australia currently exports 5,400 tonnes of uranium a year to the United States, Canada and Europe. India has set an energy target of 22 gigawatts of nuclear power by 2031-32. To reach that target, India needs between 18,000 and 20,000 tonnes of uranium—and that is just the start. India's long-term goal is 100 gigawatts by 2047. That will, again, require far more uranium.

In 2015 Australia signed the Australia-India Nuclear Cooperation Agreement, but it was not enacted until July this year. That agreement clears the way for us to export uranium to India. This bill has already passed the Legislative Council, as my colleague the Hon. John Ruddick saw its passage through the other place. It is now before this House. It is time we caught up with our own trade agreements instead of leaving them sitting on the shelf. Here is the problem: We do not produce nearly enough uranium to supply India while still honouring our existing agreements with the United States, Canada and Europe.

If we want to be a reliable trading partner to India and keep faith with our old partners, we need to produce more. Where does that uranium come from? In some cases, it is right under our feet. The world's largest uranium deposit lies under the South Australian border. The world's largest uranium mine, Olympic Dam, is in South Australia. In the 2023-24 financial year, South Australia sold $1 billion worth of uranium. That is 3½ thousand tonnes. The industry employs around 2,000 people in South Australia. These are high-paying, stable and growing jobs.

The Honeymoon mine is only 80 kilometres from Broken Hill. Many of the people who work there live in New South Wales. They drive across the border every day to earn a good living in an industry that is blocked from our own State. That is not fair. Broken Hill has been a mining town for over 140 years. Broken Hill knows how to mine safely and responsibly. But, under the current law, Broken Hill can watch the uranium industry from across the border but cannot take part in it. The uranium price is only going up. It currently sits between US$85 and US$90 a pound. Demand from India and elsewhere will keep pushing that price higher.

I have spoken often in this place about the importance of consulting regional people before changing the rules that affect them. This bill fits that principle. It does not force uranium mining onto any community. It removes a blanket ban and lets each proposal be judged on its own merits through proper environmental regulation, independent scientific assessment and genuine community consultation. Broken Hill mayor Tom Kennedy understands this opportunity. Council passed a mayoral minute in support of this bill on 29 July this year. The mayor wrote to me directly. He has asked the Government to allow uranium proposals to be assessed fairly rather than banned outright. But the mayor's support comes with a condition, and I think it is a fair one. He wants a royalty-sharing scheme similar to the Community Benefits Scheme that already applies to renewable energy projects.

If Broken Hill is asked to host a nationally significant industry, Broken Hill should share in the benefits. That means funding for roads, health services, child care, housing, education, training and emergency services. When I visited Broken Hill, everybody agreed on that. Everyone backed the idea of royalties flowing back to the region. That is not a new principle. It is already applied to renewable energy. It should be applied to uranium mining too. The bill simply repeals a blanket prohibition. It does not approve any mine. It does not skip any environmental process. It just allows uranium mining proposals to be considered on their merits, like any other resource project in this State.

Regional communities like Broken Hill have carried the weight of mining industries for generations. It is time they were allowed to compete for new opportunities too, and it is time they are properly rewarded when they do. The bill is not about turning New South Wales into a nuclear power. It is about digging up an export commodity that is already flowing out of South Australia every single day, which is down the road from Broken Hill. I support the bill. I ask the Government to work with the Broken Hill community on a genuine community benefits scheme so that if uranium mining does come to New South Wales, the people who host it are the people who benefit from it. That is all Broken Hill is asking for—a fair go. I acknowledge the Hon. John Ruddick from the other place who successfully got the bill through the Legislative Council and asked me to take carriage of it in the Legislative Assembly.

Second Reading Debate

Mr DAVID MEHAN (The Entrance) (13:20): The Government does not support the Uranium Mining and Nuclear Facilities (Prohibitions) Repeal Bill 2026. The Government comes to that conclusion after careful consideration of the economic, environmental and community consequences associated with developing a uranium industry in this State. The Government acknowledges the intentions of the member for Barwon and respects his commitment to the issue in his area. However, there are compelling reasons why the House should reject the bill. It is important to understand the current framework.

There has never been a commercial uranium mining venture in this State. Exploration and facilities around the nuclear industry were prohibited in this State in 1986, except at the facility at Lucas Heights. Under existing legislation, uranium exploration is not prohibited outright in New South Wales. Exploration may occur where ministerial consent is granted prior to an application for an exploration licence. Despite that pathway existing, there has been very limited interest in uranium exploration across the State, and no exploration licences have been granted under the current provisions. Repealing the longstanding prohibitions would create substantial policy and investment uncertainty while delivering little tangible benefit to the people of New South Wales.

Supporters of the bill often argue that uranium mining is a necessary precursor to a future nuclear energy industry. However, those arguments overlook the enormous economic and practical challenges associated with nuclear power generation. Nuclear power is an expensive form of electricity generation to establish. It requires immense up-front capital investment, decades of planning and construction, and substantial ongoing regulatory oversight. At a time when New South Wales is focused on delivering affordable, reliable and cleaner energy under

the renewable energy road map, the State should not be diverting its attention, resources or investment away from proven technologies that are already contributing to our energy transition.

Renewable energy generation, storage technologies, transmission infrastructure and firming capacity are already attracting significant investment across the State. Those industries are creating jobs and delivering energy now, not in 20 years time or longer. They are helping New South Wales achieve its legislated emissions reduction targets now. By contrast, a nuclear industry remains speculative, costly and decades away from meaningful delivery in this country. The bill risks sending exactly the wrong signal to investors by introducing uncertainty into our energy and resources policy settings at a time when confidence and stability are needed most. The New South Wales Government has signalled its priorities clearly to industry, including with the Critical Minerals Strategy and the coal industry plan announced in the past couple of weeks.

The bill also ignores the critical reality that New South Wales cannot create a nuclear power industry simply by repealing State prohibitions. Even if the bill were passed, significant Commonwealth prohibitions on nuclear power generation would remain in force. The construction and operation of nuclear power facilities are prohibited under Commonwealth law. As a result, the repeal proposed by this bill would not establish a viable nuclear industry. Instead, it would create a legislative inconsistency between State and Federal frameworks while providing no clear pathway forward. It removes safeguards without establishing replacements, it dismantles a framework without proposing a new one and it invites uncertainty without delivering any certain future. That is not sound public policy.

If a government were ever to contemplate a fundamental shift towards uranium mining and nuclear energy, it would require detailed planning, extensive consultation, bipartisan consideration and close coordination with the Commonwealth. None of that exists with this bill. I ask members to reflect on the strong community opposition shown in this State—and in other States—when it was proposed to store our own very low-level nuclear waste from Lucas Heights at another facility away from the Sydney metropolitan area. That resulted in a bunch of opposition wherever the proposal was put up as being suitable. The State does not need those additional challenges on its plate when it is heading down the path to a renewable energy future. We are well on the way to that point.

The environmental risks associated with uranium mining are significant and longstanding. I personally believe that they are not insurmountable. However, the risks include radioactive waste generation, rehabilitation challenges and the potential degradation of land that communities rely upon. Management of the risks would require a specialised assessment framework or strategy, a considered process of consultation and careful coordination across the New South Wales and Commonwealth governments. Uranium mining would also require significant government resources. Governments are being told to rein in the resources they are allocating to a whole bunch of things in our community and to balance their priorities. Opening up a whole new area—the expansion of a nuclear energy industry and uranium mining—for which the Government would have to direct significant resources, manage significant risks and deal with significant community opposition would be foolhardy without a whole bunch of groundwork going into it beforehand.

The bill offers no mechanism to address the risks. It provides no safeguards tailored to the unique challenges posed by uranium extraction. Radioactive waste is potentially hazardous for generations. Managing that waste safely requires highly specialised regulatory systems and technical expertise. New South Wales currently has no broad-based infrastructure for the management of such waste beyond the highly regulated arrangements operating at Lucas Heights. I have already spoken about the hurdles and the resistance to changing the existing disposal and storage of our very low-level nuclear waste. Similarly, emergency response capability for nuclear-related incidents requires specialised monitoring systems, health resources and preparedness measures. Those systems do not currently exist across regional New South Wales because no case has been made for their necessity. To remove prohibitions without first addressing those questions would be reckless.

As members know, this debate comes at a pivotal moment for our State's resources sector. New South Wales is on the verge of significant growth in critical minerals and high-tech metals, which are essential to renewable energy technologies, battery manufacturing, advanced manufacturing and modern industrial processes. Those opportunities are real and offer the prospect of investment, employment and economic development while supporting global decarbonisation efforts. The Government understands that is our comparative advantage. The Government is focusing on ensuring New South Wales captures those opportunities and prioritises building industries that strengthen regional economies, attract investment and support further integration into a modern energy system. The Minns Labor Government is working hard to deliver that, and that work is already underway.

The bill is asking us to remove a longstanding set of protections, understandings and practices without providing a credible alternative framework. It tells communities to accept new risks without consultation or clear benefits.

It signals to the sector that New South Wales is an uncertain jurisdiction to do business in. It asks New South Wales to embark upon a course for which there is neither a detailed plan nor a demonstrated need. There has been no community consultation on what would be a huge change in the way we consider uranium and nuclear energy in this State. The Minns Labor Government believes the people of New South Wales deserve better than that. We are focused on strengthening our regional economies, delivering affordable and reliable energy, expanding our critical minerals sector, supporting existing mines through the Government's coal industry plan, and providing certainty for energy infrastructure as we make progress towards a clean energy future. The Government will not support the bill, and I urge all members to vote against it.

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Michael Kemp): It being 1.30 p.m., in accordance with the routine of business, debate is interrupted. I set down resumption of the debate as an order of the day for a later time. I shall now leave the chair. The House will resume at 2.30 p.m.

ENVIRONMENTAL LEGISLATION AMENDMENT (PLASTIC REDUCTION AND CONTAINER RECYCLING) BILL 2026

Returned

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Mark Hodges): I report receipt of a message from the Legislative Council returning the bill without amendment.

Motions

MANUFACTURING INDUSTRY

Debate resumed from 15 October 2026.

Mr TIM CRAKANTHORP (Newcastle) (14:30): I continue my contribution to debate on the motion. Billions of dollars were spent abroad, to the detriment of thousands of local jobs. Major contracts were chronically late and over budget, and they delivered poor products to the people of New South Wales. Former Premier Gladys Berejiklian said, "Australia and New South Wales are not good at building trains. That's why we have to purchase them overseas." Dominic Perrottet said, "It is hard. Trains crack. Sometimes there are challenges with ferries. There are always going to be problems." Chris Rath, who is still a member of Parliament, said:

> It is not easy for us to manufacture mass transportation options, such as ferries, at a reasonable cost. For manufacturing mass transportation, we do not hold the comparative advantage.

From an alleged spend of $2.4 billion to a $4 billion blowout, there is no comparative advantage. I say that Labor is obsessed with the idea of local production, with giving much-needed certainty to workers, and with building a skilled and self-sufficient workforce.

We know the Coalition's record on manufacturing trains in New South Wales. I have just gone through it. What does One Nation think? Mike Newman has attacked the Government's $12 billion investment and proposed an alternative model involving overseas technology partners and foreign state financing. That is just another excuse not to do something we know we have the capability to do in New South Wales and that would support local jobs. It is also just another example of the Liberals, The Nationals and One Nation wanting to make life harder for working families in the Hunter and across the State. The Minns Labor Government's plan is clear: build trains here, rebuild the local workforce and supply chain, and create the certainty the industry needs to invest in New South Wales for decades to come. I commend the motion to the House.

Mr DAVID LAYZELL (Upper Hunter) (14:32): I make a contribution to debate on the motion regarding local jobs and manufacturing, moved by the member for Newcastle. I start by saying that the Opposition will seek to amend the motion. I move:

> That the motion be amended by deleting all words after "House" and inserting instead:
>
> (1) Notes Labor's Tangara refurbishment plan is up to three years behind schedule and that by March 2027 the Government is expected to only have four out of the 55 trains refurbished.
>
> (2) Notes that the first refurbished Tangara train was announced to be serving commuters on 4 September 2026; however, it has only worked for five days and is now mothballed.
>
> (3) Notes that the former Iemma Government ordered the Waratah fleet from China.
>
> (4) Notes that Labor's record on delivering transport projects is one of being late and over budget.

When it comes to train manufacturing, particularly train kits, Labor loves making big announcements heading into an election. Twelve billion is a big number, so everyone wants to know exactly how the money will be spent. Labor should be required to be transparent about how it proposes to spend that $12 billion. It came as a surprise to me that no significant business case was tested by a third party and that there is no financial support for this

idea. There is no real surety, guarantee or commitment that $12 billion will be enough. This could cost significantly more than $12 billion.

Big projects, like Snowy Hydro, can run over badly if the planning is not done right. The Coalition is very concerned about the Labor Government's planning. We have not been able to see exactly where the numbers fall and what the expectations are. When a government throws $12 billion around, people have a right to be nervous. Its recent track record—

Mr Matt Cross: Track, train.

Mr DAVID LAYZELL: Good link there. I thank the member for Davidson. There have been some concerns about the Government's recent announcements, like the huge $1 billion announcement by Albo and Minns about solar panel manufacturing at the AGL site in the Hunter Valley. In the end, nothing came of it. Maybe more is yet to come. We are not sure. But, to date, after nearly three years, nothing has been seen. What has been seen is $180 million for the Black Hill facility, which is an extraordinary amount of money for a foreign manufacturer to build solar panels in a large shed. The Opposition has no issue with that. However, we do not know the numbers behind it. We are right to question whether that project has a strong business case, because the world of manufacturing solar panels is very competitive. China dominates the market, so we must ensure that the Government's $180 million investment makes New South Wales competitive and that money does not just go into the gutter to be washed into the sewer. Opposition members want to make sure that taxpayers' money is spent wisely, which is why we have asked the Government to be more transparent.

The Government announced another renewable manufacturing project in the Hunter: the Energy Renaissance renewable battery. The Government's media releases from then talked of a new age of renewable energy manufacturing. Everyone was there at the announcement, from Federal politicians to local State members. It was a great announcement, but where is the project now? It went belly up, with the equipment sold for about $10,000 and the shed completely emptied out. That is another example of a failed project. There have been many big announcements in the Hunter about the new age of hydrogen that, to date, have also come to nothing. When the Government starts throwing around figures like $12 billion, the Opposition is absolutely within its rights to ask about the Government's capability and its plan.

That is because, again, when it can go wrong, it will go wrong.

The Victoria's Big Build project is an example of how badly this Labor big train project can go wrong. That Victorian project was within the scope of a royal commission that looked at whether CFMEU corruption and organised crime was involved. It was a massive financial waste with huge cost blowouts. It is pretty serious when taxpayers' money is spent and the only business plan is on the back of a fag packet. We want to see a bit more than that and more robust planning. We want to be sure there will be trains at the end of the tunnel when this project is finished. Though we would all love to see train development and manufacturing in the Hunter, the right people need to be managing it. With Labor, there are questions to be asked.

Mr CLAYTON BARR (Cessnock) (14:40): It gives me great pleasure to speak to the motion brought by the member for Newcastle about jobs and manufacturing across the Hunter. I would have thought that members representing electorates across the Hunter would be on a unity ticket to support the investment and the jobs that it would bring. Big-ticket projects have massive flow-on effects for direct and indirect employment. They also lead to wages in people's pockets, meaning the support they can offer to their local business community is limitless. I would have thought the members would be on a unity ticket, even if just on an economic basis, to welcome the investment of $12 billion to bring back train manufacturing to the Hunter.

Unfortunately, the member for Upper Hunter just fundamentally said that the position of the Liberals and The Nationals is to reject this investment. He repeatedly said that he wanted to look at some of the details. I wonder what his position was in the Liberal-Nationals party room when all the metro projects under them blew out dramatically. He was not too concerned about the money. When the wages cap was put on public sector workers, he was not too worried about the cost and impact on the community. When projects were sent offshore and came back not being fit for purpose, with billions spent to fix the mistakes in them, the member for Upper Hunter was not too concerned. The only time he has stood in the Chamber and shown any concern about billions of dollars being spent is when they are being spent in the Hunter. That is his record: the member for Upper Hunter is arguing against billions of dollars being spent in the Hunter.

As someone who grew up in Cessnock and is a Cessnock local, I support the idea of good manufacturing jobs in my area that would secure a future for workers and their family, put a roof over their heads and food on the table. Those were the aspirations of many people that I grew up with. They have gone into careers, forged their future and built a foundation for their family on the back of incredible manufacturing jobs. The only impediment to 100 years of train building in the Hunter was the former Liberal-Nationals Government. It decided

over 10 to12 years that all of that work was to be done overseas. It invested billions of dollars to create thousands of jobs overseas.

On this side of the House, the Labor Party says it is time to bring the jobs and the prosperity back to the Hunter and New South Wales. When families have security and certainty, the benefits flow through to the entire community. Whether it is the local skateboard shop, bicycle shop, cafe, hairdresser or bowling club, or even just enrolments at the local soccer or footy clubs, security brings certainty and confidence. This is a plan for 30-plus years. The member for Upper Hunter should get on board and back it in.

Mr MATT CROSS (Davidson) (14:44): It is great to get on board the debate on this motion. New South Wales has a proud history of trains. The trains in our transport system are very much a product of New South Wales, extending way back through the terms of government of both parties. We should be proud of that. Recently on 2 October I was proud to take my little boy—an 18-month-old tornado—to the K Set final suburban run. He enjoyed it very much. He just wanted to walk up and down the stairs the whole time, so we had to cut the journey short. We have a really proud history of trains. The K Set is clearly well overdue to be retired, but it was great to be a part of some history.

I support the amendment moved by the member for Upper Hunter. Before I get to his amendment, I will talk about the original motion of the member for Newcastle. The first item needs clarification. It says, "That the House commends the Government's commitment to building the next generation of trains." I think he means refurbishing the existing trains. The second point was quite accurate. It asks that the House "notes that the former Government's obsession with outsourcing saw our trains … budget blowouts, delivery delays, and structural and mechanical failures."

That is an accurate statement because where it says "former Government", I think the member means the former Labor Government because train outsourcing started under the Iemma Government, which signed a contract with a Chinese constructing firm in 2006. We can look at where that contract led. In March 2011—during the time of the Keneally Government—journalist Jacob Saulwick said in an article:

> The absent Waratah trains are an embarrassment for the Labor government, though Downer has taken on much of the blame. Yesterday it conceded it did not have enough qualified staff to deliver on its $1.9 billion contract.

The member for Maroubra, who was part of that Government, would remember Mr Saulwick. Not only did the Labor Party outsource its trains; it could not even deliver them properly. I now go to the amendment moved by the member for Upper Hunter. He raises a good point about the Tangara trains. I love a good Tangara and love getting on them, but they really do need a refurbishment. There are 55 sets and the Government said in 2023 that they will be renovated. How many of the 55 have been done since then? Would we say, like, 20?

Mrs Tanya Thompson: At least 10.

Mr MATT CROSS: No, it is lower.

Mrs Tanya Thompson: Maybe five?

Mr MATT CROSS: No. Four out of 55 has been done. In an article, Max Maddison said:

> The $450 million refurbishment of Sydney's nearly 40-year-old Tangara train series is running years behind schedule, amplifying pressure on Labor's signature $12 billion election commitment to replace the fleet.

Members would think that the first set refurbished would be up and running, and taking passengers. However, the article goes on and says:

> Three weeks later, Graham—

that is, of course, the Minister for Transport—

> informed parliament that the train had operated only five times in the 27 days since coming online.

That is another botched Labor project. It cannot get trains to run on time. It talks big on manufacturing, but perhaps it should manufacture something that actually works.

Mr DAVID MEHAN (The Entrance) (14:48): I am pleased to support my colleagues the member for Newcastle and the member for Cessnock. As somebody who grew up in the Hunter, I support this motion on local jobs and manufacturing.

Firstly, I will amend the amendment. I move:

> That the amendment be amended by omitting all words after "House" and inserting instead:
>
> (1) Commends the Government's commitment to building the next generation of New South Wales trains in the State's manufacturing heartland.

(2) Notes that the former Government's obsession with outsourcing saw our trains, ferries, light rail and buses being built overseas, leading to budget blowouts, delivery delays and structural and mechanical failures.

(3) Notes that the former Liberal Government barred agencies from prioritising local New South Wales and Australian businesses over international suppliers.

(4) Commends the Labor Government for removing these restrictions in September 2024 as part of our "if not, why not" policy.

(5) Recognises that only a Labor government will deliver local jobs and local manufacturing.

The Hunter has a long and proud history as an industrial powerhouse. Generations of workers helped build the rail infrastructure and rolling stock that connected communities and drove economic growth. When manufacturing work was sent overseas, the impacts were felt in the Hunter. Local jobs were lost, skilled workers left industries and capability we had relied on declined. As someone who grew up in the Hunter and saw how it hit our community, I make this point: In my backyard was the Goninan factory, where trains were manufactured and upgraded under former Labor governments, before it was closed down by those opposite.

Goninan did not just appear in the Hunter Valley or in the City of Newcastle. It developed in that place because there was steel manufacturing in the city. BHP did not establish steel manufacturing in the City of Newcastle just because those operators decided that Newcastle was the best place to do it. Other States and other cities were clamouring for steel manufacturing to be developed—the first large-scale steel manufacturing developed in this country. They wanted it ahead of Newcastle, but the decided policy of the early Labor Government led to the support being provided to BHP to encourage it to establish its steelworks within Newcastle, which made Newcastle a steel city.

Members criticised the parliamentary Labor Party at the time, as party policy and members' views required the establishment of a government-owned steelworks in Newcastle. The determination of the parliamentary Labor Party to, at the very least, establish a steelworks in Newcastle saw the city become the industrial and steel manufacturing powerhouse that we all know and love. The Minns Labor Government is returning to that sort of traditional Labor commitment to Newcastle through its commitment of $12 billion to the Hunter, to manufacturing in the Hunter and to my home town. That $12 billion, which the member for Upper Hunter said was "throwing around money"—

Mr David Layzell: Like confetti. That is a direct quote.

Mr DAVID MEHAN: I am happy for you to keep that quote. The House should support the amendment to the amendment. We should support manufacturing in the Hunter and support the Minns Labor Government's commitment to the Hunter Valley.

Mr JAMES WALLACE (Hornsby) (14:52): Is my understanding correct that there is actually an amendment by the Labor Government to the Labor Government's own motion, to correct its misinterpretation of the original motion that we are debating today? It is quite unbelievable if there is, because what we are actually debating today—

Mr Tim Crakanthorp: No, you have got it wrong.

Mr JAMES WALLACE: You are not amending your own motion?

Mr Michael Daley: It is an amendment to your amendment.

Mr JAMES WALLACE: Oh, you are amending our amendment, rather than just voting down the amendment. It is a very interesting style of debate. It is interesting that we are effectively having a debate about a motion for a $12 billion press release. That is all we have: one piece of paper and a press release, with a $12 billion figure put against it. It is very difficult to understand what component pieces of spending may add up to a $12 billion figure, but the Labor Party will be able to run around the Hunter spruiking the $12 billion line with its gold-plated or platinum-plated press release. The motion asks the House to commend the Government's commitment, so let us be clear what that commitment actually is: It is a press release. There is no plan, no substance and no detail behind it. There is no manufacturer, no contract and no business case. The actual budget does not allocate $12 billion; it is $150 million over four years. What is that $150 million meant to do? The $150 million is to write a business case, which has not actually been written.

Every other State that has done its own big rail project announcement, which the Minns Government is seeking to copy through its process and its media tactics, actually had a contract signed, a manufacturer in place, a delivery plan devised and a business case for what they were trying to achieve. But that is not the way things work in Government members' world. They play politics by putting out a press release with as big a figure as their minds can imagine in the circumstances, and then they go through a journey of spruiking the press release without ever delivering any detail behind it. We have seen that political strategy time and again. It is taking the culture of announceables to the absolute nth degree. If Government members have a series of amendments to amendments,

I ask them to put forward the detail. Tell us where we can actually find a business case for the proposal. Tell us where we can come up with some costings. The heckle we generally get from the Government is that it is in Newcastle.

Ms Charishma Kaliyanda: Would you like the GPS coordinates?

Mr JAMES WALLACE: We want the business case, the costings and the details of what will be delivered. We want a timetable and a purpose. We want to know the extent of the workforce impacts. We do not need a motion. The Government is not at the stage of commending itself. It has not reached that level given the work that has been done. A government should not commend itself over a press release; it should do the work and then look for the accolades once someone has had an impact from government decisions in their own life. We have to be careful, because we have seen this play out with the Government before. We saw the announcements that we would build buses in Nowra. The Government did not build buses in Nowra but bought them from China and re-stickered them in Nowra. Opposition members are very sceptical. We were told that trains would be bought in New South Wales, but where are the trains for Sydney Metro West being bought? It is from CRRC. They will not be made in Australia. We are very sceptical.

Mr TIM CRAKANTHORP (Newcastle) (14:56): In reply: I thank the member for Upper Hunter, who is still here in the Chamber. I thank the members representing the electorates of Cessnock, Davidson, The Entrance, Hornsby—oh, the member for Hornsby is already going. He came in right at the end and now he is leaving right at the end. He comes in for five seconds and then he is gone. He has never been to Newcastle; he stays in Hornsby. That is all he does. The member for Upper Hunter might want to tell the people he represents that he does not want jobs, does not want local people learning skills and does not want young ones looking for a future. As the Hunter transitions out of coal, where will the jobs be? Here are many hundreds of jobs. The member for Upper Hunter is not looking out for the next generation. He might not even be here next time around, because he is not looking out for his people. One Nation might just take his seat. I thank the member for Cessnock for his contribution, highlighting that the member for Upper Hunter actually opposes $12 million for local manufacturing, which might just bring a few jobs to his electorate.

The member for Davidson has left the Chamber too. Members opposite are not real interested. He was not aware that the Mariyung trains were not even built in New South Wales. He seemed to think all the trains were built here, but they were built in South Korea. They were many years late and went from $2.4 billion to over $5 billion. I do not know where the member for Davidson has been for the past five years. He has apparently been checking out all the trains built in New South Wales—in your dreams, mate. The member for Hornsby was not even sure what we were debating. I do not think he has been out of Hornsby. He came into the Chamber late and left early.

He has come and gone. I do not think he was listening to the beginning of the debate. I do not think he even brought his notes or knew what he was debating.

The reality is that only a Labor government will back the workers in the Hunter and New South Wales. The re-elected Minns Labor Government will revive the manufacturing industry and invest $12 billion into a state-of-the-art, State owned train manufacturing facility in the Hunter to deliver the next generation of passenger trains at Teralba. No other party has demonstrated a commitment as strong as that. The Opposition was committed to employing people in South Korea. They used to call Minister Constance the Minister for Employment over there. He was a great local member for South Korea! One Nation has come out and said that they do not support our investment at all. They do not support the workers in the Hunter. The member for Upper Hunter and One Nation are on a unity ticket. The member wants to be careful as he goes along with One Nation, because they might just slip in. They will support the workers in South Korea.

The former Liberal-Nationals Government's track record speaks for itself—12 years of offshoring, and don't we know about it? The Government's commitment to reviving the manufacturing industry is just one of many ways it is backing workers in the Hunter. It secured thousands of jobs at Tomago. It passed the Local Jobs First Bill 2026 to prioritise local jobs, no matter the government of the day. This week it finally passed the Future Jobs and Investment Bill 2025, after it was held hostage by the Coalition and the crossbench in the upper House. The bill will provide much-needed protections and support coal producing regions such as the Hunter as we transition to clean and renewable industries. We reject the amendments moved by the Coalition. We support our own amendments.

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Mark Hodges): The member for Newcastle has moved a motion, to which the member for Upper Hunter has moved an amendment, to which the member for The Entrance has moved a further amendment. The question is that the amendment of the member for The Entrance to the amendment of the member for Upper Hunter be agreed to.

The House divided.

Ayes 47
Noes 35
Majority.....12

AYES

Aitchison, J	Greenwich, A	Minns, C
Atalla, E	Hagarty, N (teller)	O'Neill, M
Bali, S	Harris, D	Park, R
Barr, C	Harrison, J	Quinnell, S
Butler, L	Haylen, J	Saliba, D
Butler, R	Hoenig, R	Scully, P
Car, P	Holland, M	Shetty, K
Catley, Y	Kaliyanda, C	Stuart, M
Chanthivong, A	Kamper, S	Tesch, L (teller)
Cotsis, S	Kirby, W	Vo, T
Crakanthorp, T	Leong, J	Voltz, L
Daley, M	Li, J	Warren, G
Davis, D	McDermott, H	Washington, K
Dib, J	McInerney, K	Whan, S
Doyle, T	McKeown, K	Wilkinson, K
Finn, J	Mehan, D	

NOES

Ayyad, T	Henskens, A	Singh, G
Clancy, J	James, T	Speakman, M
Cooke, S	Kemp, M	Taylor, M
Coure, M	Lane, J	Thompson, T
Cross, M	Layzell, D	Toole, P
Crouch, A (teller)	McGirr, J	Tuckerman, W
Dalton, H	Petinos, E	Tudehope, M
Davies, T	Preston, R	Wallace, J
Di Pasqua, S	Provest, G	Williams, R
Donato, P	Roberts, A	Williamson, R (teller)
Dwyer, R	Saunders, D	Wilson, F
Griffin, J	Scruby, J	

PAIRS

Anderson, K	Saffin, J
Moylan, B	Watson, A
Sloane, K	Hornery, S

Amendment of the member for The Entrance to the amendment of the member for Upper Hunter agreed to.

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Mark Hodges): The question now is that the amendment of the member for Upper Hunter as amended by the member for The Entrance be agreed to.

The House divided.

Ayes 47
Noes 35
Majority.....12

AYES

Aitchison, J	Greenwich, A	Minns, C
Atalla, E	Hagarty, N (teller)	O'Neill, M
Bali, S	Harris, D	Park, R
Barr, C	Harrison, J	Quinnell, S

AYES

Butler, L	Haylen, J	Saliba, D
Butler, R	Hoenig, R	Scully, P
Car, P	Holland, M	Shetty, K
Catley, Y	Kaliyanda, C	Stuart, M
Chanthivong, A	Kamper, S	Tesch, L (teller)
Cotsis, S	Kirby, W	Vo, T
Crakanthorp, T	Leong, J	Voltz, L
Daley, M	Li, J	Warren, G
Davis, D	McDermott, H	Washington, K
Dib, J	McInerney, K	Whan, S
Doyle, T	McKeown, K	Wilkinson, K
Finn, J	Mehan, D	

NOES

Ayyad, T	Henskens, A	Singh, G
Clancy, J	James, T	Speakman, M
Cooke, S	Kemp, M	Taylor, M
Coure, M	Lane, J	Thompson, T
Cross, M	Layzell, D	Toole, P
Crouch, A (teller)	McGirr, J	Tuckerman, W
Dalton, H	Petinos, E	Tudehope, M
Davies, T	Preston, R	Wallace, J
Di Pasqua, S	Provest, G	Williams, R
Donato, P	Roberts, A	Williamson, R (teller)
Dwyer, R	Saunders, D	Wilson, F
Griffin, J	Scruby, J	

PAIRS

Hornery, S	Anderson, K
Saffin, J	Moylan, B
Watson, A	Sloane, K

Amendment as amended agreed to.

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Mark Hodges): The question now is that the motion as amended be agreed to.

The House divided.

Ayes 48
Noes 35
Majority.....13

AYES

Aitchison, J	Greenwich, A	Minns, C
Atalla, E	Hagarty, N (teller)	O'Neill, M
Bali, S	Harris, D	Park, R
Barr, C	Harrison, J	Piper, G
Butler, L	Haylen, J	Quinnell, S
Butler, R	Hoenig, R	Saliba, D
Car, P	Holland, M	Scully, P
Catley, Y	Kaliyanda, C	Shetty, K
Chanthivong, A	Kamper, S	Stuart, M
Cotsis, S	Kirby, W	Tesch, L (teller)
Crakanthorp, T	Leong, J	Vo, T
Daley, M	Li, J	Voltz, L
Davis, D	McDermott, H	Warren, G
Dib, J	McInerney, K	Washington, K

AYES

Doyle, T	McKeown, K	Whan, S
Finn, J	Mehan, D	Wilkinson, K

NOES

Ayyad, T	Henskens, A	Singh, G
Clancy, J	James, T	Speakman, M
Cooke, S	Kemp, M	Taylor, M
Coure, M	Lane, J	Thompson, T
Cross, M	Layzell, D	Toole, P
Crouch, A (teller)	McGirr, J	Tuckerman, W
Dalton, H	Petinos, E	Tudehope, M
Davies, T	Preston, R	Wallace, J
Di Pasqua, S	Provest, G	Williams, R
Donato, P	Roberts, A	Williamson, R (teller)
Dwyer, R	Saunders, D	Wilson, F
Griffin, J	Scruby, J	

PAIRS

Hornery, S	Moylan, B
Saffin, J	Sloane, K
Watson, A	Anderson, K

Motion as amended agreed to.

CONCORD FIRE STATION

Ms STEPHANIE DI PASQUA (Drummoyne) (15:20): I move:

That this House:

(1) Rejects the closure of Concord Fire Station.

(2) Calls on the Government to rule out completely a closure of Concord Fire Station.

(3) Condemns the Government for adding more than 30,000 homes in the Drummoyne community and taking away vital infrastructure like the local fire station.

I move this motion in Parliament to send a very clear message to the Minns Labor Government: Hands off Concord Fire Station. This is a massive issue for my community. What sort of government plans for 30,000 more homes but cannot guarantee the local fire station will stay open? More homes, more people, more high-rises, more traffic—but one less fire station. You do not need to be a mathematician to see that it does not add up; you just need a bit of common sense. For more than a year, residents across Concord, North Strathfield, Five Dock, Mortlake, Breakfast Point and the wider community of the Drummoyne electorate have been asking one simple question: Will Concord Fire Station remain open? Yes or no? It is not a trick question or a complicated question; it is a yes or no question.

But, apparently, for the Minns Labor Government and the Minister, it is just too hard to answer. We cannot get a straight answer out of them. I have asked the Minister five times. I have written to him and raised the issue directly with him. I have taken the concerns of local residents to the Government time and again. What have we received? No guarantee, no certainty, no straight answer—just bureaucratic drivel. If Labor can find room for 60,000 new homes—which is what City of Canada Bay Council estimates we will see over the next 15 years due to Labor planning changes—surely it can find room for one existing fire station to remain open. It should not be rocket science.

We should not get some bureaucratic drivel response that the Government has started consultation on the future of the fire station with affected staff. If it does not plan to close the fire station, why is it even consulting staff in the first place about what a merger with Rhodes Fire Station might look like? That seems crazy to me. The longer the Government refuses to rule out a closure, the angrier our community becomes with Labor. This is a busy working fire station that our community relies on. According to the latest data from Fire and Rescue NSW, it is one of the busiest fire stations in Sydney. Let that sink in. It has nearly 2,000 emergency responses in a year. That is more than five responses every day on average.

Labor cannot tell us whether it intends to keep the fire station open. One of the busiest fire stations not just in metropolitan Sydney but in New South Wales should not be on the chopping block. It should be on the priority list. You would think that would be obvious, but apparently it is not to the Labor Government. It gets even more ridiculous. The Minns Labor Government is pushing ahead with massive housing density across our community. More than 60,000 new homes are projected in the next 15 years, and more than 30,000 new homes are in the pipeline around Concord Fire Station. Closing Concord Fire Station leaves a big black hole on the map. It means calls for Fire and Rescue services in our community could be answered by Silverwater, which is nowhere near us.

Labor's Transport Oriented Development plan in North Strathfield and Homebush is for 18,000 homes, including towers of up to 50 storeys at the McDonald College site and 18,300 homes in the Burwood North and Concord precinct. I know we need more homes. I have nothing against new families moving into our community. But, when we build more homes, we need the infrastructure and services to support them. That is basic planning. You do not build mini suburbs and forget the roads and schools, and you certainly do not build 50-storey towers and close the fire station down the road. Yet here we are. Labor wants the housing targets and the density. But, when it comes to infrastructure that keeps people safe, it suddenly crumbles. It cannot answer the questions.

I deeply respect the Minister for Emergency Services. He is a good person. But we cannot agree on this issue because, when someone calls 000, they expect services to arrive quickly. They care about how quickly the fire truck gets there. Closing Concord Fire Station will mean longer response times—no ifs or buts about it. The staff of Concord Fire Station are amazing. I know them. They live and work in our community. They are devastated. They have been silenced by the Government. They cannot question the decisions and have to go along with it. They are not allowed to talk to anyone, including the media, about it. They are not allowed to campaign to keep the station open. They are just told to keep quiet and shut up to save their job. That is wrong. Closing Concord Fire Station is a silly decision. Members should not just take my word for it. They should ask my community what they think. Kevin from Mortlake wrote directly to the Minister. He said:

> I write to you to raise my concern and horror at this proposal.
>
> As a Mortlake resident and business owner, sighting an ever-increasing population, traffic congestion, non-stop building developments and construction, this makes no public sense to me at all. The small similar facility at Rhodes is not … positioned for rapid response for our overpopulated neighbouring suburbs. I ask that this proposal be disbanded

The response from the Minister's office was bureaucratic drivel. I do not understand why it is so hard. If members opposite are going to close the fire station, they should just say so. If they are going to keep it open and have no plans to close it, they should just say so and rule it out. The long responses and the bureaucratic drivel that say nothing tell us everything. Those opposite cannot rule out the closure of Concord Fire Station because they want to close it. The Labor Government, the Labor Minister and the Labor candidate for Drummoyne need to keep their hands off Concord Fire Station. Keep it open, because this is not about playing politics; this is about our community and about knowing that, when an emergency happens, every second counts. Concord Road just cannot cope with the longer response times if we close Concord Fire Station.

Mr JASON LI (Strathfield) (15:27): On behalf of the Government, I oppose the motion moved by the member for Drummoyne. I foreshadow that the Government will move amendments to it. I understand why residents care deeply about Concord Fire Station. Fire stations are important community institutions. They carry history and service and a sense of reassurance. Of course, people are entitled to know who is going to come to help them out if there is an emergency. But those questions require serious answers, not politics or fearmongering in the community, and not conclusions announced before the evidence is in.

The Government opposes this motion for three simple reasons. First, no decision has been made to close Concord Fire Station. Concord Fire Station remains operational. Fire and Rescue NSW is consulting with staff and stakeholders about the best long-term service model for Canada Bay and surrounding suburbs. That review is looking at all sorts of things: population growth, housing density, new development, transport links, local hazards, incident history and emergency response coverage. Those are exactly the sorts of things that we want the experts and the professionals to consider.

However, the motion moved by the member for Drummoyne asks members of Parliament to decide the answer before Fire and Rescue NSW has completed the assessment. That is why we do not support it.

The community is growing. The member for Drummoyne said that the population may grow by 30,000 homes. If that is the case, that is exactly why we must plan properly for that growth. It cannot be said that we are not putting in infrastructure to go with housing when the review and the new Rhodes station do exactly that. Secondly, fire stations must be fit for purpose. The existing station in Rhodes is so small that a fire truck cannot be parked in the garage, and there is a toilet in the front yard. The former Government had years to address the ageing fire infrastructure in the area, but it did nothing.

Ms Stephanie Di Pasqua: Point of order—

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Mark Hodges): The Clerk will stop the clock.

Ms Stephanie Di Pasqua: I take a point of order on relevance. The motion relates to Concord Fire Station, which is important to my community. The member for Strathfield is speaking about Rhodes Fire Station. He should constrain his remarks to Concord Fire Station.

The SPEAKER: There is no point of order.

Ms Stephanie Di Pasqua: To the point of order—

The SPEAKER: There is no point of order. The member for Drummoyne will resume her seat.

Mr JASON LI: The point of order shows that the member for Drummoyne does not understand the networked way in which fire and emergency services work, but I will come to that in a second. We cannot demand a new and modern fire station at Rhodes, which the member for Drummoyne has repeatedly called for, but then insist that Fire and Rescue NSW must not examine what the new station means for the surrounding network. There will be a new fire station in Rhodes, yet the member for Drummoyne does not want to look at the network effects of that. We cannot be asked to build the new network but forbid the experts from reviewing the old one. Concord Fire Station dates back to 1929 and sits on a small, heritage listed site. It has served the community proudly for almost a century, and that history deserves respect. But a fire station is not a museum piece; it is a workplace from which firefighters go out and save lives.

Modern firefighters deal with structural fires, road crashes, rescues, hazardous materials and dangerous contaminants. They need proper clean and dirty zones, decontamination areas, equipment storage, training facilities and appropriate amenities. They deal with modern, high-tech firefighting vehicles. Those are not luxuries; they support firefighter safety. Supporting firefighters means giving them workplaces that are safe enough to do the work we ask them to do. We can respect the history of Concord Fire Station while acknowledging that modern emergency services have evolved. That brings me to my third point, which the point of order from the member for Drummoyne showed she clearly does not understand. Emergency services operate as a network. Community safety is not determined by whether every suburb has a building with "fire station" written across the front; it is determined by how quickly the right crew, with the right equipment, can reach someone in an emergency.

Fire does not respect suburb boundaries, and neither can emergency services planning. Fire and Rescue NSW has advised that the optimum distance between stations for effective coverage is between nine kilometres and 11 kilometres. The on-road distance between Burwood Fire Station and the land the Government has acquired for a future Rhodes station is about 7.8 kilometres, which is well within that range. Concord station sits right in the middle, about 3.5 kilometres from the future Rhodes site and about 3.6 kilometres from Burwood station. Those figures do not decide everything, but they demonstrate exactly why the professionals at Fire and Rescue NSW need to assess the network as a whole. The question is not where the nearest fire building is but how quickly firefighters can get there when they are needed. That question should guide those decisions.

The member for Drummoyne said that the Government is adding homes while taking away infrastructure, but the Government has acquired land for a new fire station in Rhodes. The member for Drummoyne cannot seriously say that we are taking away fire infrastructure when we are building the next generation of fire infrastructure. Our position is clear: No decision has been made. Our firefighters deserve modern, safe, fit-for-purpose facilities. Emergency services must be planned as a network, based on evidence, risk and how quickly they can help people. Our job is not to preserve every single brick; our job is to protect every community. For those reasons, the Government cannot support the motion in its current form.

Mr MATT CROSS: I move:

That the question be now put.

The House divided.

Ayes 34
Noes 46
Majority.....12

AYES

Anderson, K	Henskens, A	Singh, G
Ayyad, T	Lane, J	Speakman, M
Clancy, J	Layzell, D	Taylor, M
Cooke, S	McGirr, J	Thompson, T

AYES

Coure, M	Moylan, B	Toole, P
Cross, M	Petinos, E	Tuckerman, W
Crouch, A (teller)	Preston, R	Tudehope, M
Dalton, H	Provest, G	Wallace, J
Davies, T	Roberts, A	Williams, R
Di Pasqua, S	Saunders, D	Williamson, R (teller)
Dwyer, R	Scruby, J	Wilson, F
Griffin, J		

NOES

Aitchison, J	Hagarty, N (teller)	Minns, C
Atalla, E	Harris, D	O'Neill, M
Bali, S	Harrison, J	Park, R
Barr, C	Haylen, J	Quinnell, S
Butler, L	Hoenig, R	Saliba, D
Butler, R	Holland, M	Scully, P
Car, P	Kaliyanda, C	Shetty, K
Catley, Y	Kamper, S	Stuart, M
Chanthivong, A	Kirby, W	Tesch, L (teller)
Cotsis, S	Leong, J	Vo, T
Crakanthorp, T	Li, J	Voltz, L
Daley, M	McDermott, H	Warren, G
Davis, D	McInerney, K	Washington, K
Dib, J	McKeown, K	Whan, S
Doyle, T	Mehan, D	Wilkinson, K
Finn, J		

PAIRS

James, T	Hornery, S
Kemp, M	Saffin, J
Sloane, K	Watson, A

Motion negatived.

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Mark Hodges): The time for consideration of general business notices of motion or orders for the day not being bills having expired, I set down the resumption of the interrupted debate as an order of the day for a later time.

Bills

ELECTRICITY LEGISLATION AMENDMENT BILL 2026

Second Reading Debate

Debate resumed from 14 October 2026.

Ms FELICITY WILSON (North Shore) (15:44): I lead for the Opposition on the Electricity Legislation Amendment Bill 2026. This is a curious bill with two unrelated parts. Firstly, the bill will amend the Electricity Supply Act 1995 by inserting new part 5F, which will incorporate into the Act the overarching scheme for regulating corrosion protection systems and sources of stray current leakage, leaving the more technical aspects to be addressed in the regulations. This change is supported by stakeholders and rightly reflects the need for a robust approach to managing these two important areas of the safe management of electrical systems. The bill defines a corrosion protection system as follows:

> … a system for the protection from corrosion of a metallic structure that is in contact with land or water if the system—
>
> (i) is comprised of apparatus, including appliances, wires or fittings, and
>
> (ii) operates using electrical current …

This is very technical, and such systems need to be operated only by those with the requisite technical knowledge and the understanding of the safety issues involved. The bill establishes an appropriately robust system for

managing approvals, including appropriate penalties for operating a corrosion protection system without the required approvals.

The bill defines leakage current to mean the transmission of electrical current by a current conducting apparatus or corrosion protection system other than through the intended circuit. Electrical currents are powerful and useful when kept in the intended circuit. The bill includes an obligation on "the operator of a current conducting apparatus" to "ensure the apparatus is operated in a way that limits the risk of leakage current, and minimises risks arising from leakage current of harm to persons, and damage to property", with corresponding penalties for failing to meet that obligation.

Secondly, the bill will amend the Electricity Infrastructure Investment Act 2020 by giving two new functions to the infrastructure planner. Under section 63 of the Act, the infrastructure planner is any person appointed by the Minister for Energy to be the infrastructure planner for all or any of the functions set out in that section. The Energy Corporation of New South Wales—EnergyCo—was appointed as the infrastructure planner for the five renewable energy zones [REZs] as well as the Waratah Super Battery Project and the Hunter Transmission Project.

The Act also refers in section 45 to a consumer trustee. The consumer trustee is AusEnergy Services Limited, an independent subsidiary of the Australian Energy Market Operator. Under section 45 of the Act, the consumer trustee is charged with preparing a report about the infrastructure investment objectives that contains the development pathway for the infrastructure that is required to be constructed over the following 20 years to achieve the infrastructure investment objectives, and a plan for the competitive tenders that the consumer trustee will conduct during the following 10 years to give effect to the development pathway, including when tenders will be conducted and the classes of long-term energy service agreements for which a tender will be conducted. These plans are to be updated every two years.

Those infrastructure investment objectives are set out in section 44 of the Act and include an objective of eight gigawatts of generation capacity from the New England Renewable Energy Zone by 2030. However, I note that the *2025 Infrastructure Investment Objectives Report* shows that this objective will not be met until 2034-35, with less than two gigawatts anticipated for 2030-31. The Opposition has announced a policy to reduce the infrastructure investment objective for the New England REZ to a more realistic three gigawatts, which will not require the expensive and intrusive upgrade of the existing 330-kilovolt line to a 500-kilovolt line.

In May 2023 EnergyCo did release a report on a 20-year strategy to transform the New South Wales electricity network. However, there is currently no statutory requirement for such a plan to complement the rolling statutory 20-year plan produced by the consumer trustee. The bill will introduce such a statutory requirement for the infrastructure planner to produce every two years, beginning with a first report by 1 January 2028; a 20-year plan setting out the anticipated network requirements for the New South Wales electricity system; strategic projects to address the anticipated network requirements; and the ways in which identified projects may be delivered, including arrangements for cost recovery. In the other place the Opposition will be moving amendments to ensure that the 20-year plans include the projected total cost of addressing the anticipated network requirements, the projected cost of each identified project to address these requirements and, most importantly, the likely impact of addressing the anticipated network requirements on electricity costs for New South Wales electricity customers, and measures identified to reduce the impact on residential and small business customers.

Mr NATHAN HAGARTY (Leppington) (15:49): I speak in support of the Electricity Legislation Amendment Bill 2026, which is a very exciting bill. In essence, the bill is designed to ensure that the energy system in this great State is fit for purpose not only now but into the future. We know there are significant demands on the current energy network. Probably every jurisdiction in this great State is having a debate about energy in some fashion. There are debates about data centres. There are debates about renewable energy zones. I know plenty of people are keen to get a home battery and some solar panels on their roof. That, of course, results in an incredibly complex and more decentralised network. The bill is about ensuring that the structure and planning is in place to manage the network well for many years to come.

The bill implements a number of key recommendations from the transmission planning review, or TPR. I warn the many, many hundreds of people watching at home that this speech will contain a lot of acronyms, and I will do my best to explain them. The goal of the TPR was to establish a framework for whole-of-system network planning in New South Wales, or NSW—there is another acronym. Specifically, the bill's consequential amendments include that it establishes an infrastructure planner. At the moment that responsibility sits with Transgrid but, given the reforms undertaken by the previous Government, it is much better that it will now sit with EnergyCo. Essentially, the infrastructure planner, or IP, will be required to prepare, consult on and publish a New South Wales system plan. The idea is to coordinate network planning across the State.

As part of this, there will be a framework for EnergyCo to take on the role of jurisdictional planning body—here is another acronym—or JPB, for New South Wales. The bill also enables targeted modifications to the application of the National Electricity Law and the National Electricity Rules—or the NEL and the NER—in New South Wales to mandate joint planning and enable information sharing between the IP, network operators and—here we go again—the Australian Energy Market Operator, or AEMO. The bill will amend JPB functions to make accommodations for the New South Wales system plan, allow cost recovery arrangements, and include necessary savings or transitional matters.

There will be a requirement for the infrastructure planner to publish guidelines detailing how it performs its functions, including preparing the system plan. That is an incredibly important element of the bill because this is a government that is all about transparency. We will ensure that consumers and anyone else can see how this agency operates and how it implements its framework so that people understand the answers to all the important questions—what is going on, when is it happening and how much is it going to cost. Ultimately, as I said at the outset, the bill is about ensuring that we have an energy system in this State that is fit for purpose not just for the present but also for the future.

The bill will enhance network safety by introducing a framework for regulating corrosion protection systems and sources of stray current leakage. Given that energy is one of the biggest contributors to the cost of living at the moment, if we can identify stray current leakage, that is a good thing. These measures will allow for more robust compliance and enforcement. They will protect both the public and infrastructure from the long-term effects of stray current. As members know, stray current leakage can lead to accelerated corrosion, which obviously has a cost to the network, and the distributed network service providers, or DNSPs—there is another acronym—have a cost recovery model that flows through to energy prices.

If we can keep the network more robust and it stays in better condition for longer, the network does not need to be maintained and upgraded as often and the benefits flow through to energy prices. That can only be a good thing. The bill also clarifies the scope of regulations that can be made in relation to de-energisation and re-energisation. It also makes several necessary amendments to minimise administrative burden and improve the operation of existing policy. Those who are still listening will have noted that this is a very complex area of policy. I am the deputy chair of the Legislative Assembly Committee on Transport and Infrastructure, which recently undertook an inquiry into electric vehicles, electric vehicle infrastructure and alternative fuel sources.

By the end of the inquiry, we unknowingly became experts in the energy market. You quickly discover that it is a complex area. There are obviously considerations about the way Federal and State governments interact. There is obviously the public part of the network and the private part of the network. Then there is, of course, the need to ensure that consumers are protected, that they get value for money and, most importantly, that the lights come on when they flip the switch. There are large amounts of incredibly complex and opaque regulation, policy and legislation in this space. Anything that minimises the administrative burden and improves the operation of existing policy is a good thing. This Government is deadset dedicated to cutting red tape and making things easier, especially when it comes to business in this State.

I touch briefly on modernising whole-of-network planning. In 2025 the TPR identified inefficiencies and complexity arising from network planning arrangements being split between national and State frameworks. That goes exactly to what I just said about complexity. The review recommended appointing a single public interest entity—which, of course, under this bill would be EnergyCo—whose job it would be to coordinate transmission planning right across the State in conjunction with network operators and market bodies. Currently, the problem is that the number of different providers in this space each have different responsibilities and accountabilities. We will get better outcomes if we have one body sitting above them that is responsible and accountable for all of that. The Government has decided to implement that recommendation by way of this bill.

The Government accepted in principle some other core recommendations of the TPR. The bill amends the Electricity Infrastructure Investment Act 2020 to establish the mechanisms required to deliver on the Government's commitments in relation to those recommendations. The bill enables regulations to modify the application of the NEL and the NER to facilitate the appointment of EnergyCo as the IP and the New South Wales JPB. These reforms establish a formal joint planning obligation between EnergyCo, the network providers and the Federal oversight body, AEMO.

The bill also requires that EnergyCo, in its capacity as the IP—and this is the exciting bit for me—will deliver a 20-year New South Wales system plan that will consolidate State and national planning inputs to coordinate strategic electricity network projects across New South Wales. At the outset, I spoke about how the network is changing, and changing rapidly. Various energy generation types are coming online, and they are much more decentralised. Back in the day, our energy network was essentially a bunch of coal-fired power stations plugged into some wires, and away we went. We know that is no longer the case. It is quite different. [*Extension of time*]

The system plan is underway, and the IP plans to publish it on 1 January 2028. That will set out how, over the next 20 years, we will stay ahead of the curve and ensure that the energy network is delivering for customers across our great State. I commend the bill to the House.

Mr PAUL TOOLE (Bathurst) (16:00): I speak in debate on the Electricity Legislation Amendment Bill 2026. I have serious concerns with the bill to raise before the House, and those concerns have been raised by communities about the way in which some of these entities have behaved in the past.

The ASSISTANT SPEAKER (Mr Jason Li): It being 4.00 p.m., pursuant to standing and sessional orders, debate is interrupted for the petitions take-note debate. I set down resumption of the debate as an order of the day for a later hour.

Petitions

BAIL AND HOME DETENTION

The ASSISTANT SPEAKER (Mr Jason Li): I welcome and acknowledge members of the public in the public gallery. I remind members that this will be an emotional topic. I urge members to exercise the greatest respect during this debate.

The question is that the House take note of the petition.

Ms LIZA BUTLER (South Coast) (16:01): I warmly welcome Carol and Lawrence Micallef to the public gallery today. I am incredibly proud to bring this petition for Bailey's law before the House on behalf of Carol, a remarkable woman from my electorate. I am proud to have supported Carol in establishing this parliamentary petition, which attracted more than 40,000 signatures. I sincerely thank everyone who supported this campaign.

Carol is a mother who has endured every parent's worst nightmare, losing her beautiful son, Bailey, to a senseless act of violence. As a mother myself, my heart breaks for Carol and her family and every family in these circumstances. No parent should ever have to experience such unimaginable loss. What strikes me most is Carol's determination that Bailey's death will not have been in vain. Carol wants answers, accountability and, above all, changes that could prevent another family from enduring the heartbreak hers will carry forever.

Before I speak about the reforms, I want the House to remember who Bailey was. Bailey Jones was just 18 years old when his life was tragically cut short on 9 December 2022. He was a much-loved son, grandson and friend who loved to play rugby league, worked in his family's seafood business and was completing an apprenticeship as a welder. He had dreams, ambitions and his whole life ahead of him. The person responsible for Bailey's death was serving a sentence for armed robbery in the community under an intensive correction order, including home detention. He was subsequently convicted of manslaughter.

For Carol, this has raised serious questions about how offenders are assessed and supervised and whether the safeguards designed to protect our communities are strong enough. These questions deserve a meaningful response. An intensive correction order is a custodial sentence served in the community under supervision. While rehabilitation has an important role in our justice system, it must go hand in hand with community safety and genuine accountability. Bailey's law calls for stronger safeguards and greater accountability for offenders serving intensive correction orders.

The petition seeks stricter eligibility requirements, particularly for violent and repeat offenders. It calls for intensified supervision, including random weekly compliance checks, electronic monitoring and enforceable exclusion zones. It also seeks stronger drug and alcohol testing, random searches for illegal drugs and weapons, monitoring of concerning social media activity, improved travel reporting requirements and greater powers to review and amend orders.

At the heart of these proposals is a simple principle: If an offender is serving a sentence in the community, supervision must be effective, safeguards must be enforced and breaches must have consequences. I sincerely thank the Attorney General and the Minister for Corrections for meeting with Carol and hearing firsthand about the devastating impact of Bailey's death. I acknowledge the Attorney General's formal response, which outlines existing safeguards, including electronic monitoring, travel restrictions and the State Parole Authority's powers to respond to breaches.

But Carol's campaign asks us to consider not only what powers exist, but whether they are being used consistently and effectively. Having the power to impose a condition is one thing; ensuring it is actively monitored and enforced is another. I particularly welcome the Attorney General's referral to the NSW Sentencing Council to review offences excluded from intensive correction orders and consider whether additional offences should be

excluded. That is an important step forward, and I will continue advocating for community safety and the experiences of victims and their families to be central to that review.

I am also advocating for stronger supervision and enforcement, including risk-based random compliance checks, mandatory drug and alcohol testing where warranted, and lawful searches for illegal drugs and weapons. Where a parent, guardian or other authorised person has a formal supervision role, planned absences or travel should be reported in advance, with alternative arrangements confirmed. We must ensure warning signs are identified early, breaches are acted upon promptly and supervision is genuinely effective.

This is not about abandoning rehabilitation. It is about ensuring rehabilitation is supported by accountability and genuine protections for our community. Every time Carol tells Bailey's story, she relives that heartbreak. Yet Carol continues because she believes meaningful reform could prevent another family from suffering the same devastating loss. We owe it to Carol, to Bailey's memory and to every family in our community to take these concerns seriously and continue working towards a safer and more accountable justice system.

Mr PHILIP DONATO (Orange) (16:06): From the outset, I acknowledge constituents of mine who are in the gallery today, Gordon and Wendy Eggins. I acknowledge the tragic and avoidable loss of their son, Ricky, whom I will talk more about shortly. I also acknowledge Caroline Micallef for initiating this important petition and the member for South Coast for bringing it to the House. I also thank the Attorney General for being in the Chamber for consideration of this important petition.

I speak in support of the petition calling for meaningful reform of intensive correction orders and community correction orders in New South Wales. This petition is not simply about legislation, sentencing or supervision. It is about lives lost, families forever changed and our responsibility to listen when our community calls for change. On 9 December 2022 Bailey Jones was fatally stabbed by Dominic Saliba, who was serving an intensive correction order under home detention at the time. As the member for South Coast said, Saliba was found guilty of manslaughter.

Behind those facts is a mother, Caroline Micallef, who has endured the unimaginable loss of her son. Rather than be silenced by grief, Caroline has channelled it into a campaign to protect other families, now known as Bailey's law. I acknowledge her courage, dedication and commitment to reform. No speech can undo what happened to Bailey. But we can choose to learn from this tragedy and strengthen the safeguards meant to protect our community.

This is not an isolated case. In March 2019 Richard Eggins, who was known as Ricky, was killed in Orange at the violent hands of Darryle Tailford. Tailford was intoxicated at the time of this senseless killing and was subject to an intensive correction order. A jury subsequently found Tailford guilty of manslaughter. The circumstances differ from Bailey's case, and I do not suggest supervision alone would have prevented this death. But in both cases, the offender was serving an intensive correction order. In both cases, violence escalated rapidly, with consequences that can never be reversed.

Intensive correction orders have a place in our justice system as an alternative to full-time imprisonment. But community-based sentence options must come with genuine accountability. Conditions must be meaningful and compliance actively and strictly monitored, while breaches are addressed promptly.

A condition that only exists on paper protects nobody. That is why Caroline's petition deserves serious consideration. It proposes random in-person compliance checks; stronger supervision and eligibility requirements for violent and repeat offenders; electronic monitoring and enforceable exclusion zones; random drug and alcohol testing; appropriate monitoring of online activity and warning signs; and, where legally justified, random searches of residences for drugs and weapons. It also calls for clearer reporting obligations for responsible persons or sureties when an offender travels, and stronger powers for courts to review conditions as circumstances change.

I have raised electronic monitoring in the House before. During debate on the Mental Health Legislation Amendment Bill 2024, I moved an amendment to mandate GPS ankle bracelets for forensic patients granted unsupervised leave. Neither the Government nor the Opposition supported that. Forensic patients and offenders on correctional orders are different, and GPS monitoring is no substitute for proper risk assessment, supervision and timely intervention. But the question remains: When someone lives in the community under restrictive conditions, are we doing everything reasonably possible to make those conditions enforceable and to keep the community safe? Where monitoring is necessary, that should be considered.

Reform also requires sufficient staffing, reliable compliance checks, communication between agencies and proper responses to warning signs and breaches. Supporting Bailey's law does not mean abandoning rehabilitation or assuming everyone on a community-based sentence will reoffend. It means rehabilitation and community safety working together, eligibility informed by risk, and enforcement of court-imposed conditions. Caroline Micallef should not have to carry the fight alone. No single law will prevent every tragedy, but we must examine the gaps,

strengthen safeguards and ensure the lessons of those deaths are not ignored. I support the petition and call on the Government and all members to give its reforms serious and constructive consideration for Bailey, Caroline, Ricky Eggins and his loved ones, and every family who deserves a justice system that does everything reasonably possible to protect them. I commend the petition to the House.

Mr NATHAN HAGARTY (Leppington) (16:11): I take note of the petition lodged by the member for South Coast, which calls for reforms to intensive correction orders, also known as Bailey's law. I acknowledge Caroline and everyone in the gallery for the work and advocacy they have done. Getting 40,000 signatures on a petition shows they are doing the right thing and are on the right path, and that a significant part of this State is behind them. I also extend my deepest sympathies to them. I have two kids, a 19-year-old daughter and a 17-year-old son. Every time I speak to a bill or petition like this one, I cannot help but think about my two kids. I cannot imagine the immense tragedy that Caroline and her family have gone through. I commend them for their extraordinary determination and for the fact they have turned that tragedy into something. They have advocated for change and want to do what they can to ensure something like what happened to Bailey never happens again.

Advocacy is a bit of a theme this week. Yesterday, the House discussed laws about serious road crime. Those reforms have been driven by the parents of children who were killed in tragic circumstances. In some examples, the perpetrators of those crimes fled the scene and tried to cover their tracks. Those families did incredible work to ensure the laws were changed. One of the advocates is a constituent from my electorate whose son died in a car accident not far from my office. Yesterday she won Westfield's Local Hero for her work on serious road crime reform. She has worked for the Road Trauma Support Group and goes to schools to teach kids about road safety. I make that point because, in much the same way, this petition is about a mother and a family who have decided that they will do everything they possibly can to ensure that something like this does not happen again. The most effective way to do that is to use the laws in this State to effect change and make sure that community expectations are matched by the laws.

In my dealings with the Attorney General across a whole range of issues around community safety, he has had an open door. He appreciates that, while the legal fraternity has a certain expectation, the community also has a certain expectation, and laws need to be crafted with that in mind. When the laws do not work, they need to change. I can rattle off a number of examples where the Attorney General has been incredibly effective in ensuring that community safety in this State remains paramount. I think every member has that as their primary focus. Members come to Parliament to do everything they can to ensure that community safety is paramount.

The petition raises a number of important questions about the circumstances in which intensive correction orders are made available, how offenders are supervised in the community and what action should be taken when offenders fail to comply with those obligations. Those are serious matters, and the Government recognises that legitimate concerns have been raised. That is why the Attorney General has referred the NSW Sentencing Council to undertake a comprehensive review of the offences for which intensive correction orders are available. It will provide an independent, evidence-based review that will examine whether certain exclusions remain appropriate and whether additional serious offences should be excluded from eligibility.

The Government has undertaken a number of other measures during its first term to ensure that the community remains safe. I recognise that those measures may not answer every concern raised by Bailey's family. I would never suggest that legislative reforms could somehow lessen their grief. I assure the family that this Government listens. It has heard what they have said. I thank them for the petition. They have a commitment that community safety is paramount, and the Government will continue to do what it can in this space.

Mr TIM JAMES (Willoughby) (16:16): We are here today to speak to a petition signed by over 41,000 people. That is an amazing achievement and a testament to the importance of this issue. I am pleased to speak to the petition on behalf of the New South Wales Opposition. I acknowledge Carol Micallef, the creator of the petition, who joins us in the public gallery today. We acknowledge her terrible loss, thank her for her work and offer our most sincere condolences to her and her family. The petition, which has its origin in the death of Bailey Jones at the hands of a person serving an intensive correction order, is a way of memorialising Bailey, who is no longer with us. But we should not just focus on the circumstances of his passing. It is important to recognise who Bailey Jones was in life. He was an 18-year-old young man. He was a Roosters fan, who surely would have loved this year's results in the NRL, and he was by all accounts a handy football player. He had dreams for the life he would build—buying property, starting a family and being part of our community. That all stopped when his life was taken at the hands of an offender on an intensive correction order [ICO] in December 2022.

Intensive correction orders exist as an alternative to full-time prison sentences, but they are still sentences. Whether served in the home or in a prison, their aim is the same—to punish for the crime committed, to provide justice for the person offended against, to rehabilitate if possible and to limit the liberty and rights of the offender, consistent with their status of serving a period of correction. In determining whether or not to make an ICO, community safety is the paramount consideration, and that must be enforced. Courts must impose the standard

conditions on every ICO which require that the offender must submit to supervision by a community corrections officer. Courts also have wide powers to impose additional conditions on ICOs, which include many of the conditions called for by the petitioners. A curfew can be imposed, electronic monitoring can be required and the offender can be required to participate in a rehabilitation or treatment program.

Courts can impose conditions that offenders abstain from alcohol or drugs or both and restrict both associations and the geographical areas they may visit. At least one of these additional conditions must be imposed, but there is no limit on how many conditions may be imposed. The court already has the power to impose further conditions, on top of those that I have listed, if they consider it to be appropriate. But these conditions are only as strong as their enforcement. The petitioners wisely call for monitoring the social media of those on intensive correction orders. To the extent that community corrections officers do not already do this, we encourage them to look at not just the physical contacts of those serving a sentence but also their virtual connections. This can pick up red flags early and prevent tragedies such as Bailey's death.

Random checks for drugs are essential and should be occurring. We are conscious of the excellent work done by community corrections officers in supervising those serving ICOs but they have a mighty task to fulfil. There are currently around 2,100 Community Corrections staff operating across 67 Community Corrections offices, supervising all those on ICOs, community corrections orders and parole. We call on the Government to review this workforce, to review their case load and ensure that these hardworking men and women have the capacity to supervise all those serving prison terms in the community carefully and well.

Community safety is the paramount consideration for intensive correction orders. Judges must consider this before sentencing an offender to an ICO, and must consider this when choosing the conditions which will be part of the ICO. But, for this safety to be maintained, Community Corrections also must have the capacity to properly supervise these orders. The system broke down in the case of Bailey. We call on the Government to resource it properly and thoroughly so that it cannot break down again. Bailey Jones' story is, sadly, not an isolated incident. We call on the Government to reflect on the requests that the petitioners brought here today, and to ensure that the resourcing is in place so that adequate supervision can be achieved. The Government needs to step up and act on the safety of its citizens and young people by ensuring that our correctional services are able to function as they should. I once again want to thank and honour Ms Carol Micallef. I commend this petition to the House.

Ms JACQUI SCRUBY (Pittwater) (16:21): I acknowledge Carol Micallef, who is in the gallery today to hear this important debate in honour of her son Bailey Jones. I thank the member for South Coast for sponsoring the petition. I also acknowledge the other parents and families in the gallery, and those watching online. Carol has taken the time to tell me her story. For Bailey and for others who lost family members in similar circumstances, Carol has fought hard for reform that strengthens conditions that are imposed on offenders who are on bail or on intensive correction orders or community correction orders. I acknowledge Wendy Eggins and her son Ricky, as well as Kathleen Kirby and her daughter Audrey.

As other members mentioned, the petition calls on the House to support reforms to intensive correction orders. Carol has discussed with me and brought to light for me some of the serious flaws in the current conditions of those orders, recognising those are some of the most serious sentences that an offender can serve in the community. It is evident by the number of signatures on the petition that the community broadly has high expectations that those serving those orders must be subject to serious scrutiny to ensure community safety.

I have seen the pictures of Bailey's murderer and have been taken through the social media posts of him posing with weapons, the money he got from selling drugs, and of him flaunting and bragging about his exploits. We can empathise with the community's commonsense expectation of monitoring things like social media of those on correction orders. It is an easy tool to pick up on red flags and inappropriate behaviour of an offender serving their sentence in the community. I was shocked that it is not necessary for courts to impose conditions like random drug tests and random home visits. When those conditions are imposed, there is a question as to whether enforcement is undertaken.

The reform for offenders serving community sentences would include conditions such as introducing random in-person compliance checks; strengthening compliance requirements; reviewing eligibility of violent and repeat offenders; intensifying supervisory measures; better enforcement of electronic ankle bracelet tracking and enforcement zones; mandating random drug and alcohol testing; monitoring social media; randomising drug and weapons detection; regulating and reporting travelling privileges; and strengthening the power and ability of courts to review these conditions.

Bailey was a promising and talented young man and dreamt of one day playing in the NRL for the Sydney Roosters. He was destined for big things. Despite the tragic circumstances of Bailey's passing, his death will not have been in vain. As I said, these reforms are also the expectations of my community. Two months ago I was

contacted by a concerned constituent saying they had noticed someone in the community with an ankle bracelet who was talking to children. It was not until I met with Carol that I realised I did not have an understanding of the scrutiny that an offender may be under.

The calls in the petition meet community expectation of where we need reform. That is particularly pertinent in 2026, when social media is easy to access and a way to see what someone is up to. We also have artificial intelligence and tracking tools. I understand these reforms will come, potentially at a cost to the Government. There are also ways to monitor offenders that are more efficient now than in the past. I echo calls of the member for Willoughby for a review in that regard, of not only the workforce but also the opportunities to use technology to track social media, enforcement zones and so forth. I acknowledge that the Attorney General is in the Chamber. I look forward to hearing his response to the petition. The issues raised need to be addressed not only because of Bailey but also because it is the expectation of the broader community.

Mr MICHAEL DALEY (Maroubra—Attorney General) (16:26): In response: I respond on behalf of the Government to the petition debate regarding the proposed law reforms called Bailey's law. At the outset, as I explained to friends in the gallery, by a quirk of the rules of this place, a Minister has only three minutes to respond. I do not want to appear disrespectful by rushing through this. I have a bit to say, so I have to say it quickly.

Firstly, I reiterate my deepest condolences to Caroline Micallef and her family for the devastating loss of her son. I commend her advocacy on this critical issue. I note that is selfless advocacy, because she cannot bring back her son, but she wishes to ensure that others do not go through what she and her family have gone through. Alongside the Minister for Corrections, I had the privilege of meeting with Ms Micallef and Lawrence. I heard firsthand from the family about their pain, which I cannot begin to fathom. My heart goes out to them. I also thank the member for South Coast for her strong advocacy in calling for reform in this space. We recognise the concerns raised by the many petitioners calling for Bailey's law, including the critical importance of holding offenders accountable and maintaining public confidence in the justice system.

We acknowledge that the availability of community-based sentences for serious offences is a legitimate area of community concern. It is my strong view that intensive correction orders [ICOs] should be utilised only when appropriate, taking into account the nature and seriousness of the offending, the circumstances of the offender and the need to protect the community. To ensure that this remains the case, recently I requested the NSW Sentencing Council to review current offence exclusions for ICOs. That review will evaluate whether current exclusions remain appropriate and identify whether there are any additional offences that should be restricted.

The Sentencing Council is an expert body that will undertake a comprehensive and evidence-based review to determine whether any changes to the current framework are required. I give the petitioners this commitment: The Government will carefully consider any and all of the Sentencing Council's expert findings and recommendations once the review is finalised and received. I reassure those who are listening that this referral to the Sentencing Council is no small step. Just recently the New South Wales Government made nation-leading changes concerning the consideration of so-called "good character" reforms on sentencing off the back of Sentencing Council recommendations. It is an independent, expert advisory body comprised of former judges, prosecutors, criminal defence lawyers, victims' advocates, police and, importantly community representatives. It is the appropriate body to consider the matter and provide recommendations.

I also note that changes to ICO eligibility could potentially have major justice system impacts. Should any change be pursued, it can only occur in a context of operational readiness. As I said, the Government has listened and heard. I thank all the petitioners as well as all the members who took part in the debate today.

The scale of the tragedy underpinning the debate today is only matched by the selflessness of people like the Micallefs who do this not because it will heal the tragic loss they have experienced, but to make sure that others do not go through the same thing. We thank them very much for their advocacy.

Ms LIZA BUTLER (South Coast) (16:29): In reply: I thank members representing the electorates of Orange, Leppington, Willoughby and Pittwater and the Attorney General for their contributions. It is evident that community safety is paramount to members on both sides of this House. I acknowledge Trudy, Wendy, Gordon and Katherine, who have joined us in the gallery today and have lost loved ones. My heart goes out to them. I finish by speaking to the gallery and to Carol. I thank Carol for walking into my office when I was a brand-new MP and trusting me with Bailey's story.

I thank Carol for allowing me to be part of this journey and for her courage, determination and extraordinary commitment to ensuring that Bailey's legacy is one of positive change. I know that no law, no reform and no decision made in this Parliament can ever bring her beautiful boy back. But I hope Carol knows that

Bailey's life matters, his story matters, and a mother's voice has been heard. The fact that more than 41,000 people have stood behind Carol's campaign is a testament to the impact she has made. This has resonated right across New South Wales. Carol should know that my support does not end with this petition. I will continue to stand alongside her, to advocate for stronger safeguards, to pursue meaningful reform and to ensure that the concerns she raised continue to be heard.

Bailey's law is about protecting lives. It is about accountability and it is about giving victims and their families a voice. It is also about doing everything we reasonably can to prevent another family from enduring the unimaginable loss that Carol and her family have suffered. Bailey's life was tragically short, but through his mother's extraordinary determination, his legacy has the potential to make a lasting difference. I am incredibly proud to support Carol, to honour Bailey's memory and to bring this petition before the House. For Bailey, for Ricky, for Audrey, for Carol and for every family who deserves to feel safe in their community, we must continue this important work.

Petition noted.

Bills

PARLIAMENTARY BUDGET OFFICER AMENDMENT BILL (NO 2) 2026

Returned

The ASSISTANT SPEAKER (Mr Jason Li): I report receipt of a message from the Legislative Council returning the bill without amendment.

Commemorations

HUNGARIAN REVOLUTION

The ASSISTANT SPEAKER (Mr Jason Li): In accordance with the earlier resolution of the House, the member for Blacktown and member for Lane Cove will each make a statement of up to five minutes on the 1956 Hungarian Revolution and its significance to the Australian Hungarian community in New South Wales.

Mr STEPHEN BALI (Blacktown) (16:33): I join with the member for Lane Cove and this Parliament in pausing to commemorate the 1956 Hungarian Revolution and uprising, which captured the courage, hope and heartbreak of a nation that briefly believed freedom was within reach from the Soviet totalitarian communist regime. On 23 October 1956 young and determined students marched carrying their handwritten list of 16 demands for freedom and liberty. The response by the Government was to brutally fire on the students. Soon afterwards, tens of thousands of citizens flowed onto the streets. For a moment, Budapest felt as though it could breathe again after years under Soviet domination.

Ordinary citizens tore down the symbols of oppression, and the sound of voices raised in hope echoed through narrow boulevards, across the Danube and eventually right across the nation. What made the revolution so stirring was not just its bravery but its humanity. Workers left factories to join the crowds. Families opened their homes to strangers. People who had never spoken openly about politics found themselves shouting for freedom in the public squares. But hope can be fragile, and when Soviet tanks rolled back into Budapest in early November 1956, the street fighting became intense. The same streets that had carried chants of liberation now carried the heavy rumble of armoured vehicles being attacked by civilians with rifles or Molotov cocktails.

Yet, even in the face of overwhelming force, resistance did not collapse into silence. The revolution lasted only weeks, but its emotional imprint endured for generations. Even though the uprising was quelled by mid-November 1956, streets became quieter due to fear of who was listening and revenge arrests began. The populace was still defiant and would not give up hope. The uprising remains a testament to the Hungarian spirit and refusal to accept tyranny as destiny. It is remembered not as a failed revolt, but as a moment when one small nation stood up and declared, with unmistakable clarity, that freedom was worth everything against the might of a world superpower.

Two hundred thousand Hungarians had to leave Hungary. Staying would have meant death. They escaped across borders into camps and some 14,000 people settled into Australia, including my parents. Australia has benefited immensely from the Hungarian settlement, whether it was 56ers, post-World War II or at other times. It included people like former New South Wales Premier Nick Greiner, many legends in academia, science or business like Paul Lederer, in sport like Les Murray, or in the arts, including dual Archibald prize winner Judy Cassab. If I listed them all, we would be here for hours. I thank the Parliament for allowing the Hungarian Council of New South Wales to exhibit an emotional display of the horrors of the revolution and its legacy in Australia.

I thank Gusztav Ilosvay, the exhibition curator, for the wonderful work he has done. I also thank the Hungarian Council and president Csaba Hegyi, Katalin Ilosvay-Egyed and Edit Regan. Last Wednesday night in the Parliament's theatrette Dr Keith Rathbone from Macquarie University, Peter Montgomery the Olympian and a range of people spoke. What made the night really significant was the heart-wrenching, poignant recollections of personal involvement in the revolution from András Urge, Sándor Vass, István Kökényesi, Ildikó Molek, John Nemesh and Örtl Jenő, and Nora Szathmary's poetry reading. I thank all of them, including Reverend Péterffy Kund for his closing prayers.

I thank the Hungarian consulate and embassy for their support, including Péter Martonosi, the Chargé d'Affaires, consulate staff Mónika and Szeréna, and Johanna Németh-Nagy with her wonderful voice. I thank the President of the Legislative Council, Ben Franklin, his staff in the Office of the Black Rod and all parliamentary staff who helped put the exhibition together. The Hungarian 56ers showed the world that against overwhelming numbers and the might of a superpower, a nation alone and without any assistance stood up for what was right and just.

Mr ANTHONY ROBERTS (Lane Cove) (16:38): First and foremost, I say good afternoon to all of our friends joining us in the gallery today. I extend my sincere thanks to Péter Martonosi and Mónika Varga for bringing us together today to commemorate such an important occasion in Hungarian history.

Tomorrow marks 70 years since the beginning of the Hungarian Revolution of 1956. Seventy years ago, students, workers and ordinary Hungarian citizens stood up against Soviet domination, determined to reclaim their country's independence and the right to determine their own future. These were people who simply wanted the freedoms that so many of us take for granted. The freedom to speak openly, to live without fear, to make decisions about their own lives and to have a say in the future of their country. They wanted to live in a Hungary shaped by the will of its own people, rather than by the demands of a foreign power.

For having the courage to stand up for those freedoms, they were met with overwhelming force. The revolution was crushed, thousands lost their lives, families were torn apart and more than 200,000 Hungarians were forced to flee their homeland. But while the revolution itself was defeated, the courage of those who stood up for their country was not. Their determination to live freely, to preserve their identity and to decide their own future would endure for generations. For me, this history also carries a personal significance, because my great-uncle was involved in the revolution. That personal connection reminds us that the events of 1956 are not simply something to read about in history books. They are part of the history of generations of families and communities who have carried those memories with them. Thankfully, many Hungarians who fled their homeland eventually made their way to Australia, where they rebuilt their lives and made an extraordinary contribution to our country, while never forgetting where they came from.

I remember that 10 years ago in the Fountain Court I had the privilege of sponsoring an art exhibition commemorating the sixtieth anniversary of the revolution. That exhibition was brought together by Gustav and Katalin, two wonderful members of my Lane Cove community. I remember being particularly struck by the quality of the artwork, but also, more importantly, by the emotion that those works carried. You could see something of the pain, the uncertainty and the hardship experienced by those who had lived through the revolution. But you could also see their courage, their determination and their extraordinary pride in their country. For many of those artists, the revolution was not some distant historical event. It was something they had experienced themselves or that had profoundly shaped the lives of their families. Through their artwork, they were able to share those experiences in ways that words alone could not.

I spoke at the time about how important it was to preserve that personal and emotional history, particularly as fewer people remained who could give us a firsthand account of those events. Ten years later, that responsibility has become only greater for our Hungarian community. Today Hungary is a beautiful country, with a people who are immensely proud of their culture, their heritage and their freedom. That pride carries with it a responsibility to protect their culture, preserve the traditions and values that have been passed down through generations, and ensure the freedoms that so many sacrificed for are never taken for granted. Because freedom is not simply something we inherit; it is something that each generation has a responsibility to protect.

That is one of the greatest lessons we can take from the Hungarian Revolution. The men and women who stood up in 1956 understood the value of freedom because they knew what it meant to live without it. They understood that a country's future should belong to its people, and that no government should be able to rule through fear and oppression. Seventy years later, their courage continues to remind us of the importance of those principles. As we gather here today, I once again thank Péter and Mónika for hosting this commemoration and everyone who continues to preserve and celebrate Hungary's remarkable history and culture. I thank my dear friend the member for Blacktown for organising this commemoration. I also thank the Leader of the House for facilitating it. We owe it to all those who stood up in 1956 to remember their sacrifices, to honour their courage

and to ensure that their stories are passed on to future generations. Because in remembering their struggle, we are reminded of the value of our own freedoms and the responsibility we all have to protect them.

The ASSISTANT SPEAKER (Mr Jason Li): I thank the member for Lane Cove. I also thank the members of the public who came to listen to the debate.

Community Recognition Statements

COASTAL TWIST ARTS AND CULTURE FESTIVAL

Ms LIESL TESCH (Gosford) (16:44): I congratulate every single person involved in organising, volunteering and performing at the Coastal Twist Arts and Culture Festival for making it another huge success in 2026. The Coastal Twist Arts and Culture Festival recorded a 40 per cent growth in participation this year. Attended by thousands of people over seven days, the festival featured 14 events, with the theme "Radical radiance" bringing joy to everyone involved. My favourite, the Coastie Carnie Fair Day at the Peninsula Recreation Precinct, was enjoyed by people of all ages, genders and abilities as a celebration of community culture and pride. It was fabulous to see so many people from across the coast and visitors from four States joining in the fun of drag queen performances, the pupparazzi pooch dog show and fashion parade, live music, lots of dancing, a youth zone and a kids corner. There was also the opportunity to visit and chat with the many stallholders who are passionate about including everybody in my community. Huge congratulations and special thanks go to the amazing festival coordinators, Glitta Supernova and Juan Iocco, and to the 80 volunteers who made the day joyful, inclusive and a celebration of individuality and possibility.

MATILDA CHISWICK

Ms ROBYN PRESTON (Hawkesbury) (16:45): Today I acknowledge a young member of the Hawkesbury community, Matilda Chiswick, affectionately known as Tilly. At just 11 years of age, Tilly has set up a small roadside stall she calls Tilly's Treats, where she sells baked goods to help raise money for charity. Tilly was motivated to fundraise after hearing the country song *Speak Up*, which tells the story of Dolly Everett, a young Australian girl who sadly took her own life due to extensive bullying. Moved deeply by the lyrics, Tilly wanted to contribute to Dolly's Dream, the charity created in Dolly's honour to combat bullying across Australia. During school holidays and on occasional weekends, Tilly bakes a range of sweets, including caramel slices, rocky road and brownies, which she sells to passing residents while sharing information with them about the cause that inspired her fundraising journey. I congratulate Tilly on her fundraising efforts so far. The Hawkesbury community is incredibly lucky to have such a kind and selfless young lady raising awareness of important issues.

MICHAEL HAYES AND KANGAROO VALLEY PLATYPUS CONSERVANCY

Ms KATELIN McINERNEY (Kiama) (16:46): On behalf of my community, I proudly recognise Michael Hayes and the Kangaroo Valley Platypus Conservancy for pioneering a world-first conservation initiative in the valley. For decades, Mike has shared the magic of the Kangaroo River through the Kangaroo Valley Adventure Company, introducing countless visitors to its platypuses, even bringing Sir David Attenborough's film crew to the river in 2000. This has grown into something remarkable: a dedicated conservation area for one of Australia's most extraordinary and ancient animals. In partnership with Dr Stephen Van Mil and Wildlife Recovery Australia, Mike has established an education hub on a block of land at Upper Kangaroo River, where school groups and community visitors can learn about these remarkable native animals and the work needed to protect them. That is a fitting initiative for a valley that supports one of the country's most significant platypus populations. I thank Mike and his partners for their dedication, scientific expertise and generosity of spirit. I look forward to watching this important work flourish.

KEVIN "SCALLY" RADBURN

Mr PAUL TOOLE (Bathurst) (16:47): I acknowledge the contribution of Kevin "Scally" Radburn to his community of Neville. Affectionately known as Scally by locals, his involvement in the local community has been extensive and has spanned generations. From being part of the Neville Progress Association to giving a helping hand at Neville Public School and the Neville War Memorial, Scally has always been a friendly face and ready to help out wherever needed. Scally has also been a dedicated volunteer with the Neville Rural Fire Brigade for over 60 years. He has also been a long-serving and active member of the Presbyterian Church congregation. Scally was recognised as an elder of the Presbyterian Church of Australia in 2019 and is believed to be Australia's oldest living Presbyterian Church elder. At 98 years of age, Scally remains a prominent and well-known figure in the local community and someone I am so lucky and proud to know. I thank Scally for all he has done for Neville and the surrounding areas.

AUSTRALIAN CHINESE MINERS MEMORIAL SERVICE

Ms JULIA FINN (Granville) (16:48): On Monday I was honoured to attend the tenth anniversary of the Australian Chinese Miners Memorial Service and commemorate the Chung Yeung Festival at Rookwood Cemetery. I thank the president of the Australian Chinese Workers Association, David Chen, the organising committee and Metropolitan Memorial Parks for bringing the community together for this important occasion. The Chung Yeung Festival is a time to honour our ancestors and remember those who came before us. It was fitting to mark this tradition at a memorial dedicated to the Chinese miners and pioneers who helped shape Australia. During the nineteenth century gold rushes, tens of thousands of Chinese migrants travelled to Australia seeking opportunity and a better life. Many faced gruelling working conditions and discrimination, and many died far from their families and ancestral homes. By 1861, around 13,000 Chinese people lived in New South Wales, most of them in mining districts. Their contributions extended well beyond the goldfields, enriching communities and helping lay the foundations of modern Australia. For 10 years, this memorial has ensured that their sacrifices and achievements are remembered.

KATIE JACKSON

Mr MICHAEL REGAN (Wakehurst) (16:49): I congratulate Katie Jackson, Director of Teaching and Learning at Pittwater House and a valued Collaroy community member, on receiving a NESA Quality Teaching Scholarship. One of just 14 recipients, Katie will undertake a five-week research tour across Australia and the United Kingdom in 2027, exploring how schools can make quality teaching the norm in every classroom. With more than 25 years in education, Katie brings extensive experience as a maths teacher, school leader and researcher, including work on girls' confidence, education and wellbeing. I know Wakehurst and the entire Northern Beaches wish her luck ahead of her upcoming travels and further research. I congratulate Katie on this well-deserved recognition. We wish her every success and look forward to the insights her research will bring to schools across New South Wales.

TRIBUTE TO LESLIE BOWDEN, AFSM

Ms KATE WASHINGTON (Port Stephens—Minister for Families and Communities, and Minister for Disability Inclusion) (16:50): Tonight I pay tribute to the late Leslie Bowden, a much-loved member of the Williamtown and Salt Ash community who dedicated more than four decades to serving others through the NSW Rural Fire Service. Les joined the RFS in 1980 and went on to become a respected leader, serving in numerous roles including group captain, brigade captain and senior deputy. His extraordinary contribution was recognised with the Australian Fire Service Medal [AFSM] in 2006 and life membership of the Williamtown/Salt Ash Rural Fire Brigade in 2018. Les was much more than his impressive service record. He was a trusted mate and mentor to generations of local firefighters. He was the kind of leader who rolled up his sleeves and got the job done alongside everyone else, who would never ask someone to do something he was not prepared to do himself. His commitment to protecting his community, and the friendships he built along the way, have left a lasting legacy. Parliament extends its heartfelt condolences to Les's family, his many friends and fellow volunteers. Vale, Leslie Bowden, AFSM.

PETER QUINN

Mr TIM JAMES (Willoughby) (16:51): Congratulations to Peter Quinn, awarded the 2026 Westfield Chatswood Local Hero for his work with Lifeline Harbour to Hawkesbury Sydney. Peter has turned personal loss into a commitment to helping others. Through Mates in Mind, developed with Lifeline and Mentoring Men, he helps sporting clubs support their players' mental health and encourages people to speak openly and seek help. His recognition brings a $20,000 grant for Lifeline Harbour to Hawkesbury Sydney to continue its valuable work. I also congratulate finalists Gerard Hewson of Wheelchair Sports NSW/ACT and Max Harpham of the Shepherd Centre. Gerard established the Lane Cove Cockatoos Wheelchair Basketball Club, creating opportunities for people with disability to participate in sport and build friendships. Max draws on his own experience growing up deaf to mentor young people through Hear For You. Each has found a way to use their experience to help someone else feel supported and included. I thank Westfield Chatswood for recognising their contributions and all three recipients for the care they show our community. We are proud of you.

RED FOX PILATES

Ms LIZA BUTLER (South Coast) (16:52): I take this opportunity to congratulate Red Fox Pilates on being named Outstanding New Business at the 2026 IMB Bank Illawarra Business Awards. Building a new business takes enormous courage, commitment and hard work, and it is fantastic to see that dedication recognised at a regional level. Red Fox Pilates was recognised for its strong launch, disciplined approach, community connection and immediate demand, with classes quickly booking out and waitlists forming. This is a wonderful achievement for a new business that has already made such a strong impression on our community.

Congratulations to everyone at Red Fox Pilates on this outstanding achievement. I wish them every success as they continue to grow, support their clients and make a positive contribution to our community.

KEEP AUSTRALIA BEAUTIFUL TIDY TOWNS AWARDS

Mr DAVID LAYZELL (Upper Hunter) (16:53): There were celebrations across the Williams and Paterson river valleys when Dungog was named Overall Winner of the 2026 Keep Australia Beautiful NSW Tidy Towns Awards. Single-use Plastic Free Dungog won the Plastic Free Communities Award. Sustaining the Williams Valley Incorporated received the Biodiversity Conservation Award for its Myall Creek Rehabilitation – A Rediscovery project. Paterson Hub and Harvest won the Community Spirit and Inclusion Award. Michelle Dado-Millyn was also recognised with the Local Heroes Award. Dungog will now host the 2027 awards, welcoming councils from across the State to the shire and representing New South Wales at the 2027 Australian Tidy Towns Award. Well done, Dungog. It is a great town and now is the official tidy town.

SAMUEL OBENG

Ms CHARISHMA KALIYANDA (Liverpool) (16:54): I congratulate Samuel Obeng of Liverpool Public School on his outstanding achievements at the recent Sydney South West Athletics Carnival. Samuel delivered an exceptional performance, placing first in both the heats and finals of the 100 metres and 200 metres sprint events. His impressive results earned him a place at the NSW Primary Schools Sports Association athletics championships, where he will represent Liverpool Public School on the State stage. To top it off, Samuel was also named joint Senior Boys Age Champion, a fantastic recognition of his sporting ability. These achievements are a reflection of Samuel's dedication, determination and natural talent. I also acknowledge the teachers, coaches and family members who have supported Samuel along his sporting journey. Liverpool Public School has a proud tradition of encouraging students to excel, whether in sports, academics or the creative arts. Samuel's success is another wonderful example of the talent and potential of young people in our community. I congratulate Samuel and wish him every success at the State championships.

SCOTLAND ISLAND RESIDENTS ASSOCIATION

Ms JACQUI SCRUBY (Pittwater) (16:55): Living on Scotland Island requires a special kind of community spirit, particularly when even a trip to the shops involves a boat. For more than 70 years, the Scotland Island Residents Association [SIRA] has been the backbone of this remarkable offshore community. Founded on Easter Sunday in 1955 at Bangalla, the association helped bring electricity to the island, established the volunteer fire brigade and built the island's community hall, which was constructed over four years by residents volunteering their weekends. Today SIRA continues that extraordinary tradition, managing emergency water, community facilities and transport, while also advocating for better infrastructure and protecting the island's unique character. Special thanks to President Simon Tucker, vice-presidents Carol Beth Floyd and Marie Minslow, the entire committee and generations of dedicated volunteers. On Scotland Island, community is not just about being good neighbours. It is about building, maintaining and sometimes literally keeping the place afloat. I thank SIRA for over 70 years of island ingenuity and community spirit.

TRIBUTE TO PROFESSOR DAVID JOHN GILLET, AM

Mr JASON LI (Strathfield) (16:56): I pay tribute to the remarkable contributions of Professor David John Gillett, AM, who passed away on 10 October 2026, aged 91. Professor Gillett was a distinguished surgeon, medical researcher and educator who dedicated his career to advancing breast cancer treatment and improving patient care. As Head of Breast Cancer and Endocrine Surgery at Concord hospital and leader of the Strathfield Breast and Thyroid Centre, he played a vital role in providing specialised breast cancer care to patients in Strathfield and the surrounding communities. Under his leadership, the Strathfield Breast and Thyroid Centre worked closely with Concord hospital to deliver multidisciplinary diagnosis and treatment. In 2003 alone, the centre cared for 354 patients, with 107 undergoing surgery at Concord hospital. His commitment to improving surgical techniques, advancing medical research, and supporting patients and their families made a lasting difference to our local community. Professor Gillett's dedication and compassion leave an enduring legacy in Strathfield and beyond. I extend my deepest condolences to his family.

CRONULLA SOUTH PUBLIC SCHOOL

Mr MARK SPEAKMAN (Cronulla) (16:57): I congratulate Cronulla South Public School on its eightieth anniversary. Established in 1946 following the extension of the Cronulla railway line and responding to the area's growing population, the school was built on land known as Wondah Flats. Originally operating as an infants school, it later expanded to become a primary school. The original brick building remains a prominent feature of the campus and continues to serve as the school's administration office. During the 1970s, school enrolments reached around 600 students. Today the school provides quality education to a close-knit community of around 230 students. The school's motto "Play the game" was inspired by Sir Henry Newbolt's famous poem

Vitai Lampada or *The Torch of Life*, and reflects the values of perseverance, teamwork and integrity. I wish the school community every success as it celebrates this important milestone and goes on to educate our future generations.

PARRAMATTA DISTRICT RUGBY LEAGUE REFEREES ASSOCIATION

Ms DONNA DAVIS (Parramatta) (16:58): Congratulations to Parramatta District Rugby League Referees Association on a successful McCall Awards Night. This was an opportunity to recognise the passing of Ian McCall, life member No. 25. A long-time resident of North Parramatta, Ian was the longest serving president of Parramatta Referees and one of the most influential figures in the rugby league refereeing fraternity. Robert Morey was officially recognised as life member No. 74, and a special mention was given to Liam O'Brien, who received his NSW High Performance Grading. I congratulate Tom Cambourn and Ethan Klein, who made their match debuts in the NRL; Bella Power, Parramatta Junior Rugby League Referee of the Year; Senior Touch Judge of the Year Jazion Semeatu; Kevin Jeffes Coach of the Year Ken McNaught; Junior Most Improved of the Year Nicolas Picone; Senior Most Improved of the Year Jackson Lamont; Beyond Bank Emerging Squad Official of the Year Lachlan Bradley; Ernie Bull Trainer of the Year Lucas Harper; PARRA Decision of the Year Zane Alkhatib; and Rookie of the Year Ella McDonald It was a wonderful evening of recognition.

COUNCILLOR LISA MINOGUE

Ms STEPH COOKE (Cootamundra) (16:59): I congratulate Councillor Lisa Minogue on making history as the first female Mayor of Bland Shire. It is not just a personal achievement for Mayor Minogue; it is also an important moment in the history of the Bland shire's local government. Mayor Minogue has shown real dedication to public service, connecting with the community and working to move our region forward. Her election shows that both councillors and residents trust her leadership and believe in her commitment to making a positive difference to our local communities. By becoming the first woman to hold the office, Mayor Minogue inspires other women and girls across the Bland shire. She shows that anyone willing to serve with passion and integrity can become a leader. I congratulate Lisa again. We are so proud of her and wish her every success during her time as Mayor of Bland Shire.

POWERHOUSE YOUTH THEATRE FAIRFIELD

Dr DAVID SALIBA (Fairfield) (17:00): I am proud to acknowledge the important role that Powerhouse Youth Theatre [PYT] Fairfield plays in supporting young artists across Western Sydney. Established in 1987 and based at the Fairfield School of Arts since 2003, PYT has created accessible pathways into the arts for generations of young people. Its 2026 ensemble program brought together 25 emerging artists for four months of free training, workshops, mentoring and professional development. The program helps remove financial and geographic barriers to arts participation while connecting young people with industry experience and opportunities. This year four of the eight artists selected for the 2026 PYT company are from the Fairfield local government area, reflecting the strength of local creative talent. I commend Jacqueline Hornjik, Bina Bhattacharya and the wider PYT team for their dedication to creating meaningful opportunities and supporting the next generation of Western Sydney artists.

WOLLONDILLY ELECTORATE PROBUS CLUBS

Mrs JUDY HANNAN (Wollondilly) (17:01): On Friday 9 October I gathered with hundreds of Probus members from across the Probus clubs in the Wollondilly electorate at the Mittagong RSL, joining their celebrations of 50 years of Probus in Australia and the South Pacific. I am delighted to recognise all those clubs from across our region. I extend my congratulations to Sonya Phillips, who was the emcee, and the team of dedicated volunteers who coordinated Probus members from clubs across the electorate to get together to celebrate the remarkable milestone. I congratulate all members on their outstanding contribution. May their clubs continue offering the local communities a group where "retirement comes alive" and "fun, friendship and fellowship in retirement". I extend my appreciation to the club management committees, which generously donate their time to organise opportunities for local retired and semi-retired residents to socialise, explore new interests, share experiences and remain active and connected within their communities.

VINAL LIYANAGE

Mr WARREN KIRBY (Riverstone) (17:02): I congratulate Vinal Liyanage of the Ponds on his outstanding achievements in athletics, representing his local community and New South Wales with distinction. A member of The Ponds Little Athletics Centre since 2017, Vinal has demonstrated exceptional commitment, determination and sporting ability throughout his athletics journey. Vinal has been crowned boys age champion at the Ponds Little Athletics on five occasions. His dedication has seen him progress to representing New South Wales at State and national championships, specialising in race walking. His greatest achievement came at the 2026 Australian Athletics Junior Championships in Brisbane, where he claimed a silver medal in the under-15s

boys 3,000-metre race walk. Vinal's success reflects years of hard work, perseverance and dedication, supported by his family, coaches and the wonderful volunteers at the Ponds Little Athletics Centre. I congratulate Vinal on his remarkable achievements and wish him continued success in his athletics career.

TALK YOUR WALK FOUNDATION

Mrs TANYA DAVIES (Badgerys Creek) (17:03): I commend the work of the Talk Your Walk Foundation, based in Glenmore Park in my electorate of Badgerys Creek. The Pasifika-led empowerment and youth development organisation was founded by former NRL player Jesse Sene-Lefao. His journey as a professional rugby league player taught him valuable lessons about discipline, resilience, leadership, identity and the pressures that young people face. His mission now is to deliver preventative youth wellbeing programs across schools and youth justice settings through the Talk Your Walk Foundation. Each session creates a safe and supportive space where participants can build self-awareness, strengthen identity and develop practical life skills. Helping to prevent vulnerable children at risk of falling through the cracks from a life of crime or into poverty is commendable and worthy of recognition. On behalf of the electorate of Badgerys Creek, I thank the entire team at the Talk Your Walk Foundation for helping young people to live their best lives.

BONNYRIGG SPORTS CLUB

Mr TRI VO (Cabramatta) (17:04): On 4 October 2026 I had the privilege of attending the official groundbreaking ceremony for the new girls change rooms at Bonnyrigg Sports Club, marking an exciting milestone for local sport and our community. I warmly congratulate Bonnyrigg Sports Club, Bonnyrigg White Eagles Football Club and Bonnyrigg Juniors Soccer Club on the wonderful achievement and commend everyone involved in bringing the important project from idea and design to actual commencement. The new facilities will be a positive step towards creating a more inclusive and welcoming sporting environment for girls and young women. Providing appropriate, modern amenities is essential to encouraging greater female participation in sport and ensuring that everyone has the opportunity to feel comfortable, supported and valued. Sports play an important role in bringing people together, building friendships, developing teamwork and promoting healthy lifestyles. I once again congratulate the clubs, volunteers, players, families and supporters who have helped make the milestone possible.

EPPING DISTRICT MUSIC FESTIVAL

Ms MONICA TUDEHOPE (Epping) (17:05): I ask the Epping community to join with me in recognising Mrs Shelly Kim of Epping Heights Public School for her remarkable contribution to this year's Epping District Music Festival. For more than 50 years the Epping District Music Festival has brought together public schools from across Epping, Beecroft and the Hills district. This year more than 600 students from 10 local schools took to the stage at the Concourse in Chatswood for a program of music, instrumental bands and dance. Among them were the Epping Heights senior choir and dance troupe. Mrs Kim co-produced the festival, conducted the massed choir and accompanied the choir herself. Bringing together hundreds of students from different schools, each rehearsing separately, and having them perform as one choir on the night takes a huge amount of organisation and skill. She did all of that while teaching her own class at Epping Heights Public School. On behalf of the Epping community, I congratulate every student who performed at the Epping District Music Festival and particularly thank Mrs Kim.

ADDISON ROAD COMMUNITY ORGANISATION

Mr JIHAD DIB (Bankstown—Minister for Customer Service and Digital Government, Minister for Emergency Services, and Minister for Youth Justice) (17:06): What an event and what a Saturday. It was an absolute pleasure to attend the Addi Road Fiesta and 50-year anniversary celebration hosted by the Addison Road Community Organisation last weekend. With over 3,000 people in attendance and the sun out on display, it was impossible to mistake the love and connection we all share for the organisation and its values. Originating in 1976 and opened by the great man himself, Gough Whitlam, the organisation continues to advocate for human rights through food, services, care and community. I love Addi Road and have a long connection with that place. It is a home for everyone—for those in need or those who want help. It is a place where the Governor-General packs food hampers alongside someone rediscovering themselves and trying to recover from addiction or a Minister having a casual conversation with a Palestinian refugee rebuilding their life in Australia. It is a place like no other, a true heartbeat of Sydney. I cannot think of a more incredible community service. I cannot speak more highly of Rosanna Barbero, the CEO. I thank her, her volunteers and everybody for what they do.

VALENTINA'S VILLAGE

Ms STEPHANIE DI PASQUA (Drummoyne) (17:07): I congratulate Valentina's Village on its first fundraising gala, An Evening of Hope, held on Friday 16 October at the White Bay Cruise Terminal in Rozelle. I take this opportunity to congratulate Domenico and Sara Ruggeri and their whole extended family. Their

daughter Valentina is an inspirational young girl, who, at just two years old, is the only person in Australia living with hyaline fibromatosis syndrome. It is an ultra-rare genetic condition. Because so few children are affected, no cure exists anywhere in the world. Through Valentina's Village, they are funding a world-first personalised treatment through the Gene2Cure Foundation. I am so proud of our community for answering the call. The gala sold out within hours, moved to a larger venue and sold out again. More than 1,400 people attended, and they collectively raised over $1.1 million for beautiful Valentina. I congratulate Dom, Sara, Valentina and the extended family. Congratulations to them.

CONNOR BEISLER

Ms JENNY AITCHISON (Maitland—Minister for Roads, and Minister for Regional Transport) (17:08): Connor Beisler is a third-generation baker and a leading example of what young people can achieve through vocational education and apprenticeships in the Hunter region. Connor's dedication to his trade has seen him achieve remarkable success, securing a gold medal at the WorldSkills Australia National Championships, which earned him a place as a Skillaroo to represent Australia at the WorldSkills International Competition in Shanghai. Competing against the finest young tradespeople globally, Connor was awarded a medal of excellence and placed an impressive seventh in the world. Supported by his family business, his workplace and his mentor, Dean Tilden, Connor's achievement reflects countless hours of discipline, early mornings and a deep commitment to serving our local community through quality trade craftsmanship. I congratulate Connor on his achievements representing Maitland and Australia with such distinction on the global stage. I wish him every success as he continues his career in the baking industry.

FERRAGOSTO COLOURING COMPETITION

Ms STEPHANIE DI PASQUA (Drummoyne) (17:09): I sincerely congratulate the talented young artists who participated in my 2026 Ferragosto colouring-in competition. Each year, the competition invites students from across the community to showcase their creativity in celebration of our Italian street fair in Five Dock called Ferragosto. This year's submissions were amazing, showing an outstanding effort from all who participated. I congratulate all students who participated on their beautiful entries. Their entries captured the spirit of Ferragosto and the pride of our Italian community. Picking just one winner was a difficult decision and a testament to the quality of each submission. I congratulate the winners: Ella, aged five; Saniyo, aged four; and Danisha, aged nine. I also thank all the teachers and families who supported the children and encouraged their creativity. Well done to them. I cannot wait to see next year's entrants.

TRIBUTE TO BARBARA LONG, OAM

Ms CHARISHMA KALIYANDA (Liverpool) (17:10): I pay tribute to Barbara Long, OAM, a highly respected member of our community and one of the most influential figures in the history of netball in New South Wales. Across more than seven decades, Barbara dedicated her life to netball, making an extraordinary contribution to the sport at local, State and national levels. In 1965 Barbara helped establish the foundations of what would become the Liverpool City Netball Association, serving as its foundation president from 1968 to 1985. Through her leadership, coaching and administration, she helped create opportunities for generations of players across Liverpool and south-west Sydney. Barbara also served as a Netball NSW selector for 15 years and as an Australian selector between 1985 and 1991, helping shape the future of the sport. Her outstanding service was recognised with life membership of Netball NSW, induction into its Hall of Fame, the Medal of the Order of Australia and the Order of Liverpool. Barbara Long Park also stands as a lasting tribute to her legacy. On behalf of our community, I extend my sincere condolences to Barbara's family, friends and the Liverpool City Netball Association.

CATHOLIC CHILD

Ms STEPHANIE DI PASQUA (Drummoyne) (17:11): I recognise a local business in my community, the Catholic Child, which is a new business run by Stephanie Chachaty that organises religious resources and gifts. What an amazing opportunity for our community to be able to purchase those Catholic gifts. We are strong in our faith in our community. I bought my daughter a baby Bible from Stephanie's stall at the Ferragosto street fair. Catholic Child is a well-loved local business. Stephanie is also a published author. She has these little tummy time books for babies, introducing and encouraging faith. It is so unique and is such a special business. I congratulate her and wish her all the very best.

ASSYRIAN AUSTRALIAN PROFESSIONALS ASSOCIATION

Dr DAVID SALIBA (Fairfield) (17:12): I acknowledge the recent establishment of the Assyrian Australian Professionals Association [AAPA] and the important purpose it seeks to serve. Founded in 2025, AAPA brings together Assyrian Australian professionals, students and emerging leaders to strengthen professional connections, share knowledge and create opportunities for the next generation. Fairfield is home to

a strong Assyrian community, and AAPA provides an important local platform for mentorship, collaboration and professional development across fields including law, medicine, education, business, engineering, government and technology. Through networking, education and community partnerships, AAPA aims to support young people, encourage leadership and strengthen the contribution of Assyrian Australians to our wider community. I commend secretary John Odisho Putrus, together with AAPA's founding members, committee, organisers and volunteers, and wish them every success as the years go by.

CO.AS.IT.

Ms STEPHANIE DI PASQUA (Drummoyne) (17:13): I recognise Co.As.It., the Italian Association of Assistance, which does amazing work in my community and across metropolitan Sydney. It was originally established to support the growing migrant Italian community and has now evolved into an organisation that supports aged care, new migrants and the development of Italian language through language classes. I congratulate all the staff of Co.As.It., who work so hard to support not just the people living in my community but people across metropolitan Sydney. I congratulate Anita Bonanno, the new CEO, and recognise her work. She is a longstanding staff member who has now stepped up to be CEO. I also recognise longstanding former CEO Thomas Camporeale, who has now taken up a new role at Co.As.It in Melbourne to continue that great work.

RIZWANA KHAN

Mr WARREN KIRBY (Riverstone) (17:14): I recognise Rizwana Khan of North West Community Services for her outstanding dedication to improving the lives of those in need. For approximately 15 years, Rizwana has demonstrated an unwavering commitment to community service through her professional work and volunteering. For the past five years, Rizwana has worked as an aged social support intake officer at North West Community Services, where she has fostered cultural understanding and greater inclusion within aged-care services. Through her work with the multicultural skill development group, she has helped women build confidence and develop employment skills. Rizwana played an important leadership role in the get ready for flood campaign, helping multicultural communities across the Hawkesbury and Nepean regions understand flood risks and prepare for emergencies. Known for her kindness and generosity, Rizwana consistently goes above and beyond for her colleagues, clients and community members. Her compassion and tireless service have made a meaningful difference to many lives. I commend Rizwana for her exceptional contribution to building a stronger, more inclusive and caring community.

Private Members' Statements

DRUMMOYNE ELECTORATE

Ms STEPHANIE DI PASQUA (Drummoyne) (17:16): For 49 years, the Labor Party held the electorate of Drummoyne. For almost half a century, successive Labor local members had the opportunity to deliver infrastructure, services and investment for my community, and they did not. In 2011, when my community elected a Liberal representative, that changed. Since 2011 the people of Drummoyne have seen significant investment in their schools, hospitals, transport infrastructure, parks and community facilities. I take this opportunity to put some of that Liberal investment on the parliamentary record today, because it matters who planned those projects, funded them, fought for them and, importantly, ensured that they were delivered.

Let us start with health. The former Liberal Government committed $341 million to stage one of the major redevelopment of Concord hospital. That included the National Centre for Veterans' Healthcare, the first of its kind in Australia; the new Concord Cancer Centre facility; new aged-care and rehabilitation wards; and more beds. That investment delivered modern health facilities, the first of their kind at Concord hospital, and supported the future of the hospital, which is one of Sydney's most important and busiest hospitals. The Concord hospital multistorey car park was also planned and funded by the former Government. I am proud to have advocated to ensure that that project was continued and delivered by this Government, because anyone who has visited Concord hospital knows just how important the accessible parking is.

That major master planning work for Concord hospital was done by the former Liberal Government. The master plan is there. Our community wants to know: Where is the funding for stage two? Where is the commitment? Where is the plan? After almost four years of a Labor government, we have not seen a single dollar for the second part of the Concord hospital upgrade—a new emergency department—all while the Government is adding more than 60,000 new homes in our community. I will also talk about education. Under the former Liberal Government, our electorate benefited from substantial investment in local schools, including three new and upgraded schools: Russell Lea Public School, Victoria Avenue Public School in Concord West and the total knockdown and rebuild of Lucas Gardens School.

It also included the major upgrade to Concord High School, with 40 new classrooms. Planning for that was done by the former Government. When I became the member, I met with the Concord High School principal, who

said to me, "It's all on pause. It's all being held up. We don't know what is happening now that we have a new government."

That project is particularly important to me. I am proud to have advocated on behalf of my community for the delivery of Concord High School. The same principle applies to Rhodes Public School. When a government completes a project that was planned and funded by its predecessor, it is only right that that history should be acknowledged. The public record should be accurate. Rhodes Public School has been held up by Labor. For three whole years, there was not a single update on the Department of Education website about Rhodes Public School. When the community and I started asking questions about that, all of a sudden we saw an announcement. I will always welcome investment in my community, but let us be fair dinkum and honest about who planned and funded Rhodes Public School.

Our community has also benefited from public transport, which was made more accessible by the former Government. All of our rail stations, including at Rhodes, North Strathfield and Concord West, were updated to include lifts. Further, all of our ferry wharves, including at Drummoyne, Abbotsford, Chiswick and Cabarita, were made accessible. I note that when those works were being done, replacement services and interim arrangements were organised. That is why people in my community are so upset about the closure of Abbotsford ferry wharf for approximately two months. No practical transport replacement arrangements were made and there are no express services from Chiswick during that time. I note the Minister for Roads is present in the Chamber. I ask her to listen to the frustrations of my community and act on them. My community was given a short notification. The Government knew about this for a year but said and planned nothing. I hope the Government delivers replacement bus and ferry services for my community.

Ms JENNY AITCHISON (Maitland—Minister for Roads, and Minister for Regional Transport) (17:21): I want to set the record straight. I am advised that replacement bus services started at 6.00 a.m. this morning, so buses are in place. Let us also look at why that work needs to be done. When that wharf was replaced by the former Government in 2018, it was supposed to last for another 25 years, but it did not quite make the distance. Transport for NSW had to step in and fix the gangway, again. It had to fix the former Government's shoddy workmanship. It would be nice to get a thank you from the member for Drummoyne—she is welcome—for the work we have done in her electorate after a failed infrastructure upgrade from 2018 under the former Government. The member may be very proud of what the former Government did, but she should own her mistakes.

SUPERINTENDENT WAYNE HUMPHREY, APM

ELECTRIC BIKES

Ms JENNY AITCHISON (Maitland—Minister for Roads, and Minister for Regional Transport) (17:22): Next week the Port Stephens-Hunter Police District will bid farewell to its commander, Superintendent Wayne "Bear" Humphrey, APM, as he moves to Newcastle. Having commenced as a junior trainee 46 years ago, Wayne has risen through the ranks and served in many roles across the Hunter region. I have worked closely with Wayne since 2022, when he was appointed commander of Port Stephens-Hunter Police District. Throughout his career, Superintendent Humphrey has demonstrated exceptional leadership in emergency management and policing operations, particularly in times of flood and during major road events. He has played a key role in many high-risk incidents with the NSW Police Force and received numerous service awards for his emergency response work. Most recently, earlier this year Wayne received a Commissioner's Commendation for Service for his part in the response to the tragic Greta bus crash in 2023.

I wish Superintendent Humphrey every success as he returns to command the Newcastle City Police District. I sincerely thank him for the outstanding contribution he has made to keeping Maitland safe. I look forward to continuing the strong working relationship that exists between local police and our Government under the leadership of Acting Superintendent Lisa Jones, who is relieving in the role. One issue that will be at the top of the agenda in my electorate as I welcome our new commander is the use of high-powered e-bikes and illegal trail and dirt bikes across our region. In my close dealings with the NSW Police Force, that issue and its effect on community safety is one of the most pressing concerns not only in Maitland but also across the Hunter and throughout New South Wales.

I share the concerns raised by residents. As Minister for Roads, and Minister for Regional Transport, I take the risks that are posed by those vehicles very seriously. The potential for serious injury or loss of life to both riders and innocent members of the public cannot be ignored, and it is not being ignored. That is why the Minns Labor Government has introduced new laws that give police and Transport for NSW the power to seize and crush e-bikes. The message is very simple: If someone is operating what is effectively a motorbike while attempting to pass it off as an e-bike, it can be seized and destroyed. That applies to all illegal bikes that cannot

be registered as motor vehicles. Police can issue significant penalties, including on-the-spot fines and prosecutions. If someone's bike does not comply with the law, they risk losing it.

Those high-powered bikes present a serious safety risk. Across my electorate, I regularly hear concerns about antisocial behaviour associated with those vehicles and their impact on local people. To support enforcement, we have introduced roadside dyno testing units capable of determining whether a bike exceeds the permitted power output or can travel beyond the legal 25 kilometre per hour limit. Members will recall that that limit was raised by the former Government in its last days before the 2023 election. We have added a grandfather clause to pull back that limit for bikes on the network for three years. The results of recent operations demonstrate that those laws are already being enforced. In October, a police operation on the northern beaches saw 36 illegal e-bikes seized and sent for crushing. Just this week, a further 22 bikes were seized during a joint operation across southern Sydney and the Illawarra.

Those targeted operations use a range of police resources, including drones and stationary checkpoints, to identify offenders and remove dangerous vehicles from our streets. They demonstrate that the legislation is working as intended and that authorities are prepared to act. The operation last weekend in the Illawarra was quite successful. I personally thank the police officers and Transport for NSW team involved in those operations. They perform difficult and often dangerous work on behalf of our communities. Just last week an officer in Wollongong was struck by an e-bike rider who failed to stop when directed. Incidents like that highlight exactly why strong enforcement is needed and why getting those dangerous vehicles off our roads remains a priority for the Government.

For anyone considering purchasing a powered e-bike, or for those who already own one, my advice is straightforward: Ensure it complies with Australian standards and carries the required compliance markings. If it does not, it may be seized under our laws. I also recognise that the problem is not purely electric. Noisy and dangerous illegal dirt bikes remain a concern for many residents. Let us be clear: Petrol-powered bikes are illegal on public roads, footpaths and shared pathways in New South Wales. Those who use them will be caught, and they will lose their bikes.

DOMESTIC AND FAMILY VIOLENCE

Mr TIM JAMES (Willoughby) (17:27): Domestic and family violence is a scourge and one of the most serious challenges facing our community. It destroys lives, tears families apart and leaves lasting trauma, particularly for women and children. As the local member for Willoughby, it is deeply confronting to hear firsthand accounts from constituents seeking my help with housing or police matters, only to learn of the abuse and fear they have endured. These conversations are a sobering reminder of the suffering that often remains hidden. And I know many more people suffer in silence, never reporting their experiences, nor necessarily seeking help. This is happening right here in Willoughby. In the 12 months to June 2026, police recorded 114 domestic violence-related assaults in the Willoughby local government area and another 102 in North Sydney.

That is 216 recorded assaults across these two council areas in just one year, and these are only the incidents that are reported to police. Across New South Wales, nearly 50,000 court proceedings for domestic violence offences were initiated last financial year, up more than 14 per cent over two years. These are deeply troubling figures. Behind every statistic is someone whose safety and dignity have been threatened, often by someone they should be able to trust. One organisation making a remarkable difference locally is Mary's House Services, which supports women and children escaping violence across Sydney's northern suburbs.

For over a decade, Mary's House has provided safe accommodation, counselling, specialist casework, and legal and financial assistance. It helps women to escape violence and rebuild their lives. I acknowledge CEO Yvette Vignando, chair Helen Conway and the dedicated staff, volunteers and generous supporters. But demand is overwhelming. Last financial year, Mary's House had to decline 176 referrals for refuge accommodation because it simply had no vacancies. Think about that: Women and children made the enormous decision to escape abuse, only to find that there was nowhere available for them to go.

Yvette has raised serious concerns about the Government's understanding, in the broader sense, of this crisis. Government data fails to fully capture demand experienced by donor-funded frontline services like Mary's House. The result is an incomplete picture of how many women and children need help. As Yvette has said, you cannot manage what you do not measure. The Premier has rightly declared domestic and family violence an urgent emergency. But that declaration must be matched by action on every level. The Government needs to listen to frontline organisations like Mary's House, measure unmet demand and direct resources where they are needed most.

Mary's House receives no ongoing government funding to operate its refuge. I warmly welcome its plans for a second refuge, which will more than double its accommodation capacity. This will be a vital lifeline for

women and children seeking safety. But the expansion is being funded wholly through private philanthropy. That generosity is extraordinary, but community generosity cannot be a substitute for government support as well. The Minns Labor Government has announced additional funding for domestic violence services. That is welcome. But funding announcements mean little to a woman seeking refuge if there is no safe place available. Organisations like Mary's House must be heard and supported. Their experience on the front line should help shape government decisions.

I commend the local initiatives raising awareness and supporting those affected. Willoughby City Council holds an annual domestic violence walk, which I have been pleased to participate in over the years. Our local Rotary clubs also contribute, bringing the community together and raising awareness of this issue. I am grateful to all those organisations that support Mary's House, including the North Sydney Bears, and I am looking forward to the Mary's House Walk this Sunday.

I acknowledge Lucy's Project, which shines a light on the connection between domestic violence and animal abuse. Threats against beloved pets are too often used to intimidate and control victims. Some women feel unable to leave because they fear what will happen to their animals. Lucy's Project is working to remove that barrier to safety. Its advocacy and support for frontline services deserve recognition. These initiatives reflect the compassion and commitment of our community.

I acknowledge also the North Shore Police Area Command and its officers, who respond to incidents, support victims and hold perpetrators accountable. The former Coalition Government strengthened those protections. We invested in specialist Domestic Violence Liaison Officers within the Police Force, helping victims obtain protection orders and access support. In 2022, we passed landmark coercive control legislation. That law commenced in July 2024. It recognises that abuse is not always physical. It can involve intimidation, isolation and more. These were important reforms. But strong laws and effective policing must be backed by properly resourced frontline services.

Willoughby is a caring and generous community. The extraordinary support for Mary's House demonstrates that. But charities and volunteers cannot shoulder this burden alone. Women and children escaping violence deserve safety, support and somewhere secure to go. I thank Mary's House and everyone across Willoughby working to make our community safer. Their work deserves recognition, proper support and a government and community response that reflects the depth of the domestic and family violence crisis.

SHOALHAVEN MEMORIAL HOSPITAL

Ms KATELIN McINERNEY (Kiama) (17:32): In less than a week, on 28 October, the doors will open on the new acute services building at the Shoalhaven Memorial Hospital. Our community has waited a long time for this moment, and I am deeply proud to be a part of a government pouring a record spend of $10.3 billion into health, particularly focusing on regional health and, importantly, on paying our staff members working in those hospitals what they are worth, scrapping the unfair wages cap, ensuring that we hold onto our valued healthcare workers, and investing in housing for healthcare workers, which is so important in regions like ours, with a tight rental market.

Last week the Illawarra Shoalhaven Local Health District staff welcomed the community through the front doors on a community open day, with tours of the brand-new paediatric waiting area and the new paediatric ward, new acute-care wards, intensive care and the new emergency short stay area. Everywhere people looked, they saw large, modern, well-equipped spaces, and the day was a huge success. To say that our community will have its socks blown off by this is absolutely an understatement. This $440 million investment in our area has come about because we are absolutely making sure that our region has the health care for our needs now but also to grow into the future. I congratulate the Health Infrastructure NSW team, the Minister for Health and his team, and the Illawarra Shoalhaven Local Health District team, particularly the CEO, Margaret Martin, our previous CEO, Margot Mains, the general manager, Frank Bazik, the executive and board and, of course, all of the wonderful staff members getting ready to move across to this outstanding facility.

The numbers tell the story. Paediatric emergency beds are going from four currently to six. Our acute care unit is growing to 20. We are doubling our X-ray and CT capacity. And, for the first time, there will be an an MRI inside the Shoalhaven hospital. There is a new emergency department [ED], and we are doubling our operating theatres and endoscopy rooms. There will be a dedicated cardiology unit with a cath lab, allowing us to do stent work in the Shoalhaven; a new acute mental health unit; an expanded stroke unit; and a rooftop helipad, of course, with direct access to the ED and intensive care unit, all of which will mean fewer patients being transferred to Wollongong and Sydney and more families getting the vital care they need close to home.

Some of the best features, though, are outside the walls. This amazing hospital was made to have a minimal footprint on the site. Our gardens have been done with consultation with our Aboriginal community, and the

landscaping makes the most of a historic blackbutt tree at the southern end of Nowra Park. There is a bush tucker garden, native gardens, beautiful plantings, and a gorgeous garden out by HMAS *Albatross*. It will be a space that supports the health and wellbeing of every Shoalhaven resident.

I am often asked, though, whether we have enough staff. The wonderful news is that the Minns Labor Government has listened to nurses and, as part of our promise made in 2023, has introduced safe staffing levels at Shoalhaven Hospital. We have hired an additional 48 nurses to achieve our safe staffing levels on the floor, and we are bringing on new clinicians and doctors. On top of that, over the coming weeks we will recruit another 20 nurses into our expanded acute services building.

Just as importantly, we are pulling down the barriers to bringing healthcare workers into the Shoalhaven. Bomaderry was the first of our build-to-rent projects that ensure we are getting our key worker housing in our communities. Nine fully furnished townhouses have come online, and I visited them earlier this year, but we have taken our total up to 21, ready for doctors and clinicians to move into. We have also our $35 million Bomaderry build-to-rent partnership with Landcom almost at completion. This historic pilot will deliver 60 homes for nurses, paramedics, hospital staff members, police officers, firefighters, and aged-care and early childhood workers. This hospital is a promise kept to the community: world-class care with world-class healthcare workers right in our backyard so that we do not have to travel. Every time one of our wonderful residents talks about this hospital, it is with deep pride and an absolute commitment to making sure that, when we welcome new healthcare workers into our community, we really appreciate them coming down to our part of the world. But this hospital will blow people's socks off. I cannot wait for it to open next week. I wish the staff all the best with the transition.

FO GUANG SHAN EVERGREEN VITALITY HUB

Ms DONNA DAVIS (Parramatta) (17:36): Established on 25 June 2025, the Fo Guang Shan Evergreen Vitality Hub is a community initiative of the Buddha's Light International Association [BLIA] Sydney, proudly supported by Fo Guang Shan Nan Tien Buddhist Temple Parramatta and the BLIA Loving Care Group Sydney Western Subchapter. Since its inception, the hub has grown into a vibrant and inclusive community of more than 50 Mandarin- and Cantonese-speaking seniors aged over 60, who gather on the last Wednesday of each month to learn, connect and support one another. The Evergreen Vitality Hub delivers a diverse range of monthly programs that promote healthy ageing, lifelong learning and social inclusion. Activities include health education seminars, arts and crafts workshops, laughter yoga, dance and exercise sessions, scam awareness presentations, community information sessions, cultural celebrations and festive gatherings. These initiatives encourage seniors to maintain their physical and mental wellbeing, develop new skills, build lasting friendships and reduce social isolation, enriching the lives of older residents across Parramatta.

Community service is a defining feature of the Evergreen Vitality Hub. Members are encouraged to extend compassion beyond the classroom by participating in BLIA Sydney's charitable initiatives. Participants have prepared care packages for Dignity Homeless Services and handcrafted blessing bracelets for residents of aged-care facilities, as well as patients and healthcare workers at Westmead Hospital, and during the roaming Buddha Bathing ritual outreach. These initiatives exemplify the important role seniors continue to play in fostering compassion, resilience and community cohesion. The hub's success is underpinned by the dedicated leadership of Venerable Chueh Shan, abbess of Fo Guang Shan Nan Tien Buddhist Temple Parramatta; Mr Daniel Wu, president of BLIA Sydney; Mr Vincent Hong, chief elder advisor of BLIA Sydney; and Ms Florence Yuen of BLIA Loving Care Group Sydney Western Subchapter.

They are supported by a committed team of volunteers—Suzanne Lee, Andre Lau, Ivy Tan, Jennifer Tan, My-Chinh Tran, Molly Chan, Winson Tsai, Helena Chong, Ah Swee Tan, Michelle Huang and Chiok Yin Hor—whose generosity and dedication ensure that every gathering is welcoming, engaging and meaningful.

The Evergreen Vitality Hub advances BLIA Sydney's four core objectives: promoting peace and harmony to the community through cultural activities, nurturing talents through education, benefiting society through charitable service, and cultivating compassionate hearts and minds through Buddhist practice. Today the Fo Guang Shan Evergreen Vitality Hub stands as an outstanding example of community partnership in action. By fostering lifelong learning, active ageing, volunteerism and cultural inclusion, it has made a lasting contribution to improving the wellbeing of local seniors and strengthening social connectedness and community harmony throughout the City of Parramatta.

I am really proud of the presence of BLIA in Parramatta and the connection it brings to the wider community through the Nan Tien Temple. Its members are ever present at events across the city. I cannot speak more highly of the work they do with the BLIA Scouts, engaging with the scouting movement to ensure that the younger generation is learning about its environment, the skills that scouting brings and its connection to those in the wider community. I have worked closely with BLIA over the past four years and find it to be a wonderful,

generous part of our community. The new vitality hub initiative is another way it is working to strengthen connection across the community, reduce loneliness and be a positive contributor to the broader society.

ELECTRIC VEHICLE CHARGING INFRASTRUCTURE

Mr MICHAEL REGAN (Wakehurst) (17:41): I have been an unashamedly evangelical electric vehicle [EV] owner for over a decade. Once you make the switch, it is hard to imagine going back. EVs are fast, quiet—sadly—great to drive and cheaper to run. They reduce air pollution and emissions. I encourage the Minister for Lands and Property, who is at the table, to spread the word! But owning an EV is not always as straightforward as it should be, particularly when you venture beyond the comfort of your home charger. There is nothing quite like pulling into a charging station with your battery running low, only to discover the charger is out of order or you need to download yet another app.

Electric vehicles are rapidly becoming mainstream. In the first half of 2026, electric and plug-in hybrid vehicles accounted for more than a quarter of new vehicle sales nationally. On the northern beaches, we are helping lead that transition. According to Northern Beaches Council there are now more than 7,700 fully electric vehicles and another 1,300 plug-in hybrids registered in our community alone. CSIRO projections suggest that by 2028 we could have more than 16,000 fully electric vehicles on the northern beaches, rising to more than 33,000 by 2030. That is more than four times the number we have today. That raises an obvious question: Will we have enough public chargers to keep up?

Yesterday I was delighted to see Northern Beaches Council announce plans to expand our local charging network, identifying up to 50 potential new charging locations. I congratulate Mayor Sue Heins and the council on that initiative. We currently have just 86 publicly available chargers across the northern beaches. With EV ownership projected to quadruple by 2030, we need to plan now rather than play catch-up once drivers are queuing around the block. We also need smarter, more affordable solutions that make better use of existing infrastructure. Encouragingly, some of that innovation is happening locally on the northern beaches. Brookvale-based company Alchemy Charge has developed technology that transforms existing power outlets into smart, pay-per-use EV charging points.

That is a practical, lower cost solution for apartment buildings, workplaces and car parks, where vehicles can charge over several hours or overnight. We need fast chargers for people on the move, kerbside chargers for those without off-street parking and affordable charging solutions where people live and work. We also need chargers that actually work. Recently a constituent from Killarney Heights wrote to me about his experiences with public charging. He raised some excellent points. He described the absurdity of needing multiple apps, accounts and payment arrangements just to charge a vehicle. Imagine pulling into a petrol station and being told you cannot buy fuel until you download an app, create an account and register your credit card. This would seem crazy, yet we accept it as normal for electric vehicle owners.

He also raised the issue of queuing. At a petrol station, cars line up, move through the bowsers and drive away. But many EV charging stations have just a handful of bays tucked away in a car park, no designated waiting area and no obvious indication of whose turn is next. Add a faulty charger and someone struggling to download an app and you have a recipe for a frustrating afternoon. Then there is reliability. My constituent reported that a public charger in Forestville was out of service for seven weeks this year. For someone relying on public charging, that is simply unacceptable.

To its credit, the New South Wales Government has already recognised many of these issues. Its latest fast-charging grants guidelines require card payments without an app, clearly displayed prices and minimum reliability standards. That is welcome progress. But these requirements do not automatically extend to the entire existing public charging network, particularly older installations and privately funded chargers. I think they should. Some standards also need strengthening. For example, current fast-charging grants conditions require 98 per cent uptime for only half the charging plugs at each station. What about the other half? We also need clearer repair time requirements and publicly available reliability information so drivers can make informed decisions. Finally, safe queuing arrangements should become a standard part of charging station design, not an afterthought.

I have advocated for electric vehicles for years because they are good for consumers, our environment and our future. Even better, they are amazing for your hip pocket—I have not paid for fuel in over 10 years. I am delighted that more Australians are discovering those benefits. But we cannot expect people to embrace cleaner transport if the supporting infrastructure makes their lives unnecessarily difficult. I encourage the New South Wales Government to accelerate the expansion of public charging infrastructure, strengthen consumer standards and ensure those standards apply consistently across the network. We need more chargers, better chargers and chargers that actually work.

STRATA LAWS

Mr RON HOENIG (Heffron—Minister for Local Government) (17:46): Most people who buy an apartment do not imagine they are buying themselves into a small system of government. They think they are buying a home, and that is how it should feel. But for many people in my electorate, strata living can become far more complicated. I often hear from residents across my electorate when things go wrong. They receive a notice for a sharp increase in strata fees or they are told there will be a special levy. Sometimes the amount is several thousand dollars. Sometimes the amount can even be tens of thousands of dollars. In many cases, the owner does not deny that a levy is needed. They know a building cannot be allowed to deteriorate, and they understand that defects permitted by the disastrous policy of those opposite do not repair themselves.

But knowing that a problem exists does not make the bill any easier to pay. That is the point that too often gets lost. These discussions can become very technical very quickly. People speak about schemes, motions, committees, levies and by-laws. All of that has its place, but behind every lot number there is a person trying to keep a roof over their head. There is a pensioner or a young family. There is someone with a mortgage. There is a tenant living with the consequences of decisions made in meetings they are never able to attend. A fair strata scheme has to hold two truths at one time: Buildings have to be maintained, but people still have to be able to live.

That is why the recent reforms to strata law are so important. Owners' corporations must now offer payment plans to owners in financial hardship before taking any debt recovery action. They cannot just simply have a blanket rule and refuse payment plans. There are also stronger rules around transparency. Insurance quotes have to be itemised. Strata managers face far stronger penalties for failing to disclose conflicts of interest or kickbacks, which seems to be where their profits lie.

That is no more than basic fairness. If people are asked to pay, they are entitled to know what they are paying for.

Additionally, for major works, owners' corporations must now obtain a second quote where the cost is more than $30,000. That does not prevent hard decisions, but it does require those decisions to be tested. Residents deserve confidence that their money is being treated seriously. The reforms also give NSW Fair Trading stronger powers where owners' corporations fail to maintain and repair common property. The measures are designed to reduce the burden of expensive proceedings on residents fighting for repairs and maintenance. Lastly, developers must also have initial levy estimates independently certified so that buyers can understand the real cost of living in a prospective home.

None of that will make strata living simple. It will not remove every cost. It will not prevent every difficult meeting. But it will make the system more honest, more transparent and certainly more humane. If Sydney is to ask more people to live in apartments, then apartment living must be properly protected. It is not enough to build upwards and leave residents to fend for themselves after that, as previous governments have done. These reforms are important, sensible, practical and long overdue. More importantly, they recognise something very simple: An apartment is not just an asset, a lot number or a line in a strata roll; it is someone's home.

BATHURST ELECTORATE

Mr PAUL TOOLE (Bathurst) (17:51): Tonight I speak about a number of issues in my electorate. The first issue I will speak about is the Bathurst hospital car park. A $200 million redevelopment is underway right now, thanks to the former Coalition Government, but people need to be able to park next to the hospital. We are talking about elderly residents struggling to walk long distances, people with disabilities who need accessible parking, families rushing sick children to appointments and carers trying to help loved ones get the treatment they desperately need. People are missing medical appointments because they simply cannot find somewhere close enough to park at the hospital. That is unacceptable.

It is not a shopping centre; it is a hospital. When people are sick, in pain, elderly or caring for someone who is vulnerable, the last thing they should be doing is driving around the block looking for a parking space at the hospital. Let us not forget our hardworking nurses, doctors and hospital staff, who face that frustration every single day. Parking is not a luxury; it is an essential part of health care. The Government has an opportunity to get it right and stop ignoring the community but, instead of delivering a proper parking solution, it has allowed the problem to continue to get worse. We need to build a proper multistorey car park as part of the redevelopment, because a bigger hospital means absolutely nothing if patients cannot get through the front door.

Our community deserves better, and I will not stop fighting until we get it. Our seniors deserve better than what they are getting from the Minns Labor Government. We introduced the $250 regional seniors travel card when we were in government, and it made a real difference. It helped our seniors put fuel in their cars, pay for taxis, get to medical appointments, do their shopping and visit family and friends. For many, it was the difference

between getting out of the house and staying at home. It was real cost-of-living relief because money went directly into the pockets of country seniors. But what did Chris Minns and the Government do? They cut it.

At the very time pensioners were struggling with rising fuel prices, grocery prices and household bills, Labor took away that $250 support. Let us be clear: Living in the country is different. We do not have public transport on every corner. Our seniors have to travel longer distances just to access basic services. That is why we will bring back the regional seniors travel card. Our seniors have worked hard, paid their taxes and contributed to our communities their entire lives. They deserve respect, support and a government that puts them first. Labor cut support for our seniors and we are bringing it back.

Jenolan Caves is one of the greatest natural wonders in the world. A world-class tourism attraction featuring spectacular limestone formations and breathtaking scenery is in Bathurst's backyard, but Labor continues to drag its feet while that tourism jewel remains closed. Let us not forget the Five Mile Road. It is closed and will probably never reopen. Where is Labor's alternative? Where is the plan to get visitors back? Enough is enough. We need to stop talking and start delivering. That is why we will commit to a gondola for Jenolan Caves. A world-class attraction deserves world-class access.

Imagine visitors travelling above the magnificent landscape, taking in the spectacular views before exploring the caves below. A gondola will mean safer and more reliable access, a fantastic new visitor experience and less pressure on the roads in those areas. More tourists, more jobs and more money will flow into Oberon, Bathurst and surrounding communities. Our local businesses have waited long enough. Families have waited long enough. Labor needs to stop making excuses and start showing some vision. We do not want Jenolan Caves forgotten; we want it thriving. Labor can continue to drag its feet, but we will back the gondola and get Jenolan Caves moving again.

Regional councils are being pushed to breaking point, and it is time the Government stepped up. Look at Blayney Shire Council. Roads are deteriorating, bridges need replacing, essential infrastructure is ageing and the council simply does not have the money to keep up. A bridge that once cost $500,000 to build will now cost $1.5 million. That is three times the cost, and councils are being left to find the money. We cannot expect small regional councils to deliver big infrastructure on shrinking budgets. That is why the Coalition has made a clear commitment: At least 25 per cent of the State's infrastructure spending must go to regional New South Wales. Beyond Sydney and the big cities, regional communities will get their fair share. We need funding certainty and proper support for our councils, and that is what we will deliver.

RIVERSTONE ELECTORATE

Mr WARREN KIRBY (Riverstone) (17:56): Tonight I speak about protecting the history and identity of the Riverstone electorate while embracing the growth our community needs. I grew up in Schofields and raised my family in Riverstone. In my lifetime, I have watched the paddocks I used to play in become unit towers, the farms I used to explore become neighbourhoods and the dams we used to swim in become drainage basins. Riverstone, Schofields and districts, as it was once known, has transformed from a rural oasis in metropolitan Sydney to become the epicentre of the North West Growth Area.

The area has a long and rich history. Riverstone was originally established as Riverston Farm in 1810, but it was not until the Riverstone Meatworks was established in 1878 that the town really started to take shape. The meatworks was the lifeblood of the town right up until its closure in 1994. It supported shops, sporting clubs and generations of families. Everyone in Riverstone knew someone who worked at the meatworks. In my case, my mother got her first job there and my grandpa worked there for decades. The township of Schofields was named after John Schofield, who owned the land, and evolved into a town in the 1890s. Quakers Hill was first known as Douglas' Siding in 1872 and began to develop in 1906. Those three suburbs owe their existence to the construction of the Blacktown-Richmond railway line in the 1860s.

Over the following decades, schools and churches were built, jobs and industry flourished, but the region remained largely rural and the population base was very low compared with the rest of metropolitan Sydney. The housing expansion of the 1990s shaped Parklea, Stanhope Gardens, Acacia Gardens and large parts of Quakers Hill. They were all early examples of a plan by the State Government to develop the whole region from farms and market gardens into housing. By the early 2000s the North West Growth Centre was released, identifying 16 precincts of rural holdings into 40,000 new homes. In 2012 the plans for 40,000 homes were increased to 90,000, and almost all of those precincts were rezoned between 2012 and 2019. Tallawong, Nirimba Fields, Grantham Farm, Angus and Richards all became suburbs in 2020.

I do not offer that history lesson as a nostalgic trip down memory lane. Rather, I offer it to explain the genesis of the social challenges we now face. In 2001 the combined population of Riverstone and Schofields was just over 10,000, and the housing created in the '90s added another 25,000. Today, 25 years later, that population

is estimated to be well over 120,000 people. The people of Riverstone, Schofields and districts were not asked whether they wanted those changes. Schools built at the turn of the twentieth century were not designed for thousands of students. Roads that were designed at a time when most people rode horses were never expected to carry tens of thousands of vehicle movements per day.

For many residents, the pace and scale of change have been difficult. Familiar landscapes have disappeared, longstanding businesses have closed, and everyday journeys have become longer and longer.

Those changes have led to frustration and anger, and those feelings deserve to be acknowledged. People's family history, their contributions and attachment to the home they once knew must still matter. While many of us did not invite the change, as wave after wave of new housing materialised, it was clear we could not expect our country town to remain the same forever. Equally, new residents who were promised parks, schools and a functioning road network by developers, because they were marked on precinct plans, were sold new homes in the middle of construction sites. The developers neglected to tell them that those resources were yet to be built and that there was no timeline for their delivery. They are also frustrated and angry, and those feelings also deserve acknowledgement.

Somewhere along the line, politicians and bureaucrats forgot that longstanding residents deserve respect and newer residents deserve belonging. Perhaps that is because greenfield sites are thought of as vacant land and housing yield is just numbers. Whatever the reason, our area's history must be respected and our new population supported. My community understands the need for housing, but we deserve a fair deal from growth. That means delivering schools, roads and health services that keep pace with development. It means reliable public transport, local employment and investment benefiting established neighbourhoods alongside new communities. It means protecting heritage, retaining green space and delivering social infrastructure like libraries, sporting facilities, community halls and welcoming public spaces.

We must support the organisations and volunteers who bring people together. Our changing population brings cultures, skills, traditions and businesses that enrich our community. I am proud of the progress I have made since being elected in 2023, but that progress must translate into improvements that people can see and feel in their everyday lives. My work is far from finished. As a community we must keep working together to get it done. Having grown up in, and raised my family in, the electorate of Riverstone, I have a personal stake in its future. I am determined to keep doing the work and delivering for the people of the electorate of Riverstone. We are far more than simply a greenfield site in north-west Sydney. We are a community with a past worth protecting and a future worth shaping together.

EPPING ELECTORATE

Ms MONICA TUDEHOPE (Epping) (18:01): I make a few remarks in the aftermath of the incident with Helen Haines about what it is to be a member of Parliament with a young family who is trying their best to represent their community. It has been almost two years since the Epping by-election, and I have enjoyed every single day that I have served the people of Epping. I have tried my very best to fight for them in this House. Having a baby and other children while doing this job is incredibly challenging, but that was brought into the spotlight this week when a Federal member was attacked while doing their job.

I am sure that many members have to balance how much they involve their children. I take my job very seriously, and I think one thing that makes me very relatable to the people of Epping is that my life is like their life. I have a mortgage. My husband and I are both working. We are trying to juggle things. We attend swimming lessons in the community. We have children, and I like to think that part of who I am represents the people that I am trying to represent. Part of the role that I play is to make myself very accessible to the community and make sure that people know that the life that I live is like theirs. For that reason, I bring my baby into Parliament and put my children on social media. This week, I think all members have had to reflect on what that does for our children—who we have conscripted into this job—and our families.

I will continue fighting very hard for the people of Epping, and I hope they have appreciated that I have fought very hard for them. Whether it is the Epping Bridge, Dence Park, trying to get a lift fixed, trying to get demountables out of Carlingford High School, getting fences fixed or getting bus stops repaired, I will not stop fighting for the people of Epping. I will not stop fighting for them as a mum, a wife and a member of the community. It is a privilege to serve in Parliament. I think of all my colleagues and those serving in the Federal Parliament and how much community service we do. I hope all of our families are safe. It is a challenging time for every politician, but I do not take my position for granted. It is an absolute privilege. I am very lucky to be able to bring my baby to work and serve with my children and family. I do not take that for granted.

BANKSTOWN ELECTORATE SMALL BUSINESSES

Mr JIHAD DIB (Bankstown—Minister for Customer Service and Digital Government, Minister for Emergency Services, and Minister for Youth Justice) (18:04): The electorate of Bankstown in Sydney's south-west is home to many local businesses, all reflecting the many backgrounds, traditions and experiences that make our community unique. In a diverse community such as mine, small businesses are more than places of commerce; they are an important part of our local economic and social fabric. They introduce us to different cuisines, products and services, while creating opportunities for people from all walks of life to participate in the local economy. Today the Premier and the Minister for Transport made an announcement on Sydney Metro Southwest. The $23 billion transformational project will make a difference to our community. It will impact not only the local community but also our local small businesses.

With over 43,000 businesses calling Canterbury-Bankstown home, our local business community continues to play a crucial role in powering opportunity, jobs and growth across Western Sydney. Over the past few months, I have had the pleasure of attending several local businesses that capture not only the multicultural character of our electorate but also our hardworking spirit. Bankstown is home to companies like Ritek, a leading construction, technology and manufacturing company; and EWE Group, a logistics and supply chain company that has grown to operate across Australia and internationally out of Greenacre and Chullora. Those and other businesses provide valuable opportunities to support local jobs.

A recent tour inside Bankstown Central saw the diversity in shops and services, with the hustle and bustle evident throughout the centre, building a shared sense of local pride among shoppers and community. Those shopping centres become hubs within a community for people to get together. It was enlightening to hear directly from business owners like John, the owner of The Seafood King, on the process behind running a business in Bankstown. From Bankstown Central to visiting BuBooza Ice Cream—my favourite, where I have put on a little bit of weight—and Shareefs Shawarma or attending the grand opening of Milas Gallery, each visit reinforces the same notion that every local business has a story behind it of hard work, sacrifice, determination and an ambition to build a better future.

The theme of business was further celebrated throughout October, which is Small Business Month. The Canterbury Bankstown Chamber of Commerce proudly presented the Business and Entrepreneurship Expo 2026, a welcoming and effective way to celebrate the month. The expo was more than just an event; it was a space where connections had the potential to turn into partnerships, ideas develop into tangible business and ambitions transform into economic opportunities. From the moment I entered the venue, the motivation was palpable. With passionate business owners, founders, entrepreneurs and educators all in the one room, it was no surprise the venue was buzzing. It was enlightening to hear the unique stories, goals and hopes from speakers and guests, providing real insights and inspiration for anyone dreaming of starting their own business.

When we look at the future of Bankstown as a whole, we can see that our community is entering a really exciting period of change and opportunity. The electorate of Bankstown has seen exponential investment in infrastructure and services over the past four years under the Minns Labor Government, including the $20 million completion of the Punchbowl Public School upgrade, the $41.2 million investment in the upgrade of the Punchbowl Plaza, the investment in public preschools—enrolments are now open for the Yagoona and Chullora public preschools—the $550,000 investment in road repairs to fix the potholes that everyone keeps telling me about and, most significantly, the $2 billion investment in a brand new Bankstown hospital, where work is underway. Sydney Metro Southwest will open on 30 October. I invite Mr Temporary Speaker, the member for Castle Hill, to join me at 4.10 a.m. for a Manoosh in Bankstown before we get the 4.31 a.m. metro. Everyone in Hansard is invited as well. I know the member for Oxley will be there.

The Government has more to do in the electorate of Bankstown. As the population grows, we must ensure that our schools, health services, transport and local infrastructure keep pace. I will continue to listen to our residents and work alongside our local businesses to advocate for the investment that we need for a stronger and more connected community. In essence, by supporting our local business community, we are investing in the people of our electorate and a better future for generations to come. Local businesses and community members alike all deserve to thrive. I have seen that since becoming a member of Parliament, especially over the past four years under the Minns Labor Government.

I have often said in this House that our community is special, unique, warm and welcoming and has aspiration. For a long time, that aspiration was withheld. Nothing is holding us back anymore. No-one is saying that we cannot do it. The hospital and the metro, and the renewal and willingness of people to have a go serve as inspiring stories in Australia.

We said a long time ago that accepting second best was not an option. We deserve the best. We will make the best and will continue to do that. Again, it is Small Business Month. I recognise our small business owners. They are

mums, dads and locals who put everything on the line so that they can make a better future for themselves and our community.

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Mark Hodges): I just want to check the time that the member for Bankstown mentioned. Was that 4.31 a.m.?

Mr JIHAD DIB: It leaves at 4.31 a.m., but I will get you a zaatar manoosh. The half meat, half cheese is always very nice.

PARKES ENERGY RECOVERY FACILITY

Mr PHILIP DONATO (Orange) (18:09): I reaffirm my unequivocal opposition to the proposed energy-from-waste facility at the Parkes Special Activation Precinct and condemn the New South Wales Government's premature dismissal of a key recommendation from the Legislative Council's Select Committee on Proposed Energy from Waste. When the Government announced its preferred proponent for the Parkes Energy Recovery project in March 2025, I committed to the people of Parkes that if, after balanced and informed consideration, the community did not want this facility in their backyard, their wishes must be respected. I have honoured that commitment.

I have undertaken exhaustive due diligence through extensive community consultation, meetings with government agencies and the project proponent, questions in this Parliament and a visit to an operational facility in Kwinana, Western Australia. I came to a clear conclusion: Parkes is not the right location for this project. Parkes is a regional community surrounded by productive prime agricultural land, with an identity built on farming, food production and liveability. Unlike Kwinana, an established industrial area south of Perth, Parkes is not a long-established heavy industrial zone. The two locations are fundamentally different. I am not opposed to energy-from-waste technology in principle. However, it must be appropriately located, supported by genuine social licence and not imposed on regional communities to solve metropolitan waste problems. Transporting waste over 400 kilometres from Sydney to Parkes makes little environmental or logistical sense. Sydney must take greater responsibility for managing its own rubbish.

On Tuesday this week, the Legislative Council Select Committee on Proposed Energy from Waste Facilities released its inquiry report following many months of dedicated work. I commend committee members for their commitment to examining this complex issue and travelling across New South Wales to engage affected communities, including in Parkes. I had hoped the Government would carefully consider the report's findings and recommendations. In particular, recommendation 7 calls for a moratorium on all current waste-to-energy proposals and an independent, transparent review of all designated precincts, including the site-selection criteria, restriction to regional areas and inconsistencies in the current restricted regional precinct model, with the findings and analysis to be publicly released.

This is a reasonable and necessary recommendation. It would allow proper scrutiny of how these precincts were selected, whether the current approach is fair and evidence based, and how public confidence can be restored. Yet this morning, I became aware that the Minister for the Environment had already made an announcement, saying, "The New South Wales Government has received the report and will consider it in detail," while also stating, "The Government disagrees with the recommendation on having a moratorium on energy from waste." How can the Government claim to be considering a report in detail while simultaneously rejecting one of its most significant recommendations before that consideration has run its course? The Government's premature rejection of recommendation 7 is a mockery of the committee's comprehensive inquiry and the communities that participated in good faith. It undermines parliamentary scrutiny and sends a deeply troubling message to regional communities that expected their concerns to be heard and properly considered.

For Parkes, this is particularly insulting. The community has overwhelmingly rejected the proposed development in its home town. Residents have raised legitimate concerns about impacts on the environment, human health, transport, agricultural land and their region's future. They deserve more than assurances and a decision made before an independent review can even be considered. This is further evidence of a city-centric government that continues to treat regional New South Wales as second class. Regional communities are not dumping grounds for metropolitan waste, nor should they be expected to accept unwanted developments simply because governments deem them convenient.

The Government must explain why it refuses to pause current proposals and independently review the framework that has generated such significant community concern. It must demonstrate that regional voices matter as much as metropolitan interests. I stand with the people of Parkes. I do not support this facility. I reject the notion that regional communities should bear the burden of Sydney's waste without genuine consent, proper scrutiny and a fair process. The committee has done its work. The people of Parkes have made their position clear.

The Government must listen, reconsider its position and respect both the integrity of the inquiry and the communities it was established to serve. Sydney can manage its own rubbish. Parkes deserves better.

BREAST CANCER

Ms CHARISHMA KALIYANDA (Liverpool) (18:14): October is Breast Cancer Awareness Month, an opportunity to raise awareness, encourage early detection and recognise the extraordinary work being done to support those affected by breast cancer. It remains the most commonly diagnosed cancer among women in New South Wales, accounting for 28 per cent of all new cancer diagnoses in women. This year almost 7,000 women across our State are expected to receive a breast cancer diagnosis, while more than 1,000 women are expected to lose their lives to this disease. Behind every one of those numbers is a person, a family and a community.

We face a particular challenge in south-west Sydney when it comes to early detection. Across the South Western Sydney Local Health District, 53.6 per cent of eligible women aged between 50 and 74 are overdue for their breast screening. That means more than half of the women in our community who should be receiving regular screening are not up to date. That is a concerning statistic, particularly when we know that early detection can make such an enormous difference to treatment options and survival. The good news is that more women than ever are accessing BreastScreen NSW. Almost 390,000 women were screened over the past year, the highest number recorded in any 12-month period. But there is still much more work to do.

A recent survey of BreastScreen NSW clients found that more than 40 per cent of women had delayed their mammogram because they were too busy. Another 17 per cent simply forgot. It is understandable. Between work, family responsibilities and everything else life throws at us, our own health can sometimes fall to the bottom of the priority list. But a breast screen takes just 20 minutes, is free for eligible women and could save a life. Women aged 50 to 74 are encouraged to have a breast screen every two years, even if they have no symptoms or family history of breast cancer. For anyone who notices a change in their breasts, it is important to see a doctor without delay. I encourage women across Liverpool and south-west Sydney to make that appointment, and to remind the women in their lives to do the same. There is no more powerful way of disseminating information than the friendship network.

While early detection is critical, so too is ensuring that every person diagnosed with cancer can access the best possible treatment and care. I am particularly proud of the groundbreaking research taking place in south-west Sydney. Associate Professor Mei Ling Yap, a radiation oncologist and clinician researcher working in our local health district, is helping lead important work to improve equity in cancer care. Through her work with UNSW, the George Institute for Global Health and the Ingham Institute, she is focused on ensuring that patients can access high-quality cancer treatment, regardless of their background or circumstances. Her contributions were recognised with the 2024 NSW Premier's Cancer Research Award for improving equitable outcomes.

This commitment to equity is also reflected in the establishment of the Australian Centre for Cancer Equity, a collaboration between the Cancer Institute NSW, the Ingham Institute for Applied Medical Research and South Western Sydney Local Health District. The centre is tackling the barriers that prevent people from culturally and linguistically diverse communities, disadvantaged backgrounds and other underserviced groups from accessing quality cancer care. Its work includes multilingual resources, community engagement and initiatives to increase participation in clinical trials. I also congratulate Associate Professor Abhi Pal and the Ingham Institute team on their involvement in the National Breast Cancer Foundation's landmark $25 million research grant, working towards the ambitious goal of zero deaths from breast cancer. It is wonderful to see our local researchers contributing to advances that could change lives across Australia.

Of course, supporting people affected by cancer extends well beyond hospitals and research laboratories. It also happens through the compassion and generosity of people in our community. I have previously spoken in this place about Ladies Like To Lunch, a remarkable local not-for-profit organisation supporting women affected by cancer across south-west Sydney.

Earlier this week, I was very proud to join them for their 2026 Pink Ribbon lunch. Funds raised were allocated to support their WarriorHER wellness programs and care package program at the Liverpool Wellness Centre, providing practical assistance, connection and comfort to women navigating cancer. I particularly acknowledge Antoinette and Lorenzo Sulfaro for their tireless commitment to supporting women and families in our community. Their work reminds us that nobody should have to face cancer alone. This Breast Cancer Awareness Month, let us recognise the researchers, healthcare professionals and all involved.

COOTAMUNDRA ELECTORATE HEALTH CARE

Ms STEPH COOKE (Cootamundra) (18:19): Last week, members of the Minns Labor Government chose to silence me and the voices of my constituents during a debate on regional health investment. But I refuse

to stay silent on this vital issue. When I was elected as the member for Cootamundra in 2017, my first promise was to build a new hospital for Cowra. The Coalition delivered on that commitment, announcing funding in 2021, and a $110 million facility opened in 2025. In 2022, the former Coalition Government announced a $95 million redevelopment of the 90-year-old Temora Hospital. Recently, the community celebrated completion of the eastern wing, with the new facility on track to open in 2028.

I acknowledge the Minister for Health, who, since the change of Government in 2023, has continued supporting these projects. But the need for further investment across Cootamundra has not stopped. Coolamon-Ganmain Multipurpose Service [MPS] has long been identified as a priority for new infrastructure. This community has invested in its own aged-care and childcare services, but it now needs government support to upgrade its hospital. The discussion about the pressure older patients place on public hospitals is particularly relevant to Grenfell, which has a large ageing population.

The Commonwealth granted the MPS nine additional aged-care bed licences, but the current facility cannot accommodate those beds or the staff needed to support them. The community has advocated for years for an upgraded facility. The State Government must act. Cootamundra also needs a new hospital. That became clear during the campaign to save the pathology laboratory from closure. Cootamundra is a growing town that requires investment in health infrastructure. I also highlight the importance of HealthOne NSW services. Cootamundra is the only community in my electorate with a HealthOne service and is one of only two communities in the Murrumbidgee Local Health District with access to the service.

We know that increasing access to allied health, general practice and continuity of care reduces pressure on emergency departments and hospitals. But success requires investment in both workforce and service delivery. One of the best examples is Tresillian Family Care Centre in Cowra. The Tresillian Family Care Centre has provided specialist early-parenting support close to home, allowing families to access expert advice without travelling long distances. That service has changed the lives of families across the Central West and demonstrates the value of delivering specialist health services closer to home. I, for one, would love to see the Government invest in its expansion across the regions.

We must also recognise the gaps that remain. A dedicated Aboriginal medical service would benefit Narrandera significantly by providing culturally appropriate care for its large First Nations population and improving health outcomes. For services and infrastructure to be viable, we must have a strong regional workforce. Programs such as the Rural Generalist Single Employer Pathway provide young doctors with job security and a clear pathway into rural practice while equipping them with a broad range of skills to address workforce shortages in the bush. However, while those incentives should focus on communities with the greatest workforce challenges, hospitals in inland New South Wales are still competing with the Hunter, Illawarra and Central Coast for "rural" generalist trainees.

The Government could also do more to engage rural secondary students, help them see a career in health care, and increase opportunities to support and train them closer to home. When the bush can train its own workforce, it can retain it. That will require government investment. Regional communities only expect their fair share, and they should not have to settle for less. The investments in Cowra and Temora show what can be achieved when governments act on strong cases for regional investment. We must now continue that work by investing further in hospitals, the workforce, community health services and therefore communities across regional New South Wales. The challenges facing health care in the bush are well known and so are the solutions. We now need a commitment to deliver them.

GOVERNMENT PERFORMANCE

Ms LIESL TESCH (Gosford) (18:24): Four years ago, Premier Chris Minns and Labor promised New South Wales a fresh start. I would like to take a few minutes to reflect on what we have achieved together since 2023. Let us all remember what we walked into: a budget black hole bigger than the annual police budget; essential services stretched to breaking point; nurses, teachers and police whose pay had been held down for 12 long years; and classrooms without teachers and police stations without police. The previous Government's zealous commitment to privatisation drove it to sell off everything but the shirt off your back. Toll mania—that is what we inherited. We scrapped the wages cap. Our teachers, nurses, police, fireys and public servants have got a pay rise after 12 years of lost wages. We reduced admin hours required by teachers and gave 16,000 casual public education employees permanent jobs. Because of these reforms, teacher vacancies are now at 12-year lows. Record numbers of police are graduating every single time.

Thousands more nurses are on our wards with safe staffing levels in all of our emergency departments. The truth is that the previous Government never seemed to understand the value of our public servants. It is not a secret that the Government has been in pay disputes with some unions regarding those pay increases, but they know that our Government does not see their wages as an outlier on a budget paper to slash. The number of

teachers, nurses and police officers is no longer in freefall. When they stay employed, our kids get a teacher in front of every class, our hospitals have the staff they need and our streets are safer. We have protected our public hospitals and our public water from sale, and we did not stop there. We have written a ban on privatisation into the Constitution of New South Wales.

That means no future government can quietly sell off what belongs to the people of this State: not our hospitals, not our water—not on our watch. I know what matters most to families on the Central Coast and that is the cost of living. The Central Coast has one of the biggest commuting populations in the country. Under the Liberals, a peak-hour trip into Sydney could cost close to $30 one way. That is up to $60 a day just to get to work and back. Sydney had become the most tolled city in the world, and the Liberals called it an "infrastructure dividend". Coasties called it a copout and toll mania. One of the first things we did when we came to government was introduce the $60 weekly toll cap. Then we made it permanent and thousands and thousands of coasties have claimed it, getting hundreds of dollars back. We ended toll mania.

We have gone further. This year, we cut car registration by $100 for every private car and by $80 for every motorbike. That covers more than 4.4 million vehicles across the State. You do not fill in a form or chase a rebate; the discount comes off automatically when your rego is due. We have frozen Opal fares too, so whether you drive to work or catch the train, you are paying less than you would have under the previous Government. That is real relief, landing in real pockets, every week. We have done all of this while cutting the deficit in half. That matters because every dollar of debt the Liberals left us is a dollar not spent on a nurse, a teacher or a police officer. Compare that to what the Opposition is offering. They call their payroll tax plan a break for small business, but around half of all payroll tax is paid by about 340 large businesses.

This is not a tax cut for the corner shop. It is a tax cut for big businesses, dressed up as something else. This is the same mob that ran down the State's economy; the same mob that handed over the largest debt ever passed from one New South Wales Government to the next; the same mob that capped nurses' pay and sold toll roads. They have not changed; they have just changed the packaging. Under Premier Chris Minns and Treasurer Daniel Mookhey, we are paying down debt and delivering real cost-of-living relief. On the Central Coast, you can see the difference. Gosford is finally coming back to life. Our schools are better staffed, our hospitals are better supported, our streets are safer and we are seeing Gosford grow.

There is more to do, and I will not pretend otherwise. Families are still doing it tough, and the job of rebuilding New South Wales is not finished. But Labor has turned this State around by backing workers, protecting what New South Wales owns and putting money back into people's pockets. I am really proud of what we have achieved together, and I will keep fighting for my community every single day.

MINGARA RELAY FOR LIFE

Mr ADAM CROUCH (Terrigal) (18:29): I acknowledge the extraordinary community spirit on display at the 2026 Mingara Relay for Life, which I was privileged to be part of at the Mingara Regional Athletics Centre on 17 and 18 October. Celebrating its twenty-sixth year, Mingara Relay for Life brought the community together to celebrate cancer survivors, support people facing cancer and their carers, and honour loved ones lost. I sincerely thank the Cancer Council Central Coast organising committee for eight months of hard work and for inviting me to attend the opening ceremony as a guest of honour. To Denise, Jen, Kristina, David, Zoe, Evette, Linda, Louise, Dayle, David, Robin, Liza, Jean, Melanie, Robyn and Paul from Mingara, your dedication deserves our warmest appreciation.

Across 24 hours, more than 700 participants representing 65 teams supported Cancer Council's wider work in cancer research, prevention, advocacy and support services. I am delighted that this year's event surpassed the $150,000 fundraising goal, raising more than $170,000 to date. This remarkable achievement reflects months of preparation, fundraising and generosity across the Central Coast community. Behind that total are donations, raffles, fundraising events and countless hours of hard work. Every contributor can be proud of helping Cancer Council continue its work for people affected by cancer. I particularly congratulate the Smiles for Miles team from Henry Kendall High School, who raised more than $15,000. Their outstanding contribution demonstrates the compassion and initiative of our young people and the difference they can make by working together.

Relay for Life brings together families, friends, workplaces, schools, sporting clubs and community organisations, with team members taking turns walking around the track throughout the day and night. That continuous movement carries a powerful message: cancer never rests, but neither does our determination to support those facing it. I acknowledge Jocelyn Newton and the team from Walk It Off Terrigal Ladies, one of the many teams who walked through the night. Their commitment and enthusiasm exemplified the determination that makes Mingara Relay for Life so special. The opening ceremony was a wonderful start to the event. The beautiful performance of *A Million Dreams* by the Our Lady of the Rosary, Shelly Beach Primary School choir captured the hope shared by everyone gathered at Mingara.

For some participants, Relay for Life celebrates surviving cancer. For others, it provides an opportunity to stand beside someone undergoing treatment, recognise a carer's devotion or remember a loved one whose absence is deeply felt. The survivors' and carers' morning tea and the remembrance candlelight ceremony offered meaningful opportunities to reflect, connect and draw strength from one another. I acknowledge Mingara Relay for Life ambassador Ellie Sproll, a breast cancer survivor who has served as an ambassador for the past three years. Ellie recently shared her personal story on Triple M Central Coast, encouraging participation and rallying support for her team Stroll with Sproll. Her ongoing commitment inspires my community to contribute.

I thank Mingara Recreation Club for once again hosting this truly outstanding event. I acknowledge major sponsors Triple M Central Coast, the fantastic team at Kincumber Mitre 10, Stone Real Estate and JC Entertainment and Events. The presence and promotion of Triple M Roadies helped build community spirit and encourage participation. I also acknowledge All Risk Protection insurance brokers, Prestige Wedding and Event Hire, Fairplay Entertainment, Event Cinemas, Mickeys A Price Tyres, Coates, Best Signs Group, L&D Brown Skip Bins Hire, The Base Warehouse, Alliance Distribution Services, Liquid Furnace Studios, Fruit For All and, of course, the fantastic Eastcoast Beverages. Their generosity demonstrates the important role businesses on the coast play in supporting the community.

My thanks also go to the Lions Club volunteers who fired up the barbeque and kept participants and supporters supplied with sausage sandwiches and more. I also recognise the organising committee and the volunteers, whose preparation and dedication created a welcome place where people could celebrate, remember and support one another. To every "relayer", team captain, donor, sponsor, performer and supporter, thank you. Every lap walked, every hour volunteered and every dollar raised contributed to this truly wonderful event. I congratulate everyone involved in the 2026 Mingara Relay for Life on exceeding their fundraising goal and demonstrating the compassion, generosity and determination that the Central Coast community continues to show. We know that breast cancer is a scourge. Temporary Speaker Hodges, I note that you are a big supporter of Relay for Life in your region. Events like Relay for Life bring communities together in the shared goal of ending the scourge of cancer. I thank everyone involved in the Mingara Relay for Life. I look forward to attending next year's event, when the fundraising target for Cancer Council will undoubtedly be beaten again.

Ms LIESL TESCH (Gosford) (18:34): I thank the member for Terrigal for attending the Mingara Relay for Life. I am sorry I could not make it. A massive thank you to every single one of the organisers as well as Mingara Recreation Club, which hosts many wonderful events on the Central Coast. Also, special thanks to the 700 participants, many of whom walked through the night to raise money for Cancer Council. As someone who lost her mum to cancer, I understand that Relay for Life is a special movement that touches so many. Finally, I thank the participants from Henry Kendall High School. They are absolute champions of my community.

TEMPORARY SPEAKER (Mr Mark Hodges): As co-chair of the Parliamentary Friends of Relay for Life, I add my congratulations to everyone involved in the Mingara event. Relay for Life is a wonderful event. What it does throughout New South Wales and Australia to support people affected by cancer is absolutely fantastic, so I thank everyone involved.

PITTWATER ELECTORATE DEVELOPMENT

Ms JACQUI SCRUBY (Pittwater) (18:35): I speak on the Government's developer-led reforms, including the Low and Mid-Rise Housing Policy, the Housing Delivery Authority, State significant developments [SSDs] and uplifts for developers, which will fail to provide affordable housing. Yesterday, over 110 residents with SOS Save Our Suburb Mona Vale peacefully rallied outside Parliament before providing a comprehensive dossier to the member for Blacktown, the Parliamentary Secretary for Planning and Public Spaces, backed by more than 2,500 local signatories. This dossier is the result of over 12 months of rigorous technical investigation advised by leading specialists, including coastal engineer Angus Gordon, OAM, former Fire and Rescue NSW Commissioner Greg Mullins, AO, AFSM, and urban planning experts. It mirrors and provides more details on some of the arguments and submissions I have put to the Minister, particularly in my first meeting with him upon being elected.

On behalf of members of my community in Pittwater, I call for an immediate statutory moratorium on the application of the Low and Mid-Rise Housing Policy, the Housing Delivery Authority and residential State significant development pathways until an independent cumulative infrastructure capability and emergency evacuation audit is undertaken. This is prudent planning for a bushfire- and flood-prone region that has one road in and one road out. Consider the physical reality of the Barrenjoey peninsula. Over 35,000 residents north of Mona Vale depend on a single two-lane arterial road, Barrenjoey Road, to evacuate south. The 1996 Hiatt coronial inquiry into the deadly 1994 bushfires explicitly warned that coastal peninsulas bordered by continuous national parks become lethal traps when a single arterial road fails. Densifying Mona Vale without secondary egress directly contravenes section 9.1 of Local Planning Direction 4.3 and the binding principles of the 2019 Planning for Bush Fire Protection guide.

Fire seasons are now 21 per cent longer. This summer, unusually hot temperatures, combined with an increased baseline due to climate change, could increase the risk of flash droughts and catastrophic bushfires. There has already been a bushfire warning in the region this season. If a catastrophic bushfire emerges from Ku-ring-gai Chase National Park while Mona Vale Road is closed—as it was during the 1994 bushfires—and Pittwater Road and Wakehurst Parkway are choked, the community will have no viable road for escape. That was seen during the Los Angeles fires, where people literally had to leave their vehicles as the fires spread because of gridlock.

There are also infrastructure constraints. Warriewood Wastewater Treatment Plant currently discharges through an 80-metre cliff-face pipe off Turimetta Head into the intertidal surf zone, rather than through an ocean outfall. That is where locals swim and surf. The plant already operates beyond its designed baseline capacity of 65,000 persons. In heavy rain, partially treated effluent is discharged into the break zones. With respect to the area's transport network, there has recently been a bus crisis, with 43 bendy buses off the road. There have also been chronic driver shortages, and services have been axed. The B-Line is the only frequent transport option available to people, yet region eight accounts for nearly 30 per cent of all bus cancellations across Greater Sydney.

The Wakehurst Parkway continually floods when it rains and is therefore closed, and Mona Vale Road is a bottleneck. Whilst those projects are progressing, it will be many years before Pittwater residents finally get to see those benefits.

There is also the affordable housing myth or loophole. The uplift provided to developers will fail to provide affordable housing, especially in areas such as Pittwater. In Mona Vale, where a two-bedroom apartment rents for $1,000 a week, a 30 per cent discounted rent is $665 a week. That rent consumes 53 per cent of a first-year registered nurse's take-home pay, throwing them into rental stress. If a nurse and a police officer applied together, their combined award wages would be too high and disqualify them, leaving them with unaffordable housing. I also refer the House to the answer to my question on notice No. 5019 on 11 June 2025.

Whilst the Department of Planning, Housing and Infrastructure undertook a multi-criteria analysis to identify appropriate locations that were well supported by shops, amenities, public transport and infrastructure for the Low and Mid-Rise Housing Policy, that was only a high-level feasibility test. For an area like Pittwater, we need more detailed analysis, particularly of bushfire risk. My electorate is calling for action. I thank John David, convenor of Save Our Suburb Mona Vale, and all the residents who are calling out this policy failure. I call on the Government for a statutory moratorium for Pittwater.

COFFS HARBOUR JETTY FORESHORE PRECINCT

Mr GURMESH SINGH (Coffs Harbour) (18:40): Over 100 years ago, the people of Coffs Harbour built a jetty because they understood something simple: If you want the world to do business with you, you need to have a way to transport your goods. The jetty enabled timber to be carried to ships. Over the next century, it carried the identity of Coffs Harbour. This summer Coffs Harbour will see a change in how the world reaches us, but in reverse. In December the Coffs Harbour bypass will open to traffic. Twelve thousand vehicles a day will come off local roads. Twelve sets of traffic lights will go. On a good day, up to 12 minutes will be saved on every trip, and over an hour saved during the holidays.

The community eagerly anticipates a post-bypass Coffs. It will be a game changer for locals, for truckies and for safety. But we should also talk about the other side of the coin. For as long as anyone can remember, the Pacific Highway has delivered visitors to our front door whether they planned to stop or not. Families pulled up for a coffee, saw the water and stayed the night. Plenty of them came back every year. From this summer, the highway will carry those same families past us at highway speed. A bypass takes the traffic out of town and does not, by itself, give anyone a reason to turn off the highway. That is why the jetty foreshore matters so much right now. Let me describe the land in question because it is often described inaccurately.

The land proposed for development is not the beach, not the parkland and not the jetty. It sits behind Jordan Esplanade and largely is former industrial land in the old rail corridor. Much of it is fenced off, gravelled and closed to the public. You cannot swim there, kick a footy there or take your kids there. With parkland by the water, you would not choose to put a picnic rug there next to the train tracks. The project takes that unused land and puts it to work. Development would pay for the things people love about the jetty area and provide more green and open space, better playgrounds, upgraded facilities, better parking, and proper walking and cycling connections linking the city to the harbour. The existing parklands are protected and would be improved.

Critically for a town about to be bypassed, it delivers tourist accommodation right where visitors want to be. I ask members to think about what that means for our local businesses, our cafes and restaurants, the dive operators, the whale watching charters and the family who runs the fish and chip shop. Each one is a small business, and each one is about to lose the passing trade the old highway gave them for free. They need people to

go there on purpose. A revitalised foreshore with somewhere to stay, somewhere to eat and somewhere worth walking is how to get people to go there on purpose.

I know the project has its critics, and I respect the passion people have for the foreshore. People care deeply about the place, as they should. I have read their letters and tried my best to answer their concerns. I have pointed out that the 2024 poll asked only whether people supported multi-level private residential development on some of the foreshore land but gave no context about where that land sits or what it pays for. I encourage anyone with concerns to look at the whole plan, not focus on that single question. Some say that the poll means they do not want any development at all, which was not what the question asked.

Coffs Harbour has always been a place where people stopped. After this summer, it has to become a place people head for. The bypass gives us back our town centre, and the foreshore will give people a reason to visit and stay. For my part, the people of Coffs Harbour know where I stand because I have never stood anywhere else. I supported this project in government. I supported it in opposition. I support it today. I have not told people in one room one thing and people in another room something different, and I will not start now. I came into Parliament to make our region a better place to live, work and visit. The bypass is part of that. The foreshore is part of that. Our forebears built a jetty and trusted the future. Our city should have the same confidence again.

CRONULLA ELECTORATE TRAFFIC

Mr MARK SPEAKMAN (Cronulla) (18:44): Central Cronulla traffic is chaotic. Many members in this place talk about traffic issues in their electorate, but central Cronulla is completely dysfunctional. Let me share some comments by local residents. Mel said:

> No matter which street you turn down around Cronulla thinking you might be able to get in and out a quicker way, all the streets are bumper to bumper ... No matter what streets you take, they are all a nightmare both in and out.

Fiona said:

> My mum lives in Coronation Ave and we visit many times a week … it's a disaster in summer.

Denise said:

> Traffic is chaotic when the sun shines.

Mark said, unfortunately:

> So glad I moved from there.

Julie said:

> I live near Shark Park and most days it can take me 30 to 40 minutes to get to my mother's in South Cronulla—that's crazy.

Bruce referred to the afternoon peak hour congestion which sees traffic back up from Cronulla station all the way to the Kingsway, including on summer weekends. In September, Leonie said:

> Getting in and out of Cronulla last Saturday … (the first real "summer" day) was just downright dangerous—if emergency vehicles needed access they would have had nowhere to go. Traffic into Cronulla was banked back to Woolooware Rd.

Another Mel said:

> It took me an hour to get out of the multistorey carpark 2 Sundays ago! Never again!

I hear repeated stories of constituents who take up to an hour to get from one end of Cronulla to the other. I have experienced that. I live about a kilometre away from central Cronulla, and it took an hour to get there one summer weekend. I am not encouraging more people to use their cars. Often people just want to bypass central Cronulla, but for people in south Cronulla there is only one road in and one road out. They have to go through central Cronulla to get out. It is dangerous when emergency services vehicles cannot get there in time.

This will only get worse as we see greater density resulting from the Government's Low and Mid-Rise Housing Policy and State significant developments. I understand the argument for more density around train stations. As a matter of principle, that is fine. But, firstly, it needs supporting infrastructure. Secondly, central Cronulla, particularly south of the Kingsway, just does not have the geographical capacity for much greater density. Some will say that we need to reduce car use and encourage people to ride e-bikes or push bikes, catch an Uber or catch a train. That is fine for getting to central Cronulla or the beach. But people who live in Cronulla, particularly south Cronulla, need to use their car to get out. Sutherland council has no plan for this. The Kingsway is a State road, but all the other roads are local roads. I am calling on the State Government and the local council to work closely to come up with solutions. The status quo is simply unacceptable.

The gold-plated solution would be a tunnel around the Kingsway and under central Cronulla that comes out around Waratah Street. I have floated other options, including a bypass around Tonkin Oval and extending into the Tonkin Street cul-de-sac to Searl Road, with an underpass or an overpass at the Cronulla station pedestrian

crossing. Another option is a second left-hand turn lane from Wilbar Avenue into the Kingsway. Perhaps the BP site could be acquired to create another second right-hand turn from the Kingsway into Wilbar Avenue. Other suggestions include doing something about the Gerrale Street pedestrian crossing, reversing the direction of Cronulla Street between Purley Place and Cronulla station. People have suggested a one-way loop around Cronulla, but I do not think that is the answer.

That would just increase traffic because, other things being equal, it would take a person longer to get from point A to point B if they have to go in a big loop to get there.

There is a number of suggestions. I would ask the Government to get its traffic engineers, work with the council and come up with a solution. It is not just about bad traffic on the weekend and during holidays; it is a complete and utter dysfunction. It has been like that for decades, and it is only going to get worse. I call on the State Government and the local council to work together to fix Cronulla's horrible traffic problems once and for all.

HOLSWORTHY ELECTORATE COMMUNITY SAFETY

Mrs TINA AYYAD (Holsworthy) (18:49): Tonight I raise the urgent need for greater community safety and a stronger police presence in the Holsworthy electorate. Under the Minns Labor Government, communities across Western Sydney are witnessing deeply concerning acts of violence, from shootings and organised crime to break-ins, vandalism and antisocial behaviour. Every time we turn on the news, there seems to be another shooting, another violent attack or another innocent person caught in the crossfire. Behind every headline is a family, a neighbourhood and a community left wondering whether they could be next. No-one should have to live with that fear. No parent should have to worry about their child walking home from school. No elderly resident should feel unsafe leaving their home. No family should have to question whether their local streets are safe. Yet those concerns are increasingly weighing on communities across south-western Sydney.

The figures demonstrate why we must take those concerns seriously. In Liverpool, recorded violent crime has reportedly increased by 12 per cent over five years, including an 11 per cent increase in assaults and a 22 per cent increase in sexual assaults. While communities are calling for stronger protection, the police officers we rely upon are facing considerable pressure. According to the NSW Police Force's annual reports, the number of officers at Liverpool City Police Area Command fell from 251 in June 2024 to just 227 in June 2025. Numbers also decreased at Sutherland Shire Police Area Command. Those figures raise serious questions about whether police resources are keeping pace with the needs of our communities.

I make it absolutely clear that the hardworking men and women of the NSW Police Force put themselves in harm's way every single day to protect our communities, and they deserve our utmost respect and support. But they cannot be expected to carry an ever-growing responsibility without the resources and support they need. It is our residents who stand to lose when policing resources are stretched. In recent months, I have become increasingly concerned about reports of antisocial behaviour, damage to public property and threats to community safety across our local area. Those incidents may not always make the front page of a newspaper, but they have a very real impact on the people who live there. A damaged community facility, a frightening confrontation or an act of vandalism can be enough to leave residents feeling that their neighbourhood is no longer as safe as it once was.

I am calling on the Minns Labor Government to establish a permanent police station in Wattle Grove. Residents in the Holsworthy electorate deserve a visible, accessible and adequately resourced local police presence. A permanent station would provide an opportunity for stronger local policing, greater community engagement and a more proactive approach to preventing crime. Policing is not just about responding after a crime has occurred. It is about prevention, deterrence and giving people confidence that help is there when they need it. The people of Holsworthy are not asking for special treatment. They are asking for something that every Australian should be entitled to—the right to feel safe in their own community.

Community safety is not a luxury. It is one of the most fundamental responsibilities of government. I call on the Minns Labor Government to listen to the concerns of Holsworthy residents, properly resource our frontline police and commit to establishing a permanent police station in Wattle Grove. Our community deserves nothing less.

Ms LIESL TESCH (Gosford) (18:54): I put on the record that when we came to government, there were 2,500 fewer police than we needed in New South Wales, and the police had not had a significant pay rise for 12 years. I commend the Minister for Police and Counter-terrorism, who has brought in salary increases of 22.3 per cent to 39 per cent for non-commissioned officers and 20 per cent to 27 per cent for commissioned officers. That means the salary of probationary constables has gone from $81,000 to $97,000 a year, which makes the job more attractive. We are also paying police to do their training at Goulburn. Instead of having 30 officers

graduating, we will have 300 to 400 officers graduating. The investment in police means we are going to see a change. The numbers will go up in the Police Force across the State. I am not sure when we will be able to put in new stations but we are getting existing stations up to standard.

DAVIDSON ELECTORATE YOUTH

Mr MATT CROSS (Davidson) (18:55): I am often asked about the best part of being a member of Parliament. The answer is easy. It is meeting our youth, listening to our youth and acting on their behalf. I often reflect on my own youth. I was genuinely excited about the future and the chance to make the world a better place. I still believe in that. That optimism was encouraged by older generations who took the time to listen, support and mentor me. I particularly give a shout-out to the late Bruce Baird, who, sadly, recently left us. I believe we also have a responsibility to do the same for the next generation.

Earlier this year I established the Davidson Youth Advisory Committee, made up of 10 community-minded local young people. I opened it up to the entire community to apply. The committee is chaired by year 12 graduate Ally Sorbara, who leads a committee including Leila Alami, Angelina Barnsdall, Jess Gannon, David Griesz, Imogen Kee, Amelie Lim, Xavier Macdonald, Jack Okill, Lachlan Steenson, Renee Tokura and Veronica Wade. I thank them. The committee is there to listen to youth across our community, turn their ideas into action and advise me, as the member for Davidson. As a first step, we have launched a youth survey, which is now open. The committee and I want to hear directly from local youth aged 16 to 24 about the issues that matter most to them. I encourage people to have their say by visiting my website and filling out the petition. People can tell us what they think about the cost of living, housing, jobs, the environment, artificial intelligence, sport or any issue that matters to them.

I am also proud to announce that the committee and I will be hosting the first annual local youth summit this December. The late afternoon to early evening event in St Ives will share the survey results, give young people the chance to workshop ideas and feature panel discussions with experts from across our community to discuss matters such as mental health, environment and transport. Our youth are an important part of our community today and tomorrow. Their voices deserve to be heard, their ideas taken seriously and their energy matched with action. I look forward to listening, learning and working together to make our community even better.

I now turn to our wonderful year 12 class of 2026 as students currently undertake the final steps in their HSC and International Baccalaureate. As they enter the final stretch of their school journey, it is a time of mixed feelings. It is exciting, daunting and challenging, all at once. They are doing long days and late nights of study, juggling part-time jobs and dealing with the pressure of meeting expectations. It is also an unforgettable experience with unforgettable moments. They would have recently had their final assembly, potentially a muck-up week, the glamorous formal, the graduation ceremony and those last days with peers and teachers. I hope they hold onto these moments.

When the exams end and they put the pens down, students will question what to do next. There may be anxiousness or uncertainty. That is normal. That makes us human. I have three thoughts for their journey ahead. The first is that they embrace their passion. The late singer Tony Bennett once said, "If you follow your passion, you'll never work a day in your life." Some students already know their passion, while others will discover it in the years ahead. I am always reminded that Colonel Sanders did not found KFC until later in life. I hope they remember to embrace their passion and aim for the stars.

My second thought is that they embrace their strengths and do what they are good at. I am passionate about cricket, but I am not good at cricket. Sadly, I do not do that for a job. I hope I am a good politician—touch wood for March. Each of us has unique talents. In time, those students' talents will become clearer. They need to build on what they are good at and remember to embrace that, as they are likely to help others and the community. Third, they should embrace grit. Challenges and choices come our way. We have to persevere. Grit is about resilience, determination and believing in oneself even when things are tough. Life is a marathon, not a sprint. We must remember to embrace grit, as grit is about believing in ourselves.

No matter where we are in life, we all need to embrace it to get through. Those moments in which we embrace grit make us the people we are today. Finally, I say to students that their worth is not defined by the marks or grades they get alone. Their best days are still ahead of them. The community is behind them at this time. They have got this.

The House adjourned, pursuant to standing and sessional orders, at 19:00 until Tuesday 10 November 2026 at 12:00.

Written Community Recognition Statements

According to Standing Order 108A, the following written community recognition statements were submitted.

MARG SYMES

Mr ROY BUTLER (Barwon)—Congratulations to Marg Symes on the completion of her fourth fundraising walk in support of the Broken Hill Wellbeing Place. In August, Marg undertook an incredible 330-kilometre journey from Tibooburra to Broken Hill. This latest effort has pushed her fundraising total beyond $100,000, adding to the more than 900 kilometres walked and over $85,000 raised through her previous fundraising treks. Marg's walks have taken her across some of the toughest and most remote country in NSW. She has endured extreme weather conditions, shared the roads with road trains, and even faced a wedge-tailed eagle attack along the way. A lifelong Broken Hill local, Marg has spent decades giving back through countless volunteer and community organisations. As President of the Broken Hill Women's Auxiliary, a key supporter of the annual Flying Doctor Ball, and through her involvement in local sporting and school organisations, she has demonstrated an unwavering commitment to the wellbeing of others. Through her fundraising efforts, Marg is helping ensure vital mental health, wellbeing, alcohol and other drug services remain accessible across Broken Hill and 18 remote Far West outreach communities. Marg's generosity and community spirit are truly inspiring.

NORMAN 'NORM' TWEEDIE

Mr ROY BUTLER (Barwon)—I would like to congratulate The Y Broken Hill' volunteer Norm Tweedie, whose decades of dedication have left an enduring mark on both the organisation and the wider community. In a fitting tribute to his tireless service, the conference room at the Broken Hill Integrated Wellness Centre has been officially renamed the Norman Tweedie Conference Room, ensuring his legacy will continue to inspire future generations. Norm's commitment extends well beyond his membership with the Y's Men, which began in 2000. For many years prior, he was already generously giving his time and energy wherever it was needed, demonstrating a quiet but steadfast commitment to helping others. His willingness to step in and uplift those around him reflects the very spirit of community service. Highly regarded by his peers, Norm is celebrated not only for his reliability and work ethic, but also for his care for people. His contribution has positively influenced staff, members, and countless community participants. This recognition stands as a heartfelt thank you from The Y and the Broken Hill community, honouring a man whose service, leadership and generosity truly embody the values of community and connection.

TREVOR ODGERS

Mr ROY BUTLER (Barwon)—I recognise Trevor Odgers for his outstanding service, leadership, and dedication to the Broken Hill Community. Born and raised in Broken Hill, Trevor has spent his entire life giving back to the town he proudly calls home, contributing countless volunteer hours to organisations that have made a lasting difference to residents. Over the years, Trevor has been actively involved with the St Pat's Race Club, the Lions Club of Broken Hill, Lifeline, and numerous charitable and community organisations. Through these roles, he has supported fundraising efforts, community events, volunteer programs, and initiatives that have improved the lives of many people across the region. Known for his humility, generosity, and unwavering community spirit, Trevor has never sought recognition for his efforts. Instead, he has quietly dedicated himself to serving others, building strong community connections, and encouraging the spirit of volunteering. Trevor's commitment reflects his deep love for the city and its people. His contributions, spanning decades, have helped strengthen local organisations and foster the supportive and welcoming culture for which Broken Hill is known. Congratulations on this milestone. I am sure your legacy will continue to inspire many future generations.

COLOUR CITY ORANGE HINDU ORGANISATION

Mr PHILIP DONATO (Orange)—Mr Speaker, Orange's cultural diversity is one of its biggest assets and the city's vibrant Hindu community is at the forefront. Combined, the neighbouring cities of Orange and Bathurst have around 2000 people who celebrate the Hindu faith and its rich traditions, family values and commitment to community. These traditions and values are generously shared with the wider community making the Colour City Orange Hindu Organisation a welcoming, safe place for all denominations, which adds to Orange's expanding diversity. Celebrations such as Diwali, the festival of lights, provide a wonderful and open insight into this gentle religion, enabling us to share food and cultural activities. From an economic perspective, the Hindu community is widely represented across a wide range of industries and services, contributing to growth of Orange. The Colour City Orange Hindu Organisation is now working towards the establishment of a permanent home with plans for a temple taking shape. This space will lend itself to teaching and community activities which will be open to the whole community. I fully support the Orange's Hindu community's plans to establish a permanent base and thank them for their wonderful input into our cultural diversity.

LYN TOWNSEND

Mr PHILIP DONATO (Orange)—Mr Speaker, this year the Parkes Musical and Dramatic Society is celebrating 75 years of performance and production and today I wish to acknowledge one of the amazing volunteers that has helped it achieve this milestone. Parkes' Lyn Townsend has been a driving force behind the PMDS for more than three decades. During that time she has given thousands of hours to its productions. Lyn also pushed the introduction of subtitles for hearing-impaired audience members and pioneered autism-friendly performances, making the Society's Little Theatre welcoming and accessible to everyone. One of the many creatives in the PMDS, Lyn has also encouraged the development of the next generation of performers and theatrical technicians. As a further acknowledgement of Lyn's enormous input into the PMDS, the NSW Centre for Volunteering has named her the Central West's adult Volunteer of the Year, a thoroughly deserved acknowledgement of her skill, leadership and dedication to theatre in Parkes. I congratulate Lyn on this recognition; it is thoroughly deserved. I also thank her for her work within the Parkes Musical and Dramatic Society, which is an amazing organisation backed by a great team.

YVONNE MACRAE

Mr PHILIP DONATO (Orange)—Mr Speaker, I would like to acknowledge the Orange District Manager of Girl Guides NSW, Yvonne MacRae. Yvonne first became involved in the Girl Guides Movement as a Brownie Leader in 1992. Since that time, she has dedicated herself to supporting girls from the age of 6 to 17 years as part of the organisation which is designed to empower girls and young women to take their place in the world as leaders. Girl Guides provide a range of recreational and learning opportunities, and Yvonne MacRae has been an important part of that process for 34 years, contributing more than 20 hours a week to the organisation. Since becoming involved in Guiding 34 year ago, Yvonne has held the roles of Brownie Leader, Guide Leader, Support Group Secretary, as well as the roles of both secretary and treasurer for the Central West Region of Girl Guides. During her years of service, Yvonne has been a wonderful role model to the girls and young women entrusted in her care and the impact she has had on the lives of so many of these girls should not be under-estimated. Yvonne is a highly valued volunteer in my rural electorate.

ELIENA BENTHAM - THE DREAM CREATIVE OZ

Mrs JUDY HANNAN (Wollondilly)—I wish to recognise and congratulate Eliena Bentham, an exceptional young dancer from Industry Dance Co. in Tahmoor, on her outstanding achievement in securing a place in The Dream Creative Oz Wollongong 2026 program. Created by the renowned Dream Dance Company, this highly competitive program selects a limited number of talented dancers through an audition process, offering participants an invaluable opportunity to develop their skills, creativity and performance abilities. Eliena's selection is a testament to her dedication, passion and commitment to dance. Through this intensive program, she had the opportunity to learn from leading performers, immerse herself in high-level dance training and further develop her artistic expression alongside some of the country's finest emerging talent. Her achievement is particularly noteworthy and reflects the hard work and determination she continues to demonstrate as a member of the Industry Dance Co. 2026 Show Team. I congratulate Eliena on this significant milestone and commend her for pursuing her passion for dancing with such enthusiasm and perseverance. I wish her every success as she continues to grow as a performer and inspire other young dancers across our community.

THIRLMERE TAHMOOR ROOSTERS

Mrs JUDY HANNAN (Wollondilly)—The 2026 NRL Grand Final was a memorable occasion for rugby league fans, but for a group of nine-year-olds from the Thirlmere Tahmoor Roosters Rugby League Club, it was an experience of a lifetime. These young local players were selected to participate in the NRL Grand Final celebrations, giving them an extraordinary opportunity to be part of one of rugby league's biggest events. After watching the Sydney Roosters triumph over the Newcastle Knights in a nail-biting Grand Final, the children took centre stage in the post-match ceremony. Standing alongside some of the season's finest players, they proudly presented NRL Premiership Rings to the victorious team, creating unforgettable memories they will cherish for years to come. What a fantastic opportunity for these young Roosters from Wollondilly! Their involvement highlights the importance of supporting junior sport and providing young people with opportunities to build confidence, develop friendships and feel connected to their community. I congratulate these young players and thank everyone who supports grassroots rugby league. Investing in our junior players helps nurture future leaders, strengthen local clubs and ensure the next generation can thrive both on and off the field.

RORY AND EUAN SHEDDEN, AUSTRALIAN SCHOOLS ORIENTEERING CHAMPIONSHIPS

Mrs JUDY HANNAN (Wollondilly)—I congratulate Rory and Euan Shedden, residents of Bowral and members of the Southern Highlands Orienteers Club, for their outstanding achievements in orienteering and for proudly representing our region on the national and international stage. Both boys were selected for the NSW team

at the Australian Schools Orienteering Championships in Canberra, competing in sprint, long-distance and relay events. Rory achieved one first-place and two second-place finishes in the Senior Boys category, while Euan secured two second-place and one third-place finish in the Junior Boys category. Their exceptional performances earned both brothers selection in the Australian Honours Team. They continued their impressive form at the Oceania Orienteering Championships, where Rory recorded two first-place finishes, a third and a fifth, while Euan achieved two firsts, a fourth and a sixth. Adding to their achievements, both boys represented Australia at the European Youth Orienteering Championships in Slovenia last July. I congratulate Rory and Euan on their dedication, determination and remarkable success. Their accomplishments are a wonderful source of pride for the Southern Highlands and an inspiration to young athletes pursuing their sporting dreams. I wish them every success in their future competitions.

RESILIENT UKI WINS STATEWIDE AWARD

Ms JANELLE SAFFIN (Lismore—Minister for Small Business, Minister for Recovery, and Minister for the North Coast)—AS Member for Lismore and NSW Minister for Recovery, I was delighted to learn that Resilient Uki has been named the NSW winner of the Resilient Australia Community Award. The award recognises the Northern Rivers Community Emergency Hub Guide, a practical resource co-designed with community resilience groups across the Tweed and Byron shires. The guide, developed from local experience and knowledge gained through natural disasters, is designed to help communities establish emergency hubs during the critical first 72 hours after an emergency. As we know, communities are often the first to step up when disaster strikes. By supporting local people to prepare for, respond to and recover from emergencies, initiatives like this help build stronger and more resilient communities. Congratulations to President Mel Bloor, Vice President Brendan Esposito, Secretary Julie Aslett, Treasurer Geoffrey Colwill and everyone involved. This recognition is richly deserved because Resilient Uki is making a real difference now and for future generations. Safe Haven North Coast won the Mental Health and Wellbeing category. It was funded by NSW Health, commissioned by Healthy North Coast and delivered by The Buttery. The NSW winners will now be considered for the national Resilient Australia Awards.

THE CHANNON MARKETS 50TH ANNIVERSARY

Ms JANELLE SAFFIN (Lismore—Minister for Small Business, Minister for Recovery, and Minister for the North Coast)—This month The Channon Craft Market celebrated its 50th anniversary with a vibrant, colourful market, live music, around 200 stalls and thousands of people attending. What began as a 'make it, bake it or grow it' market in the local hall in 1976 soon expanded into a popular event at Coronation Park. The market emerged during a period of enormous social change in our region. I remember the atmosphere when I went along with a girlfriend, in our long hippie skirts. It felt that we were on the brink of something. The Channon Craft Market became a popular tourist attraction for the region on the second Sunday of the month, famous for its hippie vibe, chai tent and beautiful setting, long before other markets sprang up. Every Channon market has supported a local 'charity of the day'. Through floods, bushfires and COVID, the Channon Market has endured. I acknowledge all market committee members past and present, current president Jacob Stone, former manager Steve Cook and current manager Robyn Kelly. Special mention to Ray Flanagan who was one of the organisers in 1976, has been committee secretary, musician, and stallholder and helped co-ordinate the anniversary event.

TIM WELLM

Ms JANELLE SAFFIN (Lismore—Minister for Small Business, Minister for Recovery, and Minister for the North Coast)—I WISH to congratulate Murwillumbah's Tim Wellm on being among the fastest teenage backstrokers Australia has ever produced, swimming within 0.4 seconds of the national 50-metre backstroke record. Tim Wellm swam 24.80 seconds in the 50-metre backstroke at the National Short Course Championships (Open) in Sydney on 1 October. It is the 3rd fastest time ever recorded by a 16-year-old Australian. The swim sent him into the Men's Open final as the 10th fastest qualifier, racing against the country's best at a meet that doubles as a qualifier for the World Championships. The final was televised on 9Now where Tim came 10th with a time of 24.88 seconds. Tim said the 50-metre backstroke was the one where he exceeded his own expectations. "I did a really big PB and ended up making the A final in the 50-metre backstroke against all the older boys," Tim said. Tim started in the learn-to-swim program at Tweed Shire Council's Murwillumbah Pool when he was about three years old and it remains the place where he trains. Tim's coach, Council Pool Attendant Graham Huband, said Tim had developed into a strong backstroke and butterfly swimmer and was moving into the sprint events.

SORE BUTTS CHARITY RIDE

Ms STEPH COOKE (Cootamundra)—It is a pleasure to stand today to recognise the organisers, riders, volunteers and supporters of the annual Sore Butts Charity Ride, an outstanding community event held in the Bland Shire to raise funds for Can Assist. I particularly acknowledge organisers Greg Trethowan and Elise Trethowan for their tremendous commitment to making this event such a success year after year. The ride brings

together horse riders, families and friends from across the region, combining a great day of country camaraderie with an important charitable purpose. For many years, Sore Butts has raised significant funds to support Can Assist's vital work helping people in regional and rural communities who are affected by cancer. I thank everyone who participated, volunteered, donated, sponsored and supported this wonderful event. The generosity demonstrated the strength and community spirit that makes regional NSW so special.

GUNDAGAI SES AND GUNDAGAI HIGH SCHOOL

Ms STEPH COOKE (Cootamundra)—The dedication and commitment of NSW State Emergency Service volunteers deserves recognition not only during National Volunteer Week and Wear Orange Wednesday, but throughout the year for the vital work they perform in communities across our region. It was wonderful to see Gundagai High School welcome local SES Unit Commander Ross Tout and volunteers Ray Gardner and Peter Gailey to the school, providing students and staff with an opportunity to learn more about the important role these volunteers play in keeping our communities safe. Whether responding to storms, floods or other emergencies, SES volunteers give countless hours of their time to assist others when help is needed most. Their willingness to serve is a remarkable example of community spirit in action. I am particularly encouraged to see more young people joining the SES, with more than 30 per cent of volunteers now aged under 35. These young volunteers are developing valuable skills while making a meaningful contribution to their communities. On behalf of our community, I thank all SES volunteers for their service, dedication and sacrifice. Their efforts make our communities safer, stronger and more resilient.

BREANNA ANDERSON AND MARLENE IRVING

Ms STEPH COOKE (Cootamundra)—I wish to congratulate and acknowledge Breanna Anderson and Marlene Irving from Young on their well-deserved recognition at the Mercy Care Centre's Nurses and Midwives Excellence award ceremony. Nurses and midwives play an essential role in the health and wellbeing of our regional communities. Their compassion, professionalism and dedication provide comfort and care to people during some of life's most challenging and significant moments. The recognition of Breanna Anderson and Marlene Irving is a testament to their outstanding commitment to caring for others and the positive impact they have made within the Mercy Care Centre and wider Young community. Their professionalism, kindness and tireless service embody the very best qualities of the nursing and midwifery professions. Regional healthcare services rely heavily on the dedication of individuals such as Breanna and Marlene, whose work often extends far beyond clinical care to supporting families and strengthening community wellbeing. I congratulate them both on this wonderful achievement and thank them for their continued service and dedication to regional healthcare.

MADISON CHO — NGARALA PUBLIC SCHOOL

Mr JORDAN LANE (Ryde)—I ask the House to join me in recognising Madison Cho of Ngarala Public School for her participation in the inaugural Ryde Public Speaking Competition. This competition invited students to consider a challenge facing young people today and to present their own ideas for how government can help solve it. Madison's participation reflects confidence, preparation and a thoughtful approach to public speaking. To speak on the floor of the Legislative Assembly is a significant achievement. It requires courage, discipline and the ability to share ideas in a formal and meaningful setting. Madison represented Ngarala Public School with pride. As the Member for Ryde, I congratulate Madison on her participation and wish her every success in her future studies, public speaking and leadership.

RYDE JPS

Mr JORDAN LANE (Ryde)—I ask the House to join me in congratulating Daniel Luczynski, Adarsh Gulati, Geoffrey Budgen, Melissa Viljoen & Oliver Pickford who were recently appointed a Justice of the Peace in my electorate of Ryde! JPs play such an important role and reflect the community face of our justice system. At its core, the appointment of a person to Justice of the Peace is all about service. I thank these individuals for this service. As a JP, you are responsible for upholding the values of honesty and impartiality as you execute your official duties for the benefit of our local community. In a fast growing community like Ryde, the demand for JP services is growing exponentially, and I feel fortunate as the local Member of Parliament to see so many high-quality individuals willing to raise their hands. Your appointment as a JP underscores your character, integrity, and dedication to public service. Congratulations once again on this well-deserved appointment and thank you for the difference I know you will make in the lives of those you serve.

RYDE JPS

Mr JORDAN LANE (Ryde)—I ask the House to join me in congratulating Matthew Jung, Gerard Patrick Martin, Qian Ding and Adora Lu who were recently appointed a Justice of the Peace in my electorate of Ryde! JPs play such an important role and reflect the community face of our justice system. At its core, the appointment of a person to Justice of the Peace is all about service. I thank these individuals for this service. As a JP, you are

responsible for upholding the values of honesty and impartiality as you execute your official duties for the benefit of our local community. In a fast growing community like Ryde, the demand for JP services is growing exponentially, and I feel fortunate as the local Member of Parliament to see so many high-quality individuals willing to raise their hands. Your appointment as a JP underscores your character, integrity, and dedication to public service. Congratulations once again on this well-deserved appointment and thank you for the difference I know you will make in the lives of those you serve.

THE 23RD INTERFAITH PRAYER SERVICE

Ms JULIA FINN (Granville)—I was pleased to attend the 23rd Interfaith Prayer Service for the International Day of Peace at the Fellowship Centre, Parramatta Mission, on 21 September 2026. The service brought together people from different faiths and backgrounds to reflect on the importance of peace, mutual respect and understanding in our communities. The occasion featured an address by Rev Dr Patrick McInerney, Director of the Columban Centre for Christian–Muslim Relations, highlighting the importance of interfaith dialogue and cooperation in fostering peaceful and inclusive communities. The International Day of Peace serves as an important reminder of our shared responsibility to promote harmony, compassion and understanding across cultural and religious differences. Events such as this provide valuable opportunities for people of different faiths to come together, strengthen relationships and celebrate the values that unite us. I acknowledge the organisers of the 23rd Interfaith Prayer Service and thank Rev Dr Patrick McInerney and everyone involved for their commitment to promoting interfaith understanding, respect and lasting peace within our diverse community.

PHULA BAULA BENI

Ms JULIA FINN (Granville)—I was pleased to attend the Phula Baula Beni (PBB) 2026 cultural celebration at the Regency Function Centre in Auburn on 10 October 2026, representing the Hon Stephen Kamper MP, Minister for Multiculturalism. Organised by ORIOZ Inc., the Association of Odias in Australia, this special event brought together members of the Odia community to celebrate the rich cultural heritage, traditions and artistic excellence of Odisha, India. Through music, dance, drama and cultural performances, the celebration provided a wonderful opportunity to showcase Odia culture and strengthen connections between communities across Sydney. Events such as Phula Baula Beni play an important role in preserving cultural traditions, promoting mutual understanding and celebrating the diversity that enriches our multicultural society. I acknowledge ORIOZ President Tapas Senapati, the organising committee and all volunteers for their dedication to bringing this celebration to life. I thank the Odia community for their valuable contribution to our multicultural society and for fostering a strong sense of belonging, inclusion and community harmony.

BU ARAS

Ms JULIA FINN (Granville)—I rise today to recognise the outstanding achievement of BU Aras, a talented resident of the Granville electorate, who recently secured third place in the AIM Talent Awards 2026. The AIM Talent Awards is an annual competition organised by the AIM Association to celebrate and promote multicultural talent from across Australia. The competition showcases performers of all ages and backgrounds, featuring singing, dancing, instrumental performances, comedy and many other artistic talents that reflect the rich cultural diversity of our nation. BU Aras impressed judges and audiences alike with his remarkable performance of Dinner Shallow (Lady Gaga song). What made his performance particularly unique was his own creative rendition of the song, performed in both English and Turkish. By blending two languages and cultures, he delivered a memorable performance that highlighted both his musical ability and his cultural heritage. Achieving third place in a national multicultural talent competition is an outstanding accomplishment. For BU Aras, this success also represents the fulfilment of a lifelong dream to pursue a career in music. On behalf of the people of Granville, I congratulate BU Aras on this well-deserved recognition. And look forward to future performances by him.

CRONULLA HIGH SCHOOL – RUGBY LEAGUE CHAMPIONS

Mr MARK SPEAKMAN (Cronulla)—I congratulate Cronulla High School on winning the 2026 NSW Combined High Schools Sports Association Comprehensive High Schools Rugby League Grand Final, securing the title for the first time in the competition's history. The school's rugby league program was established following its early success in the Buckley Shield and has been strongly supported by Principal Tony Ibrahim. The program provides talented young footballers, many of whom are involved in NRL pathways, with the opportunity to continue their sporting development while completing their HSC at Cronulla High School. I acknowledge team captains Eddie Nicholson and Haiden Wooldrige, and team members Zayne Armstrong, Parker Cavanough, Max Christensen, Harper Evans, Talakai Fauonuku, Noah Kennedy, Ryan Klaassen, Ziggy Lester, Axel Murphy, Max Nicholson, Vinnie Pirrello, Charlie Rapp, Zac Redman, Lawson Rinaldi, Archie Smith, Curren Taper, Ashton Taylor and Ryan Zdjelar. I also recognise coach Cameron Paddy, manager Tony Ibrahim and assistant coaches Corey Willis and Ben Hodgson for their contribution to the team's success. This is an extraordinary achievement

for the school and a testament to the dedication and teamwork of the players, whose hard work has culminated in this result.

ST HUBERTS ISLAND RESIDENTS ASSOCIATION CELEBRATES 50 YEARS

Mr ADAM CROUCH (Terrigal)—I congratulate the St Huberts Island Residents Association on its 50th anniversary. Established by local residents in 1976, the Association has brought neighbours together and represented the interests of the island community for five decades. It was a pleasure to join residents to celebrate this wonderful milestone and acknowledge the people whose dedication has sustained the Association over the years. I thank the current and previous committees for the countless hours they have volunteered to improve the island for all residents. Their commitment reflects the community spirit that makes St Huberts Island such a special place to call home. This anniversary is an opportunity to celebrate both the Association's achievements and the friendships and connections built through 50 years of community service. I extend my congratulations to all members, past and present, and wish the St Huberts Island Residents Association every success for the next 50 years.

MENTAL HEALTH ART WORKS EXHIBITION — 27 YEARS OF CONNECTION

Mr ADAM CROUCH (Terrigal)—I congratulate Coast & Country Primary Care on its 27th annual Mental Health Art Works Exhibition, which I was delighted to attend for the official opening. For 27 years, this exhibition has provided a welcoming space for people to express themselves, share their experiences and connect with the wider community through art. This year's theme, "A Little Connection Goes a Long Way," reminds us that a conversation, a kind word or simply taking time to listen can help someone feel valued and less alone. I acknowledge this year's artists for their creativity and the courage involved in sharing their work. Each contribution offers an opportunity to see the world through another person's eyes and appreciate their experiences. I also thank the families, carers, support workers, volunteers and community organisations whose encouragement helps make this exhibition possible. Coast & Country Primary Care's commitment to inclusion and connection strengthens our Central Coast community. Congratulations to everyone involved, especially the artists. I hope you take great pride in seeing your work recognised and celebrated.

BLUEPOINT TERRIGAL

Mr ADAM CROUCH (Terrigal)—I congratulate Terrigal's BluePoint community on another successful annual Share a Cuppa for Cancer Research morning tea, bringing together more than 130 supporters and raising over $10,000 for cancer research. From humble beginnings four years ago, this event has grown through the dedication of residents and the generosity of local businesses. I particularly acknowledge organising committee leaders Karen Harper and Jane Simmonds, whose hard work and enthusiasm helped make this year's fundraiser such a success. The poolside fashion parade featured new-season fashions from major sponsor Niche Home & Living Terrigal and Najo Jewellery, while a silent auction offered nearly 100 items generously donated by local businesses. BluePoint residents provided a wonderful morning tea, with proceeds from their State of Origin gatherings also contributing to the fundraising total. Despite challenging economic conditions, this community has again demonstrated its commitment to making a difference. I thank the organisers, residents, sponsors, businesses and supporters for their generosity and community spirit. Their collective efforts are making a meaningful contribution to cancer research and offer an inspiring example of what a community can achieve together.

CHANDI SABAPATHYPILLAI—LOCAL WOMAN OF THE YEAR NOMINATION

Mr MARK HODGES (Castle Hill)—I congratulate Chandi Sabapathypillai, on her nomination for Local Woman of the Year, recognising more than 35 years of service to The Hills Shire Council. As Group Manager of Finance and Corporate Strategy, Chandi oversees Council's financial policies, reporting and oversight arrangements, alongside human resources, governance, risk and information technology. Her nomination by General Manager Michael Edgar recognises her instrumental role in strengthening Council's financial position and its capacity to provide services and facilities while operating within its means. Across the tenure of three general managers, Chandi has provided continuity, sound judgement and stewardship. Her work demonstrates the importance of responsible financial management to the delivery of community infrastructure and services. Mr Edgar's nomination particularly acknowledges her integrity, professionalism and dedication, describing a leader whose contribution has been substantial, while working quietly behind the scenes. Such service deserves recognition. The strength of our local institutions depends on people who bring expertise, consistency and commitment to the communities they serve. I commend Chandi for her contribution to local government and thank her for the diligence she has brought to her responsibilities over more than three decades. Her nomination is a deserved acknowledgement.

JOSLENE ABBOUD—LOCAL WOMAN OF THE YEAR NOMINATION

Mr MARK HODGES (Castle Hill)—I congratulate Joslene Abboud on her nomination for the 2027 NSW Local Women of the Year program, recognising her contribution to domestic and family violence prevention in the Hills community. A survivor of domestic and family violence, Joslene has chosen to share her experience to educate others. As founder of Fortitude Minds, she develops practical resources to help children, young people and adults understand their emotions, strengthen communication and build respectful relationships. At the 2026 Hills March for Change, Joslene worked alongside Hills Police, domestic violence services and community organisations. She shared her story and led activities helping students understand domestic violence, coercive control and emotional wellbeing. Students reported that hearing her experience deepened their understanding of abuse and helped prepare them to respond to disrespect towards themselves or others. Joslene has also extended these conversations into the wider community through speaking at Wesley Castle Hill. I commend Joslene for her courage, compassion and determination to help prevent others experiencing violence. Her commitment to equipping young people with the knowledge to recognise abuse and understand respectful relationships is a valuable contribution to our community. Her nomination is recognition of that important contribution.

HARTLEY ZIETSCH – SNOWBOARDER AND TAFE STUDENT

Mr STEVE WHAN (Monaro—Minister for Skills, TAFE and Tertiary Education)—Hartley Zietsch is just 15 and already one of Australia's rising snowboarding talents. Every winter, Hartley and his family move from Wollongong to Jindabyne so he can train full-time at Perisher. When a traditional school timetable became impossible to keep up with, he enrolled in TAFE NSW's Certificate II in Career Pathways and earned his Record of School Achievement this year, studying at his own pace around training and travel. He spends five days a week up the hill and still finds time to work part-time at a ski hire. His results are impressive, including selection in the 2025/2026 Snow Australia Emerging Talent Program, first place in the grom division at the 2026 World Rookie Tour Finals in Italy, and Sportsperson of the Year at the 2026 Wollongong Youth Excellence Awards. TAFE NSW Wollongong head teacher Amber Weyman says his story shows what young people can achieve when education meets them where they are in life. Congratulations Hartley, and thanks to the TAFE NSW teachers who backed him. Asked about the future, he said he just wants to be a good person. Judging by his attitude, he is well on his way.

BUNGENDORE CWA

Mr STEVE WHAN (Monaro—Minister for Skills, TAFE and Tertiary Education)—I noted in the latest CWA magazine the success of Bungendore CWA branch's community craft project for this year. The project involves producing "granny squares", these (apparently) are those crocheted squares that can be put together into a lovely warm blanket. Last year the branch produced 400 hundred 'granny squares', this year a massive 1,946 were produced by 62 entrants. The project was promoted on local ABC and, of course, by the enthusiastic local CWA members. The 1,946 squares were donated to Roundabout Canberra, an organisation that provides support to families with young children, where they will be turned into lovely handmade blankets. Congratulations Bungendore CWA.

EDEN MARINE HIGH SCHOOL RFS CADETS

Dr MICHAEL HOLLAND (Bega)—I congratulate the 21 students from Eden Marine High School who are graduating from the Rural Fire Service Secondary School Cadet Program. Over the past ten weeks, these young people have demonstrated outstanding commitment, learning valuable skills in fire safety, emergency response, teamwork and leadership. Through the program, they have gained a deeper understanding of the vital role volunteer firefighters play in protecting our communities and keeping people safe. The Far South Coast has a proud tradition of volunteering and community service. It is encouraging to see so many local students embracing these values. The confidence, resilience and practical knowledge developed through this program will serve them well in whatever paths they choose in the future. I extend my thanks to Eden Marine High School, the Rural Fire Service Far South Coast District, and the volunteers and staff members who dedicated their time to delivering the program and mentoring these students. Congratulations to each graduate on this significant achievement. Their hard work, enthusiasm and willingness to serve are a credit to themselves, their families, their school and our community. I thank them for their contribution to strengthening the spirit of service in our region.

VERA CLARK

Dr MICHAEL HOLLAND (Bega)—I recognise Vera Clark for more than 15 years of dedicated volunteering with the Eden Community Access Centre and for her outstanding contribution to Eden and the Bega Valley. Vera helps people access essential services, build digital skills and stay connected. Through patient, practical support, she guides residents through a digital world and helps ensure no one is left isolated or excluded. As a long-serving Centrelink volunteer, Vera assists people to navigate complex government systems and online

requirements. She is an Australian Taxation Office-trained volunteer, helping people complete tax returns when they cannot afford or access commercial services. Her contribution goes further. Vera provides one-on-one IT assistance, runs computer classes and organises activities that build confidence and digital literacy. She produces the monthly Eden Connection newsletter, keeping residents informed about news, events and opportunities. What makes Vera's service special is her readiness to help anyone who needs support. Whether assisting with a computer, completing an important form, or sharing community news, she responds with generosity, patience and care. Volunteers like Vera are invaluable to regional communities. I thank her for more than 15 years of service and congratulate her on being a valued member of the Eden community.

BELINDA DORSETT

Dr MICHAEL HOLLAND (Bega)—I recognise Belinda Dorsett and her contribution to the Eurobodalla community through The Mossy Cafe. Ten years ago, Belinda entered hospitality with no industry experience. Through hard work, determination and a willingness to learn, she transformed a small-town cafe into a successful group of three regional venues. She studied commercial cookery at TAFE, qualified as a chef and developed the skills to run a growing business. Her resilience was tested during the COVID-19 pandemic, but she adapted. The success of takeaway services helped inspire Mossy on Train in Broulee, while a further opportunity created another much-loved venue at the Eurobodalla Regional Botanic Garden. Most importantly, Belinda supported the people who worked beside her. When selling the business, she ensured her staff were supported, their employment benefits retained and their years of service recognised. After a decade of demanding work, Belinda has earned a well-deserved break. Her story reflects entrepreneurship, resilience, adaptability and community. She created welcoming places, provided local jobs and strengthened the character of our region. I thank Belinda for all she has contributed, congratulate her on building a business of which she can be proud, and wish her every success and happiness in the next chapter.

DR NHI NGUYEN

Ms KAREN McKEOWN (Penrith)—I congratulate Dr Nhi Nguyen, who works at Nepean Hospital in my electorate of Penrith, on receiving a prestigious Churchill Fellowship. Next year, Dr Nguyen will travel overseas to learn from leading experts and investigate how clinicians can help shape and lead the delivery of care across the health system. The fellowship will take Dr Nguyen to the United Kingdom, Denmark, Sweden, the Netherlands and Canada, where she will explore how different health systems foster partnerships with clinicians to improve patient care. The knowledge and experience gained through this study tour will inform Dr Nguyen's work with the Nepean Blue Mountains Local Health District Board and in her role as Clinical Co-Chair of the Health System Advisory Council. I thank Dr Nguyen for her dedicated service to the people of Penrith and congratulate her on this outstanding achievement and the recognition represented by her selection for a Churchill Fellowship.

JAYDEN HAZELL

Ms KAREN McKEOWN (Penrith)—I warmly congratulate Jayden Hazell of South Penrith, in my electorate, on his selection to represent Australia as a member of the Under 12 Australian Baseball Team. In November, Jayden will travel to Guam with his teammates to compete in the Under 12 Baseball World Cup Qualifier, proudly representing Australia on the international stage. This outstanding achievement reflects Jayden's skill, dedication to training and passion for baseball. The opportunity to wear the Australian colours is a tremendous honour, and his selection is a source of pride for his family, his community, his state and his nation. I wish Jayden and the entire team every success as they represent Australia in Micronesia, and Jayden all the best in his future sporting endeavours. Jayden, your community is proud of you and will be cheering you on.

WORLD TEACHERS' DAY

Ms KAREN McKEOWN (Penrith)—Friday 30 October marks World Teachers' Day, an opportunity to celebrate our educators—past, present and future. Across my electorate of Penrith, teachers, P&Cs, school staff and students work together to make our community a wonderful place to grow and learn, inspiring some students to become the educators of tomorrow. To every teacher in Penrith, I offer my heartfelt thanks for your hard work and dedication to educating our children your dedication does not go unnoticed. Teaching carries an enormous responsibility: nurturing the future leaders, doctors, nurses, tradies and philosophers who will help build a better, brighter world. Great teachers lay the foundations for our young people's futures. They help students understand the world around them, develop a strong sense of ethics, build essential skills and learn to think critically. On World Teachers' Day, 30 October, I thank all our educators for the lasting difference they make in young lives and for helping make Penrith a better place to live and learn.

COROWA MEN'S SHED

Mr JUSTIN CLANCY (Albury)—I acknowledge the Corowa Men's Shed, President Brendan Christy and its members for their wonderful contribution to our community. Most recently, members put their skills to work helping create Waldron's IGA's new outdoor seating and dining area—a fantastic new space for shoppers, staff and the wider Corowa community to enjoy. The project was two years in the planning and design, with every piece custom-made by the men's shed members. Once everything was ready, the talented members of the Corowa Men's Shed brought it all together, completing the assembly in just six weeks. Their contribution is a wonderful example of what Men's Sheds are all about—sharing skills and experience, building friendships and finding creative ways to give back to the community. During Men's Shed Week, we are reminded of the important role these organisations play across Australia, providing a place where people can belong, stay connected and continue making a difference. I thank Brendan and every member of the Corowa Men's Shed. Their craftsmanship can be seen in this new space, but their greatest contribution is the connection, purpose and community spirit they continue to build throughout Corowa.

JEFF HOGAN

Mr JUSTIN CLANCY (Albury)—I acknowledge Jeff Hogan for his outstanding and longstanding service to the Albury community and to organisations across New South Wales. For 25 years, Jeff has served with distinction on the Albury Showground Trust Board, now the Albury Showground Land Manager, helping to preserve and manage this important community facility for the benefit of Albury and the wider state. Jeff has also made an enduring contribution as President of the Albury Harness Racing Club for 14 years, earning life membership, and through five years of service with Harness Racing NSW. His commitment extends to UPA Murray Vale, where he has served on the board for 40 years, including five years as President. He gave a decade of leadership to the Lavington East Public School Parents and Citizens Committee, becoming a life member, and served 12 years with the local Riding for the Disabled Club. He also led Technical Aids for the Disabled for 10 years and contributed to the Albury Small Bore Rifle Club as Treasurer. Nominated for Albury Citizen of the Year in 2018, Jeff leaves the Land Manager Board with great credit. I thank Jeff for a quarter-century of dedicated community volunteer service.

JOEL HOWSE – FLYING SOLO BEFORE HE CAN DRIVE

Mr JUSTIN CLANCY (Albury)—I acknowledge 16-year-old Joel Howse of Albury, on his remarkable achievement of completing his first solo flight in a glider, taking to the skies independently before he is even old enough to drive a car. Joel began gliding at just 14, learning under the guidance of dedicated club volunteers and developing the skills, discipline and strong commitment to aviation safety required to fly solo. I particularly acknowledge Joel's chief flying instructor, Andrew Evans, and the volunteers who have encouraged and supported him throughout this remarkable journey. For Joel, aviation is more than a weekend pursuit. When his feet are on the ground, he is often practising on his flight simulator or designing and building small rockets and radio-controlled aircraft using his 3D printer. While Joel must wait another year before he can drive independently, the open skies are already his to explore. Congratulations, Joel, on an outstanding achievement and an exciting beginning to what may well be a future in aviation.

GEOFF RYAN

Mr PAUL TOOLE (Bathurst)—This statement acknowledges the contributions Geoff Ryan has made to his community as a volunteer firefighter for the Rural Fire Service. Group Officer Geoff Ryan has dedicated 58 years to the New South Wales Rural Fire Service, holding roles such as Deputy Captain, Captain, and a Chifley Lithgow Group Captain for over 26 years. In this time he overseen many rural brigades, is always happy to mentor up and coming crew leaders and actively participates in the training of new members. He is a vital member of the Senior Leadership Team and actively participates in key committees, using his expertise for future planning and risk minimization. As a foundation member of the NSW Rural Fire Service Association, he advocates for volunteers across the state. In 2021, Geoff received the Australian Fire Service Medal for his distinguished service. His dedication and leadership make him a worthy recipient of the National Medal 4th Clasp for his exceptional contributions to the community. Thank you Geoff for your service.

RONALD FREEMAN

Mr PAUL TOOLE (Bathurst)—This statement acknowledges the contributions Ronald Freeman has made to his community as a volunteer firefighter for the Rural Fire Service. Ronald Freeman has dedicated over 50 years to the New South Wales Rural Fire Service, exemplifying commitment and leadership in emergency communications. His efforts have enhanced safety and efficiency during major incidents, including bushfires and disaster recovery. Key contributions include Serving as Senior Deputy Captain of the Blacktown Bushfire Brigade) and later as Captain of the Blacktown and Cumberland Communications brigades, assisting in training

for communication roles within the RFS. Ron has deployed during significant fires in 2019-2020 and supervising communications at various fire control centres and mentoring new firefighters and encouraging skill development in his current role as Captain of the Raglan Brigade. Ron is also an active member of the Chifley Operation Support Brigade and plays a major role in logistical movements around the District. Ron is a respected figure in the Chifley Lithgow District and is a worthy recipient the National Medal 3rd and 4th Clasp. Thank you for your service to our community.

BARRY RICHARD

Mr PAUL TOOLE (Bathurst)—This statement acknowledges the contributions Barry Richard has made to his community as a volunteer firefighter for the Rural Fire Service. Barry Richard AFSM has recently received the 60-Year Long Service Clasp and National Medal in recognition of over 61 years of dedicated service to the NSW Rural Fire Service. Barry is a founding member of the Jenolan Caves Brigade, over the years Barry has had numerous roles at a Brigade level, he was a Deputy Group Captain and retired as Group Captain in 2025. Barry is an active RFSA Representative, is the current Captain at Jenolan Caves and was awarded Life Membership in 2018, and in 2024 Barry was awarded the Australian Fire Service Medal for his dedicated commitment to the community and the NSW RFS. Thank you Barry for your service.

PACIFIC AWARDS 2026

Mr NATHAN HAGARTY (Leppington)—It was a pleasure to attend this year's NSW Pacific Awards, held at The Cube in Campbelltown Catholic Club on 2 September. The evening was a wonderful celebration of the achievements and contributions of Pacific individuals and organisations who make a real difference across New South Wales. From community volunteers and cultural leaders to businesses and service providers, the awards recognised those who dedicate their time and efforts to supporting others, creating opportunities and strengthening the communities they serve. It was great to see so many people come together to celebrate the rich cultures, traditions and achievements of our Pacific communities. Congratulations to all the award recipients and nominees. Your hard work, leadership and commitment to giving back deserve recognition and your contributions continue to make our local communities better places to live. My sincere thanks to the NSW Council for Pacific Communities for organising another successful evening and recognising these outstanding contributions.

COMMUNITY MARKET DAY SCALABRINI VILLAGE

Mr NATHAN HAGARTY (Leppington)—It is always a pleasure to visit Scalabrini Retirement Village in Austral, and on 13 September, I had the opportunity to attend their inaugural Live Easy Community Market Day. The event welcomed more than 1,100 people for a free, family-friendly day featuring cultural performances, food, local market stalls and activities for all ages. Community events like these provide an opportunity for families, neighbours and friends to come together, but they also serve a greater purpose. The Leppington Electorate is home to people from many different cultural backgrounds, each bringing their own traditions, stories and experiences that enrich our community. Celebrating this diversity helps us better understand one another, strengthens our connections and reminds us of what makes our part of South West Sydney such a wonderful place to live. My thanks to Scalabrini Austral, the performers, stallholders, volunteers and everyone involved in organising this successful event and bringing our community together.

DASHAIN CUP 2026

Mr NATHAN HAGARTY (Leppington)—It was great to join the local Nepalese community for a fantastic Dashain Cup at Craik Park, hosted by the Austral Nepalese Community Club. Dashain is one of the most important festivals in Nepal, bringing families and communities together to celebrate the victory of good over evil, the triumph of light over darkness, and the importance of family and renewal. The Dashain Cup is a wonderful example of how these traditions continue to be celebrated here in South West Sydney, bringing people together through sport, culture and shared experiences. From soccer tournaments for adults and children to family activities, food stalls and cultural performances, there was something for everyone to enjoy. Events like this help preserve cultural traditions for younger generations while giving the wider community an opportunity to learn about and appreciate Nepalese culture. Thank you to the Austral Nepalese Community Club, the volunteers and everyone involved in making the day such a success.

BALGOWLAH GOLF CLUB

Mr JAMES GRIFFIN (Manly)—Mr Speaker, I congratulate Balgowlah Golf Club on an outstanding result at last night's 2026 NSW Golf Industry Awards, taking home both awards for which the Club and its leadership were nominated. The club was named Junior Metropolitan Club of the Year, recognising its commitment to growing the game through regular junior competitions, dedicated clinics and encouraging more girls to take up golf. Its scholarship program, which saw more than 20 young girls from across the local area take part, is a fantastic initiative helping build the future of the sport. Club President Flora Johnson also won the

Excellence in Management award – an amazing result which recognises her contribution to the Club and the broader community over the past three years. Balgowlah Golf Club is a real hidden gem on the Northern Beaches, and these awards reflect the people, community spirit and dedication that make it such a special club. I congratulate Flora, Head Professional Matt Baron-Grenot and the entire staff and volunteers on this well-deserved recognition.

MILLIN'S FREE RANGE BUTCHER

Mr JAMES GRIFFIN (Manly)—Mr Speaker, I rise to once again recognise the team at Millin's Free Range Butcher in Balgowlah Heights, who have continued their winning streak at the 2026 NSW Sausage King Awards. Millin's has snagged seven gold medals, including Best Poultry Sausage in NSW for its Satay Chicken Malay Sausage, which scored a perfect 100 per cent from all three judges. This is not the first time I've had the pleasure of recognising Millin's, and it's fantastic to see this local business continuing to raise the stakes with its innovative recipes and a commitment to quality. I congratulate the whole team on these outstanding results and wish them all the best as they take their award-winning sausages to the national championships. If you're ever passing through Balgowlah Heights, be sure to pay them a visit and support a local, independent butcher that continues to put the Northern Beaches on the map.

CAMDEN HAVEN HIGH SCHOOL ROBOTICS TEAM

Mr ROBERT DWYER (Port Macquarie)—I rise today to recognise the outstanding achievements of Camden Haven High School's robotics team, Team Tazor, following their impressive performance at the 2026 RoboCup Junior NSW State Competition. Competing against some of the best student robotics teams from across New South Wales, Team Tazor demonstrated exceptional innovation, technical skill and resilience to progress through the competition undefeated during the preliminary rounds. The team of Jass Jones, Eleanore Olsen and Tiata Corowa reached the grand final of the Open Soccer division before narrowly finishing runners-up after a technical fault impacted their robot during the decider. Despite that setback, the team's second-place finish earned qualification for the Australian Open National Championships, a remarkable achievement and one that reflects countless hours of learning, programming, design and problem-solving. Their success highlights the growing strength of science, technology, engineering and mathematics education within our region and serves as an inspiration for other young people considering careers in these fields. I congratulate Team Tazor, their teachers, mentors, school community and families for their support throughout this journey. Their achievement demonstrates that regional students can compete with confidence against the very best and continue to excel on the national stage.

HARDY FLETCHER – BODYBOARDING CHAMPION

Mr ROBERT DWYER (Port Macquarie)—I rise today to recognise the outstanding achievements of Hardy Fletcher, a talented young athlete from North Haven and a student of Camden Haven High School, whose recent success in bodyboarding has brought great pride to our local community. Hardy recently claimed the Australian Under 14 Bodyboarding Championship at the Australian Bodyboard Titles, held at his home break of North Haven. Competing against the nation's best young riders in challenging conditions, Hardy delivered an exceptional performance to secure the national title and further cement his reputation as one of Australia's most promising young bodyboarders. This achievement adds to an already impressive record of success at both state and national level. Through countless hours of training, dedication to his sport and a genuine love of the ocean, Hardy has developed into an outstanding young competitor who continues to inspire those around him. He is a tremendous ambassador for our region, and I congratulate him on this remarkable achievement. I wish Hardy every success in his future sporting endeavours and look forward to following his continued achievements in the years ahead.

IESHA APTHORPE

Mr ROBERT DWYER (Port Macquarie)—I rise today to recognise the outstanding achievements of Iesha Apthorpe, a talented swimmer from Port Macquarie whose remarkable success on the national stage continues to inspire our community. At the recent Australian Short Course Championships, Iesha delivered a career-best performance in the Women's 100-metre Butterfly Multi Class Final, claiming a National Bronze Medal and setting a new Australian Short Course Record in the S19 classification. Her exceptional swim also established both a Virtus World Record and a Virtus Oceania Record in the S19 Women's Open 100-metre Butterfly event, an extraordinary accomplishment that places her amongst the very best athletes in the world. These records recognise the fastest performances by a female S19 swimmer with high-functioning autism globally and across the Oceania region, highlighting the significance of Iesha's achievement and the dedication required to reach this level of competition. A proud representative of the Port Macquarie Swimming Club, Iesha has earned widespread respect through her determination, resilience and commitment to excellence. I congratulate Iesha on her current

success and wish her every success in her future swimming career. Her achievements are a source of great pride for our region and an inspiration to aspiring athletes.

AFGHAN MULTICULTURAL HUB

Mr WARREN KIRBY (Riverstone)—Mr Speaker today I rise to congratulate Shehla Ibrahim, Founder and President of Afghan Multicultural Hub Incorporated, on the opening of its Community Centre and Afghan Heritage Language School in Kellyville Ridge. This milestone reflects Shehla's commitment to supporting Afghan and other culturally diverse families across our community. Through settlement assistance, advocacy, family support and educational programs, the Hub aims to help residents feel welcomed, supported and connected. The new centre provides a place for people to come together, build friendships and celebrate their cultural heritage. Its language school offers younger generations an opportunity to strengthen their connection to their language, family histories and traditions while growing up as part of our Australian community. Establishing a community organisation requires dedication, persistence and the ability to bring people together around a shared purpose. I commend Shehla, her team and the volunteers whose efforts have helped make this opening possible. I look forward to getting to know Shehla and the Hub's community, building a lasting friendship and working together to support local families. I wish the Community Centre and Afghan Heritage Language School every success as they continue serving Kellyville Ridge and the wider north-west.

CAITLYN GRIMA

Mr WARREN KIRBY (Riverstone)—Today I congratulate Caitlyn Grima of Kellyville Ridge on her outstanding achievements in basketball, representing her community, New South Wales and internationally with distinction. A talented young athlete from the Hills Hornets Basketball Club, Caitlyn has demonstrated exceptional dedication, determination and sporting ability throughout her basketball journey. In 2024, Caitlyn was selected to represent NSW Metro at the Under 16 National Championships in Bendigo. Building on this success, she was selected for the NSW Metro Under 18 team competing at the 2026 Foot Locker National Championships. Caitlyn's achievements extended to the international stage in July 2026, when she represented Malta at the FIBA Under 18 Women's EuroBasket Division C Championships in Kosovo. In an extraordinary achievement, Caitlyn helped Malta secure the European Division C championship, defeating Cyprus in the final to claim the gold medal. Her individual performances were equally impressive, earning her selection in the tournament's prestigious All-Star Five, recognising her among the competition's outstanding players. Caitlyn's achievements reflect years of commitment, training and perseverance, supported by her family, coaches and the Hills Hornets basketball community. I congratulate Caitlyn on her remarkable success and wish her every success in her future basketball career.

CHELSEA GOMEZ

Mr WARREN KIRBY (Riverstone)—I congratulate Chelsea Gomez of Acacia Gardens on her outstanding achievements in taekwondo, representing her local community and Australia with distinction. A talented and dedicated young athlete, Chelsea has demonstrated exceptional discipline, determination and commitment in her pursuit of sporting excellence. In April 2026, Chelsea competed at the Junior World Taekwondo Championships in Uzbekistan, representing Australia against some of the world's most talented emerging athletes. Competing at this elite international level is a remarkable achievement and reflects years of dedicated training, perseverance and sacrifice. Chelsea has also competed at the Australian Taekwondo National Championships in Brisbane and participated in world championship selection events, demonstrating her ability to compete among Australia's leading junior athletes. Her impressive sporting achievements have been recognised locally, with Chelsea named Female Junior Sportsperson of the Year at the Blacktown City Sports Awards. This prestigious recognition celebrates not only her competitive success but also her dedication to her sport and the example she sets for other aspiring young athletes. Chelsea's achievements are a credit to her family, coaches and the broader Acacia Gardens community. I congratulate Chelsea on her remarkable achievements and wish her every success as she continues her taekwondo journey.

ST STYLIANOS GREEK ORTHODOX CHURCH – 30TH ANNIVERSARY

Mr MARK SPEAKMAN (Cronulla)—I congratulate the Parish of St Stylianos Greek Orthodox Church in Gymea on its 30th anniversary. I was pleased to attend a dinner marking this important milestone and recognise the generations of parishioners whose dedication has helped the parish to flourish. The parish was formally inaugurated in March 1995, when almost 900 faithfuls gathered to mark the beginning of a new chapter for the Greek Orthodox community in the region. A dedicated founding committee of 16 members, led by founding President Mr Stylianos Pambris, laid the foundations for the parish, which later acquired land along the Kingsway in 1998. A new church was officially opened in December 2001 by Archbishop Stylianos. Since establishment, the parish has grown beyond its place of worship to support Greek language education, Sunday school, youth and seniors' groups, children's activities and pastoral care for the elderly and sick. I acknowledge the leadership and

service of His Eminence Archbishop Makarios, parish priest Fr Constantine J Varipatis and parish deacon Dn Chris Baghos. I congratulate the Parish of St Stylianos on this significant anniversary and wish its clergy and parishioners every success.

MARINE RESCUE BOTANY PORT HACKING

Mr MARK SPEAKMAN (Cronulla)—I recognise the volunteers of Marine Rescue Botany Port Hacking, based at Hungry Point in Cronulla, on being named the busiest Marine Rescue NSW unit in September, completing 43 search and rescue mission. Behind these figures are volunteers who give their time to protect lives on our waterways, often responding to emergencies in challenging conditions and working alongside other emergency services to bring people to safety. Their commitment was evident in September, when local volunteers were involved in a search and rescue operation at Marley Beach after two swimmers got into difficulty. Tragically, one man lost his life, while another was rescued and taken to hospital. Just three days later, the crew responded when two outrigger canoes capsized off Congwong Bay, rescuing six paddlers from the water and helping ensure they received medical attention where required. I thank Botany Port Hacking Unit Commander Aaron Blackwell for his leadership and extend my gratitude to every volunteer at Marine Rescue Botany Port Hacking for their service and dedication to keeping our local waterways safe.

TULLOONA LADIES CLUB

Mr BRENDAN MOYLAN (Northern Tablelands)—I recognise the achievements of the Tulloona Ladies Club on celebrating 60 years since their inception on 5 October 1966. What began as Vera Morgan Jones inviting neighbours for afternoon tea, grew into a group sharing their knowledge and skills to support their wider community. I congratulate all involved with the club for their many achievements. At the heart of all activities being the importance of sharing friendship and social interaction for those living in rural areas. Over the years community support has included entertaining residents at the local retirement village, along with hosting tennis days, fashion parades, progressive dinners, street stalls and art shows, raising funds to strengthen local organisations and services. Today through their memberships, donations continue to support the Westpac Rescue Helicopter Service, Gwydir Industries, Moree Show, as well as the Dr William Hunter Scholarship. I commend both past and present members for their dedication and contribution over the years, and extend appreciation to current committee members, President Janny Cruickshank, Secretary Roslyn Wannan and Treasurer Sue O'Neil for their diligent leadership. Their voluntary commitment and generosity of time made a lasting and positive impact, embodying community spirit and importantly, improving the lives of others.

NEW ENGLAND GARDEN FESTIVAL

Mr BRENDAN MOYLAN (Northern Tablelands)—I recognise the New England Garden Festival Committee on staging their annual festival event. By promoting the enjoyment of gardening, fostering friendships and health lifestyle, the event provides an excellent opportunity to showcase Armidale and the surrounding New England region, for locals and visitors alike. The festival features an impressive line-up, comprising open gardens from Tenterfield to Walcha, stalls, workshops, local performers, as well as guest celebrities and presenters of Gardening Australia. I congratulate all those involved in the festivities, with special thanks to the committee: Marie Colless, Kathryn Hogan, Jodie Ryan, Bill Colless, Tania O'Hara, Ros Noakes, Jane Bercini, Lesley Nies, Lydia Roberts, Margaret Watts, Nellie Hayes, Dar Brookes, Maxine Mitchell, Annie Abbott, Kate Coward and Sally Wright. Such is their drive, the festival's great success is reflected in its significant contributions to the community. Between 2023-2026, generating over $90,000 in donations to charities and last year the impact on the New England area exceeded $1,200,000. I commend the committee for volunteering their time and expertise, and local sponsors for their generous donations of goods and services. I congratulate the committee for giving back, greatly supporting the economic and social fabric of the New England.

BLAH BLAH BLAH COFFEE

Mr BRENDAN MOYLAN (Northern Tablelands)—I recognise Mr John Crisp's outstanding contribution to the health and wellbeing of men within the Inverell community, through Blah Blah Blah Coffee for Blokes. This initiative provides an opportunity for men to gather over a cup of coffee, have a conversation, connect, share experiences and support one another, especially those who may be experiencing life challenges. I congratulate John on this grass roots community led initiative, which strengthens the resilience of members and creating a more supportive society. I also thank John for his dedication, generosity and genuine commitment to improving the lives of men throughout the Inverell community, with his efforts exemplifying the values of mateship and mutual respect. I extend my sincerest appreciation for his ongoing commitment to men's collective wellbeing and acknowledge the significant and lasting positive impact of his efforts within the local community.

FERNLEIGH 15

Ms JODIE HARRISON (Charlestown—Minister for Women, Minister for Seniors, and Minister for the Prevention of Domestic Violence and Sexual Assault)—The Fernleigh 15 has once again brought our community together for a wonderful celebration of fitness, friendship and community spirit, with a record 2,300 participants taking part in this year's event. With participation increasing by 30 per cent from last year, the 2026 Fernleigh 15 welcomed runners from across Newcastle, the Hunter, Central Coast and beyond. While the event attracts elite athletes, its greatest strength lies in its welcoming atmosphere, bringing together runners of all ages and abilities to enjoy one of our region's most treasured shared pathways. Beyond the finish line, participants raised approximately $15,000 for charitable causes, while event organisers donated a further $10,000 to the local clubs and organisations that helped make the day possible. Community groups including Newcastle Runners, 530 Runners, Night Striders and Charlestown Rotary Club play an invaluable role in the event's ongoing success. The Fernleigh 15 also provides an important opportunity to promote the safe and respectful use of the Fernleigh Track by everyone who enjoys it. I congratulate the organisers, volunteers and participants on another fantastic event that showcases the generosity, camaraderie and community spirit of our region.

THE FRAMING GAME

Ms JODIE HARRISON (Charlestown—Minister for Women, Minister for Seniors, and Minister for the Prevention of Domestic Violence and Sexual Assault)—For 40 years, The Framing Game has been helping local families preserve their most treasured memories, becoming a valued part of our local business community. Since 1986, this family-owned business has brought care, creativity and craftsmanship to everything from family photographs and original artworks to sporting memorabilia and precious keepsakes. At the heart of The Framing Game are owner and manager Karen Fuller, her brother Pete and staff member Cindy, whose dedication and personal approach have helped build lasting relationships with generations of customers. Reaching 40 years in business is no small achievement. It reflects not only the quality of their work, but the trust and loyalty they have earned within our community. Small businesses like The Framing Game are an important part of what makes our local community special. They provide more than a service, offering a personal connection and taking genuine pride in the work they do. I warmly congratulate Karen, Pete and Cindy on this remarkable milestone and thank them for their contribution to the Hunter over the past four decades. I wish The Framing Game continued success and many more years of helping local families celebrate and preserve life's special moments.

GARDEN BED COMPETITION WINNER

Ms JODIE HARRISON (Charlestown—Minister for Women, Minister for Seniors, and Minister for the Prevention of Domestic Violence and Sexual Assault)—Hunter Sports High School's GEM Academy has achieved a wonderful milestone, winning the People's Choice Award at the Living Smart Festival's School Garden Bed Competition for the third consecutive year. The award recognises the creativity, dedication and teamwork of students in the Ruby class, who worked alongside Mrs Gilmore and Mrs Cottrill to bring their garden bed to life. From designing and planting to watering, mulching and incorporating sustainable features, the students were involved in every stage of the project. Their garden bed was not only a beautiful display, but a reflection of the valuable hands-on learning taking place within the GEM Academy. Projects like this provide young people with opportunities to develop practical skills, explore their creativity and take pride in something they have created together. Winning the People's Choice Award for three consecutive years is a particularly special achievement, reflecting the enthusiasm and care the students bring to their work. I warmly congratulate the Ruby class, Mrs Gilmore, Mrs Cottrill and everyone involved in the GEM Academy on this well-deserved recognition. Their achievement is a wonderful example of how creativity, sustainability and teamwork can flourish through learning beyond the traditional classroom.

SAMANTHA ALEXANDER

Mrs SALLY QUINNELL (Camden)—We have some incredible women in our Camden area. One such local advocate is Samantha Alexander, a proud Dharug woman. Samantha began progressively losing her sight while studying for her criminology degree. She didn't let this stop her: since becoming blind, Samantha has graduated, returned to university, and obtained her law degree – a monumental achievement. Over the past decade, Samantha has been a staunch advocate for Aboriginal people and people with disabilities in the Macarthur area. She has been working in disability inclusion and coordinating Aboriginal outreach services at the Macarthur Legal Service, Tharawal Aboriginal Medical Service, and theNagle centre. As if that wasn't impressive enough, Samantha has continually volunteered with the Young Spirit Mentoring Program, supporting disadvantaged young people in our neighbouring Campbelltown community. Her consistent efforts in advocacy and community support should be recognised. Thank you for all you do, Samantha. Your work is so valuable to our extended Camden community.

HSC EXAMS

Mrs SALLY QUINNELL (Camden)—I want to wish the best of luck to all Camden Year 12 students who have been and are currently sitting the HSC exams! The High School Certificate exams run from 13th of October to the 5th of November. To the Year 12 students: you've worked so hard to reach this final stretch over your 13 years of education. While the HSC is an important milestone, remember that an exam result does not define your future success. Your teachers, families, and Camden community are all exceptionally proud of everything you achieve and will be here watching as you finish your exams and move onto the next big things. Best of luck, Year 12! You've got this.

ATURA ORAN PARK OPENING

Mrs SALLY QUINNELL (Camden)—Although I can't be there in person, I'm very excited for the Atura Oran Park Opening! The 184-room hotel in Oran Park will meet the much-needed demand for accommodation, conference spaces, and leisure facilities in our extended Macarthur community. For those travelling into the Camden area, this hotel provides an opportunity to stay local – a much-needed addition. Located just 20 minutes away from the new Western Sydney Airport too, this hotel will be sought-after for travellers, bringing tourism, employment and economic investment to the Macarthur region.

DEVONSHIRE STREET CHILDREN'S CENTRE

Mr TIM JAMES (Willoughby)—Congratulations to Devonshire Street Children's Centre in Chatswood on winning the Wellbeing Champions category at the 2026 National Kitchen Garden Awards. Selected from nearly 650 entries across Australia, this is a wonderful achievement for a much-loved local early childhood centre. At the heart of the award is a special intergenerational garden program, bringing children and their grandparents together to grow vegetables, learn about food and share knowledge. It's a lovely example of how something as simple as gardening can bring generations together, build friendships and give young children a deeper connection to nature. The children get their hands dirty, learn where their food comes from and enjoy precious time with older generations. Congratulations to the educators, children and families at Devonshire Street Children's Centre. You've shown that a small community garden in Chatswood can have such a positive impact.

BRYCE SKAROTT – NSW RUGBY LEAGUE YOUNG VOLUNTEER OF THE YEAR

Mr TIM JAMES (Willoughby)—At 18 years old, Cammeray local Bryce Skarott is already making an outstanding contribution to grassroots sport. Bryce has been named the 2026 NSW Rugby League Young Person Volunteer of the Year, recognising his dedication to the North Sydney District Rugby League Referees Association. Having refereed for five seasons, Bryce is not only a committed match official but also a mentor to younger referees just starting out. His dedication is extraordinary. In just six weeks this season, Bryce officiated 56 games across 20 different grounds, often travelling between venues to ensure local matches could go ahead. And beyond his own refereeing commitments, he finds time to train and encourage the next generation of officials. Community sport relies on volunteers like Bryce, who give up their weekends so that others can enjoy the game. It's wonderful to see a young person from our community showing such leadership and commitment to our local sporting community. Congratulations Bryce on this well-deserved recognition and for your service and contribution.

NORTHBRIDGE SWIMMING CLUB'S 102ND SEASON

Mr TIM JAMES (Willoughby)—Congratulations to Northbridge Amateur Swimming Club on the launch of its 102nd season at Northbridge Baths. For more than a century, the club has brought local families together for Saturday morning swimming and friendly competition. Generations of Northbridge residents have grown up with this much-loved community tradition, making friends and building confidence in the water. With swimmers ranging from young children to members in their nineties, the club shows that swimming really can be a lifelong activity. Its handicap races give members of different ages and abilities the chance to compete together, with an emphasis on improving their own performance. Helping children become stronger, more confident swimmers is especially valuable in our harbourside community. The club gives young people regular opportunities to develop those skills while enjoying themselves alongside family and friends. I thank President Daniel Hunt, the committee and all the volunteers who make each season possible. From organising races to helping at the kiosk, their efforts keep this local institution going. Best wishes to all members for an enjoyable and successful summer at the Baths.

TRIBUTE TO HON. HELEN SHAM HO, OAM

Mr MATT CROSS (Davidson)—I recognise the Honourable Helen Sham-Ho OAM, a trailblazer in the history of the Parliament of New South Wales. Born in Hong Kong, Helen completed high school in Australia before graduating in Arts and Social Work from the University of Sydney and in Law from Macquarie University. She went on to practise as a barrister and solicitor. In 1988, Helen was elected to the Legislative Council,

becoming the first Chinese-born member of an Australian parliament. During 15 years of service, she co-founded the NSW Parliament Asia-Pacific Friendship Group and was Charter President of the NSW Parliamentary Lions Club. Since retiring in 2003, Helen has continued to serve our community, including as Founder and Honorary Life President of the Way In Network. Her contribution has been recognised with the Medal of the Order of Australia, an Honorary Doctorate from Western Sydney University and the University of Sydney's Alumni Lifetime Achievement Award in Social Work. I thank Helen for her lifetime of service and for paving the way for so many who have followed her into public life.

KU-RING-GAI MALE CHOIR 80TH ANNIVERSARY

Mr MATT CROSS (Davidson)—On Sunday 8 November 2026, I look forward to attending the Ku-ring-gai Male Choir's annual concert to celebrate its 80th anniversary at the Hornsby RSL. Since it was established in 1946, the choir has shared the joy of choral music with our community. Its members rehearse every Tuesday evening and regularly perform at retirement villages, where audiences happily join in. This year's concert is themed "What Would I Do Without My Music?". I recognise Music Director Warren Fisher, Accompanist Hank Xiang and Secretary Dr Ken Wade for their contribution to the choir. I am proud to recognise Ku-ring-gai Male Choir in the Parliament of New South Wales as it continues to grow and welcome new singers. I congratulate all its members on 80 years of music, friendship and community spirit.

FRIENDS OF TULKIYAN BOOK LAUNCH

Mr MATT CROSS (Davidson)—On Friday 13 November 2026, I look forward to attending the launch of Tulkiyan: Ku-ring-gai's Arts & Crafts House at Gordon Library, and I congratulate the Friends of Tulkiyan on its publication. Tulkiyan, on the Pacific Highway in Gordon, was designed in 1913-14 by architects Waterhouse & Lake and gifted to Ku-ring-gai Council by Miss Margaret Donaldson, the last member of the Donaldson family. It is an irreplaceable part of our local history. Between 2004 and 2012, around 30 volunteer Friends of Tulkiyan opened the house as a museum, running house and garden tours for the community. The book began in 2008 as a guide for these tours. After the house closed, a few dedicated Friends used funds raised from the tours to turn that work into a 60-page, fully illustrated book. I recognise authors Jocelyn Brennan-Horley, Suzanne Saunders and Beverley Dunstan, and thank Gordon Library and the Ku-ring-gai Historical Society for their support. This book is a fitting tribute to the volunteers who shared Tulkiyan with our community, and a wonderful achievement for everyone involved.

2026 SOUTHERN SYDNEY VOLUNTEER OF THE YEAR AWARDS

Mrs TINA AYYAD (Holsworthy)—I congratulate the outstanding volunteers recognised at the 2026 Southern Sydney Volunteer of the Year Awards. Now in their 20th year, these awards celebrate the contribution volunteers make to communities across New South Wales. Congratulations to Bill Manning, who was named the 2026 Southern Sydney Volunteer of the Year and Adult Volunteer of the Year for his longstanding work with Cerebral Palsy Alliance and the Krazy Kosci Klimb, helping young people with disability challenge themselves and achieve their goals. I also congratulate Young Volunteer of the Year Sunny Liu, who has contributed thousands of hours to the Australian Army Cadets and Lifeline; Senior Volunteer of the Year Paul Quinn from Calvary Health Care Kogarah; and Emergency Volunteer of the Year Warren Rennie AM OAM, who has dedicated almost 70 years to North Cronulla Surf Life Saving Club. Congratulations also to the Calvary Kogarah Biography Service, named Volunteer Team of the Year, for helping people in palliative care record and preserve their life stories. I thank every nominee, recipient and volunteer for the time, compassion and service they give to our community.

LIVERPOOL WOMEN'S SHELTER

Mrs TINA AYYAD (Holsworthy)—I rise to recognise and congratulate the Liverpool Women's Shelter on the official opening of its new facility, providing a vital place of safety and support for women and children across the Liverpool community. I was honoured to attend the opening and join representatives from Women's Community Shelters, local supporters and members of our community to mark this important milestone. I particularly acknowledge Liverpool Women's Shelter Chair Cheryl Macnaught for her leadership, dedication and commitment to bringing this important service to our local area. I also extend my sincere thanks to the staff, volunteers, supporters, donors and community partners whose work and generosity have helped make the shelter a reality. For women and children experiencing domestic and family violence or other forms of crisis, access to safe accommodation and compassionate support can be life-changing. This new shelter will provide not only a safe place to stay, but also dignity, stability and the opportunity to rebuild. Congratulations to Cheryl and the entire Liverpool Women's Shelter team on this significant achievement. Thank you for your ongoing commitment to supporting vulnerable women and children and strengthening our community.

LADIES LIKE TO LUNCH

Mrs TINA AYYAD (Holsworthy)—I rise to recognise the wonderful work of Ladies Like To Lunch and their continued commitment to supporting women affected by breast cancer across South Western Sydney. I was delighted to attend the 2026 Ladies Like To Lunch Pink Ribbon Luncheon, held in recognition of Breast Cancer Awareness Month, and join members of our community in supporting this important cause. This annual event brings people together to raise vital funds for women receiving treatment and care at the Liverpool Cancer Therapy Centre and Liverpool Wellness Centre. Last year, Ladies Like To Lunch raised an incredible $150,000, helping fund essential support programs including oncology massage, acupuncture, personalised exercise, Pilates and wellbeing initiatives. These programs make a meaningful difference to women navigating breast cancer treatment and recovery, providing care, comfort and support during challenging times. I congratulate the Ladies Like To Lunch organisers, volunteers, sponsors and supporters for their generosity and dedication to making a positive difference in our community.

GEOFFREY CHARD, AM

Mr ANTHONY ROBERTS (Lane Cove)—I wish to pay tribute to Geoffrey Chard AM, one of Australia's distinguished operatic baritones and a significant figure in the musical life of Hunters Hill, who has died aged 96. Chard was a foundation member of the National Opera of New South Wales and appeared as Figaro in the inaugural 1956 production of the Australian Elizabethan Trust Opera Company, which became Opera Australia. He later established an international career, performing with Welsh National Opera, Glyndebourne and the Royal Opera at Covent Garden, and serving for 15 years as a principal baritone with English National Opera. Geoffrey also made an enduring contribution closer to home. In 1995 he was appointed President of Hunters Hill Music, helping strengthen the organisation and its tradition of bringing outstanding musicians to our local community. I acknowledge Geoffrey Chard AM for an extraordinary life in music and extend my condolences to his family, friends and the many people whose lives were enriched by his artistry.

POSABILITY LEARNING AUSTRALIA: DYSLEXIA AWARENESS MONTH

Mr ANTHONY ROBERTS (Lane Cove)—I wish to recognise PosAbility Learning Australia, a Lane Cove West-based charity supporting children and young people with learning difficulties. Led by co-founder, chief executive officer and principal psychologist Katrina Sheraton-Yu, PosAbility marked Dyslexia Awareness Month with its "Learning Differences: Understand. Support. Thrive." campaign from 12 to 16 October. The initiative provided families, educators and professionals with live online sessions, recorded webinars, fact sheets and practical resources covering dyslexia, dysgraphia, dyscalculia, effective intervention and school adjustments. Through initiatives such as this, PosAbility is helping families and educators better understand learning differences and the support available to young people. I congratulate Katrina Sheraton-Yu and the PosAbility team on their work during Dyslexia Awareness Month and thank them for their continued contribution to families in our local community.

BUSHLAND GUARDIANS

Mr MICHAEL REGAN (Wakehurst)—I'm proud to recognise the Northern Beaches Bushland Guardians following their community celebration at Oxford Falls Peace Park on Sunday 18th October, marking the withdrawal of the Lizard Rock planning proposal. It was a wonderful opportunity to reflect on years of advocacy and thank those who worked to protect this precious bushland. I acknowledge Dr Conny Harris, Rachael Leah Jackson, Nicole Romain, Kristyn Glanville, Pam Dawes, Deb Harris, Sarah Baker, Marion Kiss, Sue Denham and the volunteers who collected signatures, informed residents and highlighted concerns about the proposal. In 2023, I was proud to table their petition carrying more than 12,000 signatures, bringing these concerns before Parliament for debate. Behind every signature was someone who cared deeply about our local environment. The withdrawal is a significant outcome, following sustained scrutiny and advocacy from residents, community organisations and representatives. Having actively opposed the proposal, I valued the Guardians' incredibly important contribution to that broader effort. While securing lasting protection remains important, their persistence and commitment deserve recognition. Thank you to everyone who contributed, including those who organised Sunday's celebration. Your efforts reflect our community's deep connection to its bushland and determination to protect it.

ANGLICARE ST DAVID'S VILLAGE

Mr MICHAEL REGAN (Wakehurst)—Today I recognise Anglicare St David's Village as they just celebrated their 50th anniversary. Established in 1976, the village has offered generations of residents a community of neighbours and friends alongside independent living. None of this would be possible without the commitment of those who keep the village running each day. Staff bring patience and care to their work, while volunteers lend a hand with outings, events and the everyday moments that turn St David's into a home. Anglicare

St David's Village is a reminder of how much our older residents contribute to the character of our area, and how important it is that they continue to feel valued and connected. Congratulations to everyone at St David's on this golden milestone. I thank the residents, staff and volunteers, past and present, who have made the village such a special place, and wish them every success for the years ahead.

LIFELINE NORTHERN BEACHES 2026 BOOK FAIR

Mr MICHAEL REGAN (Wakehurst)—Today I recognise the volunteers behind Lifeline Northern Beaches book fair, following the Forestville Book Fair held from 1st to 4th October at Forestville Memorial Hall. These events depend on an enormous amount of work, with so much of it happening long before the doors open. At the Brookvale Book Depot, volunteers sort, organise and price donated books. At the fairs, they set up tables, replenish stock, assist customers and manage sales. Lifeline says each book fair takes around 150 volunteers to run. That is a remarkable collective commitment to helping others. Every purchase helps fund crisis support and local services, turning a love of reading into practical support for people facing difficult times. I thank the volunteers, donors and book buyers who make this work possible, and wish the team well for its Warringah Mall pop-up from 22 to 25 October! Your generosity helps ensure people in our community have somewhere to turn.

BRONWYN POWELL

Mr DUGALD SAUNDERS (Dubbo)—Speaker, I would like to acknowledge Bronwyn Powell, who has been named the 2025–26 Paddle NSW Instructor/Guide of the Year. A member of Western Paddlers NSW, Bronwyn also operates Macquarie Marshes Kayak Tours in the Macquarie Marshes, an internationally significant Ramsar listed wetland in central western NSW, renowned for its habitat, birds, native mammals, frogs, reptiles and native fish species. Drawing on her expertise as a Project Officer with NSW Fisheries, specialising in the Murray Darling aquatic environment, together with her extensive paddling qualifications, Bronwyn provides visitors with a truly unique opportunity to experience and better understand this remarkable ecosystem. Each year, she leads around 60 guided kayak tours through the marshes. When water levels prevent paddling, she continues sharing her knowledge as a Discovery Guide with NSW National Parks and Wildlife Service, leading wetland walking and wading tours. She also serves as a Paddle NSW instructor and assessor for Western NSW. Passionate about growing the sport, Bronwyn has delivered kayak skills courses and paddling activities for women on the Wambuul Macquarie River, helping participants develop skills and build confidence. Congratulations Bronwyn.

RUTH CARNEY

Mr DUGALD SAUNDERS (Dubbo)—Speaker, I would like to acknowledge Aunty Ruth Carney of Narromine, who was named as a finalist in the Volunteer of the Year Award at the Western NSW Local Health District Awards. A stalwart of the Narromine community, Aunty Ruth is a dedicated volunteer at the Narromine Health Service, committing her time, energy and knowledge to patient care and the development of cultural capability. She is a warm and kind presence in the day centre, and her deep connection to her culture brings an important and meaningful dimension to the support she provides to both staff and patients. Aunty Ruth is also a strong advocate for the health service and the Narromine community. She was a passionate supporter of the development of a remote X-ray operator service in Narromine. Now operational, this service has helped reduce the number of people needing to travel for X-rays, as well as the amount of time they may need to spend in hospital. A very deserving finalist for this award, I congratulate Aunty Ruth and thank her for her passion, commitment and ongoing advocacy for the Narromine community.

ASHANTI PENNELL

Mr DUGALD SAUNDERS (Dubbo)—Speaker, I would like to acknowledge Ashanti Pennell, who has been selected in the Australian Women's Team for the Deaf Rugby World Cup, to be held in Tokyo, Japan, from 30 October to 5 November 2026. The tournament will bring together elite men's and women's deaf rugby teams from across the globe for a Sevens championship, representing the pinnacle of international deaf rugby. Ashanti is a talented sportswoman who has represented New South Wales in a number of Rugby League representative squads, including the Under 19s Wests Tigers and the South Sydney Rabbitohs NSW Premiership squad. Originally from Baradine and now part of the Narromine community, Ashanti will make her Australian debut in Deaf Rugby at the tournament in Tokyo. Her selection is a fantastic recognition of her sporting ability, dedication and commitment, and is an exciting opportunity to represent Australia on the international stage. It is wonderful to see regional athletes achieving at the highest level and helping to showcase the talent and diversity of Australia's deaf and hard of hearing sporting community. Congratulations, Ashanti, on this outstanding achievement. I wish you every success in Japan.

SHELLEY KURTZ

Mrs TANYA THOMPSON (Myall Lakes)—I rise to congratulate Shelley Kurtz of Hallidays Point on claiming her second consecutive Fox Superflow National Series Championship in the women's over 30 division.

After winning the title in her first year of competition in 2025, Shelley returned in 2026 and backed up that achievement with another successful season. Her campaign took her across New South Wales, Queensland and the ACT, including races at Narooma, Mogo, Stromlo and Woolgoolga, and a first-place finish at Nerang. Behind that result are hours on the road, unfamiliar trails and the determination to keep learning and improving. The series organisers have also recognised Shelley among their 2026 Superflow Legends, featuring her in their 2027 calendar. What I admire is her willingness to give something new a go, then commit to seeing how far she could take it. For women considering a new sport or a challenge outside their comfort zone, Shelley offers encouragement. You do not have to begin with years of experience to achieve something you can be proud of. Congratulations, Shelley, on two outstanding seasons. Our community is proud of you, and I wish you continued success on the trails.

BRAD FLETCHER

Mrs TANYA THOMPSON (Myall Lakes)—I rise today to recognise Brad Fletcher, whose service to Forster-Tuncurry is grounded in a simple belief: people deserve someone in their corner. Through the Rotary Club of Lower Mid Coast, including his leadership as President, Brad has brought people together and supported practical assistance for local families and community organisations. I particularly acknowledge his involvement with the Great Lakes Suicide Prevention Network and Safe Harbour in Forster. His commitment to mental health helps encourage conversations that can be difficult to start, but so important to have. Creating a community where people feel comfortable asking for help takes compassion, patience and people willing to listen. Brad brings that spirit to his service. His decision to change direction professionally and support young people through Breakthru demonstrates his determination to put that care into practice, helping them build confidence and see possibilities for their future. His kindness and practical support are valued across Myall Lakes. Brad, thank you for giving your time, energy and heart to others. Whether through Rotary, suicide prevention or supporting young people, you help make our community a better place where more people feel noticed, included and supported.

COOMBA PARK

Mrs TANYA THOMPSON (Myall Lakes)—I rise to congratulate Coomba Park on winning the Overall Population Category A award at the 2026 Keep Australia Beautiful NSW Tidy Towns Awards, recognising communities of up to 1,500 people. This is a wonderful achievement for a small community with a big heart, where local people give their time and energy to make their village an even better place to live. Through projects including the Tidal Pool, Mystery Markets, Sustainability Table and Growers Market, Coomba Park residents have demonstrated the power of working together. These initiatives bring neighbours together; support local growers and encourage people to care for the beautiful environment we are fortunate to call home. I particularly acknowledge the Coomba and District Progress Association, the Community Centre volunteers and everyone who has contributed to these projects. Behind this award are many hours of planning, organising and quietly getting on with the job. Their efforts show that a community does not need a large population to achieve something truly outstanding. Congratulations to everyone involved. You have given Coomba Park every reason to be proud, and I thank you for the care you continue to give your community.

BIOSHELTERS

Ms KOBI SHETTY (Balmain)—Today I recognise the innovative work of Bioshelters and congratulate the Bioshelters team on winning the Best in Class Design Award for Design Research in the National Design Awards. The project was led by a team of computational designers from the School of Built Environment at UNSW Arts, Design & Architecture, creating innovative 3D-printed reef structures that have been placed around Blackwattle Bay near the new Sydney Fish Markets to help re-establish oyster populations and other sea life in Sydney Harbour. The project will help to create new habitats in an area where natural habitats have been lost to urban development. Thank you to Professor M. Hank Haeusler and the UNSW Computational Design team, including Dr Zayad Motlib, Louis Lamont, Associate Professor Nicole Gardner, Charlotte Firth, Dr Farnaz Fattahi, Dr Ivana Kuzmanovska and Dr Lisa LuBowden. Thanks to all the organisations who have made this project possible, this innovation and cooperation is a hopeful development for a sustainable future. Your work is a credit to our community.

THE CHERRY MOON GENERAL STORE

Ms KOBI SHETTY (Balmain)—I'd like to recognise the Cherry Moon General Store which was featured in Time Out Sydney's most recent, "Best Cafes in Sydney Guide". In a city known for its first-class café culture, I'm proud to see Annandale represented on a list of Sydney's finest. Cherry Moon General Store is a community hub by design. Centred around a wood-fire oven lovingly named Apollonia, the café nourishes the Annandale community with the comfort of traditional baking. The design of the oven is built on hundreds of years of knowledge and preserves historic methods of food preparation. Thank you to Cherry Moon General Store Founder Kimmy Gastmeier and to Dennis Benson for keeping the traditional oven design alive. Thank you as well to the

customers who frequent Cherry Moon and to the staff whose hard work keeps the café operating every day. You're part of what makes our community special and why Annandale is such a great part of the inner west.

SUMMER WHITE

Ms KOBI SHETTY (Balmain)—I would like to recognise and celebrate the outstanding literary achievement of Summer White, an exceptionally talented 8-year-old student at Annandale Public School. Summer was recently awarded a prestigious Gold Medal in the 2026 WriteOn NSW Competition for her wonderful imaginative short story, Boris the Dung Bettle. Managed by the NSW Education Standards Authority (NESA) in association with the State Library of NSW, the annual WriteOn competition sees hundreds of primary school students from across the state submit creative texts based on a strict stimulus quote. To secure a top Gold distinction among a record number of entries statewide is a truly remarkable testament to Summer's talents. As a Gold Medal winner, Summer's work has been published in The Best of WriteOn anthology. I congratulate Summer on becoming a published author at such a young age and extend my thanks to the dedicated teaching staff at Annandale Public School for fostering a love of creative writing in our local community. I look forward to reading many more of Summer's stories in the future.

HUW CROSBY

Ms JO HAYLEN (Summer Hill)—Local police officer Huw Crosby showed remarkable courage and selfless service during the tragic events at Bondi Beach on 14 December last year. While off duty and spending time with his children, Huw made the brave decision to put himself in harm's way and protect the community. After making sure his children were safe, Huw called himself onto duty and ran towards the unfolding emergency to provide support. Despite not having access to his usual protective equipment or support, Huw located injured probationary Constable Jack Hibbert and provided critical first aid, remaining with him until ambulance crews arrived. Drawing on his police training and experience, Huw acted with courage and composure in an incredibly challenging situation. Huw's actions reflect the best qualities of public service. His unwavering commitment to the safety of others at the risk of his own demonstrates outstanding bravery and a deep commitment to protecting the community. His actions also highlight the sacrifices made not only by police officers, but by their families who share the weight of that service. On behalf of our community, thank you Huw for your selfless efforts and for your service.

MILLOIE CAKERY

Ms STEPHANIE DI PASQUA (Drummoyne)—I rise today to recognise a wonderful local small business in my community, Milloie Cakery, a family-run boutique cakery in the heart of Drummoyne. Operated by Sori, Milloie Cakery specialises in beautifully handcrafted cakes and cupcakes, including delicate buttercream flower cakes and fresh cream cupcakes that are almost too pretty to eat! What makes Milloie Cakery particularly special is its commitment to bringing people together through creativity. Alongside its delicious creations, the cakery offers hands-on cake decorating workshops for all ages, providing a wonderful opportunity for locals to learn new skills. Milloie Cakery adds a little extra sweetness to every occasion and small businesses like this contribute so much to the character of our local community. This wonderful business is working to put Drummoyne on the map by bringing passion, creativity and a beautiful personal touch to everything they do. I congratulate Sori and the entire Milloie Cakery team on their wonderful work and wish them every success in the years ahead.

MORTLAKE AUTOMOTIVE

Ms STEPHANIE DI PASQUA (Drummoyne)—I rise to recognise Mortlake Automotive, a much-loved local business that has served the Mortlake community for nearly 80 years. The business began in 1948 as a petrol station on Brays Road. Since then, it has grown into a trusted, owner-operated mechanical workshop serving families across the many suburbs in our community. In 2011, owner Greg moved the business to its current home on Tennyson Road. This year marks 15 years that the business has called Tennyson Road its home. Today, Mortlake Automotive is run by hardworking, qualified and long-serving technicians with more than 95 years of combined experience. Mortlake Automotive has also been a generous supporter of our community, sponsoring local schools, Massey Park Golf Club, Concord Golf Club and Briars, and supporting Barnardos Australia's work with vulnerable children. I congratulate Greg and his hardworking team on their dedication to quality service and to the people of Mortlake. I wish them all the very best of success.

SALTED OLIVE CAFE

Ms STEPHANIE DI PASQUA (Drummoyne)—As part of Small Business Month, I welcome one of the newest additions to our community, Salted Olive Café. I congratulate the team on their recent opening on Tennyson Road in Mortlake. Located beside Breakfast Point Village, Salted Olive Cafe brings a Mediterranean twist to classic breakfast and brunch favourites, offering a delicious menu featuring dishes such as zaatar fried

eggs, salted olives marinated in hot honey, garlic and rosemary and served with grilled bread, fresh salads and dips. I particularly congratulate owners Nick and Rowanne, who in a short time, have already built a wonderful reputation among locals. Customers have praised the cafe for its excellent coffee, great service and the welcoming atmosphere. Opening early six days a week, Salted Olive Cafe is quickly becoming a favourite morning stop for locals and a relaxed gathering place for friends and families to come together. Small businesses like Salted Olive bring people together and contribute to the sense of community that makes the Mortlake/Breakfast Point area a special place to live. I congratulate Nick, Rowanne and the entire Salted Olive Cafe staff on this exciting new chapter and wish them every success in the years ahead.

ST GEORGE LEAGUES CLUB PHOTOGRAPHIC SOCIETY EXHIBITION

Mr STEPHEN KAMPER (Rockdale—Minister for Lands and Property, Minister for Multiculturalism, Minister for Sport, and Minister for Jobs and Tourism)—I would like to recognise St George Leagues Club Photographic Society for their upcoming Rockdale Plaza Photo Exhibition, running from September 18th to October 2nd. The exhibition will include a diverse collection of photographs featuring scenes from Australia and overseas, including many local photos showcasing the beauty of the St George region. The Society has been part of the Rockdale community for 63 years, serving as a creative hub that brings together amateur and professional photographers. I congratulate St George Leagues Club Photographic Society on hosting the exhibition, and I look forward to seeing it at Rockdale Plaza.

BARDWELL PARK UNITING CHURCH 85TH ANNIVERSARY

Mr STEPHEN KAMPER (Rockdale—Minister for Lands and Property, Minister for Multiculturalism, Minister for Sport, and Minister for Jobs and Tourism)—I would like to recognise Bardwell Park Uniting Church on celebrating its 85th Anniversary on August 23rd, 2026. The Church, which opened on August 23rd, 1941, as the Bardwell Park Methodist Church, has played a significant part in the development and history of Bardwell Park as a suburb over its many years. Back when the church opened, it was a small wooden cottage on a hill overlooking the still mostly rural streets of Bardwell Park. Since then, the church has been rebuilt twice, joined the uniting church in 1977, and has seen whole generations of people grow up and start families while attending services there. Bardwell Park Uniting Church has been a bedrock of the Community in Bardwell Park for over half a century, and no doubt will continue to be for many years to come. I wish all the congregants of Bardwell Park well and congratulate them and their church on this achievement.

NSW RFS, JOHN GORDON - ALBION PARK BRIGADE -45 YEARS DILIGENT SERVICE NATIONAL MEDAL 3RD CLASP

Ms KATELIN McINERNEY (Kiama)—I recognise John Gordon, affectionately known as JG, who joined the NSW Rural Fire Service Albion Park Brigade on 26 February 1980. John has answered countless call-outs across Albion Park and the Illawarra, and has deployed out of area to Grafton, Canberra, Kangaroo Island, Victoria and Western Australia. He has served as Captain from 1992, Deputy Captain from 2000 and Deputy Group Officer from 1998 to 2000. Since 15 July 2011 he has been the respected Group Captain for Group 5 within the Illawarra Sutherland Team. John's commitment has been honoured with the National Medal with first and second clasps, the Canberra Emergency Service Medal, the National Emergency Medal and the Premier's Bushfire Emergency Citation for his Black Summer service. He was made a Life Member of Albion Park in 2018. Such service is a family commitment. I acknowledge John's family, whose time together has so often been given up to call-outs and deployments. Thank you, JG.

LES MILLER, LONG SERVICE MEDAL 2ND CLASP, ALBION PARK BRIGADE

Ms KATELIN McINERNEY (Kiama)—On behalf of our community, I acknowledge the service and dedication of Les Miller of the Albion Park RFS Brigade. Les was awarded the Long Service Medal, 2nd Clasp, for 31 years of diligent service. Les joined the Dunmore Brigade in 1994 and served as Equipment Officer, Welfare Officer, Assistant Training Officer, Training Officer and, for a short time, Brigade Secretary. He was Senior Deputy Captain from 2019 to 2021 and Deputy Captain from 2021 to 2022. He deployed to the significant fires at Grafton, the Shoalhaven and the Bega Valley, and assisted during the major Wollongong floods of 1998. In 2022 Les transferred to Albion Park, stepping up to Deputy Captain, Senior Deputy Captain and, in 2024, Captain, a role he still holds today. His honours include the Long Service Medal first clasp, National Medal first clasp, National Emergency Medal and Premier's Bushfire Citation 2019/20. Three decades of volunteering means countless hours of training, call-outs and time away from home. Les's dedication has kept our community safer in its hardest moments, and we extend our thanks to his family, who enable his incredible service through their support.

KANGAROO VALLEY FOLK FESTIVAL

Ms KATELIN McINERNEY (Kiama)—Congratulations to the dedicated team behind the Kangaroo Valley Folk Festival, who delivered another outstanding event that has become a true jewel in our region's cultural calendar. This year, around 75 acts performed across 13 venues over the weekend, spanning folk, roots and acoustic music, poetry and storytelling. Dancers performing Bush, Contra, Irish, Swing, Scandinavian, Morris and belly dancing- truly there was something for everyone. The festival's contribution reaches well beyond the music. By drawing artists and audiences from near and far, it strengthens our region's reputation as a cultural destination, bringing visitors to local accommodation, cafes, shops and producers, and delivering real economic prosperity to the Valley and the wider Shoalhaven. It also celebrates something deeply human: the folk traditions of storytelling, song and dance that bring people together across generations. Kangaroo Valley, with its beauty and warm community spirit, is a wonderful place to keep those traditions alive. To the organisers, volunteers, performers and supporters, thank you for your extraordinary effort and generosity. On behalf of your community I am proud to recognise your work and congratulate you on another wonderful festival.

CAMERON MASSEY - 20 YEARS AT HAYMANS MAITLAND

Ms JENNY AITCHISON (Maitland—Minister for Roads, and Minister for Regional Transport)—Local business longevity relies on dedicated workers, and congratulations are extended to Cameron Massey on celebrating a remarkable 20 years with Haymans Maitland. What began as a temporary two-month role to relocate from Sydney turned into a two-decade career. Taking on the role of Branch Manager in 2012 at just 25 years of age, Cameron stepped up to lead the team, navigate industry changes, and support local trade customers through both challenging and prosperous years. Over the past 20 years, his steadfast commitment, early starts, and focus on building strong relationships with staff, suppliers, and long-term clients have helped Haymans Maitland grow into a trusted staple for our local electrical and trade industry. Recognising that great local businesses are built on great people, I commend Cameron on reaching this outstanding milestone and thank him for his enduring contribution to Maitland's business community.

LINCOLN JOHNS - AUSCYCLING JUNIOR NATIONAL CHAMPION

Ms JENNY AITCHISON (Maitland—Minister for Roads, and Minister for Regional Transport)—Outstanding achievements in youth sport deserve high praise and congratulations are extended to Maitland High School student Lincoln Johns on his sensational performance at the 2026 AusCycling Junior Road National Championships on the Sunshine Coast. Competing in the Under 15s category against Australia's best young riders, Lincoln claimed 1st place in the Individual Time Trial to be crowned National Champion and earn the prestigious green and gold jersey. He backed up his incredible victory with exceptional grit, securing two 4th place national finishes in both the Criterium and the Road Race. Lincoln's stellar results reflect countless hours of discipline, early morning training, and immense commitment. To achieve national dominance at such a young age is a remarkable accomplishment for both Lincoln and his family, who have no doubt dedicated countless hours to training. I congratulate Lincoln on becoming a National Champion and wish him every success as he continues his promising cycling career.

LOWER HUNTER RFS - LONG SERVICE MEDALS

Ms JENNY AITCHISON (Maitland—Minister for Roads, and Minister for Regional Transport)—The Rural Fire Service is one of our most dedicated and remarkable voluntary services in New South Wales, playing a vital role in protecting regional communities and natural landscapes across our state. At the recent Lower Hunter Medal Presentation, outstanding commitment was recognised across our local brigades. Congratulations go to Bryce Mearns of Lower Hunter Support and Colin Brooker of the Lochinvar Brigade, who both achieved their Long Service Medal 2nd clasp for 30 years of service. Special congratulations to Peter Gifford of Lower Hunter Support, who received his 2nd clasp for an incredible 38 years of dedicated service. These members, along with all award recipients, generously give their time to protect local communities, not only responding to bushfires, but attending road accidents, severe storms, and countless emergencies. Their selfless efforts are carried out without any expectation of reward, and we owe them a great debt of gratitude. Sincere thanks are also extended to the families of our long-serving volunteers. Their steadfast support enables our brigades to step into harm's way for the safety and wellbeing of us all.

KIRRAWEE KANGAROOS FOOTBALL CLUB - PREMIER LEAGUE FIRST GRADE TEAM

Ms ELENI PETINOS (Miranda)—The Kirrawee Kangaroos Football Club has once again proven itself a powerhouse of local football, claiming the Sutherland Shire Football Association's 2026 Premier League First Grade Championship for the second consecutive year! In a thrilling grand final showdown against Caringbah Redbacks FC at the Harrie Denning Centre, the Kangaroos delivered an impressive 4–2 victory to secure back-to-back premierships. This remarkable achievement reflects the talent and teamwork of a side that continues

to set the standard in local football. Behind this incredible success is a team of dedicated local footballers. I recognise the outstanding premiership team namely Nicholas Croucher, Luke Gearin, Jason Joaquim, Ben Natta, Drew Fowler, Deren Taskin, Sean Thomas, Hayden Morton, Tyler Cawston, Andrew Ferizis, Liam Thomas, Benjamin Bullock, Isaac Vincent, Patrick Morales, Benjamin Smith, Joshue Watson, Samuel Boardman and Matthew Macarthur, alongside coach Warren McCarthy. Congratulations to the Kirrawee Kangaroos on back-to-back premiership glory! With two consecutive titles secured, here's to making it a hat-trick in 2027!

SKG SERVICES

Ms ELENI PETINOS (Miranda)—From humble beginnings as a small family business to an industry leader employing more than 1,200 people, SKG Services has built an extraordinary legacy over the past 50 years. Founded in 1975 by Steve and Kathy Manoussakis, SKG Services began with just a handful of family members, built on hard work and a commitment to excellence. Today, the business operates across New South Wales, delivering quality cleaning services while remaining proudly family-owned. What makes this milestone particularly special is the next generation's commitment to carrying forward the values, dedication and vision established by its founders. I pay tribute to the late Steve Manoussakis, whose vision laid the foundations for this remarkable success story. I recognise the Manoussakis family, including Kathy, George, Harley and Jesse, alongside Christopher Barra, CEO Prabin Shrestha and Chairman Niko Mavro, for their dedication and contribution to the business's continued success. Congratulations to the entire SKG Services team on this golden milestone highlighting the enduring strength of family, hard work and a shared vision for the future.

KIRRAWEEN KANGAROOS FOOTBALL CLUB, BILL MCILVEEN MEMORIAL CUP

Ms ELENI PETINOS (Miranda)—The Kirrawee Kangaroos Football Club has once again proven its strength on the field, claiming the Sutherland Shire Football Association's 2026 Bill McIlveen Memorial Cup. Awarded to the best-performing club across the Under 12 to Under 21 competitions, the Cup recognises an outstanding season for the Kangaroos. From the Under 16As reaching the grand final to the Under 21Cs claiming premiership glory, the club's achievements reflect the talent, teamwork and determination of its young players. This prestigious honour is a testament to the collective efforts of teams across all age groups. Behind every successful season are dedicated coaches and managers. I recognise coaches Roy Badawi, Marcus Rose, Ben Wentworth-Perry, Michael Black, Mark Silverthorne, Mark Nayton, Tyler Slattery, Olly Santo, Anthony O'Flynn, Dylan Hyde, Bill Plakias, Robert Bonner, Mitchell Swan and Anthony Bulmer, alongside team managers Jodie Badawi, Sarah Whitton, Xinming Miao, Candida Teremi, Michelle Hurly, Louise Wood, Kate O'Brien, Evan Lowe, Karen Flanagan and Callum Smith. I also acknowledge Executive Committee members Glenn Johnson, Greg Sharkey, Kelly Manna and Mathew Kirby for their tireless commitment. Congratulations to the Kirrawee Kangaroos on this well-deserved recognition and another remarkable season!

ALLEN BUSH - GLENMORE PARK JUNIOR RUGBY LEAGUE

Mrs TANYA DAVIES (Badgerys Creek)—Congratulations to Glenmore Park Brumbies Junior Rugby League Football Club Secretary Allen Bush for his win at the 2026 Penrith District Junior Rugby League Awards night. Allen was honored with the 2026 Panthers Juniors Ian Robinson Volunteer of the Year Award following another successful season for the club. Allen has volunteered in junior sports for more than 50 years, including 18 years with the Glenmore Park Brumbies. The Brumbies were also named the 2026 Panthers Juniors Club of the Year in recognition of the work the club has done to strengthen the local ruby league community. On behalf of my electorate of Badgerys Creek, I would like to thank Allen for giving his time and energy to the Brumbies. Without people like Allen grass-roots sporting clubs would not survive. Well done and thank you.

AMELIA NOBLE-MURRAY

Mrs TANYA DAVIES (Badgerys Creek)—Well done to young Oran Park performer Amelia Noble-Murray on a remarkably successful year, which has included performing on one of Australia's most iconic stages. The talented artist was cast in Opera Australia's 2026 production of Hansel and Gretel at the Sydney Opera House. The production kept her busy, with Amelia playing the role of Bed Tim Girl several times a week over six months. Other highlights were being nominated for the Best Young Talent category at the Australian Club Entertainment (ACE) Awards, an invitation to perform in Vienna, and filming a television commercial to air around Christmas time. Congratulations, Ameilia. I wish you every success in 2027 and beyond.

IVY BECASTRO

Mrs TANYA DAVIES (Badgerys Creek)—Congratulations to young Glenmore Park swimmer Ivy Belcastro on qualifying for the 2026 National Swimming Championships in Melbourne in November. The 10-year-old Year 4 Student at Bethany Catholic Primary School will compete in the Multi Class category representing the state of New South Wales. Ivy was diagnosed with a cyst on her brain at the tender age of one and later diagnosed with hyponotic cerebral palsy. At the time, her family was told she may never walk but at the

age of two Ivy took her first steps. Since then, Ivy has undergone years of intense physiotherapy and hydrotherapy to assist in building her muscle strength. Remarkably, Ivy has not let her health challenges stop her from competing and achieving her swimming goals. On behalf of the Badgerys Creek community, I want to wish Ivy all the very best at the National Championships. In our eyes, she is already a winner.

THE GIN JOINT

Ms ROBYN PRESTON (Hawkesbury)—Mr Speaker, I wish to acknowledge The Gin Joint at Grose Vale for hosting Natalie Claire Jazz Band's "Celebrating the Classics" show on Saturday, 21 March 2026. This intimate venue provided the perfect setting for a memorable evening of vintage swing, jazz standards, tender ballads, and upbeat Latin rhythms, bringing live music and cultural enrichment to the Hawkesbury community. The Gin Joint, under the leadership of Madame Belle, has demonstrated vision and courage in creating a space for live music, offering performers and audiences alike a unique, 1930s-style jazz lounge experience. The venue fostered a connection between the band and the local audience, allowing Natalie Claire and her talented ensemble to perform with spontaneity, improvisation, and warmth - hallmarks of authentic jazz. By welcoming the band to Grose Vale, The Gin Joint supported regional arts, encouraged engagement with live performance, and provided a platform for both emerging and established musicians to showcase their craft. The night was a celebration of music, community, and creativity, highlighting the important role venues like The Gin Joint play in sustaining the cultural life of Hawkesbury. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

DENNIS MITCHELL

Ms ROBYN PRESTON (Hawkesbury)—Mr Speaker, I rise to recognise Mr Dennis Mitchell of the Ebenezer Rural Fire Brigade, who has been honoured for an outstanding 60 years of service with the NSW Rural Fire Service. For six decades, Dennis has dedicated his time and energy to protecting the Hawkesbury community, standing alongside fellow volunteers during emergencies, bushfires and times of great need. His remarkable contribution is a testament to his enduring commitment, courage and willingness to serve others. Like so many members of our RFS, Dennis has never volunteered for recognition or accolades. Instead, he has quietly and consistently given back to his community with humility, reliability and a strong sense of responsibility. Sixty years of service is an extraordinary milestone and reflects the countless hours Dennis has spent supporting his brigade, helping keep his neighbours safe and strengthening the resilience of the Hawkesbury community. I congratulate Dennis on this incredible achievement and thank him for his decades of dedication. His service is an inspiration to all volunteers, and our community is incredibly grateful for the difference he has made. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

MARILYN "MAZ" PEARSON

Ms ROBYN PRESTON (Hawkesbury)—Mr Speaker, I rise to recognise the remarkable contribution of Hawkesbury athletics coach Marilyn "Maz" Pearson of Kurrajong Hills, whose coaching career spans more than four decades. Marilyn is a Level 4 High-Performance Coach who began actively coaching in 1984 and has since guided generations of athletes competing at state, national and international levels. Her athletes have represented Australia at world championships, Commonwealth Games, World University Games, Pacific Games and Pacific School Games. Marilyn was selected as an Australian team coach for the 2003 IAAF World Youth Championships in Canada, reflecting her considerable experience and contribution to Australian athletics. Marilyn has also supported young athletes through injuries and setbacks while building their confidence and discipline. As Marilyn prepares to step away from active coaching, I thank her for her extraordinary dedication to athletics and the generations of young people she has inspired. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

2026 LIVING STORIES WESTERN SYDNEY WRITING PRIZE

Ms DONNA DAVIS (Parramatta)—"Is It True …?, is the associated publication of the 2026 Living Stories Western Sydney Writing Prize. The Prize is supported by WestLit Libraries – Western Sydney Zone Libraries, Arab Bank and Australian Catholic University. The Prize, now in its sixth year, asks writers from across Western Sydney to respond to, in short story or poetry, the theme Is It True … ? The anthology contains the 109 winners and highly commended entries from every local government area from across Western Sydney and the Wingecarribee Shire. It is fantastic to see our region's stories bought to life for all of us to enjoy. A special mention to Parramatta entrant Ashia Chand in the 13-15 years LGA Category for receiving a Highly Commended and to Simon Gross for receiving a Highly Commended in the 18+ years LGA category. It was an honour to read If by Olive van Riel, overall winner of the 2026 10-12 year old category. The event took place at the new home of WestWords, Old Government House, on Friday 17th July. Congratulations to all the entrants, Michael Campbell, Executive Director, and Ally Burnham, Creative Producer, WestWords alongside Board Directors."

THE DOUGHNUT MUM

Ms CHARISHMA KALIYANDA (Liverpool)—I love doughnuts, and some of the best you'll find are right here in Warwick Farm at The Doughnut Mum! This family-run business has been serving up delicious, handcrafted doughnuts since opening its doors in October 2019. At the heart of the business is Lita, the eponymous Doughnut Mum, whose passion for baking has helped turn decades of family experience in the industry into a much-loved local business. It's no wonder that everytime I stop by to pick up some goodies, I run into familiar faces from across our community. But it's not just their delicious doughnuts that make them special. Since opening, Lita and her team have embraced the local community, building friendships and spreading kindness through some challenging times. During the devastating 2019 bushfires, customers even purchased doughnuts and coffees for our hardworking firefighters. Their motto, 'Make Kindness Loud', perfectly captures the community spirit behind this wonderful small business. I congratulate Lita and the team at The Doughnut Mum on their ongoing success and thank them for bringing a little extra sweetness to Warwick Farm.

KIRSTINE GONANO

Ms CHARISHMA KALIYANDA (Liverpool)—I congratulate Kirstine Gonano, current Principal of Liverpool Girls High School, on her appointment as the Foundation Principal of the new Liverpool High School. Kirstine is already a familiar face in our local education community and highly experienced in south-west Sydney, having previously served as principal of Campbelltown Performing Arts High School. Her appointment will provide valuable continuity as Liverpool Girls High School and Liverpool Boys High School prepare to merge in 2028. The new Liverpool High School, currently under construction, will accommodate up to 2,000 students in modern, purpose-built facilities. As Foundation Principal, Kirstine will play an important role in shaping the school's identity, culture and future, while building on the proud traditions and achievements of both schools. I also acknowledge Avryl Queffert, who has stepped into the role of Acting Principal at Liverpool Girls High School during this transition. I look forward to continuing to work with Kirstine as we prepare for this exciting new chapter in public education in Liverpool. Congratulations, Kirstine, on this well-deserved appointment!

NASREEN KAADAN

Ms CHARISHMA KALIYANDA (Liverpool)—I wish to recognise Nasreen Kaadan, an extraordinary Liverpool local whose dedication to improving lives extends from our community to the wider NSW health system. Through her career in epidemiological data and oncology systems, Nasreen has helped improve cancer care and outcomes. Her expertise is contributing to the statewide rollout of NSW Health's Single Digital Patient Record, while her research focuses on improving cancer outcomes for diverse communities. Having lost both her husband and father to lung cancer, Nasreen has channelled personal grief into remarkable community service. In 2019, she ran, walked and cycled an incredible 1,571 kilometres to raise funds for lung cancer research at the Ingham Institute. Nasreen also volunteers as Event Director of Chipping Norton Parkrun, encouraging locals to stay active and connected. I have personally witnessed Nasreen's dedication to motivating others in our community, especially new Parkrun participants. A proud mother of three, Nasreen leads by example, inspiring her children to pursue careers serving others. Recognised with the Order of Liverpool Award in 2024, Nasreen embodies the generosity, resilience and community spirit that make Liverpool special. Thank you for what you do.

WHITE SOX BASEBALL CLUB

Ms SONIA HORNERY (Wallsend)—The competition's oldest, White Sox Baseball Club, 13 times Major First Grade Premiers, is in its 80th season and haven't won a championship in 40 years. Though generating several good opportunities to score, White Sox went down to Mayfield Boomerangs 5-2 in a tight Grand Final contest on Saturday 19 September 2026 at their home field for more than a decade, Plattsburg Park in Wallsend. White Sox finished the regular season in 3rd, beaten by Boomerangs twice during the year with one win and a draw. They came from behind to beat Toronto 8-6 in the last round to qualify for the finals, with an 8-1 win over premiers Belmont in the prelim to make the Grand Final. Back in the 1986 decider, they beat Boomerangs 8-6 and the club missed out on the finals last year. New coach Shane "Bucket" Barclay is trying to re-establish consistency, improving the dynamic of the club. They used to play as veritable nomads around other suburban grounds but look forward to making Plattsburg Park a fortress. Well done on a great season. Looking forward to next year!

UNIVERSITY OF NEWCASTLE FOOTBALL CLUB

Ms SONIA HORNERY (Wallsend)—On Saturday 3 October 2026 at NEX Newcastle Exhibition and Convention Centre, the Newcastle Football Zone Football League celebrated its successful 2026 season and the University of Newcastle Football Club was crowned Club of the Year across both men's and women's football. The Zone League Women's Team of the Year included Goalkeeper of the Year Mia Wallace, midfielder Freya Clifton who won the 2026 Women's Goal of the Year, striker Emma Hooper and defender Maisy Osborne, Captain

of University of Newcastle Football Club Zone Football League Women. In men's football, the Zone League 1 Team of the Year included striker Nicholas Forsyth, also named in Team of the Year. The club is proactive, continually striving for success and working towards a common goal, supporting the association to run a professional and seamless competition. Game days are run well, and any issues are immediately addressed, with action taken where required. The club has also linked with opponents to run wonderful charity days, with the recent Callaghan Cup raising over $9000 for disability Australia. Congratulations on these wonderful achievements!

EDGEWORTH MEMORIAL NEIGHBOURHOOD CENTRE

Ms SONIA HORNERY (Wallsend)—Edgeworth Memorial Neighbourhood Centre (EMNC) is dedicated to supporting young people, families and the wider community across North-West Lake Macquarie, providing a welcoming, inclusive space where people can access support, build connections and participate in community activities and offering food assistance, playgroups, school holiday activities, community events and wellbeing programs. Lauren, Demi and Jess work with community leaders, delivering programs, offering free individualised support and mentoring for young people aged 10-24 to help them build confidence, develop life skills, achieve personal, educational and employment goals, strengthen relationships, manage challenges and connect with the services and resources they need. Senior Constable Zack Hearn from the Morisset Police Youth Command has been working with the EMNC team and other specialty Police, along with community leaders, looking after high-risk boys, mainly 15-16 years old, combating toxic masculinity, working with NSW Health and a dietitian from the University of Newcastle, exploring other pathways besides school for the boys. Senior Constable Hearn believes in being proactive and diverting anti-social behaviours towards building positive relationships and attitudes between community and police. Thank you for your commitment to strengthening our community.

PARRAMATTA PRIDE

Ms DONNA DAVIS (Parramatta)—It was an absolute honour to open the eighteenth year of Parramatta Pride but I've got to say Felicia Foxx was an extraordinarily hard act to follow Parramatta Pride flies the flag for LGBTQIA+ organisations, issues, and people in Western Sydney. Rainbow Labor joined my team and local volunteers to run a stall and show our support for the visibility and celebration of our LGBTQ community in Western Sydney. For too long critical support services for our LGBTQ community have been based in the east, so it is pleasing that Parramatta is now home to the Western Sydney Sexual Health Centre and the Rainbow Sexual, Domestic and Family Violence Helpline. I want to acknowledge all the organisations that have become staples at the Picnic including Boomerang Bags, DV West and Rainbow Cumberland. I thank the NSW Police particularly Bernie Sloane for their ongoing presence at the picnic, and the attendance this year of Bishop Vincent Long with members of the Diocese of Parramatta. Thank you to ACON for your coordinating role and in particular to Gavin Prendergast for making the Pride Picnic happen in such a perfect location, the Rose Garden in Parramatta Park.

JILL STOWELL

Mr TIM CRAKANTHORP (Newcastle)—This month, Newcastle lost one of our most prominent art critics, Jill Stowell. Born and raised in Melbourne, Jill studied History at the University of Melbourne before moving the Germany to pursue her art. Upon returning to Australia, Jill, her husband John, and their family made Newcastle their home. It is around this time that Jill became a founding member of the Newcastle Chamber Music Society, and one of the first Gallery Guides at the Newcastle Art Gallery, a role she held for almost 30 years. In 1985, Jill joined the team at the Newcastle Herald as an art critique. Over her 40 year tenure, she wrote more than 3000 reviews. These reviews tell the story of our region's art history and evolution. Jill's artistic contributions to Newcastle extend beyond her reviews. She most notably curated a 1991 exhibition at the Art Gallery of NSW titles 'Shifting Ground' telling the story of Newcastle's 1989 earthquake. Jill will be remembered for her passion and knowledge of the art world, as well as being an encouraging voice to aspiring regional artists. She will be sorely missed.

MICHAEL PSARRIS

Mr TIM CRAKANTHORP (Newcastle)—Callaghan College has been delivering quality public education to the students of Newcastle and this year, the school is celebrating their 25th anniversary! The 2026 Callaghan College Inspire Awards recognised all the fabulous teachers who have served at the school since its opening in 2001, including Mr Michael Psarris. Public school teachers are the cornerstone of our communities, fostering curiosity, resilience, and lifelong learning in our youngest Novocastrians. 25 years of service is a commendable commitment to shaping future generations and uplifting the entire school community. Congratulations Mr Psarris on 25 years at Callaghan College! Thank you for your service to public education and guiding local students through their schooling.

BRIEN MCVERNON

Mr TIM CRAKANTHORP (Newcastle)—Callaghan College has been delivering quality public education to the students of Newcastle and this year, the school is celebrating their 25th anniversary! The 2026 Callaghan College Inspire Awards recognised all the fabulous teachers who have served at the school since its opening in 2001, including Mr Brien McVernon. Public school teachers are the cornerstone of our communities, fostering curiosity, resilience, and lifelong learning in our youngest Novocastrians. 25 years of service is a commendable commitment to shaping future generations and uplifting the entire school community. Well done Mr McVernon on reaching this impressive milestone and thank for your dedication, your direction, and your care for local students.

DANIEL REDGROVE - AUSTRALIA AGRICULTURE AWARD FINALIST

Mr DAVID LAYZELL (Upper Hunter)—Daniel Redgrove – congratulations on being a New South Wales finalist for the inaugural Australian Agriculture Awards. Daniel is a Singleton dairy farmer - fifth generation of a family proudly farming at Scotts Flat for almost 120-years. He will represent our state at the national awards in Canberra next month as the New South Wales Sustainability in Agriculture finalist. Daniel has introduced machinery to turn waste from washing out the dairy barns into fresh bedding for the cows. Judges commended Daniel for exemplifying the spirit of sustainability by reducing waste, improving the quality of the product and enhancing animal welfare. Upper Hunter wishes Daniel all the best for the Australian Agriculture Awards. I also acknowledge Dan's wife, Sarah, and his parents, John and Allison, for their contributions to this success. Congratulations also to Kristen Nicol of Allynbrook, who was also a finalist in the State Sustainability award. Kristen and husband, Ben, have built their beef cattle business by improving soil health whilst producing high-quality beef. Daniel and Kristen, thank you for shining the spotlight on great work in the Upper Hunter.

THANK YOU TO THE RURAL AID VOLUNTEERS

Mr MICHAEL KEMP (Oxley)—I want to say a big thank you to the Rural Aid volunteers who have come from across Australia to lend a hand to our local farming families. For many Macleay Valley farmers, recovery is still ongoing. Damaged fencing, debris, lost pasture and repairs to farm infrastructure all take time, money and a lot of hard work. That's why the work Rural Aid does is so important. From 19 to 23 October, Rural Aid staff and volunteers are working alongside farmers across ten properties in the Kempsey region, helping with jobs such as fencing, debris removal and water infrastructure. This support is about more than just getting the work done. It's also about giving farmers the chance to connect with others, share a conversation and know their community is standing beside them. I've seen the resilience of our farming families firsthand, and I know how much a helping hand can mean during a long recovery. Thank you to Rural Aid, Allianz Australia and every volunteer who has given their time and energy to support our local farmers. Your generosity is making a real difference across the Macleay.

DORRIGO FOLK AND BLUEGRASS FESTIVAL 2026

Mr MICHAEL KEMP (Oxley)—What started as a small festival at the Dorrigo Showgrounds in 2002 has grown into one of the region's major events, attracting more than 1,000 people from across Australia each year. The Dorrigo Folk & Bluegrass Festival brings together musicians, visitors and locals to celebrate traditional and contemporary folk, bluegrass and acoustic music, while showcasing the creativity and character of the Dorrigo community. The festival offers a mix of local, national and international talent, creating opportunities for musicians to perform, share their skills and connect with audiences. Beyond the music, the festival plays an important role in supporting the local economy, bringing visitors to Dorrigo who support local businesses, food vendors and market stalls. These visitors help showcase the region and contribute to the vitality of our local community. Run entirely by volunteers as a not-for-profit event, the festival is a testament to what a dedicated group of people can achieve when they get behind something they believe in. Congratulations to the organisers, volunteers, performers and supporters who have helped build this much-loved event over the past 24 years and continue to bring people together through music and culture.

LANEWAY FESTIVAL 2026

Mr MICHAEL KEMP (Oxley)—Clyde Street, Kempsey will come alive with music, art, entertainment and activities when the Macleay Laneway Festival brings people together to celebrate the talent and energy of our local young people. The festival gives young people an opportunity to showcase their skills, share their creativity and connect with the wider community, while providing families with a chance to enjoy a day out in Kempsey. From live music, market stalls and a youth street food cook-off to martial arts demonstrations, a youth art exhibition, live street art and a silent disco, there will be plenty happening throughout the event. There are also activities for all ages, including a rock climbing wall, petting zoo, circus playground, face painting and interactive games, making it a great opportunity for families to get involved. Events like the Macleay Laneway Festival also

play an important role in supporting our local economy. Bringing people into town creates opportunities for local businesses, gives young talent a platform to be recognised and helps showcase what the Macleay Valley has to offer. Well done to everyone involved in organising the festival.

ROSE BAY PUBLIC SCHOOL INTERGENERATIONAL ART PROJECT

Ms KELLIE SLOANE (Vaucluse)—I commend Rose Bay Public School on its wonderful Intergenerational Art Project, which paired Year 1 students with local seniors, including people in the early stages of dementia, to create meaningful connections through art. The artworks will be displayed at the school's Art by the Bay fair. The initiative grew out of discussions with Woollahra Council about ways to strengthen the school's connection with the local community, after council research highlighted feelings of loneliness and isolation among older residents. The project has had a profound impact on both the students and the seniors involved, by fostering connection and a sense of belonging across generations. It is a wonderful example of how simple, thoughtful initiatives can bring people together and make a meaningful difference. I commend Rose Bay Public School for embracing this important initiative and demonstrating the power of creativity to build a more connected and inclusive community.

THE SCOTS COLLEGE UNIVERSAL ROBOTICS CHALLENGE WORLD FINAL

Ms KELLIE SLOANE (Vaucluse)—I congratulate the six students from The Scots College who travelled to Osaka in September to represent their school and Australia at the 2026 Universal Robotics Challenge World Final. After months of preparation and training, the students competed against teams from around the world, putting their coding, engineering and problem solving skills to the test. The Python Division team placed 7th in the world, while the Advanced Division team achieved an impressive 14th place finish. Competing at an international level is a valuable opportunity to challenge and develop these skills. I commend the students on their hard work and commitment, and also acknowledge the teachers and coaches who supported them throughout their preparation. The boys should be proud of representing The Scots College and Australia on the world stage, and I wish them every success in their future endeavours.

CLARENCE HARVEST CELEBRATION

Mr RICHIE WILLIAMSON (Clarence)—I congratulate Clarence Harvest Celebration President Allira Robison and her hardworking committee on the outstanding success of the 2026 Clarence Harvest Celebration, which brought thousands of people to Maclean over the June long weekend. Celebrating our beef, sugar cane and seafood industries, the three-day event showcased the best of our region, from Friday's Beef, Beats and Eats featuring the Maclean High School Cattle Show Team, to Saturday's iconic Cane Harvest Festival float parade, with around 100 floats, and Sunday's Clarence River Fest. Congratulations to prawn-peeling competition winner Mark Johnson, Cane Harvest Queen Rhianna McMahon, Cane Harvest Princess Lilly Small, and Mini King and Queen Emily and Oscar. I was also delighted to attend the Clarence Harvest Ball at Yamba Golf and Country Club the weekend before. As one of the judges, I enjoyed seeing eight young women participate in the Queen and Princess quests. The Ball was a spectacular highlight that brought our community together. The success of these events reflects the incredible community spirit, local pride and dedication of the many volunteers, entertainers, participants and supporters who make the Clarence Valley such a special place to live.

ELLA ROSE

Mr RICHIE WILLIAMSON (Clarence)—I congratulate local dancer Ella Rose on qualifying for the World Ballet Crown National Finals in Sydney, an outstanding achievement reflecting her talent, dedication and passion for dance. Ella began dancing at five years old and has worked tirelessly to develop her skills across classical ballet, contemporary, jazz, tap and acrobatics at McAuliffe School of Dance in Casino. Her commitment has seen her accepted into the Prima Youth Classical Academy Affiliate Program and participate in productions with RB Corp Instruction. She has also undertaken workshops with Queensland Ballet Academy and Prima Youth Classical Academy, while receiving additional mentorship to further develop her technique. With aspirations of becoming a professional classical and contemporary dancer, Ella has already received offers from Newcastle Ballet Theatre and Annette Roselli Dance Academy in Brisbane to undertake full-time training. I commend Casino RSM Club for its generous $2,500 sponsorship to help Ella cover travel and competition costs, supporting her pursuit of a professional dance career and her opportunity to represent the Northern Rivers at the national level. I wish Ella every success at the National Finals and in her future dance career.

JAMIE CORKILL 2026

Mr RICHIE WILLIAMSON (Clarence)—Congratulations to Yamba Golf and Country Club Head Professional Jamie Corkill, who has made golfing history after being named the 2026 PGA Queensland Club Professional of the Year. Not only is this an outstanding achievement in its own right, but Mr Corkill has managed to secure the prestigious honour for the second consecutive year, becoming the first professional in the history of

the awards to achieve back-to-back wins. The award recognises excellence across club operations, member services, junior golf development and commitment to the community. This latest honour builds on an extraordinary period of success, following Mr Corkill's recognition as the 2025 PGA National Club Professional of the Year. Mr Corkill's achievements are also a wonderful reflection on Yamba Golf and Country Club and the Clarence community as a whole. His passion, dedication to club members and commitment to developing the next generation of golfers are clearly having an impact well beyond the fairways at Yamba. Mr Corkill will now once again progress to the PGA National Awards, with the opportunity to defend his national title. Congratulations Mr Corkill on this historic achievement. I am sure the entire Clarence community are incredibly proud of your success.

BARB WHITFIELD

Mrs HELEN DALTON (Murray)—Speaker, Today I would like to recognise Barb Whitfield of Moulamein for her many years of service to her community. Barb has been a driving force behind local community welfare projects, bringing people together to improve the lives of others. Her contribution to the local retirement village has been particularly significant. Barb has helped create a welcoming and supportive place where older residents feel valued and connected. She has also given countless hours to Council initiatives, community organisations and volunteer programs. Barb does not wait for someone else to step up. She gets involved and makes things happen. Small towns like Moulamein depend on people like Barb. I thank Barb for her generosity, leadership and service to the people of Moulamein.

RON MORGAN

Mrs HELEN DALTON (Murray)—Speaker, Today I would like to recognise Ron Morgan for 16 years of service as a Community Transport volunteer. In that time, Ron has driven countless people to medical appointments, essential services and social outings, always with a friendly face and a helping hand. He also helps maintain the transport vehicles and volunteers with Meals on Wheels. At his retirement village, Ron has helped bring neighbours together through the White Flag Happy Hour. When the white flag goes up, residents know it is time to gather for a chat and some company. Ron has also spent years helping maintain the back nine at his local golf club. Around 15 years ago, he helped build Heart to Heart in Barmah, a respite home for people recovering from organ transplants. Ron is not one to make a fuss. If something needs doing, he simply gets on with it. I thank Ron for his generosity, kindness and many years of service to his community.

BONDI TO MANLY ULTRA 2026

Mr JAMES GRIFFIN (Manly)—Mr Speaker, this Saturday 24 October is the day of the 2026 Bondi to Manly Ultra, which will see runners tackle a gruelling 80-kilometre journey from Bondi to Manly Beach. Beyond the incredible physical challenge, the event will help to raise critical funds for a range of worthy causes. One of the largest participating groups will be running in support of Cure SCN2A, a charity established by local parents Mel and Scott Tindal in honour of their son Jack, who lives with the rare genetic condition. Mel and Scott have done an incredible job raising awareness and funds to accelerate research towards a treatment for SCN2A, with their community already helping them raise $500,000 towards their goal. The funds will help progress critical research and preclinical testing needed to move Jack closer to treatment. I look forward to getting out there alongside the other runners and encourage everyone to get behind the event and donate where they can to the many important causes being supported, including Cure SCN2A. Bondi might be hosting the start line, but Manly has the finish line, and I know which one I'd rather be at.

FRIENDS OF NARRABEEN LAGOON CATCHMENT

Ms JACQUI SCRUBY (Pittwater)—Since 2005, Friends of Narrabeen Lagoon Catchment have been dedicated guardians of our precious bushland, waterways and wildlife. Under the leadership of outgoing President Ron Patton and newly elected President Jacqui Marlow, alongside dedicated members including Conny Harris, Judith Bennett, Ann Sharp and Joanne Drewett, the organisation continues to make an extraordinary contribution to environmental conservation. Their achievements include advocating for the $1.9 million Urban Sustainability Grant in 2007, supporting rehabilitation of Middle, Mullet and Nareen Creeks, and championing the protection of wildlife corridors and threatened species habitats. Their volunteers undertake regular bush regeneration at Belrose and Wheeler Creek, removing invasive weeds and restoring native vegetation. The group has also organised 64 community forums, alongside educational bushwalks and eco-paddles, sharing knowledge about biodiversity, Aboriginal heritage, sustainable development and the health of Narrabeen Lagoon. In 2021, their efforts were recognised with Northern Beaches Council's Caring for Our Waterways Eco Award. Their tireless advocacy, scientific research and hands-on conservation work demonstrate the importance of community-led environmental stewardship. Pittwater thanks every member and volunteer for their extraordinary commitment to protecting Narrabeen Lagoon for future generations.

ANGUS GORDON, OAM

Ms JACQUI SCRUBY (Pittwater)—Angus Gordon OAM has dedicated more than five decades to coastal engineering, environmental management and public service, making an extraordinary contribution to Pittwater, Australia and communities around the world. A North Narrabeen local, Angus served as General Manager of Pittwater Council from 1996 to 2005, helping shape the management and future of our local area. His expertise has taken him across Australia and internationally, working on coastal engineering and environmental projects in Brunei, Dubai, Kuwait, Indonesia, Hong Kong and New Zealand. He has published more than 90 technical papers and contributed to significant coastal management legislation in NSW. Angus helped establish the NSW Beach Improvement Program in 1976, contributed to the Coastal Protection Act 1979 and later helped develop the Coastal Management Act 2016. He also served as Chair of the NSW Coastal Panel and advised on international climate change research. In 2018, Angus received the Medal of the Order of Australia for his service to environmental management, planning and the community. Despite his international achievements, Angus remains a passionate advocate for protecting Pittwater's unique coastal environment. His lifetime of expertise, leadership and service is an extraordinary contribution to our community.

DUFFY'S FOREST RESIDENT ASSOCIATION

Ms JACQUI SCRUBY (Pittwater)—For more than 60 years, the Duffy's Forest Residents Association has been looking after one of Pittwater's best-kept secrets, a peaceful, rural escape that feels a world away from Sydney, despite being right on its doorstep. Established on 1 June 1965, the Association began by campaigning for the basics – electricity, roads, water and telephone lines. But its greatest legacy has been protecting the bushland, rural charm and unique character that make Duffy's Forest so special. Under the leadership of the Executive Committee, Richard Smallwood, Angus MacIlraith, Wendy Smallwood and David Harris that community spirit continues today. From advocating for bushland adjoining Ku-ring-gai Chase National Park and restoring the historic Duffy's Wharf track, to supporting the protection of Waratah Park, the Association has helped safeguard some of the area's most treasured places. It has also championed the Anembo Reserve and Kinka Reserve horse arenas and the Community Bridle Path along Booralie and Thuddungra Roads, helping preserve the area's proud equestrian traditions. Duffy's Forest hasn't stayed beautiful by accident. It has taken generations of passionate locals standing up for the place they love. Pittwater thanks every Association member, past and present, for keeping Duffy's Forest special.

UNWANTED FC GREENWOOD PLAZA

Ms FELICITY WILSON (North Shore)—Brothers Kevin and Keith Chan are giving are transforming unwanted fashion items into sustainable football clothing. I congratulate the brothers for opening Unwanted FC storefront at Greenwood Plaza in North Sydney, celebrating their entrepreneurial spirit and commitment to sustainable fashion. Founded online in 2018, Unwanted FC grew from the brothers' lifelong passion for football kits and a desire to reduce fashion waste. By transforming discarded jerseys into caps, outerwear and accessories, Kevin and Keith have demonstrated how creativity and innovation can give unwanted materials a new life. Their new storefront also serves as a creative studio and learning environment where customers can explore upcycled fashion, trade football kits and discover the principles of circular design. Alongside fellow sustainable start-up Swap in the City, Unwanted FC is helping establish Greenwood Plaza as a destination for innovative, environmentally conscious local businesses. I congratulate Kevin and Keith on this exciting milestone and commend their contribution to small business, sustainability, and innovation in North Sydney. I wish them and the entire Unwanted FC team every success as they continue to grow their business and inspire the community to think differently about fashion and waste.

GROOM CLUB

Ms FELICITY WILSON (North Shore)—It is a pleasure to congratulate Groom Club on being named the 2026 North Shore Local Business Award winner in the Pet Care category. For many families across the North Shore, pets are an important part of everyday life, and businesses that care for them provide a service that is built on trust. Groom Club has developed a strong reputation by placing the safety, comfort and wellbeing of the animals in its care at the heart of its approach. Professional grooming requires not only technical skill, but patience, understanding and a genuine commitment to animal welfare. Groom Club's focus on creating a positive experience for pets, while providing reassurance and communication to their owners, demonstrates the value of a truly customer-focused local service. This award is recognition of the care, professionalism and dedication shown by the Groom Club team. I warmly congratulate everyone involved on this well-deserved achievement and thank them for the important contribution they make to local families and their pets. Groom Club is a wonderful example of a local business that combines professional expertise with genuine compassion and community connection.

NORTH SHORE BOMBERS

Ms FELICITY WILSON (North Shore)—I congratulate the North Shore Bombers Australian Football Club for the extraordinary achievement of winning back-to-back AFL Sydney Premier Division premierships in both the women's and men's competitions. On 19 September, the men's side defeated the Manly Warringah Wolves 104 to 66 to secure their third consecutive premiership, while the women's side defeated Sydney University by 10 points to successfully defend their title. I acknowledge the contribution of the coaching staff, including men's co-coaches Ryan Meldrum and Daniel Roberts, and women's coach Craig Tidemann, whose leadership helped guide their teams to success. This historic achievement made the North Shore Bombers the first club to win both AFL Sydney Premier Division titles in consecutive years. The club also claimed the men's and women's Division 1 premierships, capping off a remarkable season. These successes reflect far more than talent on the field. They are built on the dedication of players, coaches, volunteers, families and supporters who contribute countless hours throughout the season to help their club thrive. I congratulate everyone involved with the North Shore Bombers on this outstanding achievement.

SUE DICK

Mr MARK COURE (Oatley)—Speaker, I rise today to congratulate Sue Dick from Lugarno Football Club on being named the 2026 Football St George Gold Medal winner. This prestigious recognition celebrates Sue's longstanding contribution to local football and everything she has given to Lugarno Football Club and the wider Football St George community. Sue has a deep and lifelong passion for the game. Through her leadership at Lugarno FC, she has worked tirelessly to strengthen the club and has been a particularly strong supporter of female football. Grassroots sporting clubs depend on dedicated people like Sue, who give their time, energy and experience to create opportunities for others. Her commitment has helped players of all ages enjoy the game, feel supported and become part of a strong local sporting community. This award is a fitting recognition of Sue's many years of service, leadership and passion for football. I congratulate Sue on receiving the 2026 Football St George Gold Medal and thank her for her outstanding contribution to Lugarno FC and football across the St George region.

ANDREW TOTMAN AND ROWLAND REYES MARTINEZ

Mr MARK COURE (Oatley)—Speaker, I rise today to congratulate Andrew Totman of Heavy Pressure Studio and Rowland Reyes Martinez on being selected for Georges River Council's 2027 Community Art Space program. Their work will be exhibited at the Dragon's Lair Gallery at Hurstville Museum & Gallery, providing members of our community with the opportunity to experience and enjoy their creativity. This is an outstanding achievement, particularly following a record number of applications and an exceptionally high standard of exhibition proposals. Artists make a valuable contribution to our community. Through their creativity, they tell stories, encourage new ideas and help people see the world from different perspectives. I congratulate Andrew and Rowland on their successful selection and look forward to seeing their work exhibited in Hurstville during 2027. I wish them every success with their upcoming exhibitions.

BUS STOP FILMS

Mr MARK COURE (Oatley)—Speaker, I rise today to congratulate local organisation Bus Stop Films on receiving a $20,000 grant from the CommBank Staff Foundation. Based in South Hurstville, Bus Stop Films creates opportunities for people with disability to learn about filmmaking and build meaningful careers in the screen industry. This funding will support the creation of 22 inclusive films, giving participants the opportunity to develop their skills, build confidence and share their stories with audiences. Since it was established in 2009, Bus Stop Films has grown from one Sydney program into an organisation delivering accessible filmmaking programs across Australia. Its success shows what can be achieved when people are given the right support and the opportunity to demonstrate their talents. I particularly the dedicated staff, filmmakers and supporters who make these programs possible. I congratulate everyone at Bus Stop Films on receiving this well-deserved funding and thank the CommBank Staff Foundation for supporting this fantastic local organisation.

INDIANS IN SYDNEY GALA DINNER

Mr JIHAD DIB (Bankstown—Minister for Customer Service and Digital Government, Minister for Emergency Services, and Minister for Youth Justice)—On Monday, 31 August, Indians in Sydney celebrated their annual Gala Dinner, a night that brought together the Indian Australian community, championed multiculturalism, and celebrated the India's 80th Independence Day. The evening was a colourful celebration of culture; dance, food, music, and languages filled the room. I was proud to be amongst a vibrant community and am honoured to have joined Founder Nadeem Ahmed amongst other members of parliament, diplomats, community leaders, business representatives, volunteers and families. It made me smile when I learned that Indians in Sydney started out in 2007 as an online community, a Facebook Group, aimed at helping newly arrived

migrants settle into their new environment. What's incredible is its growing legacy, with over 139,000 members across NSW. This is a testament to grassroots connection, to unity, aspirations to belong while holding onto heritage and tradition. Multiculturalism is about our communities living in harmony, and I would say it's also a choice. A choice to accept differences, a choice to trust, and the courageous act to stand in what makes us unique. I thank Nadeem Ahmed, staff and volunteers for bringing people together to celebrate Indian culture.

ST JOHN VIANNY CATHOLIC PRIMARY SCHOOL - COMMUNITY BUILDING PARTNERSHIP

Mr JIHAD DIB (Bankstown—Minister for Customer Service and Digital Government, Minister for Emergency Services, and Minister for Youth Justice)—I recently had the pleasure of visiting St John Vianney Catholic Primary School in Greenacre to see the school's new hydro bank, built with support from the NSW Government's Community Building Partnership program. The new hydro bank provides students with convenient access to multiple drinking fountains, helping them stay hydrated throughout the school day. Whether they're learning in the classroom or playing on the playground, investments like this support student wellbeing and early water education. It was also wonderful to see Indigenous artwork incorporated into the hydro bank. The artwork adds an important cultural element to the space and provides an opportunity for students to engage with and develop an appreciation for Aboriginal culture and connection to Country as part of their everyday school environment. The project is a welcome addition to St John Vianney. I would like to thank Mr Andrew Benfield for taking the time to show me around the school and the new hydro bank, and to everyone involved in bringing the project to life. Congratulations to the entire St John Vianney Catholic Primary School community!

RIVERWOOD SPRING FESTIVAL

Mr JIHAD DIB (Bankstown—Minister for Customer Service and Digital Government, Minister for Emergency Services, and Minister for Youth Justice)—I recently had the pleasure of joining our community at the 2026 Riverwood Spring Festival, which was a wonderful celebration of the people, cultures, and connections that make our community so vibrant. It was fantastic to see people from all over our Bankstown electorate, come together and create a welcoming atmosphere where everyone could come together to share food, music and culture. The Spring Festival was an important reminder that our neighbourhoods are strongest when people have opportunities to come together, build relationships and celebrate the diversity that makes our community unique. The energy throughout the day was a reflection of the strong community spirit that exists in the Bankstown Electorate. Thank you to Chairperson, Pauline Gallagher OAM and CEO Karl Saleh OAM for their leadership and tireless work in bringing this festival to life. I also extend my thanks to the dedicated board, staff and volunteers at Riverwood Community Centre, whose commitment and hard work helped make the day such a success. It was wonderful to join our community for such a meaningful celebration. Thank you to everyone who contributed, participated, and helped create a day filled with connection, culture, and community spirit.

MINISTERS AWARDS FOR WOMEN IN LOCAL GOVERNMENT

Ms LIZA BUTLER (South Coast)—I am incredibly proud to recognise three exceptional women from Shoalhaven City Council who have been honoured at the 2026 Ministers' Awards for Women in Local Government. Congratulations to Keira Whitford, recognised in the Rising Star category, Katie Buckman, recognised in the Woman of Distinction category, and Amanda Crangle, recognised for Excellence in Mentoring and Sponsorship. These prestigious awards celebrate the remarkable contributions women make to local government and the leadership, dedication and passion they bring to serving their communities. Having three outstanding women from Shoalhaven City Council recognised at the state level is a wonderful achievement and a proud moment for our entire South Coast community. Each of these women is helping to create positive change, inspire others and strengthen the future of local government. Congratulations Keira, Katie and Amanda. Thank you for your outstanding contributions to our community and for being such wonderful role models for women across the Shoalhaven and beyond.

CENTRAL COAST COMPASSIONATE CARE

Mr DAVID HARRIS (Wyong—Minister for Aboriginal Affairs and Treaty, Minister for Gaming and Racing, Minister for Veterans, Minister for Medical Research, and Minister for the Central Coast)—Congratulations to Central Coast Compassionate Care from Wyong for being a finalist for Excellence in Medium Business and Outstanding Employee Tania Baldwin at the 2026 Business NSW Central Coast Awards. Central Coast Compassionate Care are passionate about providing comprehensive in-home care, personalised NDIS support, disability support, personal care, community access, social support across the Central Coast region with support workers and care managers residing locally. Founder and Director Ashleigh Bate has 15 years of experience across the disability and community services sector. Ms Bate founded Central Coast Compassionate Care with a commitment to providing person-centred support built on dignity, choice and genuine connection. Her focus is on creating a service where individuals feel respected, supported and empowered to maintain independence and achieve their goals. The Excellence in Medium Business Award recognises a business with

21-99 employees that has effectively driven growth and can demonstrate the specific strategies implemented to achieve business success or resilience. The Outstanding Employee Award recognises an inspirational employee who has demonstrated a passion for their role and a commitment to their workplace and the community. I wish Central Coast Compassionate Care all the best in the upcoming Business NSW State Awards.

FROCKIN' THE OUTBACK

Mr DAVID HARRIS (Wyong—Minister for Aboriginal Affairs and Treaty, Minister for Gaming and Racing, Minister for Veterans, Minister for Medical Research, and Minister for the Central Coast)—I would like to recognise Frockin' The Outback an Iris Foundation initiative working alongside local providers to deliver clothing, essential items and connection to women across regional NSW. The project was co-ordinated by three dedicated Iris volunteers Paula Hardwick, Elisha Winship and Vickie Johnston. Recently, the organisation travelled 1,750 kilometres through five regional NSW communities, Coonamble, Narrabri, Moree, Tamworth and Gunnedah while working alongside six service providers and directly supported 385 women. More than 3,000 items of clothing, bags and accessories, together with 750 packets of sanitary products, reached women who were facing financial pressure, domestic and family violence, homelessness, disability, isolation and other difficult circumstances. What mattered most was not simply what was handed out. It was the laughter in the room, the relief of receiving something genuinely useful, the conversations that began, and local services standing close by when a woman was ready for further support. The project was successful with their committed volunteers, community supporters, donations including clothing, sanitary products and funds and positive feedback from the regional communities. Frockin' The Outback are ready to travel again. Recently, Frockin' The Outback is nominated for Volunteer Group of the Year at the Central Coast awards.

TANIA BALDWIN

Mr DAVID HARRIS (Wyong—Minister for Aboriginal Affairs and Treaty, Minister for Gaming and Racing, Minister for Veterans, Minister for Medical Research, and Minister for the Central Coast)—Congratulations to Tania Baldwin Central Coast Compassionate Care from Wyong for being a finalist for Outstanding Employee at the 2026 Business NSW Central Coast Awards. Central Coast Compassionate Care are passionate about providing comprehensive in-home care, personalised NDIS support, disability support, personal care, community access, social support across the Central Coast region with support workers and care managers residing locally. Central Coast resident Ms Baldwin is a dedicated and compassionate support worker who genuinely cares about the people she supports. She represents what Central Coast Compassionate Care is all about, compassion, kindness, respect, dedication and putting people first. Founder and Director from Central Coast Compassionate Care is proud of Ms Baldwin of her dedication and care she brings everyday to support her clients and families. The Outstanding Employee Award recognises an inspirational employee who has demonstrated a passion for their role and a commitment to their workplace and the community. I wish Tania Baldwin all the best in the upcoming Business NSW State Awards on Friday, 30th October.

ASHANTI ATALLAH

Ms ANNA WATSON (Shellharbour)—I would like to congratulate Ashanti Atallah on her selection for a 2026 Illawarra Academy of Sport scholarship in Girls Rugby Sevens. Her selection is a testament to her dedication, determination and passion for rugby. Being chosen for the Academy is a significant achievement and recognises the talent and commitment each athlete has demonstrated. The Illawarra Academy of Sport provides valuable support to emerging athletes, helping them develop their skills while preparing them for future opportunities in elite sport. I congratulate Ashanti on this well-deserved recognition and wish her every success in the future.

INDIE BRAMSTEDT

Ms ANNA WATSON (Shellharbour)—I would like to congratulate Indie Bramstedt on her selection for a 2026 Illawarra Academy of Sport scholarship in Girls Rugby Sevens. Her selection is a testament to her dedication, determination and passion for rugby. Being chosen for the Academy is a significant achievement and recognises the talent and commitment each athlete has demonstrated. The Illawarra Academy of Sport provides valuable support to emerging athletes, helping them develop their skills while preparing them for future opportunities in elite sport. I congratulate Indie on this well-deserved recognition and wish her every success in the future.

LAYLA BRAMSTEDT

Ms ANNA WATSON (Shellharbour)—I would like to congratulate Layla Bramstedt on her selection for a 2026 Illawarra Academy of Sport scholarship in Girls Rugby Sevens. Her selection is a testament to her dedication, determination and passion for rugby. Being chosen for the Academy is a significant achievement and recognises the talent and commitment each athlete has demonstrated. The Illawarra Academy of Sport provides

valuable support to emerging athletes, helping them develop their skills while preparing them for future opportunities in elite sport. I congratulate Layla on this well-deserved recognition and wish her every success in the future.

ARMENIAN GENOCIDE COMMEMORATION

Dr HUGH McDERMOTT (Prospect)—On Tuesday 15th September 2026, I was honoured to represent the New South Wales Government, to join in prayer with our resilient Armenian Australian community and lay a wreath at the Annual Armenian Genocide Commemoration in Parliament. More than 1.5 million Armenians perished in the Armenian Genocide of 1915 to 1923. Held each year since 1996, the Commemoration is a tribute to this Parliament's recognition of the Genocide, the first legislative body in Australia to do so. Today, the children and descendants of Armenian Genocide survivors are part of our thriving multicultural New South Wales, contributing immensely to the harmony and prosperity of our State. As Co-Chair of the Parliamentary Friends of Armenia, I am proud to continue standing with our Armenian-Australians in Prospect Electorate and throughout New South Wales. The Khachkar, or traditional Armenian stone commemorative cross, is a symbol of Christian faith, endurance and permanent witness. It is a fitting tribute as we renew our call for justice. Thank you, Vache Kahramanian, Chair, Sebastian Majarian, Political Affairs Director, Armenian National Committee for coordinating this important event, and Fr Avedis for leading us in prayer. I demand justice for the victims of the Armenian Genocide.

THE MEADOWS PUBLIC SCHOOL - FLAG PRESENTATION

Dr HUGH McDERMOTT (Prospect)—On Friday 16th October 2026, I had the pleasure of presenting a new Australian Flag, First Nations Flags and New South Wales State Flag to students and staff at The Meadows Public School. Situated in Seven Hills, The Meadows Public School was established in 1890 and is an historic centre of public education in Prospect Electorate. Established with just 15 students over a century ago, today The Meadows is home to more than 300 students from Kindergarten to Year 6, including an estimated 70 percent of students from a language background other than English, a living celebration of our diverse Western Sydney community. I was thrilled to meet and speak with 2026 School Captains and student leaders for the presentation, to listen to their unique perspectives and learn how they help their fellow students to explore our shared identity and symbols. It was wonderful to present the school's new flags to these model students and emerging leaders. Thank you Daphne Constantinou, Principal and all our dedicated teachers, staff and parents across The Meadows Public School community, for your warm welcome and for your steadfast support for our local students and young learners.

DAMIAN LLOYD KAYAK RESCUE

Ms MARYANNE STUART (Heathcote)—I recognise the courageous acts of Damian Lloyd, Life Member of Coalcliff Surf Life Saving Club, who, supported by Barry Allen and Ryan Thew from Coalcliff SLSC and Guy Ezzeddine and Karl Weber from Helensburgh-Stanwell Park SLSC, rescued a kayak fisherman off Coalcliff Beach on 14 July 2026. Strong westerly winds had carried the kayaker kilometres out to sea from Stanwell Park Beach, prompting distress calls and a Surf Life Saving NSW emergency call-out. The volunteers responded aboard SLS Illawarra's Support Ski One. Damian entered the wild seas with only a rough idea of the kayaker's location, describing the search as "like looking for a needle in a haystack." Once he found the kayaker, Damian held the kayak alongside the jet ski driving slowly into the swell and wind, bringing him safely back to Coalcliff Beach. Damian's bravery, skill and selfless dedication saved a life that day. His actions inspire others to support Surf Life Saving NSW, helping keep the community safe and connected. To Damian and everyone involved, thank you for your courage and commitment.
